FOR CONSTRUCTION OPERATIVES

CSCS

HEALTH, SAFETY & ENVIRONMENT TEST PREPARATION

2026 – 2027

The Complete Operatives Revision Guide to Site Safety Laws and Hazards, with 1,000 Practice Questions, 20 Full-Length Mock Tests and Detailed Answer Explanations

1,000 QUESTIONS • 20 MOCK TESTS • DETAILED ANSWERS
REAL-WORLD SITE SCENARIOS • ONLINE TEST SIMULATOR • FLASHCARDS

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Introduction to the Bonus Practice Tests

This PDF contains Practice Tests 8–20, provided as a companion to your printed study guide. Together, they give you more opportunities to practise the questions and review the topics covered in the book.

Work through each test before checking the answer key. When you mark your answers, take time to review the questions you missed and understand why the correct option is right. Return to those topics in the study guide, then try another test to check your progress.

You can use these tests throughout your revision or save some for the final stage of your preparation. Aim to improve your understanding with each attempt, rather than simply memorising the answers.

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PRACTICE TEST 8

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A man buys a terraced house to let out and pays one builder to refit its kitchen and bathroom before the first tenants arrive. He says he is a domestic client because he owns the house personally, so the builder holds his client duties. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** He is a domestic client because the house is in his own name, so the single builder takes on his client duties automatically under CDM 2015

☐ **B)** He is a commercial client but may pass every client duty to the builder verbally, because a single contractor can take on the role

☐ **C)** Work done for a letting business makes him a commercial client, so he keeps the full client duties and cannot hand them to the builder

☐ **D)** He becomes a commercial client only once tenants have moved in, so until then the builder carries the client duties as a default

2. A profoundly deaf labourer joins a yard where reversing loaders and telehandlers work all day. The supervisor decides to keep him on the cabin side of the fence, away from the vehicles, rather than discuss the job with him. Which approach is the soundest?

☐ **A)** Keep him on cabin duties permanently, because excluding him from vehicle areas removes the hazard and is the safest way to meet the law

☐ **B)** Use the standard yard assessment unchanged, because he would carry the same legal duties as everyone else and should rely on spotting vehicles

☐ **C)** Give him a hi-vis jacket and a buddy for the first week, and leave the assessment unchanged if no incident has occurred by then

☐ **D)** Assess the risks for his actual tasks with him, then adjust the work, for example with separated routes, visual alerts and a banksman

3. A site architect who uses a wheelchair will attend weekly meetings in a first-floor cabin reached by a stair. The manager says the standard alarm and assembly point are enough, and that colleagues will carry her down in an emergency. What is the best way to deal with her evacuation?

☐ **A)** Rely on the existing site fire plan, since an alarm and a marked assembly point apply equally to every person on the site

☐ **B)** Agree a personal evacuation plan with her, covering the route, any equipment and trained helpers, and test it before she attends

☐ **C)** Ask her to use the passenger hoist on the cabin block when the alarm sounds, as it is the quickest way to reach the ground

☐ **D)** Let two colleagues carry her down by whatever grip is quickest, because speed matters most and the fire service can take over outside

4. At a weekly check, the supervisor finds a cabin extinguisher with its gauge needle in the red and its seal missing. A new labourer who has never been shown how to use one offers to swap it for a spare and use it if there is a fire. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Allow the labourer to use the spare on his own initiative, as the instructions on the label are enough for anyone to use it

☐ **B)** Take the faulty unit out of service for a competent person to deal with, and have anyone expected to use extinguishers shown how first

☐ **C)** Leave it in place until the annual service falls due, because a unit that is still hanging on its bracket gives some cover

☐ **D)** Let the supervisor release a short test burst to check it, then refit the seal himself and hang it back on the bracket

5. A contractor must buy two compressors for a six-month demolition job. Supplier A offers a cheaper unit with no canopy and a high noise declaration, supplier B a canopied unit with a much lower one. The manager prefers A and plans to fence off

the area and issue ear defenders. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Choose the cheaper unit, as ear defenders are legally acceptable for any machine once the exclusion zone is fenced and signed

☐ **B)** Choose the cheaper unit and fit a plywood screen beside it, which will bring the noise down to a safe level for the whole crew

☐ **C)** Prefer the quieter canopied unit, since cutting noise at source comes before hearing protection, and check its output on delivery

☐ **D)** Choose the cheaper unit, because noise controls are not needed until the daily exposure of the crew is above the upper action value

6. Labourers tip 25 kg bags of cement from a pallet onto a mixer, tearing each bag open and shaking out the last of it. Dust hangs around the mixer and two of them have sore backs. Which change deals best with both problems?

☐ **A)** Rotate the labourers every hour so that nobody lifts too many bags, and spray water over the dust cloud around the mixer

☐ **B)** Use pre-mixed material or smaller bags delivered at waist height, and open and empty each bag low and gently into the mixer

☐ **C)** Have two people lift each bag and shake it out vigorously, with both wearing a disposable mask and the pallet left at ground level

☐ **D)** Issue back support belts and basic dust masks to all labourers, then carry on as before, since protection covers both risks

7. A fit-out crew hire a 4 m mobile tower for ceiling work. The foreman, who built towers from another maker's kit years ago, plans to erect this one from memory, fitting the guardrails last. The manual is still in the delivery bag. What is correct?

☐ **A)** Let the foreman build it from memory but fit the guardrails afterwards, since the top guardrails protect the person working at the top

☐ **B)** Let the crew build it and inspect it at the end of the first week, since the hire company has already checked every part before delivery

☐ **C)** Have trained and competent people erect it following this maker's manual, with guardrails fitted as it rises, and inspect it before first use

☐ **D)** Allow the foreman to erect it, since experience with another maker's tower is enough because aluminium towers are generally assembled alike



8. Look at the mobile tower in use. Which problem is the most significant?

☐ **A)** He is not clipped to the tower with a harness, which is needed on a tower platform whatever the guardrails

☐ **B)** The cordless drill is held overhead, which is the real hazard because it makes the tower unstable when the bit bites

☐ **C)** The castors are unbraked and no outriggers are fitted, so the whole tower is free to roll or tip while he works

☐ **D)** The operative has raised himself on crates, so the guardrails no longer protect him and the tower is less stable

9. Two operatives must lift a heavy cast-iron cover in the nearside lane of a busy road. One has a crowbar, the other proposes dropping a single cone and lifting between passing vehicles while a colleague watches the traffic. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Set up signed and coned traffic management first, then lift with a purpose-made lifting key or mechanical aid

☐ **B)** Lift with the crowbar and two operatives using good posture, since the single cone and a lookout adequately cover the traffic risk

☐ **C)** Time the lift for a gap in the traffic and work quickly, because a short exposure means the road risk is acceptably low

☐ **D)** Pull the cover with a gloved grip at the edge while kneeling beside it, as gloves protect the hands from being crushed

10. To reach a high soffit, a contractor wants two operatives to

ride in a site-made steel cage fitted to the forks of a telehandler. The driver is experienced and says the machine is well within its capacity. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The lift is acceptable if the operatives wear full harnesses attached to the cage, which then prevents any fall from height

☐ **B)** The lift is acceptable because the combined weight of the cage and operatives is below the rated capacity, and the driver is experienced

☐ **C)** The lift is acceptable for short tasks of under an hour, since the extra risk to the operatives grows with the time spent in the cage

☐ **D)** The machine is built for loads, so lifting people is for exceptional circumstances, and a purpose-designed platform or MEWP is safer

11. A self-employed builder hires a self-employed electrician for one day to run cables in a loft the builder has worked in all week. The builder knows several boards are rotten but says, "He is his own boss, so his safety is his problem." Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The builder controls the loft, so he must warn the electrician about the rotten boards and coordinate the work, while the electrician remains responsible for his own methods and tools

☐ **B)** The electrician alone is responsible, because a self-employed person hired by the day accepts every risk of the premises as part of his agreed day rate and own look-out

☐ **C)** Duties towards people who are not employees apply only to jobs lasting longer than one day, so a single day of hire leaves the builder with no legal duty to him

☐ **D)** Neither tradesperson has an employer, so no health and safety duty arises between them and any responsibility rests with whoever owns the property being worked on

12. A roadworker has signed an opt-out from the 48-hour weekly working limit. His supervisor rosters him for six 11-hour night shifts every week for the next two months, saying the opt-out covers it. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The opt-out covers only the weekly limit, and night workers cannot opt out of the 8-hour average in 24 hours, so this roster breaches the night rule

☐ **B)** The opt-out also removes the night limit, provided the employer pays a night premium and confirms the roster in writing at the start of every single week

☐ **C)** The 8-hour night figure is a guideline for workers with special hazards, so an ordinary road crew can be rostered well beyond it by agreement with the employer

☐ **D)** Eleven-hour shifts are lawful as long as each is followed by at least 11 hours of rest, because daily rest is the one limit that really matters for night work

13. After four hours digging in cold rain, a labourer is soaked, drowsy, confused and slurring his words. A colleague suggests sending him to the cabin alone for a hot shower. What is the most appropriate action while help is called?

☐ **A)** Add extra layers over his wet clothing and let him carry on digging, since heat from steady exercise will bring his body temperature back up

☐ **B)** Rub his arms and legs briskly to restore circulation and give him a small measure of spirits to warm him from the inside quickly

☐ **C)** Call 999, move him to shelter, remove his wet clothing, wrap him warmly including his head, and stay with him talking until help comes

☐ **D)** Let him take a hot shower to rewarm quickly, then rest unobserved so he can recover in privacy, calling help only if he is no better later



14. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the operative is properly protected because he has a hard hat, glasses, a mask, ear defenders and gloves. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** A half mask and glasses cannot cope with rebounding grit and fine dust, so he needs a supplied-air blasting helmet.

☐ **B)** Cotton overalls are the weak point, because leather aprons would offer better protection from the rebounding grit and the heat.

☐ **C)** Ear defenders should be replaced with earplugs, because defenders cannot seal properly against the hard hat brim in this noise.

☐ **D)** Leather gauntlets should be fitted with grip-assist coatings so the nozzle hose cannot be dropped during the blasting task.

15. A banksman works beside a block-cutting saw at about 92 dB(A) among reversing dumpers. He keeps lifting his ear defenders off whenever a vehicle moves, to hear the alarms. What is the best way to resolve this?

☐ **A)** Fit louder alarms on all the dumpers so they cut through the defenders, as the noise regulations cover only the equipment that the banksman himself personally uses

☐ **B)** Choose protectors giving roughly 70 to 85 dB at the ear, have him wear them throughout, and add visual warnings and segregation so alarms are not the only cue

☐ **C)** Issue the lowest-rated plugs available so the alarms stay clear, since once any hearing protection has been handed out the employer's duty to protect is met

☐ **D)** Let him lift them off when a vehicle comes within about ten metres, because such short removals add very little to his exposure and the alarm is the main vehicle warning

16. A new concrete ramp rises 1.5 m to a first-floor slab and has an open side edge. Barrow loads run up it, and the only protection is red-and-white barrier tape between posts. The supervisor says tape and a sign are enough because the drop is under 2 m. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Tape cannot stop a fall or a barrow, so guardrails with an intermediate rail and toe board are needed, as no minimum fall height applies

☐ **B)** A barrier with two warning signs is acceptable if inspected every day, because inspection is what the Regulations actually require for open edges

☐ **C)** Tape is acceptable under 2 m, but a harness must be worn by anyone pushing a barrow along the open edge of the ramp as extra protection

☐ **D)** A top rail alone at the correct height is adequate, because toe boards are needed only where other people are working beneath the open edge

17. A roofing gang must climb a 6 m fixed vertical ladder with a cage to a flat roof, each carrying a 15 kg roll of felt on his shoulder. The foreman says the cage will stop anyone falling, so no harness is needed. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Allow the cage to be relied on, but limit each climber to one 15 kg roll and require a handhold on every third rung.

☐ **B)** Hoist the rolls separately and climb with a harness on the ladder's fall-arrest system, as a cage gives little protection.

☐ **C)** Climb in pairs so the lower person can catch the upper one, and fit a harness only once both have reached the roof edge.

☐ **D)** Fit a lanyard to a rung at head height and climb carrying the rolls in a rucksack so that both hands stay free for the rungs.

18. A lorry must reverse into a site gate across a busy public footway. The marshal stands directly behind it in the gateway and waves pedestrians through behind him whenever the footway looks clear. What is the main fault in this arrangement?

☐ **A)** He stands in the lorry's path and blind spot, so he should stand clear, stay visible to the driver and keep pedestrians out of the reversing area

☐ **B)** He should carry a radio headset and remain behind the lorry, because radio contact lets him warn pedestrians in good time if the driver starts to reverse

☐ **C)** His position is acceptable if his clothing is high-visibility, because a reversing driver is required to stop for any person who is wearing it

☐ **D)** Pedestrians must be stopped from using the footway altogether for every delivery, because a marshal has no practical means of controlling members of the public

19. A tipper driver is told to discharge hardcore under a temporary pipe gantry 5 m up, on soft ground that slopes slightly sideways after rain. He says the raised body will clear the pipes by half a metre. Which assessment is correct?

☐ **A)** Tip as planned because pipework, unlike power cables, cannot electrocute anyone, so only the slope matters and a slow tip deals with that

☐ **B)** Tip as planned but with the driver standing well back from the cab holding the controls, which would protect him if the lorry became unstable

☐ **C)** Do not tip there, as the raised body can foul overhead pipework and tipping needs firm level ground, so move to a clear, level area first

☐ **D)** Tip in stages with a banksman watching the clearance, since he can warn the driver in good time to lower the body before it touches anything

20. A site's steel container holds 25-litre cans of solvent paint and thinners on a bare floor beside a tub of oxidising bleach powder. A heater cable is run inside and the doors are kept shut. The spill kit hangs in the site office. Which change best reduces both fire and pollution risk?

☐ **A)** Leave the layout as it is but move the spill kit inside the container and open the doors during working hours so that vapour can escape

☐ **B)** Swap the cans for a few larger 205-litre drums, since fewer containers mean fewer places to leak and much less to monitor for damage

☐ **C)** Use a ventilated, lockable, bunded flammables store free of heaters, keep the oxidiser elsewhere and hold a spill kit at its door

☐ **D)** Stack the cans on pallets and cover them with a fire-retardant sheet, which contains vapour and prevents any spill from reaching a drain

21. An electrician finishes a task covered by a permit to work on an isolated plant room supply. He tells the site manager it is done, and leaves for another job. The manager wants the supply back on straight away. What should happen before the permit is closed?

☐ **A)** The receiver signs the permit back as complete, then the issuer checks people are clear and equipment is safe, cancels it, and only then reverses the isolation

☐ **B)** The permit lapses automatically at the end of the shift, so the manager can re-energise the supply once the planned finish time has passed

☐ **C)** The manager can cancel it on the electrician's verbal word, since the person who did the work knows best that the plant is safe to energise

☐ **D)** The electrician must stay on site until the supply is back on, because the receiver is the person who authorises the isolation to be removed

22. On a large site with three gates, a labourer collapses on the fourth floor of a block at the back. The first aider rings 999 from her mobile. The only gate open to vehicles today is Gate C. What should she tell the call handler?

☐ **A)** The head office address and the nearest main road junction, since that is the location recorded in the firm's general emergency plan on file

☐ **B)** Only the site postcode and the casualty's condition, because the sat-nav will take the ambulance straight to the casualty and extra detail would delay the call

☐ **C)** The casualty's condition and the site manager's mobile number, since the crew can phone ahead for directions once they have reached the area of the site

☐ **D)** The site address and postcode, Gate C as the open entrance, the block and floor, and that a person will meet the crew at the gate

23. Roofers heat a bitumen boiler on a flat roof and ladle hot bitumen to the working area. The boiler runs well above its normal temperature to speed the job, and a bucket of rainwater sits beside it. Which approach controls fume and burn risks best?

☐ **A)** Run the boiler hotter to thin the bitumen so less is handled, and wear a simple dust mask because that filters out the fumes rising from the pot

☐ **B)** Keep the water bucket close to cool any spilt bitumen quickly, and stand upwind of the boiler so the fumes are always blown away from the face

☐ **C)** Wear thick cotton overalls and work only for short bursts, because fabric stops hot splashes and short exposures keep fumes below harmful levels

☐ **D)** Hold the recommended working temperature, keep water and damp materials away from the hot bitumen, and cover skin and eyes against splashes

24. A gang renewing an old brick sewer is told that the hepatitis A and tetanus vaccinations are up to date for everyone. A worker says the jabs mean he need not bother with washing facilities, and he eats lunch in the chamber's access area. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** The vaccines cover every illness found in sewage, so

hygiene precautions are required only for any workers who have not yet been vaccinated

☐ **B)** Vaccination adds protection but does not replace hygiene, so washing before eating, covering cuts and using clean welfare facilities remain necessary

☐ **C)** Hygiene precautions apply to those working inside the chamber, so colleagues at the surface may eat and drink beside the open cover

☐ **D)** Washing is needed only once the shift ends, because eating in the access area is safe provided gloves were worn throughout the whole job

25. Two fitters on a scissor lift platform, rated for 250 kg, are installing ductwork under a mezzanine slab, where another gang is laying decking. They carry 120 kg of duct and tools between them. Which arrangement best covers the platform and overhead risks?

☐ **A)** Check the combined weight of people, tools and duct against the rated load, and stop or protect work above, with helmets worn on the platform

☐ **B)** Place the lift under a finished section of slab so nothing can fall, and let both fitters stand on the guardrail midrail for extra reach

☐ **C)** Let the fitters lean on the guardrail to reach the soffit, and ask the decking gang to shout before each drop of material above them

☐ **D)** Count only the weight of materials against the rating since the platform is built for people, and rely on its guardrails to catch falling items



26. Look at the scene. The roofer says that because he is wearing a harness he is protected for the rest of the roof inspection. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The parapet is lower than the guardrail height, so the harness is irrelevant and only a taller wall would meet the requirements for edge work

☐ **B)** The ladder rises about a metre above the hatch opening, which leaves a person little to hold when stepping out and onto the roof

☐ **C)** The hatch lid is propped open on a stay, which makes the opening a risk to people below and is the main fault with the roof access

☐ **D)** The lanyard is clipped to a hatch lid hinge that is not a rated anchor, and its slack length allows him to reach the unprotected edge

27. A 2.4 m trench with a trench box is finished and the pipe has been laid. The foreman wants to lift the box out in one go with the excavator while two groundworkers stay in to shovel the last bedding. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Let the two stay in the box until it clears the ground, since their weight stops it swinging and the sides stay supported by the laid pipe and bedding

☐ **B)** Lift the box out first and then backfill the open trench in one pass, since the soil looks stable enough for the short time it is unsupported

☐ **C)** Drag the box along the open trench to the next section with the pair walking beside it, because that avoids lifting and re-setting the box

☐ **D)** Get the groundworkers out first, then backfill and compact in stages as the box is raised, so nobody stands in an unsupported trench

28. A mapped 11 kV cable must be exposed so the network operator can divert it. A groundworker says rubber-handled hand tools and insulated gloves make it safe to dig right beside it before the operator arrives. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Dig with insulated tools and gloves at close range, because the cable's outer sheath and the tool insulation together give full protection against a strike

☐ **B)** Start digging after switching off the nearest site supply, because cutting the site power also disconnects a mapped cable lying in the ground

☐ **C)** Treat the cable as live until its owner proves it dead, hand-

dig carefully to expose it, and follow the operator's instructions

☐ **D)** Use the excavator to expose the cable faster, as the cab's rubber tyres will protect the operator if the bucket happens to touch the cable

29. A mature oak with a 0.8 m trunk diameter is to be kept beside a new build. Protective fencing is set 3 m from the trunk, and the manager wants to store sand and park a cement mixer just outside it, and wash out within that gap. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Leave the fence at 3 m, as roots grow only below the branch spread, and allow sand to be stored and mixers washed out within the gap

☐ **B)** Fence the root protection area worked out from trunk diameter, and keep storage, plant, fuel and washout outside it

☐ **C)** Move the fence out to 5 m, and allow the plant to park and washout to drain inside the new line as long as nobody digs

☐ **D)** Keep the fence where it is and lay thin plastic sheet over the ground beyond it, because the sheet stops compaction and contamination reaching roots

30. A demolition crew clears a brick warehouse. Some bricks are sound and sorted, the rest is clean concrete and brick rubble, and a few pieces are suspected asbestos cement. The client wants it all sent to one skip. Which plan best follows the waste hierarchy?

☐ **A)** Send the mixed skip to an energy recovery plant, as recovery avoids landfill and the contents then need not be sorted on site

☐ **B)** Isolate the suspected asbestos for specialist handling, reuse sound bricks, crush the clean rubble as aggregate, and landfill only what cannot be recovered

☐ **C)** Landfill the whole lot, since sorting costs more than the tax and a single skip is quicker to clear with fewer lorry movements

☐ **D)** Crush everything together as aggregate, since recycling sits at the top of the hierarchy and mixed rubble can still be recycled

31. A roofing subcontractor learns that a crane will lift plant onto the adjoining block's roof while his crew works below. His foreman says coordination is the principal contractor's job alone and he will brief the crew only if they ask. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** His duty to cooperate ends at the boundary of his own subcontract, so a lift on the adjoining roof is a matter for the crane contractor alone

☐ **B)** He must cooperate with other contractors, but consulting his workers is optional unless a trade union safety representative has been appointed within his firm

☐ **C)** He must cooperate with the other contractors as far as safety needs, follow the principal contractor's directions, and consult his own workers on risks affecting them

☐ **D)** The principal contractor carries the whole duty to coordinate, so a subcontractor need only obey instructions and has no obligation to share or seek information from other trades

32. A manufacturer of petrol cut-off saws learns that the blade guard can crack and detach in service, and two users have been injured. The saws were sold through hire firms months ago. The manufacturer says its liability ended at the point of sale. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Its duty continues: once a serious risk becomes known it must pass on revised safety information to those it supplied, so far as is reasonably practicable

☐ **B)** Liability ended at sale, because section 6 duties cover design and testing only, and the hire firms and users take over all later risk for the equipment

☐ **C)** It needs to act only if the HSE serves a notice, since its duty covers the information supplied at purchase and does not extend to later discoveries

☐ **D)** Informing the owners of the two injured users' saws is enough, because information about other units is required only for defects found in pre-sale testing

33. A yard cuts steel reinforcement bars with an abrasive cut-off saw, giving about 100 dB(A) at the operator's ear. The manager asks which sequence of controls follows the hierarchy for noise. Which is correct?

☐ **A)** Fit a screen and defenders together first, then rotate workers, and treat switching to a shear or pre-cut bars as a final option because it needs a purchase

☐ **B)** Issue ear defenders straight away as the quickest control, then enclose the saw, then reduce the time spent cutting, and

consider a quieter method last of all

☐ **C)** Rotate operators first to limit each person's daily dose, then fit defenders, and enclose the saw or change the cutting method only if readings stay high

☐ **D)** Order bars pre-cut off site; if not possible use a quieter shear; then enclose or screen the saw; then limit exposure time, with ear defenders as the last resort

34. Four labourers build a temporary flood barrier by lifting 25 kg wet sandbags from a lorry to waist height and stacking them on a slippery slope for four hours. One says 25 kg is the safe limit. Which approach best applies the manual handling hierarchy?

☐ **A)** Provide back support belts and require lifting with bent knees, because the belts allow heavier repeated loads to be handled safely over a long period

☐ **B)** Let each worker set his own pace and rest breaks, since assessment of the task applies only to single lifts that exceed the guideline weights

☐ **C)** Mechanise or avoid the handling where possible, then cut load and repetition with smaller bags, a handling chain with rotation, and firm, dry footing

☐ **D)** Treat 25 kg as a legal limit for men and rely on fitness checks and lifting technique training to cover the repetitive stacking on the slope

35. The door to a compressor room shows a yellow triangle for noise and a red circle with a diagonal bar over a walking figure. A visitor asks whether he must wear ear defenders and whether the red sign will keep people out. What is the correct reading?

☐ **A)** The yellow triangle is a mandatory sign for hearing protection and the red circle is a physical barrier, so both controls are already in place.

☐ **B)** The red sign forbids entry without defenders, and the yellow triangle tells visitors where to collect them before they go in.

☐ **C)** The yellow sign only warns, so a blue mandatory sign is needed, and the red sign needs a lock or permit behind it.

☐ **D)** The yellow triangle shows a safe condition for visitors, and the red sign is guidance that employees can follow at their own discretion.

36. An electrician must run cable across an unboarded loft to a junction box 6 m from the hatch. The ceiling below is plasterboard between joists. He plans to step from joist to joist carrying the drum, stepping on the board where the gap is wide. What is the best way to do it?

☐ **A)** Lay a line of crawling boards across the joists to the work position, carry the drum separately, and keep every foot and knee on the boards.

☐ **B)** Step only on the joists, spreading the feet wide for balance, and use a torch held in the free hand to see where the next step goes.

☐ **C)** Step on the board only close to the wall edge and near a joist, since ceiling boards are firmly screwed at the perimeter and will take body weight.

☐ **D)** Keep to the joists and ask a colleague below to push up on the ceiling board when a foot strays, so any sagging is spotted in time.

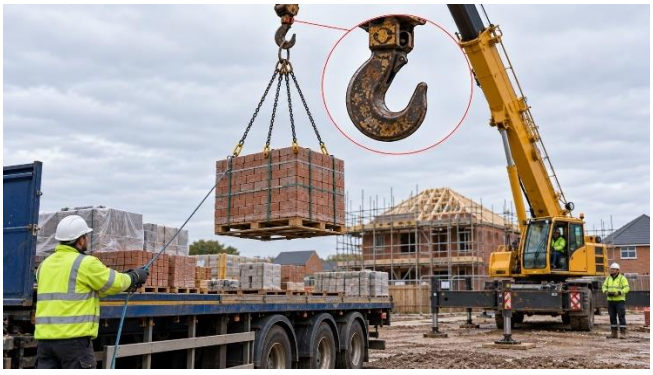
37. A mobile crane will lift ducting beneath bare overhead lines. At 8 am the site engineer measured a comfortable gap to the jib and marked it. By mid-afternoon it is hot and the wind has risen. What should the safe system rely on?

☐ **A)** Insulated slings and rubber gloves for the slinger, because contact with the lines is dangerous only when the load being lifted is made of metal

☐ **B)** Isolation by the network owner where possible, otherwise clearances allowing for worst-case conductor sag and swing, with barriers and a trained banksman

☐ **C)** The morning measurement, since a gap that was clear at the start of the shift stays valid all day provided the crane itself has not been moved

☐ **D)** The banksman's eyesight alone, because an experienced signaller can judge by eye whether the jib and load are staying outside arcing distance of the lines



38. Look at the lift. The slinger says the chains and pallet are well inside the crane's rated capacity. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** Bricks on a banded wooden pallet cannot be crane-lifted and must be moved in a lifting cage or skip designed for loose building materials

☐ **B)** The hook has no working safety catch, so the sling master link could slip off the hook if the load shifts or the chains go slack

☐ **C)** The slinger is standing too close to the lorry while the chains are tensioned and must move back to at least the full height of the jib

☐ **D)** A worker is holding a tag line, which keeps his hands close to the load and should be replaced by steadying the pallet with a long pole

39. An operator is loading a 14-tonne tracked excavator onto a low-loader on a muddy verge with a slight slope. The tracks are caked with clay and the ramps are wet. He plans to drive up fast and slew the cab to turn it on the ramps. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Drive up in a single burst of speed so momentum carries the machine over the ramps, then slew the cab round once it is on the bed.

☐ **B)** Park the low-loader across the slope so the ramps are lower, steer the machine as it climbs, and secure it with a single central strap.

☐ **C)** Load on firm level ground with clean tracks and ramps, drive straight up slowly guided by a signaller, then chain it down.

☐ **D)** Have the driver watch the ramp edges from the cab alone, with the bucket raised for balance, and secure the machine after the journey starts.

40. On a dry, windy week, lorries on an unsurfaced haul road raise dust that drifts over neighbouring homes downwind. The manager suggests handing neighbours masks and sweeping the road dry at the end of each day. Which response best controls the problem?

☐ **A)** Offer neighbours masks and a complaints line and log each report, because dust from a temporary haul road is a nuisance rather than a controlled risk

☐ **B)** Suppress dust at source by damping the road without runoff, cutting vehicle speeds and sheeting loads, and pausing dusty work when winds are strong

☐ **C)** Flood the road with water each morning so the surface stays wet all day, because heavy watering is the only measure needed in dry weather

☐ **D)** Raise the boundary hoarding to full height and keep dry sweeping the road each evening, since a screen stops dust and sweeping removes what remains

41. An inspector serves an Improvement Notice requiring effective dust extraction on a block saw within 28 days. The extraction unit is on back-order and will arrive after the deadline. The manager has not appealed. What should the contractor do?

☐ **A)** Carry on as normal because placing the order shows intent to comply, and the notice is paused automatically while a purchase is outstanding

☐ **B)** Rig a cheap temporary fan and tell nobody, as the notice only demands some visible improvement and not the inspector's agreement to the method

☐ **C)** Wait until the deadline passes and then explain the supplier delay, since an inspector must accept a late delivery as a valid excuse for non-compliance

☐ **D)** Write to the inspector before the date asking for an extension, and fit interim dust controls, because missing it without one risks prosecution

42. A method statement for lifting a chiller onto a plant-room roof lists the hazards and PPE, then says only "lift into place" and "call 999 if needed". Which addition would improve it most?

☐ **A)** The company safety policy and general site rules attached in full, so every operative can see the standards that apply across the whole project and its trades

☐ **B)** A step-by-step sequence naming the crane and accessories, plus task-specific emergency arrangements such as who raises the alarm

☐ **C)** Copies of each operative's CSCS card and the crane brochure, since evidence of competence and capacity makes a stated sequence unnecessary

☐ **D)** A line saying the foreman will decide the order of work and the equipment on the day, as he knows the roof and the crew best

43. In a site joinery workshop, fine sawdust has settled on beams, light fittings and the top of the dust extractor, and a grinder is used nearby. The supervisor plans a Friday clean-up with a brush and a compressed air line. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Leave settled dust undisturbed on high surfaces, because it is harmless until timber offcuts catch fire and only visible flames matter

☐ **B)** Sweep daily with a dry brush and keep the doors shut, since sweeping removes the fuel and closed doors stop draughts lifting dust

☐ **C)** Blow it down as planned but with the grinder switched off first, because dust is only a fire risk while a spark is actually present

☐ **D)** Remove it often with an industrial vacuum suited to fine dust, avoid raising clouds, and keep ignition sources away from dust layers

44. Air monitoring shows a joiner machining hardwood door frames is exposed at about 70 percent of the workplace exposure limit. The manager says that is under the limit, so safe, and removes the extraction hood to speed up the work. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A limit is not a safe line; COSHH needs exposure kept as low as reasonably practicable, so the working extraction must stay.

☐ **B)** The limit is a legal pass mark, so a result of 70 percent leaves a 30 percent margin that can be used up by removing some of the controls.

☐ **C)** The limit applies only to a full eight-hour average, so a short machining task is covered by no exposure standard and needs no controls.

☐ **D)** The result is below the limit, so adequate control is shown and the hood can go, provided the joiner wears a disposable paper mask.

45. A young labourer says his foreman shouts at him, hides his tools and gives him the worst tasks, and he now dreads work and sleeps badly. Raising it with the foreman is not realistic. What is the most appropriate route?

☐ **A)** Wait until a doctor formally diagnoses a condition, because an employer has no duty to act until illness has been certified

☐ **B)** Ask for a move to another gang and say nothing more, because a transfer solves it without involving management or leaving any paper trail behind

☐ **C)** Take it straight to the HSE, because it investigates individual bullying complaints and can discipline the foreman directly on site

☐ **D)** Report it in writing, with dates, to senior management or HR under the bullying policy so the employer can investigate



46. Look at the scene at the pedestrian gate. The gate marshal says the worker crossing is fully compliant with the mandatory signs on display. Which statement best identifies the problem?

☐ **A)** His helmet should be fastened with a chinstrap here, because falling objects from the reversing lorry are the main hazard at the crossing

☐ **B)** He needs eye protection and gloves too, as anyone walking near vehicles and plant must be equipped like a machine operator

☐ **C)** The hood under his helmet blocks hearing and side vision while he crosses a live vehicle route, and it stops the helmet sitting properly

☐ **D)** Nothing is wrong, because he wears each item shown on the mandatory signs and those items give complete protection at a gate

47. On a hot plant-room refit, an operative dry-sands dusty plaster for seven hours a day despite on-tool extraction. His fit-tested FFP3 mask gets hot and wet, and he keeps pulling it down for air. Which solution is most suitable?

☐ **A)** Move him to a lower-grade FFP2 mask that breathes more easily, because the protection gap between the two grades is small for plaster dust

☐ **B)** Keep the FFP3 but swap it for a fresh one every hour, since a drier mask removes the discomfort without changing the

equipment type

☐ **C)** Let him lower the mask whenever the dust looks thin, as visible dust is a reliable guide to when protection is actually needed

☐ **D)** Provide a powered hood respirator with suitable filters, which eases breathing and needs no face-fit test, checked before each shift

48. On a two-storey house extension with a 40-degree pitched roof, a scaffold with guardrails runs along the eaves only. Roofers must fix barge boards along the gable verge. The foreman says the eaves protection covers the whole roof. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** The verge is a separate fall edge needing its own edge protection, such as a gable scaffold lift, with harnesses only as a fallback

☐ **B)** Harnesses clipped to the ridge are enough for the verge, as collective protection is needed only where roofers work alone on the slope

☐ **C)** Keeping a metre back from the verge in dry weather is enough, since careful, experienced roofers reduce the need for any edge protection at all

☐ **D)** The eaves guardrails count for every edge of the roof, because a person falling at the verge would be stopped by the same top rail

49. A temporary distribution board feeding site tools is screwed to the hoarding at the gate, 300 mm above ground, beside a low spot that floods and the lorry turning area. Its door is wedged open for easy access. Which correction is most suitable?

☐ **A)** Move it to a raised, lockable weatherproof enclosure clear of flooding and vehicles, with cables protected where they cross routes

☐ **B)** Put it in an unlocked indoor-rated cabinet beside the gate, since a roof overhead gives enough protection from weather and damage

☐ **C)** Leave it in position but cover it with a plastic sheet at night, because the sheet keeps rain off while access stays quick for everyone

☐ **D)** Keep the position but add bollards and a higher-rated RCD, since impact protection and tripping devices make a damp low site acceptable

50. Four people are named on a lift plan for placing a plant unit by mobile crane: appointed person, crane supervisor, slinger and operator. Which description of their roles is correct?

☐ **A)** The appointed person attaches the load and signals, while the slinger plans the lift and selects the accessories that the crew will use

☐ **B)** The supervisor plans the lift and then leaves, the appointed person works the crane controls, and the slinger decides when to stop for safety

☐ **C)** The operator is in overall charge and plans the lift from the capacity chart, the supervisor is the site manager, and the slinger only hooks on the load as told

☐ **D)** The appointed person plans the lift and picks the equipment, the supervisor checks it follows the plan and can stop it, and the slinger attaches the load

Answer Key

1. C — A domestic client is someone having work done on their own home or a family member's home, not as part of a business, so a property being refitted to let is a commercial client's project.

A: Personal ownership does not decide the status, because the work is for a letting business and not for his own or a relative's home. B: Commercial client duties cannot be passed on by a verbal agreement, and they remain with the client who commissions the project. D: The purpose of the work, not the date a tenant arrives, decides his status, and the work is already being done for a business.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that owning a property personally makes you a domestic client, whatever the reason the work is being done.

2. D — Risk assessment should consider the individual's circumstances, and reasonable adjustments can often allow safe, fair work, which is better than excluding him or leaving him to rely on audible alarms.

A: Excluding him without assessing or consulting him can be unlawful discrimination and ignores adjustments that would make the work safe. B: A generic assessment misses hazards that are specific to him, such as unheard reversing alarms, so it fails to protect him. C: A buddy and a jacket are a token gesture, and waiting for an incident to occur is a reactive approach rather than an assessment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a worker's disability as a reason to exclude him, or as something to ignore, instead of adjusting the work after talking to him.

3. B — Fire arrangements must account for people who cannot use stairs, and a plan agreed with the person, with suitable equipment and trained helpers, is safer than improvised carrying.

A: A general plan does not provide a way for someone who cannot use the stair to get down, so it leaves her without a means of escape. C: Lifts and hoists can fail or trap people in a fire, so they are not a dependable escape route unless designed for evacuation. D: Improvised carrying risks injury to her and the helpers, and it relies on untrained people making decisions during an emergency.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming one general evacuation plan covers everyone, rather than planning in advance for people who cannot use the stairs.

4. B — Defective extinguishers must be removed and attended to by a competent person, and people who may use one need instruction, including that they should only tackle a fire when it is safe to do so.

A: Reading a label in an emergency is no substitute for instruction, and untrained users may fight a fire that they should evacuate from. C: A unit with a low gauge reading and a broken seal may not work, so leaving it gives false confidence at a fire point. D: Discharging it weakens its effect for a real fire, and resealing or refilling is work for a competent service provider.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a fire extinguisher on the wall provides cover whatever its condition or whether anyone knows how to use it.

5. C — The noise regulations require noise to be reduced at source where reasonably practicable, so choosing quieter plant using supplier noise data is better than relying on zones and ear defenders.

A: Hearing protection is the last resort, and a fenced zone does not remove the duty to cut noise at source when it is reasonably practicable. B: A screen is an add-on control of limited effect, and it does not replace buying a quieter machine in the first place. D: The duty to reduce risk from noise applies from the lower action value, and plant selection should aim to cut exposure well below the upper value.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating ear defenders as a cheap answer to noisy equipment instead of choosing quieter plant first.

6. B — Removing or reducing the lift cuts the manual handling risk, and handling the material low and gently stops the dust being thrown into the air, which is better than relying on a mask.

A: Rotation spreads the strain without reducing it, and spraying water around the mixer does not stop dust forming at the open bag. C: Pairs lifting from the floor still strain backs, and vigorous shaking creates more dust than gentle emptying. D: Belts and masks are personal measures that do not remove the lift or the dust, and a belt does not make a poor technique safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Dealing with dust and lifting as separate problems, and reaching for masks and belts rather than changing the way the material is supplied.

7. C — Towers must be assembled by trained, competent people following the specific manufacturer's instructions, with edge protection in place for each stage, and then inspected before anyone uses it.

A: Edge protection should be fitted as the tower is built, because people working on lower lifts of the assembly are also exposed to falls. B: The inspection is needed after assembly and before first use, and a hire company's check does not cover how the crew erects it. D: Systems differ between makers, so memory of another kit is no substitute for the instructions for this particular tower.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that building a tower once, with another make, is enough to erect any tower without the maker's manual.

8. D — Standing on crates lifts the body above the guardrail height and raises the centre of gravity, so a loss of balance can take him over the rail or topple the tower.

A: A tower platform with complete guardrails and toe boards is itself the fall protection, so a harness is not the fault here. B: Using a drill is normal work on a tower, and the hazard is the unsafe standing position rather than the tool. C: The castors are braked and outriggers are fitted, so this describes a fault that is not present in the scene.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking guardrails still protect you after you have stood on something to gain extra height.

9. A — The lift is a manual handling risk and the road is a traffic risk, so both are controlled by protecting the work area before starting and using a proper lifting device rather than hands or a bar.

B: A single cone and a lookout do not protect operatives kneeling in a live lane, and prying with a bar risks trapped fingers and strained backs. C: Short exposure does not replace traffic management, and a rushed lift of a heavy cover increases the chance of injury. D: Gloves do not prevent crush injuries or back strain, and kneeling in the road puts the operatives in the path of traffic.

COMMON MISTAKE: Dealing with only the weight of the cover, or only the passing traffic, instead of controlling both together.

10. D — Equipment not designed to lift people should only be used in exceptional circumstances, so a MEWP or a purpose-designed platform with suitable planning and examination is the proper choice here.

A: Harnesses do not make an unsuitable arrangement safe, and a harness cannot replace equipment designed for lifting people. B: Capacity is only one factor, and a site-made cage on a machine not designed for lifting people does not meet the extra safety requirements. C: Risk is not controlled by the length of time, because the cage could detach or the machine tip the moment it leaves the ground.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a person-lift on the telehandler's load rating alone, without asking whether the equipment was made to carry people.

11. A — Self-employed people must not expose others to risk from their work and must cooperate and coordinate where they share a workplace, so the builder owes information about hazards he controls even though the electrician answers for his own working methods.

B: Self-employed status does not transfer the controller's duty to warn of known hazards, and no price agreement can contract out of health and safety law. C: The duty not to expose others to risk applies to any work activity, however short, and has no minimum duration. D: The Health and Safety at Work etc. Act places duties on self-employed people as well as employers, so the absence of an employer does not remove the builder's duty.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that hiring someone who is self-employed, even for a single day, passes all responsibility for the work area onto them.

12. A — A night worker's hours must average no more than 8 in each 24-hour period over the reference period, and unlike the weekly limit this cannot be waived by signing an opt-out.

B: The night work limit cannot be opted out of, and extra pay or written confirmation does not change that. C: The average limit applies to all night workers, and the special-hazards rule makes the cap stricter, not looser. D: Daily rest and the average night-hours limit are separate rules, and meeting one does not satisfy the other.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a signed opt-out from the 48-hour week lifts every working time limit, including those protecting night workers.

13. C — These are signs of hypothermia, which needs emergency medical care, and the safe interim steps are shelter, removing wet clothes, gentle insulation and continuous observation.

A: Wet clothing keeps drawing heat from his body, and a confused worker needs to stop work and get medical help. B: Rubbing limbs and giving alcohol are both advised against in hypothermia, as they can make his condition worse. D: Hot baths or showers are not advised for hypothermia, and someone confused must not be left alone or have emergency help delayed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating confusion and slurred speech in a cold, wet worker as tiredness that he can work off rather than as a medical emergency.

14. A — Abrasive blasting creates a heavy cloud of grit and dust

which rebounds, so the face, eyes and airways need a purpose-made blasting helmet with a clean air supply rather than a half mask under glasses.

B: Clothing matters, but the breathing and face protection is a far greater risk from the dust cloud. C: Defenders suit this noise level, and the picture does not show a sealing problem that plugs would fix. D: Grip is a minor point compared with the breathing and eye risk, and gauntlets are a normal choice for this task.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting the number of PPE items worn instead of asking whether each one suits the actual hazard.

15. B — Protection must be worn continuously to work, and selecting an attenuation that avoids both under- and over-protection, with other vehicle controls, keeps him safe from noise and traffic.

A: Louder alarms add to everyone's noise exposure, and the regulations require noise to be controlled for all workers affected. C: Protection that leaves his ear exposure above 85 dB does not control the noise risk, whatever has been issued. D: Even brief removal cuts the protection achieved over a shift, and an audible alarm should never be the only control on vehicle movements.

COMMON MISTAKE: Taking hearing protection off for moments to hear a warning, as though a short removal costs little protection.

16. A — Edge protection must physically prevent people and materials from falling, and the Work at Height Regulations apply wherever a fall could cause injury, with no minimum height.

B: Inspection checks that protection is working, and it cannot replace physical edge protection that prevents a fall. C: There is no 2 m threshold in the Regulations, and personal fall protection is not preferred over collective edge protection. D: Toe boards also stop barrow wheels and materials from going over the edge, not only protect those below.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on the idea that falls from below two metres are minor, so tape and signs can stand in for proper edge protection.

17. B — Cages are not reliable fall protection and carrying a load on a vertical ladder prevents a secure grip, so the load should be hoisted and the climber should use a suitable fall-arrest system.

A: A cage does not stop a fall and a load on the shoulder still prevents a firm grip. C: A colleague cannot catch a falling person and the climb is where the risk is highest. D: A rung is not a suitable anchor and a heavy rucksack pulls the climber backwards off the ladder.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a ladder cage is as good as a fall-arrest system and that a load can be carried up on the shoulder.

18. A — A signaller must stand in a safe position out of the vehicle's way, be visible to the driver at all times and keep the reversing area clear of pedestrians.

B: A radio does not remove him from the swept path, and a person directly behind a reversing lorry is exposed to being struck. C: Visibility helps but does not make a blind spot safe, and drivers cannot be relied on to see or stop in time. D: Closing the footway is not the only control, as a marshal can hold pedestrians clear from a safe position, with barriers or planned routes where needed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a marshal standing behind a reversing vehicle can safely control pedestrians just by watching them and waving.

19. C — A tipping site must be clear overhead of pipes and cables and firm and level, as a raised body on a slope can become unstable and swing into obstructions.

A: Overhead pipework is also an obstruction that a raised body can strike, so the area must be clear of it as well as cables. B: The driver should stay in the cab with the doors closed during tipping, not stand outside where an unstable body could fall on him. D: A banksman cannot correct soft, sloping ground, and instability can develop faster than any warning can be given.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a tipping position only by whether the raised body is expected to miss obstructions, without checking the ground is firm and level.

20. C — Solvents need ventilation and no ignition sources, incompatible oxidisers need segregating, and a bund with a kit at the point of storage contains leaks before they reach drains.

A: This leaves the heater, the oxidiser next to the solvents and the lack of any bund unchanged, so both risks remain. B: Larger containers increase the volume that can be lost in one failure, and the ignition source and oxidiser problems remain. D: A sheet does not contain vapour, separate incompatible materials or stop a spill, and pallets give no containment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a lockable container as proper storage without checking ventilation, ignition sources, segregation and spill containment.

21. A — A permit is closed through a defined handback: the

receiver declares the work finished and the authorised issuer verifies the area before cancelling it, so nobody is exposed when the supply is restored.

B: A permit stays live until formally cancelled, and the passing of a time does not prove that the work is finished or the area is clear. C: A verbal report skips the signed handback and the issuer's own check that people and tools are clear of the plant. D: It is the issuer, not the receiver, who authorises restoration, and the receiver's duty is to hand the permit back.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a permit to work as finished when the job is, rather than when the issuer has formally cancelled it.

22. D — Crews need the address, the access point that is actually open and the exact location, and a guide at the gate saves minutes finding a casualty inside a large site.

A: The head office is not where the casualty is, and a road junction does not identify which gate or block to go to. B: A postcode usually leads to a main gate or road, which may be closed or far from the casualty. C: Relying on a callback wastes time, and the call handler needs the location and access details during the call itself.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that the site postcode alone will get an ambulance to the right gate and the right part of a large site.

23. D — Overheating raises fume output, water in hot bitumen causes violent spitting, and covering skin and eyes protects against splashes, so these controls address both risks.

A: Higher temperature increases fume and burn risk, and a simple dust mask does not filter bitumen fume. B: Water thrown on hot bitumen can cause violent spitting, and standing upwind alone does not control skin contact. C: Cotton can be soaked through by hot bitumen, and limiting time does not replace temperature control and proper protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Raising the heat to save time without thinking that it increases both fume and the severity of any splash.

24. B — Vaccines cover only some infections and are an added layer, so the hygiene controls, clean welfare facilities and covering cuts are still needed to stop other infections.

A: Vaccination covers only specific diseases, and many sewage-borne infections have no vaccine. C: Contaminated tools, boots and spills reach the surface, so eating next to the open chamber exposes people there too. D: Gloves can carry contamination to food and the mouth, so hands must be washed before eating in a clean area.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that being vaccinated means normal hygiene rules for dirty work no longer apply.

25. A — The rated capacity includes people and materials, and guardrails on the platform do not protect occupants from objects dropping from the work above.

B: Standing on rails is unsafe, and the question of the load rating and the other gang's work above is left unresolved. C: Leaning on guardrails risks overturning the lift, and shouting is not a reliable control over falling items. D: People count towards the rated load, and the guardrails and toe boards cannot stop objects falling from above.

COMMON MISTAKE: Forgetting that the people on the platform count towards its rated load, and that guardrails do not stop objects dropped from above.

26. D — Fall protection depends on a designed anchor point and a lanyard set so that a fall is prevented or arrested safely, but a hinge on a hatch lid is not designed for that load and the slack lets him reach the edge.

A: A low parapet does not meet edge protection standards, but the harness is still relevant and its attachment is the specific fault shown. B: A ladder rising about a metre above the landing is the correct arrangement and gives a handhold, so this is not the problem. C: An open lid can be a hazard, but the stay holds it and it is not the main danger shown in the scene.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that wearing a harness means a person is protected, without checking what it is attached to.

27. D — Support is removed progressively as backfilling proceeds, and nobody should be in the trench while the box is lifted, because the sides can collapse once the support goes.

A: People inside a box being lifted risk crushing and collapse, and the pipe gives no support to the trench sides. B: Removing support before backfilling leaves the sides unsupported, and soil that looks stable can collapse without warning. C: Dragging a box along an open trench leaves sections unsupported and puts workers beside moving plant and collapsing sides.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking support can come out all at once and people can stay in the trench for the last small tasks.

28. C — Insulation on tools gives no assurance against a damaged live cable, so it must be treated as live until the owner has isolated and proved it dead, with careful hand digging used to expose it.

A: A damaged sheath can expose conductors, and tool insulation does not guard against high-voltage arcing or a strike. B: The site supply is independent of the buried network cable, which remains

live until its owner isolates it. D: Machine digging near cables can sever or damage them, and tyres give no dependable protection against high voltage.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that insulated tools or gloves make it acceptable to work beside a cable that has not been made dead.

29. B — The root protection area is calculated from the trunk diameter, so a 3 m line is too close, and compaction, spillage and washout inside it can kill roots.

A: Roots extend well beyond the trunk and often beyond the canopy, and a fixed 3 m line ignores the tree's actual size. C: Compaction and washout within the protected area harm roots without any digging. D: A sheet does not stop compaction, and an inadequate fence line still leaves much of the root area exposed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Setting tree protection by guesswork rather than from the trunk size, and treating the area just outside as free for storage.

30. B — The hierarchy puts reuse before recycling and disposal last, while segregation at source stops contamination from downgrading clean rubble and hazardous pieces need specialist handling.

A: Recovery ranks below reuse and recycling, and mixed loads containing asbestos cannot go to ordinary facilities. C: Disposal is the last option and the unsorted loads would waste material that could be reused or recycled. D: Reuse ranks above recycling, and crushing suspected asbestos cement into aggregate would spread fibres and contaminate the load.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating recycling as the best outcome for all waste and skipping the sorting that makes reuse and clean recycling possible.

31. C — Under CDM 2015 every duty holder must cooperate with others working on the same or an adjoining site, and employers must consult their workers on health and safety matters that affect them.

A: The duty to cooperate expressly extends to those working on an adjoining site or related work. B: Employers must consult workers directly where there is no recognised union representative. D: Cooperation is a duty on every contractor, not only the principal contractor.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that coordination and consultation are the principal contractor's job and a subcontractor only needs to look after his own work.

32. A — Section 6 of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974 requires suppliers and manufacturers to provide revised information when a serious risk to health or safety becomes known.

B: Section 6 includes a continuing duty to give revised information about serious risks that become known. C: The duty arises when the risk becomes known, not when an enforcing authority intervenes. D: The duty covers everyone supplied with the article, not just those already harmed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a manufacturer's safety responsibility stops once the equipment has been sold or hired out.

33. D — Noise should be removed at source first, then substituted or engineered down, then managed by working arrangements, with hearing protection used only for the risk that remains.

A: Eliminating or substituting the noise source comes first, and purchase effort does not reorder the hierarchy. B: This inverts the hierarchy by putting personal protection first and elimination or substitution last. C: Administrative measures and PPE rank below removing or reducing noise at source.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reaching for ear defenders first because they are quick and cheap, instead of working down from eliminating the noise.

34. C — Manual handling controls start with avoiding or mechanising the task, then reduce the load, repetition and poor conditions identified through the task, individual, load and environment factors.

A: Back belts are not a recognised control and do not make repeated heavy lifting safe. B: Repetitive handling and the environment must be assessed even when individual lifts are below guideline weights. D: Guideline weights are not legal limits and repetition, twisting and slippery footing change the risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a guideline weight as a safe limit and ignoring repetition, posture and ground conditions.

35. C — A warning triangle does not instruct anyone to wear anything, a mandatory blue circle does, and a prohibition sign only states a rule so physical access control is needed to stop people entering.

A: Yellow triangles warn of a hazard and do not instruct wearing PPE, and a sign of any colour is not a physical barrier. B: A red prohibition sign forbids an action and does not set conditions, and a warning triangle does not direct anyone to equipment. D: Safe

conditions are shown in green and a prohibition sign states a rule that has to be followed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a warning sign as an instruction to use PPE or a prohibition sign as if it were a barrier.

36. A — Plasterboard cannot carry body weight, so a person must be supported by boards spanning several joists, and a clear route with good lighting reduces the chance of a foot slipping off the joist.

B: Balancing on narrow joists leaves no margin for a slip, and holding a torch removes a hand that could be used to steady himself. C: Screws at the edge do not make plasterboard load-bearing, and it will not take body weight anywhere in the ceiling. D: Plasterboard can fail with no warning and a colleague pushing from below cannot stop a foot or leg breaking through.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a ceiling board next to a joist will take your weight if you step lightly.

37. B — Conductors sag in heat and swing in wind, and electricity can arc without contact, so isolation or a fixed clearance planned for worst-case movement is needed.

A: Insulated accessories do not make approaching live lines safe, and the whole crane and rope can become live. C: Lines sag and sway with temperature and wind, so a one-off measurement does not remain valid. D: Distance to overhead lines is very hard to judge by eye, so physical controls are needed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging clearance from a single morning measurement or by eye, ignoring heat, wind and arcing.

38. B — Lifting hooks must have a functioning safety catch or equivalent so the load cannot become detached, whatever the rated capacity.

A: Banded, properly packaged pallets can be lifted on suitable slings, so this is not the key defect. C: The slinger is clear of the load path, and no rule requires standing back by the jib's full height. D: Tag lines are a standard way to control a load from a safe distance and are not the hazard here.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a lift safe because the load is under the rated capacity, without checking the lifting accessories and hook condition.

39. C — Clean tracks and ramps, level ground and a straight, slow ascent prevent slipping or tipping, and a signaller guides the driver from a safe position before the machine is secured to the trailer.

A: Speed on wet ramps invites a skid, and slewing or steering while on the ramps can unbalance the machine. B: A sloping surface and steering on ramps risk a tip, and one strap would not hold the machine's weight. D: A signaller helps with the blind spots and a raised bucket raises the centre of gravity, and securing must be done before departure.

COMMON MISTAKE: Rushing a machine up ramps with muddy tracks, treating loading as a quick task rather than a controlled lift of a heavy machine.

40. B — Dust is best prevented at source with damping, speed limits and covered loads, with the work adjusted to weather, rather than leaving neighbours to cope.

A: Dust must be controlled at the site, and relying on neighbours' masks is not a control. C: Heavy watering can cause mud and polluted runoff to drains, and does not address speed or covered loads. D: Dry sweeping re-suspends fine dust, and a hoarding alone does not control dust at source.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating site dust as a minor nuisance to be tolerated or cleaned up afterwards instead of stopped at source.

41. D — A compliance period can be extended by the inspector if asked in good time, whereas simply missing the date without an agreed extension is a failure to comply with the notice.

A: A notice is suspended only by an appeal to a tribunal, not by an order being placed with a supplier. B: The notice requires the specified contravention to be remedied, so an unagreed makeshift measure may not satisfy it and hides the problem from the inspector. C: A supplier delay is not an automatic defence, and any extension should be requested before the compliance period has run out.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that ordering the equipment or having a good reason for delay is enough, instead of asking the inspector for more time before the notice period ends.

42. B — A method statement should set out how the task is done in order, with the plant needed and the emergency arrangements that apply to this particular job.

A: General policy does not describe how this specific lift will be carried out or how an emergency on the roof would be handled. C: Evidence of competence and capacity supports the plan but does not replace a clear sequence of work and emergency arrangements. D: The sequence and plant must be planned in advance so that risks are controlled, and cannot be left to be improvised during the lift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a method statement as a list of hazards and PPE rather than a practical description of the order of work, the plant used and the emergency plan.

43. D — Settled dust is fuel and a disturbed cloud can ignite or explode, so regular vacuum removal without dispersal controls the risk at source.

A: Dust layers are themselves combustible fuel and are easily disturbed into a cloud by a draught or impact. B: Dry brushing throws fine dust into the air, and a closed space lets the airborne concentration build up. C: Blowing creates a suspended cloud and spreads dust onto new surfaces, and hot surfaces and motors can still ignite it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking fire needs a visible flame source nearby and overlooking that fine settled dust is a fuel that can be thrown into an explosive cloud.

44. A — A workplace exposure limit is a maximum, not a guarantee of safety, and for a substance that can cause cancer or asthma COSHH expects exposure to be reduced as far as is reasonably practicable, which here means keeping the extraction.

B: The margin is not a spare allowance to be spent, because control measures are judged on reducing exposure rather than on staying just inside the figure. C: Exposure limits are set for specific averaging periods but short tasks still count towards the exposure and the general COSHH duties still apply to them. D: Being under the limit does not end the duty to reduce exposure, and a paper mask is a weak substitute for a source control that is already working.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a result just under the exposure limit as proof that the work is safe and the controls can be relaxed.

45. D — The employer must deal with bullying and work-related stress, and a dated written report to someone above the foreman starts that process and creates a record.

A: Employers must act on the risk of harm from work-related stress and do not need to wait for a diagnosis. B: Moving away leaves the conduct unaddressed, so others may suffer and the employer is never put on notice to act. C: HSE does not investigate bullying and harassment, and it expects concerns to have been raised with the employer first.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that bullying is only a personal matter, or that you must put up with it until it damages your health.

46. C — Clothing that covers the ears and narrows the field of view reduces awareness of reversing vehicles and can stop the helmet fitting correctly, so ticking the sign items is not enough.

A: A reversing lorry is a struck-by hazard and not a falling-object one, and a chinstrap does nothing about his reduced hearing and vision. B: Eye protection and gloves are not shown on the signs and do not address crossing a vehicle route. D: Wearing the listed items does not make the combination safe, since his hood defeats the awareness a vehicle crossing demands.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging PPE compliance by counting the items on the sign rather than asking whether what he wears leaves him able to see and hear the hazards.

47. D — A powered respirator with a loose-fitting hood lowers breathing effort and heat over long tasks and does not need fit testing, though it needs its airflow and battery checked.

A: Choosing a lower grade for comfort cuts protection, and RPE must be selected for the exposure and not for ease of wear. B: A fresh mask does not fix the heat and breathing effort over seven hours, so he will still be tempted to remove it. C: The finest and most harmful particles cannot be seen, so the respirator must be worn throughout the exposure.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing respirators by habit or comfort rather than matching the type to the task length, heat and the protection the dust requires.

48. A — Edge protection protects only where it is fitted, and collective measures take priority over personal fall protection at every edge from which a person could fall.

B: Collective protection should come before personal protection, which depends on correct use, a sound anchor and a rescue plan. C: Reliance on behaviour and weather is not a control, and a fall of this height can seriously injure whoever slips. D: A guardrail protects only the edge it runs along, and the gable verge lies beyond it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming edge protection at the eaves covers every other edge of a roof, such as verges and gable ends.

49. A — Distribution equipment must be kept dry, out of the way of vehicle damage and secure against unauthorised access, with cables protected along their route.

B: An indoor-rated enclosure is not designed for outdoor exposure and an unlocked cabinet still allows unauthorised access. C: A sheet does not stop flooding or vehicle impact and leaves live parts open to anyone who walks up to the board. D: Bollards and RCDs do not stop water entering a board standing in a flood-prone spot, and devices do not replace a suitable position.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a temporary board as low-risk because it is temporary, and siting it wherever is convenient rather than where it stays dry, protected and locked.

50. D — The appointed person plans and organises the lift, the

crane supervisor oversees that it is carried out to plan with authority to stop it, and the slinger attaches the load and signals.

A: These duties are reversed, as planning and selecting equipment belong to the appointed person and attaching the load belongs to the slinger. B: Planning is the appointed person's job, the supervisor must stay to oversee the lift, and the trained operator, not the appointed person, controls the crane. C: The operator controls the crane within the plan but does not own planning, and supervision must be by a trained person appointed for the lift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing the crane operator or the person nearest the load is responsible for the whole lift, instead of a clear split between planning, supervising, slinging and operating

PRACTICE TEST 9

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A principal contractor locks the welfare cabin and takes the site rules off the gate on Saturdays, saying none of its own staff work then. A subcontracted electrician works alone one Saturday with its agreement. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Site rules matter only when several trades overlap, so a lone worker needs just a portable toilet and a mobile phone for emergencies

☐ **B)** Welfare must be available throughout the construction phase to everyone working there, and the electrician must still follow the site rules

☐ **C)** The electrician's own employer must arrange toilets and washing, because the contractor's duty covers only its own staff on its planned working days

☐ **D)** A lone worker needs no welfare provision for one day, because facilities become mandatory only once a minimum headcount is on site

2. Four agency labourers with little English join a site on Monday. The agency says its generic assessment covers them, and the site supervisor plans to hand out the English risk assessment and have one fluent crew member interpret. Which approach best meets the duties?

☐ **A)** Relying on the fluent crew member is fine, as informal interpreting by a colleague is the quickest way to cover every hazard on site

☐ **B)** The agency's assessment is enough, as the agency is the employer and the site only needs to provide the paperwork if anyone asks for it

☐ **C)** Pass on site risks and controls in a form the workers understand, such as translation or a trained interpreter, and check understanding

☐ **D)** Handing over the English document is sufficient, since the workers accept responsibility once they have been given it and have signed for it

3. While stripping plaster in a ground-floor flat, a joiner smells gas strongly. Two colleagues are working upstairs and the lights are off. He is about to switch them on to look for the cause. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Turn the lights on to find the source, then tighten any visible joints before the smell spreads, because the fault is probably small

☐ **B)** Avoid switches and flames, open doors and windows on the way out, evacuate everyone and report the leak from outside

☐ **C)** Switch off the power at the consumer unit to remove ignition sources, then continue working in the other rooms while the gas disperses

☐ **D)** Wait for the site plumber to arrive and check it, as the workers are better placed to judge whether the leak is serious enough

4. In a site cabin, wet jackets are draped over an electric heater to dry. A four-way adaptor in an extension lead feeds the kettle, microwave and a second heater, and the plug is warm. Which action best controls the fire risk?

☐ **A)** Keep the jackets on the heater but fit a plug-in timer to cut the power, because heat for a limited time cannot ignite fabric

☐ **B)** Place a fire extinguisher by the door and a smoke alarm in the cabin, since detection means the existing set-up is acceptable

☐ **C)** Replace the warm plug and extension lead with a heavier lead, then keep the same appliances running through the adaptor

☐ **D)** Provide a ventilated drying area away from heaters, and spread the loads over separate sockets so no adaptor is overloaded

5. In a small bathroom with one closed window, a fitter plans to lay laminate worktop using a solvent-based contact adhesive. A gas boiler with a pilot light sits next door, and the supervisor says

a mask will deal with the fumes. What is the best course of action?

☐ **A)** Open the window slightly and keep the same product, as the instructions on the tin already set out every control needed

☐ **B)** Look first for a water-based adhesive, and if solvent is needed, ventilate well and remove ignition sources before starting

☐ **C)** Use a fan to blow vapour into the corridor, because moving the vapour away is as effective as controlling it at its source

☐ **D)** Wear a disposable mask and work quickly with the window shut, since the small quantity of adhesive keeps vapour levels low

6. Two glaziers must move several 2.4 m by 1.2 m panes of toughened glass, each about 45 kg, from a van to a first-floor flat by a narrow stair. The foreman says two strong people can carry anything. Which approach best applies the manual handling principles?

☐ **A)** Carry the panes as fast as possible to reduce the time the load is held, with gloves worn only when handling cut edges

☐ **B)** Use mechanical aids such as a glazing trolley or vacuum lifter, plan the route, and wear cut-resistant gloves and sleeves for any carrying

☐ **C)** Have the two strongest workers carry each pane, since the load is shared between them and falls below the guideline for a single person

☐ **D)** Leave the assessment to the workers on the day, since experienced glaziers know the weight and shape of the panes better than the supervisor

7. A security camera sits 5.5 m up on a gable wall and needs its lens cleaned and re-aimed every month. A contractor proposes a ladder with a full-body harness. Which plan best applies the hierarchy for work at height?

☐ **A)** Use the ladder with the harness clipped to the ladder rung, because personal fall protection is the first control for a short job

☐ **B)** Employ a second person to foot the ladder and rely on a monthly inspection to keep the camera visit short and low risk

☐ **C)** Fit a hinged or lowering bracket so the camera is serviced from the ground, otherwise use a MEWP or tower with guardrails

☐ **D)** Erect a scaffold tower for each visit, since collective protection always ranks first and avoiding the work is not a requirement



8. Look at the scene. An electrician is fixing a cable tray from the stepladder. Which feature creates the most serious risk of a severe fall?

☐ **A)** The concrete slab is too smooth for the rubber feet, so the stepladder is likely to slide away from the cable tray he is fixing

☐ **B)** The ladder has no harness anchor, so he cannot connect fall-arrest equipment to it while he works on the cable tray overhead

☐ **C)** A tool bag on his belt adds weight to his body, which makes him top-heavy and unstable on the third step of the ladder

☐ **D)** The stepladder stands close to an open floor edge with no edge protection, so a slip or overreach could carry him over

9. A 2.2 m trench with timber-and-strut support has a pallet of kerbs stacked beside it, and a delivery lorry is about to park next to the pallet. The groundworker says the trench support is installed so it will carry any extra load. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The support will carry the extra weight as long as it was fitted as the first step in the dig and has been inspected today

☐ **B)** A fixed one-metre gap from the edge is a legal limit, so anything outside it is safe whatever the depth, soil or vehicle weight

☐ **C)** Loads and vehicles near the edge add pressure on the sides, so keep them well back or design the support for them

☐ **D)** Placing the pallet on timber sleepers spreads its weight,

so the lorry can park beside it without further checks

10. A planner routes a loaded forward-tip dumper down a rough ramp whose gradient is steeper than the figure in the manufacturer's handbook. The driver is experienced and says low gear and slow speed will make it safe. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Allow the trip if the driver wears a seat belt and keeps to walking pace, since those two measures cover the extra risk on the ramp

☐ **B)** Re-plan the route or regrade the ramp within the manufacturer's gradient limit, since driver skill cannot override design limits

☐ **C)** Reduce the load to half the usual weight and the ramp is safe, because the limit relates only to the weight being carried

☐ **D)** Let the driver judge it on the day, as experience of similar slopes is a better guide than a figure printed in a handbook

11. An agency labourer props a self-closing stair door open with the landing's wall-mounted fire extinguisher, and has emptied the cabin eyewash bottles rinsing paint from his hands. The principal contractor provided both items. He says he is not their employee. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The duty falls only on the contractor who provided the items, because an agency labourer is not that firm's direct employee on site

☐ **B)** The duty not to misuse safety and welfare provision covers any person, so he has breached it, and he should report why he needed them

☐ **C)** The duty is met because he used the items for a practical reason, and the employer should have supplied a door wedge and a wash basin

☐ **D)** The duty is breached only if someone is hurt, because misuse that causes no injury is a matter of site discipline, not law

12. A groundworks gang votes to smoke inside their closed welfare cabin all winter and to vape anywhere on site, including beside the diesel store, saying vaping is not smoking so no rule can touch it. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A closed cabin must stay smoke-free whatever the vote; vaping, though outside that law, can be assessed and restricted by site rule

☐ **B)** Vaping is legally identical to smoking, so it is banned in every enclosed space and the gang may not use e-cigarettes anywhere on the site

☐ **C)** A unanimous vote of everyone using the cabin lets them smoke inside it, since only people who have agreed to the smoke are exposed to it

☐ **D)** Both are personal choices, so the employer cannot restrict either one and can only provide a designated area outdoors for the gang to use

13. An electrician fits fine control wiring in a dim plant room, lit only by his head torch and a lamp on the floor. By afternoon he has red, aching eyes and a headache, and has started making wiring errors. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Provide good general light and adjustable task lamps placed to avoid glare and shadow, and allow breaks from close work

☐ **B)** Issue tinted safety glasses to cut the glare from the floor lamp, and let the electrician carry on since the glasses control the eye strain

☐ **C)** Place a single powerful floodlight at head height facing the work, so that the plant room is bright enough for every close task

☐ **D)** Arrange an eye test for him because the strain suggests faulty eyesight, and keep the room lighting as it is for the others to use



14. Look at the operative drilling a steel bracket at the workshop bench. Which statement best identifies the problem and the correct fix?

☐ **A)** The drilling raises fine metal dust, so the main concern is his breathing, and a half-mask respirator should be worn for all drilling here

☐ **B)** The belt housing guard hides the drive, so it should be

removed to let him check the belt tension before each hole is drilled

☐ **C)** He wears no hard hat, so the main risk is a falling object, and a bump cap should be worn throughout all bench work in the workshop

☐ **D)** Hair, a dangling lanyard and open cuffs can be caught by the chuck, so tie the hair back, remove the lanyard and fasten the cuffs

15. A welder joins stainless pipework in a plant room where local exhaust cannot reach the joint. The supervisor issues a tight-fitting half-mask with brown gas-type cartridges, saying a gas filter is the strongest available. The welder has a short beard. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Welding fume is made of fine solid particles, so he needs a P3 particulate filter, a face-fit test and a clean-shaven seal

☐ **B)** Either filter will do if the cartridge is in date, because the expiry date and the seal matter more than the type of filter fitted

☐ **C)** A disposable FFP1 dust mask is enough, as it is a particulate type, and a beard matters little because the mask has a soft edge seal

☐ **D)** A brown organic vapour cartridge is correct, because strong gas filters trap the metal fume as well, and the beard only needs trimming

16. Two cleaners are to use a building's permanent suspended cradle with a safe working load of 250 kg. A third colleague wants to ride along with a heavy toolbox, and the examination report and rescue plan are missing from the handover pack. What should the supervisor do?

☐ **A)** Let the three ride together if each is trained, since the safe working load is a guide that applies to the weight of the tools alone

☐ **B)** Start with two operatives now, since the cradle is permanent and fixed, and ask for the paperwork when the first day finishes

☐ **C)** Rely on the harness each operative wears, because fall arrest makes the missing rescue plan and the weight of the load unimportant here

☐ **D)** Hold the job until the examination report and rescue plan are seen, and keep people and equipment within the safe working load

17. On a new house, a first-floor window opening has a sill 700 mm above the floor, and the window frames are two weeks late. Carpenters work in the room daily. The foreman proposes hazard tape across the opening and a sign. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Run one tube at sill height because the sill already gives 700 mm of protection, and the opening is small enough for that to be enough

☐ **B)** Make the carpenters wear harnesses clipped to a stud in the framing, as fall arrest is quicker to arrange than building a guard here

☐ **C)** Keep the hazard tape and add a warning sign at the door, because workers who see them will keep well clear of the open edge

☐ **D)** Fit a rigid guard across the opening, with a top rail at least 950 mm high and an intermediate rail, fixed to the structure until glazing

18. A chain-lift skip lorry reverses toward a full skip in a narrow yard. The labourer who will hook on the chains stands between the skip and the lorry's rear, wearing hi-vis, saying the driver can see him in the mirrors. What is the main correction?

☐ **A)** Wait clear of the reversing path in the driver's view, and approach the chains only once the lorry is stopped, braked and signalled

☐ **B)** Wear a second hi-vis layer so mirrors show him clearly, and stay between the vehicles because the yard is too tight for another position

☐ **C)** Stay in the gap but face the lorry and shout the distance to the driver, because the reversing alarm will warn everyone nearby too

☐ **D)** Walk beside the skip with a hand on its edge to guide the chains, since touching the skip lets the driver feel the contact

19. A hoist on a scaffold is built for goods only, with a gate at each landing. A supervisor tells an apprentice to ride up with a pallet to save climbing to the third floor, saying the closed gates make it safe. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** People must not ride a goods-only hoist whatever the gates do, and gates stay shut while the platform moves and

open only to load

☐ **B)** One short trip is acceptable if the load is under the safe working load and the apprentice holds on to the frame of the platform

☐ **C)** The apprentice may ride if gates at every landing are closed and he stands clear of the pallet, as closed gates remove the risk of falling

☐ **D)** Riding is allowed when the operator is told first, because the warning lets him check the gates and run the platform slowly up

20. To keep an air compressor warm and pressurised, a contractor leaves it idling all night beside houses. A planning condition limits noisy plant to 08:00 to 18:00 on weekdays. A neighbour complains. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Rely on the earlier consent for noisy work from the council, because that consent covers running the compressor at any hour of night

☐ **B)** Issue ear defenders to all site staff, because hearing protection brings the noise level inside what the planning condition requires

☐ **C)** Shut the compressor down outside the permitted hours, change the routine so it needs no overnight run, and keep its canopy doors closed

☐ **D)** Leave it running but add a sound screen around it, since screening at the source removes the need to follow the hours in the planning condition

21. A principal contractor shortlists a demolition subcontractor holding a valid SSIP-recognised certificate. The job is dismantling a tall chimney beside an occupied school, and the firm has so far done only low-rise strip-outs. What should the principal contractor do before appointing it?

☐ **A)** Appoint it on the certificate alone, because HSE accepts accreditation as full proof of capability for any project the firm takes on

☐ **B)** Reject any firm without a previous chimney of this exact height, since only identical past projects can prove organisational capability

☐ **C)** Appoint it now and assess its competence through the method statement once work is under way and the chimney scaffold is up

☐ **D)** Treat the certificate as a starting point, then check the firm's experience, resources and proposed method for this particular chimney job

22. The unsupported edge of a 1.8 m trench slumps and pins a labourer to the waist in soil. Two colleagues want to jump in and dig, and the machine operator offers to scrape the spoil away with the bucket. What is the correct order of response?

☐ **A)** Scrape away the loose spoil with the excavator under a banksman's signals, then call 999 once the casualty has been uncovered.

☐ **B)** Jump in at once and dig around his chest by hand, then call 999 when he is breathing freely and sitting up in the trench.

☐ **C)** Stop plant and keep people back from the edge, raise the alarm and call 999, then support the sides before anyone goes in.

☐ **D)** Send one person to call 999 while the others lie flat at the edge and pull him free by the arms with the plant left running.

23. A scraper strips a patch of textured ceiling coating in a school corridor, and a lab result later suggests it contained asbestos. A colleague proposes brushing the dust off the floor with the site dustpan and washing his overalls at home. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Lightly spray the dust and sweep it up with the dustpan, then wash the overalls at home on a hot cycle to remove fibres

☐ **B)** Carry on once the dust is out of sight, since one short disturbance of a thin coating is too small an exposure to matter

☐ **C)** Use the site vacuum cleaner on the floor, because a few minutes of suction is safe for such a small patch of dust

☐ **D)** Stop work, keep others away, tell the supervisor, leave cleaning to trained staff using damp methods, and bag the overalls as waste

24. A civils firm starts a night shift of twelve operatives breaking out and relaying a road with plant moving. The only trained first aider works days, and the night supervisor, an appointed person, holds a charged phone. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Nights need only a stocked first-aid kit, since a smaller gang means fewer injuries and a lower first-aid requirement

☐ **B)** The appointed person is enough on nights because the

day first aider's certificate covers the whole contract period

☐ **C)** The day first aider can be on call by phone, provided he lives within thirty minutes' drive of the site

☐ **D)** First-aid cover must match the hours worked, so a trained first aider needs to be present on the night shift as well

25. A first-floor slab was cast four days ago over adjustable props. The bricklaying foreman wants to stack two pallets of blocks near the edge, saying the concrete feels hard and the props are in place. Who must clear the loading?

☐ **A)** Anyone may load it after seven days, as that is the standard period after which any new slab carries site materials

☐ **B)** The prop supplier's delivery note confirms safe loads, so loading may begin once all the props have been fitted

☐ **C)** No loading until the temporary works coordinator has checked the props against the design and issued a permit to load

☐ **D)** The foreman may decide, since an experienced bricklayer can judge whether hardened concrete will carry two small pallets



26. Look at the scene. Which combination of faults makes a serious injury most likely during this delivery?

☐ **A)** The lorry has been parked on a steep slope, and the platform edge has a barrier that has been tied back out of the way

☐ **B)** The operator is walking backwards towards an unprotected drop, and the lorry sits off the platform without its wheels chocked

☐ **C)** The pallet is stacked too high and unwrapped, and a second worker is standing in the path of the pallet truck

☐ **D)** The operator has no hard hat or gloves, and the platform surface is wet and poorly lit for the pallet truck

27. A screw conveyor on a batching plant jams. The operator presses the emergency stop, then reaches into the trough with a steel bar to free the material, saying the machine is stopped. What is wrong with this approach?

☐ **A)** A stop button is not isolation, so the plant should be locked off at its isolator and stored energy released before anyone reaches in

☐ **B)** Nothing, because an emergency stop is designed to cut power to the whole machine and it can be treated as isolation

☐ **C)** He should post a colleague at the control panel with a hand on the stop button while the bar is used inside the trough

☐ **D)** He should switch off at the guard interlock only, since an interlocked guard held open always prevents the screw from turning

28. A carpenter is told to build a stud partition boxing in a live distribution board in a corridor, with battens screwed to the wall around it. Cable routes behind the plaster are not known. Which approach is best for someone who is not an electrician?

☐ **A)** Stop and ask a competent electrician to move or isolate the board, keeping clear access to it and checking cable routes before fixing.

☐ **B)** Switch off the main switch on the board himself to make it dead, then fix the battens, as any worker can isolate a supply.

☐ **C)** Box it in fully with screwed panels, as a covered board is protected from damage and nobody will go near the live parts.

☐ **D)** Drill the fixings with a cordless drill and an insulated bit, since battery tools cannot pass mains current to the user.

29. A site has six empty 205-litre steel drums that held solvent-based sealant. They still smell of solvent and contain residue. The foreman books a registered carrier to take them away as scrap metal on a standard transfer note. What is the right approach?

☐ **A)** Send them as scrap metal, since steel is recyclable and a registered carrier with a transfer note meets the duty of care

☐ **B)** Check the carrier's registration number only, because the destination site's permit is the carrier's concern rather than the producer's

☐ **C)** Rinse them in the yard and run the washings to the gully, which then lets the drums be classed as non-hazardous waste

☐ **D)** Treat them as hazardous waste: classify them correctly, use a consignment note, and check the carrier's registration and

the destination's permit

30. A 25-litre drum of acid-based brick cleaner splits when dropped on a paved wash area. The liquid runs towards a surface-water drain that discharges to a brook. Nobody has yet seen it enter the drain. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Absorb it with the kit, put the used absorbent in the general waste skip, and report only if the brook looks discoloured

☐ **B)** Dilute it with plenty of water from the hose so the acid is weak enough to be washed safely down the drain

☐ **C)** Stop the leak, cover the drain and dam the spill, absorb it, and phone the regulator's hotline if it may reach the brook

☐ **D)** Neutralise it with a bag of cement powder, then sweep the residue into the drain once it has stopped fizzing

31. Halfway through construction, the client asks for a lighter roof beam to be substituted for the specified steel one. The structural designer issues a revised drawing by email to the site agent. The principal designer says the change is a site matter now. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Liaison ended when the pre-construction phase finished, so the revised drawing only has to be filed with the health and safety file at handover

☐ **B)** The designer must consider the risks the change creates and pass on the information, while the principal designer keeps liaising with the principal contractor

☐ **C)** The designer may issue the revision without further information provided the new beam meets the structural calculations and the client has approved it

☐ **D)** The change is an alteration to the construction method, so only the principal contractor must assess it once the original design has been signed off

32. A labourer notices a propped wall opening a wide new crack and walks away from the area, telling his foreman immediately. The foreman calls it overreacting and cuts the labourer's hours the following week. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A worker who leaves because of serious and imminent danger is protected from detriment if the steps taken were appropriate in the circumstances

☐ **B)** Protection applies only to appointed safety representatives, so an ordinary labourer must wait for a representative to raise the matter on his behalf

☐ **C)** Leaving is permitted but the employer may reduce hours as a fair consequence of lost production, provided the supervisor was informed first

☐ **D)** A worker may withdraw from any task he feels uneasy about, and the employer cannot challenge the decision whatever the actual level of danger

33. A new bricklayer signs the gatehouse induction sheet, which covered routes, welfare and emergency arrangements. The foreman says that covers everything, so the gang's task briefing on the cut-out of a lift shaft is not needed. Which statement correctly distinguishes the two?

☐ **A)** Induction gives site-wide rules before work starts; the task briefing explains the controls to those doing the job and is repeated if the method changes

☐ **B)** A signed induction record shows the worker has been told about every task on site, so a separate briefing only duplicates it unless an accident has occurred

☐ **C)** The task briefing replaces the induction for anyone who has worked on similar sites, because experienced workers already know the general site arrangements

☐ **D)** The briefing is a record-keeping exercise for managers, who sign attendance, while the induction is the only part that actually informs the workforce

34. Two labourers lay mineral wool insulation between loft rafters on a hot day, with sleeves rolled up. By lunchtime their forearms itch and their eyes sting. One blows fibres off his overalls with an air line. What is the best way to control the problem?

☐ **A)** Keep working in short sleeves and apply barrier cream at lunch, since the irritation is temporary and the itching soon fades once skin toughens.

☐ **B)** Wear long sleeves, gloves and eye protection, limit cutting and handling, and wash off fibres with soap and cool water at welfare.

☐ **C)** Blow the fibres off clothing with the air line after each task, then rub the stinging eyes clean with a gloved hand.

☐ **D)** Scrub arms hard with hot water and a stiff brush at the

end of each shift, because hot water opens the pores and removes the fibres.



35. Look at the scene. The operative is wearing high-visibility clothing, a helmet and safety boots. What is the most significant problem with how this work is set up?

☐ **A)** The operative should face the traffic at all times, since he could then see any vehicle approaching and step clear in good time

☐ **B)** The saw is being used at kerb level, which is the main hazard, because cutting low produces more dust and requires respiratory protection first

☐ **C)** There is no proper signing, guarding or separation from the moving traffic, so the work zone itself does not protect him

☐ **D)** Traffic noise will stop him hearing the saw, so hearing protection is the most urgent missing item, before any change to the traffic arrangements

36. A fitter must work at a ceiling in a loading bay whose concrete floor falls gently towards a drain. He sets up podium steps, applies all the castor brakes and packs plywood under the low-side wheels. He says the brakes make it stable. What is the most accurate response?

☐ **A)** The arrangement is acceptable provided the plywood is thick enough to bring the steps visually level and the fitter keeps three points of contact

☐ **B)** The fitter should fix a rope from the platform to a hand rail so that the steps cannot move when he leans to reach the ceiling

☐ **C)** Applying the brakes to all four castors satisfies the manufacturer's requirements for any surface, so the slope matters only to the drain

☐ **D)** Braked wheels stop rolling but not tipping, so the steps need a surface within the maker's limits or equipment with levelling legs

37. A 1.4 m deep service trench is to run 0.5 m from the strip footing of a 1930s house whose base is about 0.6 m down. The supervisor says the trench box he has hired holds the sides, so nothing else is needed. Which action is best before digging?

☐ **A)** Dig by hand in short lengths beside the footing and backfill each length immediately, as hand digging is gentle enough to avoid any ground movement

☐ **B)** Get a competent engineer to assess whether the footing needs temporary support, then set a method and a way of watching for movement

☐ **C)** Rely on the footing being 0.6 m deep, since foundations of that depth sit below the level where digging nearby could affect them

☐ **D)** Keep the box tight against the trench sides, because a snug shield also prevents any movement of the soil beneath the neighbouring footing

38. Drivers of a large rigid dump truck reverse across a stockyard shared with labourers on foot. The site manager points to the convex mirrors fitted to every cab and says the drivers have all-round vision, so the walkers need no separate route. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Drivers who pass a competence test with mirrors can reverse without a signaller, since the test proves they judge distances accurately

☐ **B)** Larger or additional mirrors remove the blind spots completely, after which separate pedestrian routes and signallers add nothing to the arrangement

☐ **C)** Mirrors only reduce blind areas and distort distance, so pedestrians should be kept out of the manoeuvring zone, with a signaller where reversing remains

☐ **D)** Convex mirrors give a full view when correctly adjusted, so wearing high-visibility clothing is enough to let walkers share the area safely

39. A 13-tonne excavator working into a winter evening slews beside a temporary Heras fence, with 0.5 m between its tail swing and the fence. Its work lights shine on the trench. Walkers use the public footway behind the fence. Which action best deals with the risk?

☐ **A)** Ask the operator to check the mirrors before each slew and to work slowly, since the trench lights are enough to show the fence line

☐ **B)** Rely on the machine's flashing beacon and audible alarm to warn walkers, as the fence already prevents access to the swinging counterweight

☐ **C)** Set the fence beyond the full tail-swing radius or limit the slew, and light the whole area so operator and walkers can see the boundary

☐ **D)** Fit a second Heras panel against the first to thicken the barrier, so that a bumped fence can no longer be pushed into the footway

40. A crew finishing a slab at night uses four high-mounted floodlights aimed across the site. Bedroom windows in the houses opposite are lit up, and a neighbour complains. The foreman says light is not pollution, so nothing can be required of the site. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Treat it as a nuisance risk: aim and shield the lights downward, use only what the task needs, and switch off when not needed

☐ **B)** Ask the residents to draw their curtains while the work continues, because the site's lighting is needed for the safety of the crew

☐ **C)** Fit brighter lamps so the area is lit evenly and no deep shadows remain, which will make the glare from the site less noticeable

☐ **D)** Ignore it, since lighting is not a pollutant and the nuisance rules cover only noise, smoke, dust and smell from a site

41. Eight weeks into a fit-out, a specialist cladding subcontractor is appointed late. Its method needs crane lifts across the main walkway and moves two other trades' work areas. The principal contractor says the construction phase plan was agreed at start, so the cladders must adapt to it. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** The plan is revised only if the client asks for it, because it is the client's approval at the start that makes the document valid

☐ **B)** The principal contractor must update the plan for the new sequence and lifts, then tell the other trades and the wider workforce about the changes

☐ **C)** The plan stays as agreed at the start, and the cladding subcontractor writes its own method statement to cover the new lifts and the moved work areas

☐ **D)** The other trades update their own risk assessments individually, because the plan only needs revising when the project overruns its programme

42. A roof-edge repair was assessed in summer as low risk. On a clear November morning, a hard frost glazes the access scaffold boards and the flat roof surface. The supervisor wants the crew to start on time, saying the assessment and RAMS are signed and in date. Which action is most appropriate?

☐ **A)** Let experienced roofers decide for themselves whether the frosted surface feels safe, since they are competent to judge ground conditions at height

☐ **B)** Start as planned, because the signed RAMS already cover the task and operatives are expected to take extra care on slippery boards and roof

☐ **C)** Treat the frost as a change that outdates the assessment, then delay the start or de-ice the access and roof, and brief the crew on the new controls

☐ **D)** Issue grip-soled boots and carry on, because the footwear then makes the access and the roof surface safe to work on in the frost today

43. A labourer slips on hydraulic oil beside a mini-excavator and sprains an ankle. The oil came from a weeping hose that had been reported twice, but the weekly plant check form has no hose item and the programme left no time for maintenance. Which is the best statement of the root cause?

☐ **A)** The oil on the ground was the cause, so the labourer should have looked down and watched his footing while walking beside the machine itself

☐ **B)** The sprain happened because the labourer walked too close to plant, so the root cause is a lack of exclusion zones around working machines

☐ **C)** The hose failed through ordinary wear, so the cause is unavoidable and a spill kit placed beside the machine would be the right response here

☐ **D)** Weak management arrangements, namely checks that miss hoses and reports not acted on, let a known leak continue

and spread

44. Two labourers must carry 6 m lengths of plastic drainage pipe about 40 m across uneven ground to a trench. One is much taller than the other, and they plan to carry each length on their shoulders without any discussion beforehand. Which approach is best?

☐ **A)** Have each person lift one end at the same moment on a shout, which is enough co-ordination for a short carry of this kind

☐ **B)** Let the taller person take the front end and walk quickly, because a short exposure time reduces the strain on both of them

☐ **C)** Carry on as planned, since sharing the pipe between two people halves the load and therefore removes the manual handling risk entirely

☐ **D)** Assess the task, pair operatives of similar height, nominate one to signal, clear the route and consider a trolley for the distance

45. A banksman tells his supervisor he has a long-term health condition that may affect him at times. The site classes banksman duties as safety critical. The supervisor wants to remove him from the role at once, while a colleague says his private health is not the company's concern. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Discuss his needs with him, take occupational health advice, consider adjustments, and decide his duties on the individual evidence, not assumptions

☐ **B)** Move him to labouring duties and record that he declined work, which means the company avoids any further duty to consider changes

☐ **C)** Remove him from all safety-critical work permanently, because the employer's health and safety duty overrides any wish to keep him in the role at all

☐ **D)** Leave him in post and say nothing further, because an employee's health is private and the employer has no right to ask about fitness

46. A joiner who wears prescription glasses is about to use an angle grinder on masonry. He says his own glasses, with a pair of stick-on side shields, are enough, and the site goggles feel too loose to fit over them. Which action is correct?

☐ **A)** Allow his own glasses, because the lenses already give a barrier and the stick-on side shields stop particles reaching the eyes from the side

☐ **B)** Provide eye protection suited to the grinding hazard that fits him properly, either over-glasses goggles or prescription safety eyewear

☐ **C)** Let him use the loose goggles anyway with the strap tightened up, since any goggles are better than none for a short task like this

☐ **D)** Let him do the task without eye protection by keeping his head turned away from the sparks and debris, since the cut is a short one



47. Look at the scene. The operative says the 110 V supply is low voltage and his rubber boots will protect him as he reaches for the charger. What should the supervisor do first?

☐ **A)** Stop him touching anything, isolate the supply at source, then move the equipment out of the water and have it checked

☐ **B)** Tell him to wait until the pump has drained the floor, then carry on using the same set-up since the water will be gone by then too

☐ **C)** Let him lift the charger onto the plank and carry on, because the reduced 110 V supply and his rubber boots give him enough protection

☐ **D)** Have him dry the plug and the connectors with a dry rag while they stay live, so the contacts are not wet when he picks them up

48. A firm hires a scissor-lift MEWP to change light fittings in a warehouse. The trained operator will work alone in the platform, and nobody else has looked at the machine's controls. Besides the operator's pre-use checks, which arrangement must be in place before the lift starts?

☐ **A)** A delivery check carried out by the hire company, which covers the machine for the hire and makes daily user checks unnecessary.

☐ **B)** The fire service number displayed by the machine, as the brigade will carry out any rescue if the platform fails or the operator is taken ill.

☐ **C)** A colleague standing at the base to hand up tools, who can pull the emergency lowering lever if the operator shouts for help.

☐ **D)** A rescue plan naming someone trained to use the ground controls and emergency lowering, and a marked exclusion zone below the platform.

49. A trench is to run 700 mm from the brick wall of a below-ground chamber that holds live electrical cable joints. The drawings show the cables, and the supervisor wants the excavator to dig the full depth, saying the chamber is solid and the cable owner need not be involved. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Use the excavator for the first metre only, then hand dig, because the drawing has already shown where the cables are located

☐ **B)** Let the excavator dig, but keep the trench sides sloped, since sloping alone stops any movement of the chamber wall beside the trench

☐ **C)** Agree the work with the cable owner, hand dig near the chamber, and support the trench so its wall is not undermined

☐ **D)** Isolate the cables yourself with the supervisor's approval, since the contractor is allowed to switch off equipment belonging to another owner

50. A mobile crane must lift a plant skid with no weight marked and set it behind a hoarding the operator cannot see over. The foreman estimates it from the skid's size and offers to wave the operator on from the front gate. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Lift the skid a short distance first to see how the crane handles, then continue if the boom and outriggers appear steady.

☐ **B)** Let the foreman wave the operator on from the front gate, since an experienced person's hand signals are enough without any training or radio.

☐ **C)** Confirm the weight from documents or by weighing, check it against the load chart at the working radius, and use a trained signaller.

☐ **D)** Add a generous margin to the foreman's estimate and rely on the crane's overload indicator to warn if the real weight turns out heavier.

Answer Key

1. B — The principal contractor must provide suitable welfare facilities for the whole construction phase and keep site rules in force, so a lone subcontractor on a quiet day is covered by both.

A: Site rules are part of controlling risk throughout the project and apply to every worker, however few are present. C: The principal contractor's welfare duty extends to all workers on the site, not just its own people or its normal days. D: The duty to provide facilities does not depend on a headcount threshold being reached on a particular day.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming welfare and site rules only matter on days when the main workforce is present.

2. C — Information on risks and control measures must be comprehensible, and the site where they work knows its own hazards, so understanding must be confirmed rather than assumed.

A: An untrained colleague may omit or misstate risks and nobody checks the other workers understood the controls. B: A generic assessment cannot cover site-specific hazards, and the site controlling the work must supply that information. D: Information must be comprehensible to the people receiving it, and a signature does not show it was understood.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that giving someone a document, or an agency's generic paperwork, shows they have been properly informed about site risks.

3. B — Any switch can spark and ignite a gas build-up, so ignition sources are avoided, ventilation is helped, people are evacuated and the leak is reported from a safe place.

A: Operating a switch may ignite the gas, and untrained repairs inside a gas-filled space add to the danger. C: Operating the consumer unit can itself spark, and staying inside leaves workers exposed to an explosion. D: Nobody should stay in the building to investigate, and a plumber is not the emergency service for a suspected leak.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that switching off electrics or investigating the source yourself is safer than getting out first.

4. D — Fire needs fuel, heat and oxygen, so keeping clothing off heaters and keeping circuits within their rating removes both the fuel near the heat and the overheating cable.

A: A timer does not stop fabric on a heater igniting, and it leaves the overloaded adaptor untouched. B: Alarms and extinguishers are response measures and do nothing to prevent the overheating that starts the fire. C: A heavier lead helps the cable but does not remove the overloaded adaptor or the clothing placed on the heater.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a warm plug or a heater used as a clothes rack as normal wear rather than an early fire warning.

5. B — COSHH requires substitution before ventilation or respirators, and solvent vapours are flammable as well as harmful, so ignition sources must be controlled.

A: Substitution should be considered first, and the supplier's label does not replace an assessment of this room and its ignition sources. C: Blowing vapour around spreads flammable vapour towards other rooms and neighbouring ignition sources rather than controlling it. D: A dust mask does not filter solvent vapour, and a closed small room lets flammable vapour build up.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on a mask and a bit of fresh air instead of first asking whether a safer product could do the job.

6. B — Manual handling duties require avoiding the lift where possible, then assessing task, load, individual and environment, so aids and a planned route reduce the hazard before reliance on strength.

A: Hurrying increases the risk of a drop or collision, and the stair, route and edges all need planning beforehand. C: Sharing does not make the awkward, fragile load safe, and mechanical aids should be considered before manual carrying. D: Employers must assess the task in advance and cannot leave a foreseeable heavy awkward lift to chance on the day.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that putting two people on a heavy awkward load is the same as assessing and reducing the risk.

7. C — Work at height is avoided where reasonably practicable, then falls are prevented with suitable equipment, and personal protection or ladders come last.

A: Personal protection ranks below avoiding the work and collective protection, and a rung is not a suitable anchor. B: Footing is a minor aid for a ladder and does not remove the work at height or prevent a fall. D: The regulations require work at height to be avoided where reasonably practicable before choosing any access equipment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Jumping to the access equipment (ladder, harness or tower) without first asking whether the work can be done from the ground.

8. D — A fall at the slab edge is not limited to the ladder height, so the missing edge protection turns a minor stumble into a fall

of several metres.

A: The ladder stands on a dry, level concrete slab with its feet flat, which is a suitable base. B: A stepladder is not an anchor point, and a harness is not the control for short ladder work, so this is not the main hazard. C: A light tool bag worn on the body is acceptable, and it is far less serious than working beside an unprotected edge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a ladder setup only by the ladder itself and ignoring what surrounds the working position.

9. C — Material and vehicles near an excavation add weight that increases pressure on the sides, so they must be kept clear or allowed for in the support design.

A: Fitting and inspection do not show the support was designed for added loads from nearby stored materials or vehicles. B: There is no fixed legal distance, since the safe distance depends on depth, ground, support design and the weight of the load. D: Sleepers spread local load but do not remove the extra pressure near the trench, and the lorry's weight is still unaddressed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a supported trench is safe against anything placed beside it.

10. B — Routes must suit the machine's stated gradient capability, and a steeper ramp risks loss of control or overturn however carefully a skilled driver proceeds.

A: A seat belt and slow travel do not offset a gradient beyond the machine's design limit. C: The gradient limit is a stability and braking limit of the machine and does not become acceptable because the load is lighter. D: Route planning should not depend on a driver's judgement, and manufacturer limits must be respected for the machine.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that skilled driving and slow speed make it acceptable to exceed what the machine is designed to handle.

11. B — Section 8 of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act applies to everyone on site, not just employees, so misusing provided safety equipment is an offence whatever his employer.

A: Section 8 says no person may misuse such provision, so it is not limited to the employer who supplied it. C: A convenient purpose does not excuse deliberately misusing equipment, and the missing prop and wash facilities should have been reported, not worked around. D: The offence is the intentional or reckless misuse itself and does not depend on an injury occurring.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that only employers and direct employees carry duties and that a safety item can be borrowed for another use if nobody is hurt.

12. A — Smoking is banned in nearly all enclosed workplaces, while e-cigarettes fall outside that ban, so the employer should assess their risks, including near fuel, and can set a policy.

B: E-cigarettes are not regulated like tobacco, so there is no general legal ban and any restriction comes from the employer's policy. C: The ban on smoking in enclosed workplaces cannot be waived by a vote or by the agreement of the people inside. D: The employer can and must control smoking indoors, and may restrict vaping through site rules and risk assessment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that because vaping is not smoking in law, an employer has no ability or reason to control where it happens.

13. A — Poor or badly positioned lighting strains the eyes and raises error risk, so the employer should provide suitable and sufficient lighting for the task and reduce long spells of close work.

B: Tinted glasses reduce the light reaching the eye in an already dim room and leave the poor lighting unfixed. C: One strong light at eye level causes glare and harsh shadows, which can make eye strain and errors worse. D: The cause here is inadequate lighting for the task, so testing one worker's sight does not remove the hazard for him or anyone else.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating tired, sore eyes as the worker's own problem rather than a sign that the task lighting is unsuitable.

14. D — Rotating parts can snag long hair, loose clothing and swinging items, so these must be secured or removed before using the machine.

A: Drilling a small steel bracket gives off swarf rather than a significant airborne dust, so a respirator does not address what is wrong. B: Fixed guards must stay in place while the machine runs, and removing one adds a hazard instead of dealing with the real one. C: Nothing overhead is shown in the workshop, so head protection is not the risk that matters in this picture.

COMMON MISTAKE: Focusing on the hazards of the material, such as swarf and dust, and overlooking what a worker is wearing or carrying that could be dragged into the machine.

15. A — A white particulate filter stops fume particles, P3 gives the highest protection, and a tight-fitting mask works only if the seal is clear of facial hair and has passed a fit test.

B: Filter type must match the contaminant, so a new gas cartridge still fails to stop particles, whatever its date. C: FFP1 gives the lowest

protection level and a beard still breaks the seal of any tight-fitting mask. D: Brown filters remove organic vapours, not solid particles such as metal fume, and trimming does not guarantee a face seal.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing respirator filters by how strong they look rather than matching the filter type to whether the contaminant is a particle, a gas or a vapour.

16. D — Contractors should see the thorough examination report and the rescue plan before work, and the safe working load covers the people and everything else on the cradle.

A: The safe working load includes the people as well as the equipment, so a third person and toolbox could overload the cradle. B: Checking that the cradle is examined and a rescue plan exists must happen before anyone is suspended, not after the work starts. C: A harness does not replace a rescue plan or the load limit, and it cannot rescue a worker suspended after the platform fails.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a permanent installation or a harness means the paperwork and load limit can be sorted out after work begins.

17. D — An opening that people can fall through needs proper edge protection, with a top rail at least 950 mm high and no gap over 470 mm, kept in place until the window is installed.

A: A single rail at 700 mm is below the minimum top rail height and leaves a gap large enough for a person to fall through. B: Collective protection comes before personal protection, and a stud is not a rated anchor point for a fall arrest lanyard. C: Tape and signs only advise people and do nothing physical to stop a fall through the opening.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking an existing sill, tape or signs can stand in for proper edge protection across a low wall opening.

18. A — The gap between a reversing vehicle and a skip is a crush point, so the person hooking on should wait outside it in view and approach only once the vehicle is stationary and secured.

B: Hi-vis helps visibility but cannot make a crush point safe, and a tight yard is a reason to change the arrangement, not to stand there. C: Standing in the crush point is the hazard itself, and a shouted distance or an alarm cannot stop a lorry in time. D: The driver cannot feel contact through the lorry, and a person beside a moving skip can still be trapped against a wall.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting that being seen in a mirror, or wearing hi-vis, makes it safe to stand in the path of a vehicle that is still moving.

19. A — A goods hoist is not designed or approved to carry people, and its landing gates must be closed while the platform moves.

B: Staying within the load limit does not make a goods hoist suitable for carrying a person. C: Closed landing gates protect people from the shaft but do not make a goods platform safe to travel on. D: Telling the operator changes nothing about the fact that the platform has no protection or controls for passengers.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a piece of guarding or a short journey turns equipment built for goods into equipment fit for carrying people.

20. C — A planning condition on working hours binds the site separately from other noise controls, so the plant must be off outside the hours and the canopy kept closed to reduce noise.

A: A consent for noisy works is not a licence to break a planning condition, and the two requirements both apply. B: Ear defenders protect workers only and do nothing about noise reaching nearby homes. D: A screen reduces noise but does not alter the planning condition, which restricts when the plant may operate.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a screen, ear defenders or a council consent for noisy works cancels the working hours set in a planning condition.

21. D — Accreditation shows a general health and safety standard, but HSE says it is not on its own enough to judge a firm's capability for a specific project.

A: HSE does not treat membership as a sufficient assessment of organisational capability for the particular work. B: Capability is judged on relevant skills, resources and planning, not on having completed an identical job. C: Competence must be checked before appointment, since waiting until work has started leaves the risk uncontrolled.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a valid accreditation certificate settles whether a subcontractor can safely carry out this specific job.

22. C — Further collapse could bury rescuers as well, so the area is made safe and help summoned first, and nobody enters until the sides are supported or specialist rescuers take over.

A: Machine digging next to a trapped person can crush him and cause more fallen material, and the emergency call should not wait for the dig. B: Entering an unsupported trench without protection risks a second collapse that buries the rescuers, and calling for help is delayed when it should be immediate. D: Dragging a trapped casualty can cause crush and spinal injuries, and running plant adds vibration and the risk of more of the edge falling in.

COMMON MISTAKE: Rushing into a collapsed excavation to rescue a colleague before the ground has been made safe.

23. D — Dry brushing and taking clothing home spread fibres, so work stops and trained people clean up using damp or Class H methods while contaminated overalls are treated as asbestos waste.

A: Sweeping still raises fibres and domestic washing carries them into the home and the machine. B: Any exposure matters and the area must be controlled, because no safe level of asbestos exposure is known. C: An ordinary vacuum passes fine fibres through its filter back into the air and is not suitable for asbestos.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a small amount of dust can be tidied away with ordinary site cleaning tools before telling anyone.

24. D — Adequate first-aid provision is needed at all times people are at work, and an appointed person only takes charge of arrangements, so higher-risk night work needs a trained first aider on shift.

A: Plant movement and breaking-out work keep the hazard high, and a kit cannot treat anyone without someone trained to use it. B: A certificate belongs to one person who is not present at night, so it gives the night shift no first-aid cover. C: Delayed help from off site is not first-aid provision for a high-risk workplace where injuries need immediate action.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting first-aid cover as met by a day-shift certificate or a phone rather than a trained person present at the time.

25. C — Loading a slab on temporary works must be controlled by a coordinator, who confirms the props match the design and the concrete has gained the strength the designer requires.

A: A fixed day count ignores the design, the tested concrete strength and the condition of the supports. B: A delivery note shows what was supplied and not that the props are installed to the design or the slab is ready. D: Feel and appearance do not show the strength of young concrete or the capacity of the props.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging whether a young slab can be loaded by how hard it feels instead of waiting for formal clearance.

26. B — Walking backwards towards an open edge with no barrier risks a fall, and an unchocked vehicle with a gap beside the platform can move or leave a gap to fall into.

A: No slope or tied-back barrier is shown, since the picture shows an edge with no protection at all. C: The pallet is low, stable and shrink-wrapped, and the second worker is well away from the pallet truck. D: The operator is wearing a hard hat, gloves and boots, and the platform is dry and well lit.

COMMON MISTAKE: Looking only at the load or the clothing and missing the unprotected edge and the unsecured vehicle beside it.

27. A — A stop control can be reset or fail, so the plant must be isolated from its power source, secured against restart and made safe from stored energy before clearing the blockage.

B: An emergency stop is a control device that can be reset by someone else, so it is not positive isolation. C: A person standing by is not a physical barrier against restart and cannot react quickly enough to a start-up. D: An interlock can be defeated or fail, and it does not remove stored energy or secure the supply against restart.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a stop button or a guard interlock as a substitute for locking off the supply before clearing a jam.

28. A — Only competent people should work on or near live electrical equipment, the board must stay accessible for emergency isolation, and fixing into a wall with unknown cables risks striking a live conductor.

B: Isolating needs a competent person who proves the supply dead and secures it, and other circuits and the board's incoming terminals stay live. C: Enclosing the board blocks access for emergency isolation and inspection, and does nothing about cables hidden in the wall. D: A battery tool still cuts into live cable, can cause arcing, and does not remove the need for cable detection and competent advice.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a closed enclosure or a battery tool makes work beside live electrical equipment safe for anyone.

29. D — Drums holding hazardous residue count as hazardous waste, which in England needs a consignment note and checks that the carrier is registered and the receiving site is permitted.

A: The residue makes the drums hazardous, so a standard transfer note and a recyclable material label are not enough. B: The producer's duty of care extends to confirming that the waste goes to a site holding the proper permit. C: Washing solvent into a drain is a pollution offence and the resulting washings are themselves waste.

COMMON MISTAKE: Calling a container empty because it is no longer usable, when residue inside can still make it hazardous waste.

30. C — Cutting off the source and protecting the drain stops the chemical reaching water, and a risk to a watercourse should be reported to the environment regulator straight away.

A: Used absorbent is hazardous waste, and waiting for visible damage delays a report that should follow the risk. B: Dilution still delivers the chemical to the brook and increases the volume of polluted liquid to deal with. D: Improvised neutralising is uncontrolled and adds alkaline pollution, and sweeping the residue into a drain still pollutes the brook.

COMMON MISTAKE: Waiting until pollution is visible in a watercourse before containing a spill or contacting the regulator.

31. B — Designers keep their CDM duties for design changes made during construction, and the principal designer must liaise with the principal contractor and share relevant information for the length of the appointment.

A: Liaison with the principal contractor continues for the duration of the principal designer's appointment, not just until construction starts. C: Structural adequacy and client approval do not remove the duty to address health and safety risks from the change or share information about them. D: A design change is still design work, so the designer's duties to address foreseeable risk and provide information remain in force.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming design responsibilities stop once construction begins, so later changes are treated as purely a site matter.

32. A — Under the Employment Rights Act 1996 workers are protected from detriment for leaving or refusing to return to a workplace in serious and imminent danger, judged on what they knew and the facilities and advice available.

B: Protection also covers individual workers who leave because of serious and imminent danger, not just safety representatives. C: Reducing hours because the worker acted on serious danger is exactly the kind of detriment the law prohibits. D: Protection depends on the belief and the steps taken being reasonable in the circumstances, not on the worker's unease alone.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that raising a safety concern or walking away from danger is a disciplinary risk the worker must simply accept.

33. A — A site induction covers general site arrangements, whereas a task briefing communicates the specific hazards and agreed controls from the risk assessment and method statement to the people carrying out that work.

B: A generic induction cannot cover the task-specific hazards and controls of each activity, and briefing is not limited to post-accident situations. C: Every new arrival needs site-specific induction, as emergency routes, welfare and rules differ from site to site whatever the experience. D: A briefing exists to inform those doing the work of the controls, and attendance records alone do not achieve this.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a signed induction sheet as proof that workers understand the controls for the specific task they are about to do.

34. B — Mineral wool fibres irritate skin, eyes and airways, so covering the skin, protecting the eyes and washing properly with welfare facilities all reduce harm, and fibres are not driven back into the air.

A: Barrier cream does not stop the sharp fibres reaching skin and eyes, and relying on the skin to toughen up is not a control. C: Compressed air throws the fibres back into the air for others to breathe, and rubbing eyes with a contaminated glove drives fibres into them. D: Scrubbing and hot water inflame already irritated skin and can embed fibres, whereas gentle washing with soap and cool water is advised.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating itching from insulation fibres as a harmless nuisance that skin will get used to.

35. C — High-visibility clothing is a last line of defence, and work beside a live carriageway needs planned signing, guarding and physical separation so that traffic cannot reach the working area.

A: Watching traffic is not a control, as a vehicle at speed leaves no time to react, and it removes his attention from the saw. B: Dust is a real concern but it is secondary to the risk of being struck by passing vehicles a metre away. D: Hearing protection is a separate matter and would not address the risk of being hit by a vehicle.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on bright clothing and personal vigilance to deal with traffic when the work area itself has not been properly signed and separated.

36. D — Podium steps are designed for firm, level ground, and brakes only prevent movement along the floor, so improvised packing is not a substitute for equipment suited to the slope.

A: Packing under castors is an unstable improvisation, and a level appearance and good posture do not make it safe. B: Tying off a free-standing platform does not correct its stability on a slope and may create a new hazard. C: Manufacturer limits cover the slope and surface condition as well as braking, so brakes do not satisfy them on their own.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that locked castors alone make a mobile platform stable, whatever the slope of the surface beneath it.

37. B — Excavations must not undermine nearby foundations,

and a trench box supports the trench sides without necessarily protecting the footing, so structural advice and monitoring are needed.

A: Hand digging reduces vibration but does not stop the soil beside the footing losing support or the footing being undermined. C: The trench is deeper than the footing, so the soil supporting it may be disturbed, and depth alone does not remove the risk. D: A shield holds the trench walls and workers safe but does not guarantee the ground carrying the footing will stay stable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that supporting the sides of a trench also protects the foundations of any building close beside it.

38. C — No mirror or camera removes every blind spot on a large dump truck, so the main control is to segregate pedestrians from vehicle movements and limit reversing.

A: Training does not remove blind areas or the distorted distances shown by convex mirrors, so it cannot replace segregation. B: No set of mirrors eliminates all blind spots on a large vehicle, and further controls remain necessary. D: Mirrors cannot show every blind spot, and bright clothing does not help if the driver cannot see the person at all.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating mirrors and cameras as a substitute for keeping pedestrians out of the area where large vehicles manoeuvre.

39. C — The tail swing must be kept clear of people and fixed barriers by a safe margin, and the lighting should cover the barrier and approach as well as the digging face.

A: Operator vigilance is a weak control, and lighting aimed at the trench does not show the fence line or the walkers beyond it. B: Beacons and alarms are only warnings, and a fence 0.5 m from the counterweight does not give enough clearance for a body or a hand through the mesh. D: A thicker barrier does not increase clearance from the counterweight and may increase the crush point between the fence and the machine.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking a warning light and a barrier placed tight against the machine are enough to protect the public from tail swing.

40. A — Artificial light can be a statutory nuisance, so lighting should be directed and limited to the task and works area.

B: Safety lighting can be directed and shielded, and the burden is not on neighbours. C: Brighter lamps increase the glare and spill without addressing the complaint. D: Artificial light from premises can also be a statutory nuisance.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming only noise, dust and smoke count as nuisance when work lights are left shining on neighbours.

41. B — Regulation 12 of CDM 2015 requires the principal contractor to keep the construction phase plan appropriately reviewed, updated and revised, so a late appointment that changes the work sequence and hazards means changing the plan and telling those affected.

A: The duty to keep the plan up to date rests with the principal contractor and does not depend on a request from the client. C: A subcontractor's method statement does not replace the principal contractor's duty to keep the overall plan and the interfaces between trades up to date. D: Changed sequence and new hazards trigger a revision, and separate trade assessments leave nobody coordinating the overlaps.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the construction phase plan as a document finished on day one rather than one that must change as the work and the contractors change.

42. C — Risk assessments must be reviewed when conditions change, and a frozen walking surface at height calls for revised controls such as de-icing or waiting until it clears.

A: Competence does not remove the employer's duty to reassess and set controls, and individual feel is not a reliable check on ice. B: A signed assessment written for summer conditions does not control an ice hazard, and relying on care alone is a weak control. D: Footwear is a last line of defence and does not deal with ice on boards at height, where a slip may mean a fall.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a signed risk assessment stays valid whatever the weather does on the day.

43. D — Root causes lie in the management systems that let unsafe conditions develop, whereas the oil on the ground is only the immediate cause of the slip.

A: The spilled oil is the immediate cause, and blaming individual attention ignores why the oil was there at all. B: This invents a different problem and does not explain why a leaking hose stayed in service. C: Wear is predictable and preventable through inspection and maintenance, and a spill kit only helps clean up after the event.

COMMON MISTAKE: Stopping the investigation at the first physical cause, such as the spill, and blaming the person who slipped.

44. D — Team handling needs a planned task, matched people and one co-ordinator so the load stays level and moves together, and mechanical aids should be considered for longer distances.

A: A shout at lift-off alone does not cover the whole carry, the route or the mismatch in heights, so planning is still missing. B: Speed and uneven heights tilt the load and increase the chance of a trip or a sudden transfer of weight. C: Sharing a load reduces the weight each carries but unbalanced, uncoordinated carrying creates new risks of slips, twisting and sudden load shifts.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that two people always make a heavy or awkward load safe without planning how they will move it.

45. A — Employers must consider reasonable adjustments for disabled workers and should avoid blanket assumptions, while still ensuring that anyone in a safety-critical role is fit to carry out that work safely.

B: Reassigning without consultation does not discharge the duty to consider adjustments and could be discriminatory. C: Automatic removal without an individual assessment ignores the duty to consider reasonable adjustments and treats the worker unfairly. D: Fitness for a safety-critical role affects other people, so the employer must handle the information properly and assess the risk, not ignore it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a health condition automatically either rules someone out of a safety-critical job or can be ignored.

46. B — Everyday spectacles are not designed to resist impact, so he needs protection chosen for the hazard and fitted to him, either worn over his glasses or made to his prescription.

A: Ordinary lenses and add-on shields are not impact-rated for grinding, so they can break or let fragments through. C: Eye protection that does not fit properly cannot protect reliably, and tightening a poor fit does not fix the problem. D: Positioning is not a substitute for protection, and grinding throws fragments in unpredictable directions.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that everyday prescription glasses count as eye protection for grinding.

47. A — Electrical equipment and connections in standing water must be made dead at the source before anyone touches them, and the set-up must then be relocated to a dry place and protected by an RCD.

B: The water is only one fault, and the daisy-chained, unprotected connections need correcting before any reuse. C: 110 V can still cause serious injury in wet conditions, and boots do not make it safe to handle live equipment in water. D: Touching live connections in a wet area is dangerous, and drying them while live exposes him to shock.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that 110 V or rubber boots make working with electrical equipment in wet conditions safe.

48. D — If the platform stops with the operator aloft, a trained person must be able to bring him down quickly, and the zone below keeps people clear of falling tools and moving parts.

A: The hire company's inspection does not replace the operator's pre-use check, and it says nothing about rescue or the area underneath. B: Relying on the emergency services leaves the operator stranded for too long, and a rescue plan must be workable by people on site. C: A person who has not been trained on the controls may lower the machine wrongly, and standing under the platform puts him in the fall zone.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a MEWP rescue can be worked out on the day if something goes wrong.

49. C — Digging near live services calls for safe digging practice, such as hand digging to expose them, and an excavation must be supported or otherwise made safe so that nearby structures are not undermined or collapsed.

A: Drawings are not a reliable guide to exact positions, and the chamber wall itself is still at risk from mechanical digging. B: Sloping on its own does not guarantee that the ground beneath a nearby structure stays stable, and it ignores the live cables. D: Isolating another party's live network is not for the contractor to do, and it does not deal with the instability near the chamber.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating an existing chamber as a fixed, solid obstacle and forgetting that digging beside it can undermine it.

50. C — The lift plan needs a verified load weight to check against the crane's capacity at that radius, and a blind lift needs a trained signaller using agreed signals or radio.

A: A trial lift cannot reveal how close the crane is to its limit, and capacity at the radius must be established before the load is raised. B: A signaller must be trained, positioned with a clear view of the load and landing, and use agreed signals, which a person at the gate cannot do. D: A guess is not a verified weight, and the indicator is a last warning device that should not be used to find the load weight.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a load's weight by eye and trusting the crane's alarms to catch a wrong guess.

PRACTICE TEST 10

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A principal contractor runs a site with two buildings and four contractors. The fire sounder is audible only in the main block, and no evacuation drill has been held since the subcontractors arrived. Which arrangement best meets the CDM duty on emergency procedures?

☐ **A)** Emergency arrangements cover evacuating any part of the site, suit its layout and headcount, are made known to all concerned, and are tested at suitable intervals

☐ **B)** Each contractor writes its own evacuation plan for its own gang and chooses its own assembly point, because the sounder in the main block alerts everyone who needs it

☐ **C)** The procedure is read out at each new starter's induction, which makes everyone familiar with it and removes the need for any later testing of the arrangements on site

☐ **D)** One evacuation plan is pinned in the main cabin and signed by every contractors' supervisor, with any practice drill left until the next formal audit takes place

2. A principal contractor assesses a crane lift in a shared yard where four self-employed bricklayers also work. The findings stay in the office file, and only the contractor's own staff hear about the controls. What must change?

☐ **A)** The record must be kept for three years then destroyed, matching the accident records, and sharing becomes necessary only after an incident has happened

☐ **B)** Relevant findings and controls must reach everyone the lift could affect, including the self-employed gang, and the record stays current while the work continues

☐ **C)** Findings need telling only to the contractor's own staff, because self-employed workers are responsible for assessing the risks of their own tasks in the yard

☐ **D)** A hazard notice at the site gate is enough, as individual briefing is needed only where findings must be written down for five or more employees

3. Smoke is rising from a skip holding timber offcuts, oily rags and part-used thinners tins. Nobody is hurt, and a lorry driver offers to haul the skip into the open yard. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Cover the skip with a tarpaulin to starve it of air and leave it to burn out, calling the brigade only if flames appear later

☐ **B)** Soak the whole skip at once from the nearest hose, since water is the safest extinguishing agent for any kind of mixed waste fire

☐ **C)** Leave the skip put, raise the alarm, call the fire and rescue service, keep people clear, and tackle it only if trained and safe

☐ **D)** Tow the skip to the open yard to put smoke away from the buildings, then flood the contents with a hose until the smoke stops

4. A site is locked at 6 pm with a chain and padlock, and the only key is held by the manager at home. At 2 am a neighbour reports smoke from a cabin. Which weakness most affects the fire response?

☐ **A)** The missing night guard, since only a guard can unlock gates and meet crews, and a keyholder arrangement can never be adequate

☐ **B)** None, since crews can force a gate quickly and any damage is the contractor's problem, and delay matters only when workers are on site

☐ **C)** The padlock itself, as sites should be left unlocked overnight so crews can enter, with security provided by CCTV and a sign instead

☐ **D)** Crews cannot get in promptly, so out-of-hours access should be arranged, such as a key box or a keyholder who can attend quickly

5. Two fitters weld galvanised brackets in a workshop with a portable extractor beside them. That evening both have chills, aching muscles and a metallic taste, and feel fine by the next morning. One says it is a cold. What is the likely cause and best control?

☐ **A)** Zinc fume from the coating causing metal fume fever;

control it with effective extraction at the arc and suitable respiratory protection

☐ **B)** Heat exhaustion from the warm workshop; control it with extra rest breaks and cold drinking water, as coating fume is harmless at this level of use

☐ **C)** A delayed reaction to arc light on the eyes; control it with tinted visors, as fume matters only when symptoms appear during the welding itself

☐ **D)** Ozone from the arc causing a viral-type illness; control it with welding screens around the bench to contain the gas

6. A joiner restoring old doors in an occupied school uses a strong solvent-based paint stripper, with a half-mask respirator and one open window. The assessment simply lists the mask. What should the assessor consider next under COSHH?

☐ **A)** Strip only in the school holidays, as removing other people from the building is a sufficient control for the joiner who is applying it

☐ **B)** Whether the stripper can be eliminated or substituted, by a safer product or another removal method, before relying on ventilation or masks

☐ **C)** Open three more windows and limit each person to two hours of stripping, since cutting exposure time makes substitution unnecessary

☐ **D)** Upgrade to a full-face respirator and keep the stripper, because protective equipment gives the best protection when substitution might alter the finish of the doors

7. A flatbed arrives with packs of roof tiles stacked 2 m high. The driver plans to climb the stack to release the top straps, as he has on every site. Which approach best follows the working at height hierarchy?

☐ **A)** Avoid going on the load using ground-based methods or a fixed gantry with edge protection, with other protection only if avoidance is impossible

☐ **B)** Let him climb but require a hard hat and gloves, since he is experienced and 2 m is below the height at which fall controls are needed on a lorry

☐ **C)** Have a labourer hold the corner of the stack while he climbs, as a second person on the ground counts as proper fall protection

☐ **D)** Let him climb using a stepladder set on the lorry bed, because a ladder provides a safe route to work on top of the stacked load of tiles



8. Look at the scene. The operative says his harness is clipped on, the MEWP is on firm level ground and he only needs a few more centimetres of reach. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The basket is set too near the roof deck, so a second worker should hold the bucket steady for him as he reaches

☐ **B)** Standing on the bucket lifts his body above the guardrail, so a lean or slip could throw him out of the basket

☐ **C)** His lanyard should be anchored to the ceiling pipework above him instead of the basket, so that it holds him closer to the work

☐ **D)** The bucket has no slip-resistant top, so a rubber-topped step would make standing on it acceptable in the basket

9. In a house, an electrician switches off the socket circuit's breaker, plugs a socket tester into another socket on it, sees no lights, and starts replacing a socket. What is wrong with this practice?

☐ **A)** The tester is acceptable, but a non-contact voltage detector held against the cable should be added as stronger evidence of isolation

☐ **B)** Nothing is wrong, because a tester showing no lights proves the circuit is dead and lock-off is needed only on industrial installations

☐ **C)** A plug-in tester does not prove dead; he should lock off, then test with an approved voltage indicator proved on a known source before and after

☐ **D)** He should have switched off the whole installation at the main switch, as isolating a single breaker cannot make a socket circuit safe

10. A contractor wants to crane a 4-tonne mini excavator onto a

first-floor suspended slab to break out a screed. The slab is cured and looks sound. What must be established before the machine goes on it?

☐ **A)** That the machine runs on rubber tracks, which spread its weight enough that no check of the slab structure is then needed at all

☐ **B)** That the concrete is over 28 days old, because slabs reach full design capacity then, whatever the load placed on them

☐ **C)** That the machine's weight is below the crane's rated capacity, since a satisfactory crane check also proves the slab can bear it afterwards

☐ **D)** The slab's permitted loading, including track point loads, confirmed by a competent person such as the structural designer

11. A groundworks subcontractor sends an 18-year-old, in his second week, to lay kerbs on a principal contractor's site. His gangleader spends the day on another plot, and the site manager says the principal contractor will keep an eye on him. Who must provide the supervision, and how much?

☐ **A)** The principal contractor, because it controls the site, so the subcontractor's own duty to supervise ends once the young worker has attended the site induction

☐ **B)** Nobody specifically, because at 18 he is legally an adult and a signed training record shows he can work without close checking

☐ **C)** The subcontractor, as his employer, must arrange competent supervision matched to his inexperience and the risk, frequent enough to check and correct his work

☐ **D)** The subcontractor, but a weekly visit from the gangleader meets the duty provided he has been given written instructions for each task

12. Operatives remediating contaminated made ground rinse their hands under a bowser tap without soap, then eat sandwiches at their break. At day's end they drive home in the same muddy overalls and wash them with the family laundry. Which arrangement best controls the exposure?

☐ **A)** Use alcohol wipes before eating, then wear the overalls home once they have been brushed down, because dried mud carries very little contamination

☐ **B)** Keep rinsing under the tap before breaks and wash the overalls at home on a hot cycle, since heat destroys the contaminants in them

☐ **C)** Wear disposable gloves during the break and fasten the overalls tightly for the drive home, since covering skin matters more than removing soiled clothing

☐ **D)** Wash hands and face with soap before eating, and change out of the contaminated overalls on site, with the employer arranging for them to be cleaned

13. A two-day fencing job in open farmland is a 25-minute drive from the nearest public toilet. The contractor plans to ask the farmer if the crew can use the farmhouse bathroom, and to bring bottled water for hands. The farmer is often out. Which approach best meets the welfare duty?

☐ **A)** Supply hand gel and a spade for the two days, since the full welfare duty applies to sites that last longer than a week

☐ **B)** Rely on the farmer's verbal permission, because an agreement to use the house counts as provision even when nobody is home to open it up

☐ **C)** Provide welfare before starting, such as a mobile unit, with a toilet, soap, clean water and towels that the crew can reach quickly

☐ **D)** Let workers drive to the town toilets when needed, because travel time to a public facility is accepted as reasonable access on remote jobs



14. Look at the operative drilling anchor holes into a concrete soffit. The supervisor says he is wearing the PPE the task assessment requires. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The dust extraction fitted to the drill is unnecessary, because a respirator is the correct way to control dust from drilling concrete

☐ **B)** His safety glasses are pushed up on his forehead, so they give no protection from falling dust and chips where the drilling

creates the risk

☐ **C)** His helmet-mounted ear defenders cannot give adequate protection from hammer-drill noise, so earplugs must replace them for any overhead drilling

☐ **D)** His work gloves reduce grip on the drill handle, so hammer drilling should be done bare-handed to keep full control of the tool

15. Before a roof-edge job, a roofer takes a harness that fitted a taller colleague. The dorsal D-ring sits at the nape of his neck and the leg straps hang loose, though the webbing is undamaged. He says he will clip on and sort the straps later. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Tighten only the leg straps and ignore the ring position, since the lanyard's energy absorber takes the strain wherever it is attached

☐ **B)** Leave the ring high, as that keeps the lanyard clear of the legs, and tighten the leg straps once he has reached the roof edge

☐ **C)** Use it as it is, because the chest strap carries the load in a fall and loose leg straps only affect comfort rather than safety, or injury

☐ **D)** Adjust it on the ground so the D-ring sits between the shoulder blades and the leg straps are snug, with a colleague checking it

16. On the fifth floor of a concrete frame, a plasterer will work beside an unprotected lift-shaft door opening. The planner proposes orange mesh fencing on freestanding feet plus a sign, saying only lift installers will need the gap. Which control is required before plastering starts?

☐ **A)** Let the plasterer work if he wears a harness clipped to a mobile anchor, with the barrier deferred until the lift installers arrive

☐ **B)** Post a colleague to watch the opening during plastering, because a lookout can warn the plasterer before he gets too close to the edge

☐ **C)** Keep the freestanding mesh and add a taped line two metres back, since keeping distance from the opening is as good as a fixed guardrail does

☐ **D)** Fit a rigid barrier fixed to the structure, with top rail, intermediate rail and toe board, able to take a falling person

17. A re-roofing firm builds a temporary weather roof of beams and corrugated sheeting, carried on tube supports, over a terrace. The foreman wants to stack pallets of new tiles on the beams to save hoisting, saying the frame looks sturdy. What is the correct decision?

☐ **A)** Sheet over the stacks to guard against wind uplift so the tiles can stay on the roof overnight, with the frame checked each morning

☐ **B)** Limit stacks to two pallets high, since the frame was checked as sound by the erector and a visual look suffices for such modest loads

☐ **C)** Stack nothing there unless the designer has set an allowable storage load, otherwise keep tiles on the ground or a purpose-designed platform

☐ **D)** Spread the pallets evenly across the beams above the supports, because even spreading keeps the total load within what any frame can carry safely

18. An operator compacts hardcore in a narrow yard with a walk-behind vibrating roller. His planned passes finish with the roller reversing towards a brick wall while he walks behind it, and he says the operator-presence handle will stop it. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Keep the plan but reverse slowly, because the operator-presence control stops the machine and removes any chance of being trapped against the wall

☐ **B)** Station a banksman at the wall to shout when the roller is within a metre, as an operator walking behind cannot judge the gap himself

☐ **C)** Re-plan the passes so he never reverses towards the wall or another fixed object, and keep the operator-presence control as a back-up only

☐ **D)** Let him walk beside the roller on the final reverse pass, steering it with one hand while keeping clear of the gap to the wall

19. A forklift has a slab-clamp fitted. The truck's original plate shows 3,000 kg, the clamp is marked 2,000 kg, and a newer plate for the truck with the clamp shows 1,800 kg. The driver wants to carry 1,900 kg of paving slabs, below the first two figures. Which

statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The plate for the truck with the clamp fitted governs, so 1,900 kg is too heavy and the slabs must be carried in smaller loads

☐ **B)** Any of the three figures may be used if the driver keeps the mast tilted back and the clamp low, because careful driving offsets the extra weight

☐ **C)** The original 3,000 kg plate governs, because it is the manufacturer's figure for the truck, and the later plate is only advisory guidance

☐ **D)** The clamp's own marking governs, since attachments are rated separately, so 1,900 kg is acceptable when it stays under the 2,000 kg stamped on the clamp

20. Groundworks 20 m from a pond holding great crested newts are covered by a licence method statement requiring an exclusion fence. A dumper flattens 6 m of fence, and an open pipe trench is left overnight beside the gap. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Cover the trench each evening and continue working, because the licence applies only when a newt has actually been seen on site

☐ **B)** Repair the fence at the start of next shift and continue, since newts are active at night and the gap was not open while work was under way

☐ **C)** Carry on and ask the dumper driver to watch for newts as he works, because a sighting would then trigger a stop under the method statement

☐ **D)** Stop work in the affected area, have the ecologist check and reinstate the fence, and fit ramps or covers to the trench first

21. A manager's weekly audit sheets show every control ticked as in place for eight weeks, yet an inspector finds a gang working beside an unprotected edge. The sheets are filled in at the cabin desk, copied from the week before. What should change?

☐ **A)** Ask the safety adviser to audit once a year and report, since frequent checking on site only duplicates what the RAMS already covers

☐ **B)** Add more tick-box items to the sheet and make every supervisor sign each page each week, so that responsibility for the answers is much clearer

☐ **C)** Rely on the accident book, because a low injury count over eight weeks shows the controls in the RAMS are doing their job

☐ **D)** Have competent people watch real work, compare it with the RAMS on the ground, record what they see and fix gaps before anyone is hurt

22. A plumber starts cutting into old pipework in an occupied flat while electricians test circuits nearby. Nobody has checked where the stopcock, gas valve or consumer unit is, and the stopcock is thought to be under stored furniture. What should have been done before work began?

☐ **A)** Find and test each isolation point, keep access to it clear, and tell everyone on the job where it is and who may operate it

☐ **B)** Nominate one person to know the locations and keep others away from the valves, so nobody operates the wrong one by mistake

☐ **C)** Leave the occupier to know where the valves are, since they live in the flat and will be there if anything goes wrong

☐ **D)** Rely on the utility's emergency line, as the supplier can cut the water, gas or power remotely faster than anyone can find a valve

23. Two fitters must swap a 30 kg pump motor in a plant room with 1.4 m headroom and pipework across the route. The job needs pulling it across the floor, bending under pipes and twisting to a bench. The supervisor offers a short lifting-technique refresher. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Assess the task, load, individuals and environment, then remove the awkward postures with a small hoist or skates and a cleared route

☐ **B)** Let the stronger fitter do the pulling and twisting while the other guides, since a fit individual can tolerate cramped postures without harm

☐ **C)** Issue back-support belts to both fitters, which let them hold awkward postures safely while the motor is dragged and turned into place

☐ **D)** Give the refresher and add a third person to steady the motor, because good technique cancels out the strain of the cramped posture

24. A crew ties reinforcement mats all day. After lunch their

output and attention fall, two have wrist pain, and one nearly stepped into a gap. The foreman proposes a piece-rate bonus to keep them going. Which approach best addresses both the wrist symptoms and the attention lapses?

☐ **A)** Move only the two with wrist pain to lighter duties and treat the lapses in the others as a matter of personal discipline and attitude

☐ **B)** Pay the piece-rate bonus so a faster pace keeps interest high, and give the two with sore wrists elastic wrist supports to wear

☐ **C)** Allow earphones and music so boredom is relieved, as a stimulated mind will keep concentrating through a long repetitive task

☐ **D)** Rotate people between tasks with different movements and mental demands, plan regular breaks and ask the crew about any symptoms

25. Scaffolders plan to hang a working platform from steel beams across a stairwell void, copying a layout from a guide for standard freestanding scaffolds. The decorators want it tomorrow. Which requirement applies to this scaffold?

☐ **A)** The guide layout is enough provided the tube and fitting quantities match and a trained scaffolder erects it, with no separate design needed

☐ **B)** A competent person must produce a specific design and plan, including whether the beams can carry the load, and it must be inspected before first use

☐ **C)** The building owner's verbal agreement that the beams are sound is enough, with any design check made once the platform is up and in use

☐ **D)** Design is needed only if the load exceeds general-purpose loading, and the first inspection can then wait until seven days after use begins



26. A roofing gang is about to continue sheeting the roof shown. Looking at the picture, which problem most needs correcting before anyone works further along the roof?

☐ **A)** The eaves guardrail is too low and needs a second top rail fitted, because the roofers could otherwise tip over it when they lean out for sheets

☐ **B)** The newest sheets at the working edge are unfixed and nothing protects the gap beyond them, so a slip or tilting sheet could drop someone

☐ **C)** A strapped bundle of sheets rests on the purlins, and any load placed on the structure before the sheets are fixed is unacceptable here

☐ **D)** The roofers have no harness lanyards clipped to the eaves guardrail, which is a legal requirement whenever anyone is working on a roof

27. In a 3 m deep basement excavation a submersible pump stops and water starts to rise. A labourer standing in shallow water reaches for the pump's electrical cable to pull it up and check the intake. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Keep the supply on so the pump restarts when it cools, and station one worker beside the sump to watch the water level

☐ **B)** Switch off at the pump's own switch, then lift by the cable, as the pump is then dead and the rope is only meant for lowering it

☐ **C)** Get everyone clear of the rising water, isolate the supply at source, then lift the pump by its handle or rope and not its cable

☐ **D)** Pull it up by the cable quickly, since the RCD on the supply will cut the power if anything is wrong and delay lets the basement flood

28. On a wet plot, a generator-fed saw runs through a 30 mA RCD adaptor, which the electrician tested with its button once on Monday. On Wednesday it trips every time the saw starts, and the operator wants to plug straight into the generator's unprotected socket. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Stop using that saw, treat the tripping as a fault for a competent person to find, and press the RCD test button before every future use

☐ **B)** Use the unprotected socket for this cut only, as Monday's

test showed the RCD works and the tripping is just nuisance from start-up surge

☐ **C)** Swap to a 100 mA RCD that ignores the start-up surge, because it still protects people from shock while giving fewer unwanted trips

☐ **D)** Reset it after the saw cools and test the RCD weekly, since the periodic combined test already covers the day-to-day checks

29. A topsoil stockpile stands 15 m from a surface-water gully on a sloping site. In dry weather it blows dust, and heavy rain is forecast. The drainage plan shows a silt trap downstream, and the foreman says the trap alone will cope. Which action best follows the plan?

☐ **A)** Hose the heap before the rain to bind the surface, since wetted soil cannot wash away and the dust is controlled at the same time

☐ **B)** Keep the heap small and sited away from drains, cover it or bund it, put a silt barrier below it, and check controls after rain

☐ **C)** Leave the heap as it is and empty the trap after the rain, because silt reaching the gully is acceptable where a trap is shown

☐ **D)** Pile sandbags round the gully cover only, so no water enters the drain and the heap can stay in its current position

30. A site labels separate skips for timber, metal and clean rubble to support recycling. A subcontractor throws conduit and cable offcuts into the timber skip, saying it all goes to the same tip anyway. Which statement best explains why this matters?

☐ **A)** The subcontractor alone is liable here, since the site's duty ends once the skips are labelled and the crews have been told

☐ **B)** Only the transfer note changes, as different waste types can share a skip if the note lists every type that has been placed in it

☐ **C)** A contaminated load is usually downgraded to mixed waste, losing recycling value and raising cost, so labels need briefing and checking at the skip

☐ **D)** It does not matter because carriers sort every load at the tip, so skip labels are only a courtesy and the paperwork is unaffected

31. A subcontract electrician's foreman tells the principal contractor that a temporary distribution board in its control has a cracked, open enclosure. The principal contractor replies that it runs the site, so work will continue. Which statement about responsibility is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The subcontractor becomes liable if its workers are hurt, since a concern raised out loud is a request and does not create a duty until someone is injured

☐ **B)** Only the principal contractor is liable, because CDM 2015 gives it control of the site, so the subcontractor's duty ends once the concern has been reported verbally

☐ **C)** Both hold duties, the principal contractor for the board and the subcontractor for its own team, so the foreman should keep them clear and escalate in writing

☐ **D)** The foreman may isolate the whole site supply himself, because reporting a concern gives him authority to stop the other trades' work at once

32. A contractor planning a cheaper method for work covered by an Approved Code of Practice says ACoPs and HSE guidance are only advice, so ignoring them carries no legal risk. After an injury he is prosecuted. How will the ACoP be treated?

☐ **A)** It has the same standing as ordinary HSE guidance, which a court may set aside where a competent person judged the cheaper method adequate

☐ **B)** Having not followed its relevant provisions, he must prove he complied with the law in another equally effective way, or the court will find him at fault

☐ **C)** It carries no weight in court because only the Act and its regulations count, so the prosecution cannot refer to the code when trying to prove a breach against him

☐ **D)** It is treated as the law itself, so any departure from its wording is an automatic offence, however effective his alternative measures were

33. A contractor boasts 300 days without a RIDDOR-reportable injury and trims site inspections to save time. A review finds weekly inspection actions overdue, lapsed training records and very few supervisor observations. What is the soundest conclusion about measuring performance?

☐ **A)** A low injury count is a lagging measure; overdue actions and lapsed training are leading indicators of weakening controls,

so both kinds need monitoring

☐ **B)** The overdue actions matter if the HSE asks for them, because RIDDOR data is the measure the law uses to judge whether a site is managed well

☐ **C)** The injury record proves the controls are working, so inspections can be reduced further until an injury occurs and shows a problem needs attention

☐ **D)** The injury record is the most reliable measure, because inspections and training records describe paperwork and cannot show whether controls are actually working in practice

34. Two labourers must move a full 205-litre steel drum of lubricant, roughly 180 kg, about 30 m across a compacted yard to a store. They plan to tip it onto its rim and roll it between them, sharing the weight. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Push the forks of a telehandler straight under the rim, because a trained driver can then carry the drum without anyone touching it

☐ **B)** Roll it as planned but add a third labourer to steady it, since splitting the weight three ways brings each person's share under the guideline figure

☐ **C)** Use a purpose-made drum trolley or handler with the drum strapped on, along a cleared level route, so equipment takes the load instead of people

☐ **D)** Stand it on a pallet and drag it with a rope, as the pallet cuts friction and means nobody has to take any of the weight

35. A roofer on a bright summer day buys fashion sunglasses to cut glare and plans to wear them under his helmet while cutting tiles with a disc saw. A colleague says a UV 400 label makes them suitable. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Keep the sunglasses, as UV 400 lenses meet the standard for outdoor eye protection and the helmet peak shields the eyes from saw fragments

☐ **B)** Rely on sun cream and the helmet peak, because glare is a comfort issue and eye protection rules apply to dust, sparks and splashes

☐ **C)** Wear safety spectacles marked to EN 166 with an EN 172 sun-glare filter, as fashion lenses are not impact rated and a UV label ignores fragments

☐ **D)** Choose darker wraparound sunglasses, since a closer fit stops fragments reaching the eye and a darker tint gives better UV protection

36. A boom MEWP basket is raised beside a flat roof edge. To finish some flashing, the operator proposes unclipping his lanyard and stepping across the small gap onto the roof, saying it is only a short step. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** Exiting at height is not normal practice; it needs an assessment showing it is safest, plus the manufacturer's transfer procedure with protection still connected

☐ **B)** Stepping across is allowed for operators whose card covers boom MEWPs, since the category includes transfer onto structures as routine work

☐ **C)** It is acceptable for a short step if the basket gate is closed behind him and a second person watches him closely from the ground below

☐ **D)** Unclipping is the right sequence, as a lanyard left on the basket could drag the machine or pull him backwards as he steps across onto the roof

37. Workers heading to the cabins after dark must pass a 1.8 m deep, supported excavation across the walkway, marked by a single strand of tape on stakes and one cone. The foreman says the sides are shored, so nobody can be buried. What is the best assessment?

☐ **A)** Shoring makes the excavation compliant, because a properly supported excavation cannot injure anybody who accidentally steps or falls into it from the walkway

☐ **B)** A banksman is needed during working hours, since an excavation left overnight is not covered by the excavation rules until work starts again

☐ **C)** Support covers collapse only; people must also be stopped from falling in, so it needs a solid barrier, lighting and a protected route

☐ **D)** Tape and a cone are enough because the excavation is under 2 m deep, the depth at which fall protection becomes a legal requirement for pedestrians



38. Look at the van moving in the yard. The driver says he has checked both mirrors, they are clean, and he is only reversing a few metres. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The second worker is walking too close to the van's route and should be moved away before anything else is done

☐ **B)** A worker crouched low behind the van lies in a blind zone that mirrors cannot cover, and no signaller is controlling the manoeuvre

☐ **C)** The wing mirrors are poorly aligned, so cleaning and adjusting them before the van reverses would remove the main risk

☐ **D)** The pallet of blocks beside the container is stacked too high and should be lowered before the van moves

39. A tower crane will lift cladding panels onto the rear of a building, where the operator cannot see the slinger. The plan uses hand signals passed through a second person, and the operator will use the radio channel shared with deliveries. What is the best arrangement?

☐ **A)** Keep the relay of hand signals, since standard signals are clearer than voice and need no equipment that could lose power or signal

☐ **B)** Use the shared channel with clear speech, as any radio will do and the operator can ask other users to confirm an unclear instruction

☐ **C)** Radios on a dedicated channel with call signs and a single signaller, repeating commands during fine movements so a break in them means stop

☐ **D)** Keep a mobile phone call open between the slinger and the operator, since a call cannot be interrupted by other users and needs no call signs or agreed command procedure

40. To save skip costs, labourers burn timber offcuts, plastic wrapping and plasterboard scraps in a steel drum at the site boundary beside homes. The foreman says one small fire a day is harmless and the waste is only wood and packaging. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** The fire is lawful if it is kept away from the boundary fence, since only smoke that crosses onto a neighbour's land counts as nuisance

☐ **B)** Burning is acceptable for timber and packaging, but plasterboard must go in a skip, because only gypsum products are unsuitable for a fire

☐ **C)** A small drum fire is acceptable if it is attended and put out each evening, because the quantity burned each day is too small to matter

☐ **D)** Burning mixed site waste can pollute air and cause nuisance and is generally not allowed, so segregate it and send it for lawful recovery or disposal

41. Short of trained staff, a small roofing employer asks an apprentice with no work-at-height training to plan and supervise gutter repairs from a ladder. He argues that finding a competent person was not reasonably practicable that week. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Competence has no practicability defence, so the shortage is no excuse, although choosing the access equipment is judged by that test

☐ **B)** Every work-at-height duty is qualified by practicability, so a genuine staffing shortage excuses him if the apprentice was told to take care on the ladder

☐ **C)** A trainee may plan and supervise a job if he is being trained, because the Regulations do not require any trainee to be supervised

☐ **D)** Competence is needed just for work above two metres, so a short ladder job low on the building falls outside the duty

42. Two proposals each look adequate for controlling noise from a bench cut-off saw: a hired acoustic enclosure around it (dearer), or a shift rotation for operators with issued ear defenders (cheaper). Applying the principles of prevention, which should be preferred?

☐ **A)** Whichever the site manager prefers, since the hierarchy of control is guidance and no order of preference is set out in law

☐ **B)** The rotation, because when two controls look equally

adequate the cheaper one satisfies the law and the saving can pay for extra training

☐ **C)** Both together, because the law requires every available control to be used whatever it costs, with defenders worn even inside any enclosure fitted

☐ **D)** The enclosure, because collective measures take priority over individual ones, unless the cost is grossly out of proportion to the benefit

43. During a care-home refurbishment, an electrician cuts a 150 mm hole through a fire-resisting corridor wall to pass cables, then packs the gap with ordinary expanding foam. He says the wall is sealed. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Ordinary foam is not fire stopping, so the gap needs a tested product suited to the wall's fire resistance, fitted by a competent person

☐ **B)** The gap can stay unsealed until handover because the corridor has smoke detectors, which give warning and make sealing unnecessary

☐ **C)** Foam is acceptable because it fills the gap and blocks smoke, and only fire doors need rated protection to keep a compartment intact

☐ **D)** Foam is acceptable if it is painted with intumescent paint at practical completion, since the paint restores the fire rating

44. Labourers hand-sort timber from a soft strip, with protruding nails and broken glass in the waste. The supervisor issues standard cut-resistant fabric gloves and says that deals with it. What is the best improvement?

☐ **A)** Keep the gloves because their cut rating also covers nail punctures, and ask everyone to confirm their tetanus vaccination is current

☐ **B)** Remove nails and bag glass at source using pickers, then add puncture-resistant gloves and penetration-resistant footwear

☐ **C)** Have one labourer sort at a time on rotation, so that only one person is exposed to the sharps at any moment

☐ **D)** Change to thick leather gloves and ask workers to sort slowly, as extra care gives the same protection as removing the sharps

45. A groundworker saw a colleague fall from an excavator step and die on site last week. Since then he sleeps badly, jumps at loud noises and avoids the area. His supervisor says he should toughen up and get back on the machine this morning. What is the most appropriate response?

☐ **A)** Leave him alone and say nothing, because how a worker copes with an event outside his own work tasks is a private matter for him

☐ **B)** Talk to him privately, offer access to occupational health or counselling, allow time off if needed, and review his return to work with him

☐ **C)** Insist that he returns to the machine at once, because keeping to the normal routine is the best way to help someone get over a shock

☐ **D)** Move him to a remote task without telling anyone why, so that nobody sees he is struggling and he is left to recover without any fuss

46. Ear defenders hang in a van, crushed under tools. Many have hardened, cracked cushions and loose headbands, and the stores log records only each pair's issue date. What must the employer do?

☐ **A)** Nothing yet, because defenders stay effective until a muff splits and the issue date shows they are within a normal two-year life

☐ **B)** Swap everyone to disposable foam plugs, since plugs cannot wear out and so need no storage, checking or replacement

☐ **C)** Make each worker responsible for storing and replacing their own pair, since personal issue passes the maintenance duty to the wearer

☐ **D)** Provide suitable storage, check condition regularly, and clean or replace worn parts or whole defenders at the maker's intervals



47. Look at the scene. The site manager says everyone is correctly dressed and the crane is properly set up, so the area is controlled. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The marked safe route runs beneath the path of the suspended load, so people are directed under it

☐ **B)** The banksman stands at the far end of the walkway and so cannot give clear signals to a crane operator working on the other side

☐ **C)** Red-and-white barrier tape surrounds the crane base, which is a warning colour meant for exclusion areas and should not be used here

☐ **D)** The outriggers rest on timber mats instead of steel plates, so the crane could sink and swing the load into the walkway

48. A plasterer on a mobile tower platform 4 m up leans out over the top guardrail to finish a corner just beyond reach. A colleague suggests clipping his harness to the guardrail to make that safe. What is the right response?

☐ **A)** Allow it on a platform over 2 m if the stabilisers are fully extended and two colleagues hold the base firmly while he leans out

☐ **B)** Place ballast weights on the platform on the opposite side to his lean, to balance the tower and restore stability

☐ **C)** Allow short leans only, because brief movements cannot overturn a tower braced at four corners and are not a risk worth stopping work for

☐ **D)** Stop, and move the tower so the work is within reach inside the rails, since leaning out shifts the centre of gravity and the rail is no anchor

49. Two operatives repoint a canal wall from the towpath, half a metre from deep, cold water. The rescue plan is that the stronger swimmer will jump in if the other falls, and one buoyancy aid hangs in the cabin. Which change matters most?

☐ **A)** Issue the stronger swimmer a wetsuit, since a strong swimmer in suitable clothing can safely rescue a colleague from the water

☐ **B)** Keep a second buoyancy aid in the cabin, and ask the pair to stay within shouting distance so help can be called quickly

☐ **C)** Stop bankside work in winter only, because cold water shock is a risk in cold months and not in the warmer ones

☐ **D)** Issue worn lifejackets and keep throw lines and a ring buoy to hand, with rescuers reaching or throwing from the bank

50. A slinger plans to lift a 1.5 t steel beam with sharp, unrounded edges using a polyester web sling marked 3 t. He says the load is half the marked limit, so the lift is safe. What is the right response?

☐ **A)** Wrap the sling twice round the beam so the extra layers share any cutting, which keeps the marked working load limit unchanged

☐ **B)** Fit edge protection such as sleeves or radius pieces, or use a sling suited to sharp edges, because cuts reduce capacity despite the marking

☐ **C)** Lift as planned, because the two-to-one margin already allows for edge damage, and inspect the sling carefully once the lift is finished

☐ **D)** Pull the sling into a tight choke hitch so the webbing beds into the edges and cannot slide over the steel

Answer Key

1. A — CDM 2015 requires suitable emergency arrangements, including evacuation, that reflect the site's size, layout and numbers, with those covered made familiar with them and the arrangements tested.

B: Separate uncoordinated plans leave people in the far building without a warning or a common assembly point. C: Familiarity and testing are separate requirements, and a one-off reading does not show the arrangements actually work. D: A displayed plan does not make workers familiar with it, and the arrangements must be tested at suitable intervals.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a written plan and an alarm in one cabin cover a multi-contractor site without anyone checking it works across the whole layout.

2. B — Those who could be affected, including others sharing the workplace, need the relevant findings and controls, and the record must be reviewed and kept current as the work changes.

A: The three-year period relates to accident records, and risk information must be shared before work, not after harm. C: Duties to co-operate and share information in a shared workplace cover other workers whom the lift can harm. D: The five-employee threshold governs recording, not telling, and a gate notice does not pass on the specific controls.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a filed assessment as finished work, when its value depends on reaching the people who must follow the controls.

3. C — Moving a burning skip can spread the fire, so the priority is raising the alarm, calling the brigade and keeping people clear, with firefighting attempted only if it is safe and the person is trained.

A: A tarpaulin can burn or trap heat, and delaying the call loses time for a fire that is already smouldering. B: Water is unsuitable for oils and solvents and no agent suits every waste, so the contents and brigade advice matter. D: Dragging a burning skip spreads fire, and water can scatter burning solvents and oils rather than put them out.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that moving the source or soaking it with water is the quickest way to deal with any fire.

4. D — Emergency arrangements must let the fire service reach the site at any hour, so locked gates need a means of quick entry that does not depend on one person travelling in.

A: A guard is one option, but a key box or reliable keyholder also gives access, so a guard is not the only way. B: Delay lets an unattended fire spread to neighbouring property and cabins, whether or not anyone is working. C: Leaving a site open invites theft and arson, and controlled access is the answer rather than removing the lock.

COMMON MISTAKE: Securing a site against theft without planning how the fire service gets in when nobody is there.

5. A — Welding galvanised metal releases zinc fume that causes flu-like metal fume fever hours later, so it needs capture at source plus suitable RPE where extraction is not enough.

B: Delayed flu-like symptoms after welding galvanised metal point to fume exposure, not heat, and rest breaks do not reduce fume. C: Fume effects typically start hours after exposure, and visors do not filter what is breathed in. D: Screens block arc radiation but do nothing to remove fume from the breathing zone.

COMMON MISTAKE: Dismissing flu-like symptoms after welding as a cold when the pattern points to fume from the metal coating.

6. B — COSHH requires elimination or substitution to be considered first, with ventilation and then respiratory protection used only for the risk that remains.

A: Clearing the building protects others but leaves the person applying the stripper exposed. C: Reducing duration and diluting vapour are lower in the hierarchy and do not replace consideration of a safer product. D: PPE is the last line of defence, and a change of finish does not justify skipping substitution.

COMMON MISTAKE: Starting the control search at the mask or the window instead of asking whether the hazardous product is needed at all.

7. A — The Work at Height Regulations require work at height to be avoided where reasonably practicable, then collective protection such as a gantry, with personal protection used last.

B: There is no minimum height for work at height, and PPE of this kind does not stop a fall. C: A person holding a stack cannot arrest a fall and is exposed to the load if it moves. D: A ladder on a vehicle bed is unstable, and it does not avoid the climb or provide edge protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a low height or an experienced worker as justification for skipping a safer way of doing the job.

8. B — The guardrail only protects a person standing on the basket floor, and an improvised step raises the body above it and makes overbalancing and ejection more likely.

A: A colleague cannot make an unsafe standing position safe; the platform should be repositioned instead. C: The lanyard must be attached to the basket's designated anchor point, never to structure or services. D: No improvised raising of the standing position is acceptable, whatever its grip.

COMMON MISTAKE: Adding height with a bucket or box inside a platform to gain reach instead of repositioning the machine.

9. C — Safe isolation needs the supply locked off and the circuit proved dead with an approved two-pole voltage indicator, checked on a known live source before and after use.

A: A non-contact detector is not a reliable way to prove a circuit dead and is not an approved proving device. B: A plug-in tester gives no reliable proof of dead, and lock-off applies to domestic circuits too. D: Isolating the circuit correctly, locked off and proved dead, is a valid method.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a quick plug-in tester or a switched-off breaker as proof that a circuit is dead.

10. D — A suspended slab has a limited design capacity, so a competent person must confirm it can carry the machine, its point loads and other loads on that floor.

A: Rubber tracks lower ground pressure but the total and point loads still need checking against the slab design. B: Age shows strength gain but does not confirm the slab was designed for this machine's loading. C: The crane's rating relates to the lift and says nothing about what the slab can carry afterwards.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a floor by how solid it looks instead of checking what the structure was designed to carry.

11. C — Employers must provide information, instruction, training and supervision for their own employees, and the level rises with inexperience and risk, so the principal contractor's general oversight cannot replace it.

A: A site induction does not transfer the employer's own supervision duty to the principal contractor. B: Being an adult and holding a training record do not remove the need for supervision matched to inexperience. D: Written instructions and an occasional visit are not supervision proportionate to a new starter doing risky work.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming the principal contractor's presence on site means a subcontractor no longer has to supervise its own inexperienced workers.

12. D — Washing before eating stops contaminants being swallowed, and leaving soiled work clothing on site, cleaned by the employer, stops it carrying contamination into vehicles and homes.

A: Wipes do not remove contamination like soap and water, and brushing leaves residues and releases dust. B: Hot washing does not destroy many contaminants and spreads them through the household machine and laundry. C: Gloves worn at a meal become contaminated themselves, and soiled clothing still transfers contamination to the car and home.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a quick rinse and taking dirty work clothes home as normal practice when the ground is contaminated.

13. C — Workers in remote locations still need toilets and washing facilities within easy reach, and a short job or a hoped-for favour does not remove that duty.

A: Welfare duties apply to any construction site regardless of how short the job is, and gel does not replace washing facilities. B: Facilities that may be locked or unavailable are not reliably accessible when the crew needs them. D: A 25-minute drive each way is not reasonable access and wastes working time.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a very short or remote job does not need proper toilets and washing provided for the crew.

14. B — PPE only protects when worn correctly at the point of risk, and eye protection resting on the forehead gives no protection against debris falling from an overhead drilling task.

A: Capturing dust at source is preferred, and a respirator does not replace extraction. C: Properly worn and suitably rated defenders can control hammer-drill noise, and this is not the failing shown. D: Gloves are normally worn on hammer drills to protect against vibration, cold and abrasion, and they are not the main problem here.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting PPE as being in place because it is on the worker somewhere, rather than being worn properly over the part of the body at risk.

15. D — A harness only works in a fall if it is adjusted to the wearer, with the ring centred high on the back and snug leg straps, and a buddy check confirms this before exposure.

A: The energy absorber does not compensate for a poor ring position, which can leave the wearer hanging badly or head-down. B: Adjustment must be completed before going near the edge, and ring position affects body position after a fall. C: Loose leg straps can let the wearer slip or be injured in a fall, and a poorly placed ring changes how the body hangs.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming an undamaged harness is ready to wear straight from the van, without adjusting it to fit the wearer

first.

16. D — Openings need robust, fixed collective protection that can resist a person's weight, which freestanding mesh and signs cannot do.

A: Personal protection with a mobile anchor is lower in the hierarchy than a fixed barrier and leaves others exposed to the opening. B: A lookout is an administrative control that fails when attention lapses and does not physically stop a fall. C: Tape and distance only warn, and a person stumbling or pushing a trolley can still reach the opening.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a sign, tape or freestanding mesh counts as edge protection simply because it is visible.

17. C — A temporary roof is designed for particular loads such as wind and self-weight, so added stored materials need the designer's agreement or the structure may be overloaded and collapse.

A: Covering the stacks adds wind load and does not address the overloading of the structure. B: A visual check of soundness gives no figure for capacity, and stacking limits chosen by eye are guesswork. D: Even spreading does not make an undesigned load safe, since the structure's capacity is not known.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a temporary structure's strength by how sturdy it looks instead of by what it was designed to carry.

18. C — A safe system of work avoids the crush risk by design, and a protective control is a back-up that must not be relied on as the only safeguard.

A: Relying on one control alone is unsafe, since it may fail or be defeated and leaves the crush risk in place. B: A shouted warning relies on a person reacting in time and leaves the crush risk in place. D: Steering at arm's length from beside the machine is not a planned method and still leaves him close to the crush point.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a machine's safety device to protect an operator whose planned working method already places him in a crush zone.

19. A — Fitting an attachment derates the truck, and HSE guidance says a plate relating to the attachment must be applied, so the combined figure is the one that limits the load.

B: Careful driving does not change the rated capacity, and the lowest applicable plated figure must not be exceeded. C: The original figure applies to the truck as plated with forks, not with a heavy attachment fitted in front. D: The clamp's rating does not allow for the reduced stability of the truck with it fitted.

COMMON MISTAKE: Picking whichever rating on the truck or attachment is highest or most convenient instead of the one for the combination actually in use.

20. D — Newts may already be inside the working area or trapped in the trench, so work stops until the licensed ecologist checks and the barrier and trench are made safe for wildlife.

A: The licence conditions apply to the whole works area, whether or not an animal has been seen. B: Newts may already be inside the area, and continuing without a check risks killing or injuring them. C: Spotting animals by chance is not a control, and the damaged fence must be dealt with first.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating wildlife protection measures as paperwork that only matters once an animal has actually been seen.

21. D — Active monitoring means observing whether controls actually work in practice, so failures are found and corrected before they cause harm, rather than assuming the paperwork reflects reality.

A: An annual audit is too infrequent to catch changing site conditions, and the RAMS describes intended controls and does not prove they are used. B: More boxes and signatures still record opinion from the cabin and do not test whether controls work at the work face. C: Injury figures are a lagging indicator, and an absence of injuries can hide controls that are failing and have simply not yet caused harm.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a completed checklist proves a control is working, when only watching the work itself shows whether it is.

22. A — Emergency shut-offs only help if they are known, reachable and proven to work before the job starts, since searching for them during a burst or gas leak wastes critical time.

B: If that one person is absent or cut off, nobody else can act, so everyone working must know where the isolation points are. C: The contractor must plan the emergency arrangements, and an occupier may not be present, may not know, or may not be able to reach the valves. D: Emergency lines cannot isolate an individual property instantly, and a burst or leak needs shutting off within seconds by people on site.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming someone else, such as the occupier or the utility, will know how to shut things off in an emergency.

23. A — The manual handling assessment should avoid or

reduce the hazardous movements, and in cramped spaces the environment is the main driver, so changing the task beats relying on technique.

B: Individual strength does not remove the strain from awkward postures, and putting more risk onto one person only concentrates the harm. C: There is no good evidence that belts make awkward handling safe, and they do nothing to remove the hazardous movements. D: Technique and extra hands do not remove the pulling, stooping and twisting that the cramped environment forces on the body.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that training in lifting technique is enough when the real problem is a cramped space and an awkward task.

24. D — Varying the work and building in rest reduces repetitive strain and the fatigue and monotony that cause lapses, and asking about symptoms allows early action.

A: Moving the symptomatic workers leaves the cause in place for the rest, and lapses from fatigue are a work-design problem and not a discipline issue. B: A bonus pushes pace and repetition up, which raises the strain and the chance of mistakes, and supports do not remove the repetitive movement. C: Earphones mask warnings from plant and colleagues and do nothing for the physical strain on the wrists.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating tiredness and lapses on repetitive work as a motivation problem rather than a problem with how the work is organised.

25. B — A hung scaffold is outside standard configurations, so it needs bespoke design and a plan, and a competent person must inspect it after erection and before it is used.

A: A guide for freestanding scaffolds does not cover a platform hung from the structure, so a specific design is needed. C: The supporting structure must be checked by a competent person as part of the design before the scaffold is used, not after. D: A non-standard scaffold needs design whatever the load, and inspection is required after erection and before first use.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a scaffold can be built from a standard guide when it hangs from the structure instead of standing on the ground.

26. B — The progressing leading edge needs collective protection, such as nets or edge protection, and sheets must be fixed as laid so the working edge cannot give way or leave an open fall.

A: The eaves protection in the picture is continuous and at a suitable height, so it is not where the fall risk lies. C: A secured bundle supported on purlins is normal practice and is not the main fall hazard shown. D: A guardrail is not an anchor point, and a harness is a lesser measure than collective protection at the leading edge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging roof edge safety by the completed eaves protection and overlooking the moving leading edge where the work is actually taking place.

27. C — Standing in water with a live supply risks shock, and pulling on the cable can damage it, while a rising level in a deep basement also needs people to leave and be accounted for.

A: Leaving the supply live and a worker in rising water exposes him to both shock and drowning while the fault stays unfixed. B: A local switch does not prove isolation at source, and the cable is not designed to carry the pump's weight. D: An RCD is a secondary protection and not a licence to handle live equipment in water, and pulling the cable can expose conductors.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting an RCD or the pump's own switch enough to handle electrical equipment while standing in water.

28. A — An RCD that trips is a warning of a fault, it must never be bypassed, and the test button should be used before each use rather than once a week.

B: A trip is a sign of a fault, a test earlier in the week proves nothing about today, and bypassing the RCD removes the protection. C: Higher-rated RCDs protect against fire and do not protect people from shock, and the underlying fault would remain. D: Repeatedly resetting hides a fault, and the user test button check is needed before each use as well as periodic testing.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a tripping RCD as a nuisance to be bypassed or swapped and not as a sign of a real electrical fault.

29. B — Controlling silt and dust at source with a smaller, covered, bunded stockpile and a barrier stops pollution reaching the drain, with checks keeping the measures working.

A: Wetting does nothing to stop rainfall washing soil away and can add to run-off, so it is not a substitute for covering or bunding. C: Silt must be kept out of drains and watercourses, and a trap is a last line of defence that can be overwhelmed in heavy rain. D: Blocking the gully risks flooding and sends silty water elsewhere, and it does nothing to control the soil at its source.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on a silt trap at the end of the drain instead of stopping soil from leaving the stockpile in the first place.

30. C — Segregation at source keeps materials recyclable, in

line with the waste hierarchy, and only briefing and checking where waste is deposited keeps the streams clean.

A: The site must manage its waste and cannot discharge that duty by labelling alone, so checking and supervision still apply. B: Listing the types on the note does not restore the recyclability of the load, and segregating at source is preferred by the waste hierarchy. D: Carriers and receiving sites do not routinely resort contaminated loads, and the labels exist to keep streams recyclable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming it makes no difference where waste goes because it all ends up at the same disposal site.

31. C — A principal contractor's coordinating role does not remove the subcontractor's own duty under CDM 2015 regulation 15 to plan, manage and monitor its work, so each is answerable for its part.

A: Duties arise from the risk and exist before harm occurs, so waiting for an injury is a breach already. B: A subcontractor keeps its own legal duties to its workers and cannot hand them to the principal contractor by reporting a concern. D: Raising a concern does not give one subcontractor authority over other trades or the site supply, and an uncontrolled shutdown can create new hazards.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that because the principal contractor controls the site, a subcontractor's own legal duty to its workers is somebody else's problem.

32. B — An ACoP has a special legal status: failure to follow it is not an offence in itself, but in a prosecution the burden falls on the defendant to prove compliance by other means.

A: Ordinary guidance is optional, but an ACoP has a stronger status that a competent person's opinion alone does not displace. C: Courts can and do refer to an ACoP, and its special status shifts the burden onto a defendant who did not follow it. D: An ACoP is not law, and a defendant who shows equally effective alternative measures can still demonstrate compliance.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating every HSE publication as optional advice and overlooking that an Approved Code of Practice has special weight in court.

33. A — Lagging measures such as injuries only record failures after the event, while leading indicators show whether controls are being maintained, so relying on either alone gives a misleading picture.

B: The law requires risks to be managed, and RIDDOR reporting is not a test of performance, so ignoring open actions is a management failure. C: Waiting for an injury to signal failure defeats the purpose of prevention and ignores the evidence of weakening controls. D: Active checks reveal control failures before harm occurs, and a short injury record can reflect luck rather than good management.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading a run of injury-free days as proof that the safety management system is working.

34. C — The Manual Handling Operations Regulations expect the load to be avoided or moved by a mechanical aid, and a drum on a strapped trolley is stable and less likely to tip or spill.

A: Bare forks under a rim do not hold a drum securely, and the drum can slip off and burst. B: Rolling a tipped drum still involves uncontrolled forces and crush and spill risks, and dividing the weight does not remove them. D: Dragging a loaded pallet involves heavy pulling and an unstable drum that can topple and spill.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a load is acceptable to handle by hand so long as enough people share its weight.

35. C — Eyewear for outdoor cutting must give impact protection from fragments as well as glare reduction, which industrial sun-glare safety spectacles are designed and marked to provide.

A: A UV label says nothing about impact resistance, and a helmet peak does not stop fragments from the disc saw. B: Bright light and UV are recognised eye hazards, and the cutting task still needs impact protection. D: Fit and tint do not make a lens impact rated, and a shattering fashion lens can add to the injury.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that any dark glasses with a UV label count as eye protection for site work.

36. A — Operators should not leave a platform while elevated unless a detailed risk assessment shows it is the safest way to reach the work, and the transfer follows the manufacturer's procedure.

B: A card shows training on the machine and does not authorise exiting at height without an assessed plan. C: A watcher and a closed gate do not control a fall from the gap or the unprotected roof edge. D: Disconnecting leaves him with no fall protection during the riskiest moment, and the transfer needs a planned anchor arrangement.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a short step from a MEWP onto a structure as trivial because the gap looks small.

37. C — CDM 2015 regulation 22 requires steps to stop people falling into an excavation as well as protection against collapse, which tape and a cone do not give, especially in the dark.

A: A person can still be injured by falling into a supported excavation, and support does not prevent that. B: Duties continue while the

excavation is open, and the risk to people walking past is greater when it is dark and unattended. D: No such depth threshold exists, and the duty to prevent falls into an excavation applies at any depth where a person could be injured.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that supporting the sides of an excavation is all that is required to make it safe.

38. B — Mirrors do not show a person kneeling directly behind a van, so without a signaller, camera or exclusion of the area the driver cannot know he is safe to reverse.

A: He is well clear of the van and visible, so he is not the hazard that makes the manoeuvre dangerous. C: The mirrors are clean, and even perfectly adjusted mirrors cannot show someone low down directly behind the vehicle. D: The pallet is at a normal height and is not what puts anybody at risk from the reversing van.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a driver who has checked his mirrors can see everyone behind a reversing vehicle.

39. C — When the signaller is out of sight, standard hand signals cannot be used, so a dedicated radio link with call signs lets the operator know who is speaking and stop if the link fails.

A: Hand signals only work in direct view, and a relay adds delay and the chance of a mistake between people. B: A shared channel allows interference and unrelated chatter, and an instruction cannot be reliably confirmed by unrelated users. D: A phone is not a purpose-designed lifting system, can lose signal, and occupies the operator's hands without agreed commands.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any form of communication will do for a lift as long as the people involved can hear each other most of the time.

40. D — Site waste should be segregated and dealt with by lawful means, because burning mixed waste emits harmful smoke and can be an offence.

A: The offence is not limited to smoke crossing a boundary, and the burning itself is generally not permitted. B: Plastic wrapping and treated timber also give off harmful emissions when burned. C: Quantity does not make burning mixed waste lawful, and the smoke still affects neighbours.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a small bonfire of site waste as a cheap, harmless way to get rid of it.

41. A — Regulation 5 of the Work at Height Regulations is an absolute duty with no 'reasonably practicable' qualifier, whereas other duties, such as how the work is carried out safely, are qualified.

B: Several duties, including competence, are absolute, and telling someone to take care does not replace competence. C: A person who is still being trained may work only while supervised by a competent person. D: The Regulations apply to any place where a person could fall and be injured, with no minimum height.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that every legal duty can be softened by arguing that compliance was not reasonably practicable.

42. D — The principles of prevention give collective protective measures priority over individual ones, and extra cost justifies a lesser control only where it is grossly disproportionate to the risk reduction.

A: The principles of prevention in the Management Regulations set a preference for collective over individual measures. B: The controls are not equal, since the rotation depends on people complying and protects only the operators who wear the defenders. C: The duty is qualified by reasonable practicability, so not every available control must be used regardless of cost.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the cheaper of two controls as equal in value when it relies on individuals behaving correctly.

43. A — Penetrations must be sealed with products tested for the wall's fire-resistance period, otherwise fire and smoke pass through and the compartment no longer protects the building.

B: Detection gives warning but does not stop fire spreading through an occupied building in the meantime. C: Walls and every opening through them must keep their fire resistance, not just the doors. D: Paint over untested foam does not create a tested seal, and the gap is unprotected until then.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that any filler that plugs a hole counts as fire stopping.

44. B — Reducing the sharps at source comes first, and PPE for what remains must be rated for puncture as well as cut, which are separate performance ratings.

A: Cut and puncture resistance are tested separately, and a vaccination does not prevent injury. C: Rotating people reduces numbers exposed but leaves each sorter with the same cut and puncture hazard. D: Care and gloves alone leave the hazard in place, and leather can be punctured by nails.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a glove marked as cut-resistant is also resistant to punctures from nails.

45. B — Employers should support workers after a traumatic event, and early help and a planned return are better than pressuring someone back to the same task.

A: A serious workplace event is the employer's concern, and silence withholds support. C: Forcing an immediate return to the scene can worsen distress and risks his safety and others. D: Isolation without support or a plan does not address his symptoms.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that people are best left to toughen up after witnessing a serious accident.

46. D — PPE regulations require employers to maintain, clean or replace PPE and to provide accommodation for it when not in use, because worn cushions and bands lose protection.

A: Hardened cushions and slack bands reduce attenuation before any visible split, and there is no fixed two-year rule. B: Plugs still need correct fitting and hygienic storage, and the choice must match the noise level. C: The employer remains responsible for maintaining and replacing PPE it provides.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking PPE is only the employer's concern on the day it is issued.

47. A — A pedestrian route and its sign must keep people clear of the lifting zone, and the safe-condition sign here sends workers beneath a suspended load, which no PPE can protect against.

B: The banksman's position is not the failing, since the real fault is that people are walking under the load. C: Barrier tape around a crane base is a normal way to mark the area where the counterweight swings. D: Timber mats are an accepted way to spread outrigger load, and the crane in the picture is stable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a fully dressed workforce is protected when the layout itself puts people under a suspended load.

48. D — Leaning beyond the rails adds overturning force that grows with platform height, and a guardrail is not designed as an anchor point for a harness.

A: Stabilisers and people holding the base do not make a lean-out safe, and the tower should be moved instead. B: Weight on the platform raises the centre of gravity, and any ballast belongs at the base as the maker instructs. C: A sudden lean or push can start an overturn, and the work should be repositioned regardless of duration.

COMMON MISTAKE: Stretching beyond the platform guardrail to avoid the effort of moving the tower.

49. D — Lifejackets reduce drowning risk, and cold water shock can disable even strong swimmers within moments, so rescue should use throw lines and reach from the bank.

A: A rescuer entering the water risks cold water shock and becoming a second casualty, whatever they wear. B: Equipment in a cabin cannot help a casualty in seconds, and shouting is not a rescue plan. C: Cold water shock can occur in any water below roughly 15 degrees, including in summer.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a good swimmer can safely rescue someone from cold water.

50. B — Sharp edges can cut webbing at loads well below its marked limit, so the sling must be protected or a more suitable accessory chosen.

A: Extra turns do not protect the outer layer from the edge and change the rated configuration. C: A margin does not allow for cutting, and inspection after the lift comes too late to prevent a failure. D: A tight choke presses the webbing into the sharp edges, increasing the risk of cutting.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a sling only by the weight on its tag without considering what the load can do to it.

PRACTICE TEST 11

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A company is convicted after a worker loses fingers in an unguarded machine. The managing director had twice been told of the missing guard and deferred the repair to save money, then argued that the company is a separate legal person and the site manager was responsible. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** He can be prosecuted only if he personally operated or adjusted the machine, since a director is liable for nothing beyond his own direct acts

☐ **B)** He can also be prosecuted personally, because an offence involving an officer's consent, connivance or neglect makes that officer guilty too

☐ **C)** He faces action only through the company, because directors are personally liable for corporate manslaughter but not for health and safety offences

☐ **D)** He is protected, because handing the repair to the site manager moves all personal criminal liability for the offence onto that manager alone

2. A 1960s office block with no surviving drawings is to be stripped out and then demolished. The foreman proposes to start at once by removing partitions and edge columns on the top floor, and to have material tested as it turns up. How should the work be planned?

☐ **A)** Remove the edge columns and heavy walls first to open up access, because a structure will always stay stable while its floors remain intact above

☐ **B)** Start stripping now but stop and test whenever suspect material turns up, as a full survey is only needed before the final demolition stage begins

☐ **C)** Rely on the original design intent for blocks of that age, as an unrecorded building from the 1960s will have followed standard practice throughout

☐ **D)** Get asbestos and structural surveys first, then set a sequence that keeps the frame stable, removing non-critical parts before the stiff ones

3. Smoke and a smell of burning hydraulic oil come from the engine bay of a working excavator. The operator can see no flames yet. What should he do?

☐ **A)** Drive the machine clear of the stockpiles and the fuel store first and then stop the engine, because a burning machine is safest in open ground

☐ **B)** Open the engine cover fully to locate the source, then discharge an extinguisher straight into the bay to put out the first flames quickly

☐ **C)** Ground the attachment, stop the engine, get out, move clear and raise the alarm, tackling it only if trained and never by opening the cover

☐ **D)** Leave the engine idling so the cooling fan keeps the bay cool, and fetch a colleague to help fight the fire from the cab step

4. During a refurbishment of the second floor of a working office, the contractor's team removes ceiling tiles that carry emergency lights and bags over the exit signs to keep dust out. Staff remain on the floor above. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Remove the fittings, since the work area is under the contractor's control, and warn the staff on the floor above by email about the changes

☐ **B)** Keep escape routes lit and signed, using temporary emergency lighting and signs where fittings come out, agreed with the responsible person

☐ **C)** Remove them for the duration, since emergency lighting is only needed when the building is dark and this work runs only in daylight hours

☐ **D)** Cover the signs but keep torches in the work area, because torches are accepted as an equal substitute for fixed escape lighting on stairs

5. A new block has stood empty for eight months with its water system filled but unused. Before handover, a plumber flushes only the kitchen taps and says that cold water cannot grow

harmful bacteria. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Risk-assess the whole system, flush all outlets, control temperatures and remove dead legs, because stagnant water can grow legionella

☐ **B)** Add the check to the first annual service, since legionella is a risk only to residents after they have used the system for months

☐ **C)** Flushing the kitchen taps is enough, as the other outlets contain the same water and will be clean once the first taps run clear

☐ **D)** Cold water is safe at any temperature, so only the hot system matters, and bacteria cannot grow in a sealed new installation

6. After cutting concrete blocks, a labourer blows the fine dust off his overalls and the bench using the compressor air line, wearing goggles and a mask. A colleague objects. Why is the labourer's method a poor control?

☐ **A)** It wastes compressed air and wears the line, since dust that has settled is harmless provided that the person doing the cleaning wears a mask

☐ **B)** It puts fine dust back into the air for everyone nearby to breathe, and air at pressure can force particles or even air into the skin

☐ **C)** It is fine with goggles and a mask, but the overalls should be washed at home, since dust on work clothes is a household risk only

☐ **D)** It is acceptable outdoors at low pressure, because the wind carries the dust away and the airflow is too gentle to injure the skin or eyes

7. A roof worker's fall is arrested and he hangs by his harness at the eaves, conscious but pale and unable to pull himself up. No rescue plan was prepared. The supervisor wants to wait for the ambulance. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Rescue him, have him walk around to restore circulation, and return him to light duties if he says he feels fine after a few minutes

☐ **B)** Delay rescue until a platform can be built, because a properly fitted harness supports the body safely for an hour or more with no harm

☐ **C)** Rescue him promptly with the rescue kit, help him take weight off his legs, and get him medically checked afterwards even if he seems well

☐ **D)** Leave him hanging until the emergency services arrive, since only their specialists should move a casualty, and he should stay as still as possible



8. Look at the image. A worker is leaving a parked machine at the end of a task. What is the most serious risk of injury shown?

☐ **A)** He steps down facing outward with a tool in one hand, so he cannot keep three points of contact and may slip and fall

☐ **B)** The bucket is raised clear of the ground, so a hydraulic fault could drop it onto him as he steps away from the cab steps

☐ **C)** The engine appears to be running with the tracks free to move, so the machine could lurch off while he is still half-way out of it

☐ **D)** He is not wearing a hard hat or hi-vis, so he cannot be seen by others or protected from falling objects as he leaves the cab

9. A faulty socket circuit in a busy plant room is to be repaired. The manager says that shutting it off would halt production for an afternoon, and that the competent electrician can work live if he wears insulating gloves. What do the Electricity at Work Regulations say?

☐ **A)** Live work needs dead working to be unreasonable, live working reasonable and suitable precautions taken, so lost production alone is not enough

☐ **B)** Live work is allowed on circuits below 400 volts, since the regulation applies only to high-voltage conductors that can arc over at distance

☐ **C)** Live work is allowed if the manager signs a written instruction accepting the risk, as this makes the decision a

managerial one to take

☐ **D)** Live work is allowed where the electrician is competent and wears insulating gloves, because suitable precautions alone satisfy the regulation in full

10. Fitters hang a one-tonne lever hoist from a beam to raise a 400 kg pipe spool. The lever is stiff, so one slides a scaffold tube over the handle, and the apprentice offers to ride the spool upwards to steady it. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The apprentice may ride it if he is clipped to the hook, but the tube must come off since only the lever should operate the hoist

☐ **B)** Both are acceptable provided the beam has been checked, because the spool is well below the hoist's rated load, and the apprentice holds the chain

☐ **C)** Neither is acceptable: a stiff lever signals an overload or fault to check, and nobody may ride a load on equipment not designed to lift people

☐ **D)** The tube is acceptable since the spool is well below the one-tonne rating, but the apprentice must stay clear and use a tag line

11. A contractor is fitting out a retail unit over twelve weeks with forty workers. The shop owner says council environmental health officers police shops, so an HSE inspector's visit is a mistake. Who enforces here, and what may the inspector do on entry?

☐ **A)** The enforcing body depends on who employs the workers, so the inspector may question managers only and needs the contractor's permission to take samples

☐ **B)** HSE enforces only after an accident, so before then the inspector may observe and advise but needs a warrant to examine site documents or question workers

☐ **C)** HSE enforces as this is notifiable construction work, and the inspector may enter at a reasonable time, take photographs and samples, and require documents

☐ **D)** The council enforces because the premises is a shop, and the HSE inspector may only advise, needing the owner's written consent to take photographs or samples

12. A decorator who strips old paintwork in powdered latex gloves develops itchy red hands. Days later he wheezes and his eyes stream when a colleague opens a new box of the same gloves nearby. Which response best fits the risk?

☐ **A)** Issue cotton liners under the latex gloves and a barrier cream, because the rash comes from sweat and the wheeze is probably just hay fever

☐ **B)** Give him powder-free latex gloves only, as the allergy is to the powder rather than the latex, and let colleagues keep using powdered ones

☐ **C)** Have him wash his hands after each glove change and carry on, since symptoms that ease overnight show irritation rather than a true allergy

☐ **D)** Remove him from latex exposure, switch the team to powder-free nitrile gloves, and refer him to occupational health, as airborne glove powder can trigger asthma

13. A fourteen-person site, including two women, has one toilet cabin with three cubicles opening off a shared room. The doors cannot be secured from inside and no cubicle has a bin. The manager says separate cubicles satisfy the rules. What is required?

☐ **A)** Separate rooms are needed only once six or more women work on site, and until then a notice asking men to knock first meets the duty on privacy

☐ **B)** A single shared room is lawful if the women may use the first-aid room, since the rules count toilets per worker and not who uses them

☐ **C)** Partitions inside one shared room are enough on sites under twenty people, provided women get set times by rota and used items are flushed away safely

☐ **D)** Separate rooms for men and women, or one-person rooms locking from inside, kept clean and lit, with a suitable means to dispose of sanitary dressings



14. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the operator is fully protected for jet cleaning because his head, face, hands and

hearing are all covered. What is the most significant gap?

☐ **A)** His rubber gauntlets should be replaced with leather work gloves, which grip a wet lance better and resist a stray jet more reliably

☐ **B)** His canvas trainers give no toe or foot-bone protection, so a stray jet or dropped lance risks crush injury or water injection

☐ **C)** His ear defenders should be swapped for disposable foam plugs, which seal better against the engine noise of a petrol pressure washer

☐ **D)** A full-face visor is a weaker eye guard than safety glasses for jetting, so glasses should replace it to give a tighter seal

15. A plasterer finishes a dusty shift and hangs his half-mask on a van hook with the facepiece coated in dust. He knocks the P3 filters on the wheel arch and plans to reuse them tomorrow, saying he will change them when they "feel blocked". What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Blow the dust off the facepiece and filters with compressed air at the end of each shift, then hang the mask on the van hook to dry in the open air

☐ **B)** Clean and dry the facepiece as the manufacturer advises, store it in a sealed clean container, and replace filters that are damaged, dirty, expired or hard to breathe through

☐ **C)** Wash the filters under a tap each week to restore them, then refit them once fully dry, because a washed filter regains its original efficiency

☐ **D)** Keep the same filters until the facepiece seal fails its fit check, as filters only wear out once the rubber seal on the face has worn away

16. A 4.8 m high flat-roof edge is reached by a ladder whose foot is 0.6 m from the wall and sits on a slumped mound of spoil. Its top is level with the coping. Which set of corrections makes it safe to climb?

☐ **A)** Move the foot about 1.2 m out onto firm level ground and use a longer ladder rising at least 1 m or three rungs above the coping

☐ **B)** Move the foot about 1.2 m out, lay a plank on the spoil to spread the load, and keep the top level with the coping so it cannot snag

☐ **C)** Keep the 0.6 m setting but footing the ladder with a colleague, and extend it by one rung above the coping to give a place to grip

☐ **D)** Move the foot about 2.4 m out to lower the risk of tipping backwards, and pack the spoil flat with bricks, keeping the ladder top level with the coping

17. A bricklayer's scaffold bay carries a notice marked "Loading Class 2". The foreman wants three pallets of bricks placed on the working platform and says the class number only shows how many people may stand on it. How should the class be understood?

☐ **A)** It gives the distributed and point loads the platform was designed for, so workers and materials together must stay within it, or a higher class is needed

☐ **B)** It states the weight of people only, because materials are carried by the ties and standards rather than by the boards of the platform

☐ **C)** It states the scaffolder's competence grade, so a Class 2 notice shows skilled erectors built it and heavy stacking is then permitted

☐ **D)** It states how many boarded lifts the scaffold may have, so three pallets are acceptable if only one lift is occupied at any one time

18. Pedestrians cross a haul road used by loaded dumpers where it bends past a stockpile that hides each party from the other. The planner proposes mirrors and a signaller there. What is the better control for the crossing?

☐ **A)** Keep the crossing at the bend as it is the shortest route to the cabins, and add a speed hump and a warning sign facing approaching drivers

☐ **B)** Cut the stockpile height to knee level and keep the crossing in place, relying on drivers sounding their horns as they round the bend

☐ **C)** Move the crossing to a straight length giving clear view both ways within stopping distance, and mark, light and fence the approach

☐ **D)** Leave the crossing where it is, paint it clearly across the road, and brief all drivers that pedestrians always have priority on it

19. A rear-tip dumper driver must reverse the length of a yard to

the tipping point, where pedestrians sometimes cross. The alarm and beacon work, and he says everyone is therefore warned. Which approach is best?

☐ **A)** Remove reversing with a one-way route or turning area, keep people out of the reversing zone, and check behind before and during any reversal

☐ **B)** Have the driver reverse slowly in short bursts with the window open, because lower speed means anyone behind has time to move out of the way

☐ **C)** Rely on the alarm and beacon and ask pedestrians to listen for them, as audible and visual warnings let anyone behind clear the path in time

☐ **D)** Let pedestrians use the yard freely but wear high-visibility clothing, since being seen by the driver is the main protection near a reversing vehicle

20. A strip-out produces fluorescent tubes, emergency-light batteries and part-used aerosol cans. The labourers plan to crush the tubes to save space and tip everything into a general waste skip. What is the correct handling?

☐ **A)** Crush the tubes in a bag to contain the glass, and put the batteries and cans in the general skip as only large quantities count as hazardous

☐ **B)** Treat them as hazardous waste, keep them intact in separate marked containers, and pass them to a registered carrier with a consignment note

☐ **C)** Send them with the skip operator's ordinary transfer note, as the operator takes responsibility for classifying waste once it leaves the site

☐ **D)** Place the tubes, batteries and cans together in one lidded skip marked hazardous, since mixing hazardous items does no harm once they are labelled

21. A firm will replace bathroom fittings in a sheltered housing block while residents, some with dementia, stay in their flats. A colleague says the assessment need only cover the operatives, as residents are not employees. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Limit the assessment to operatives, since residents are the building owner's responsibility and signs on the doors will warn them off

☐ **B)** Residents are people affected by the work, so assess their risks too, then agree work areas, access times and tool security with the building manager

☐ **C)** Assess the residents only if a complaint or incident occurs, because the assessment is meant to track hazards that have actually caused harm

☐ **D)** Brief the residents on the hazards at a start-of-job meeting, because informed adults can then keep clear of the work area themselves

22. A six-storey timber-frame block is under construction beside a narrow lane. The principal contractor has a written site fire plan but has never spoken to the local fire and rescue service. A subcontractor says contact is only needed after a fire starts. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Share the plan early, covering appliance access, water supplies and hazards, and update the service when site layouts change

☐ **B)** Send the plan once at the start of the job, because the site layout stays the same and later updates would only confuse the service

☐ **C)** Wait until a fire happens, as the service will then take control and the site plan is for site staff rather than attending crews

☐ **D)** Rely on building control approval of the finished design, since it covers fire access for both the completed building and the building site

23. Before loft insulation goes in, two labourers must clear years of pigeon droppings from a roof void. The foreman suggests sweeping the dry material into sacks and using a plain nuisance-dust mask. What is the best approach to the biological hazard?

☐ **A)** Dampen the droppings, scoop them into sealed bags, and wear disposable coveralls and an FFP3 respirator, washing before eating

☐ **B)** Do the work in the cooler evening and keep the hatch open, because ventilation alone dilutes any airborne spores to a safe level

☐ **C)** Brush the dry droppings briskly into sacks to shorten exposure time, and wear a nuisance-dust mask for the short job

☐ **D)** Leave the droppings in place and treat the void only with a disinfectant spray, as the spray kills any organisms present

24. A kerb layer returns after seven months off with a lower-back injury. He says he feels fine and wants his old full duties from day one. The site manager must decide how to bring him back. Which approach is most appropriate?

☐ **A)** Keep him away until he is completely free of any restriction, because an employer cannot support any adjustments to a worker's duties

☐ **B)** Give him light duties with no end date and no review, since a lighter workload removes the need for any further follow-up

☐ **C)** Accept his own judgement and return him to full duties, because a competent adult knows his body better than his employer does

☐ **D)** Hold a return conversation, agree phased lifting adjustments, review his manual handling assessment, and check progress regularly

25. A scaffolder rigs a gin wheel to raise buckets of mortar to a first-floor lift. The supervisor wants speed and says the wheel is light kit that needs no planning. What must be in place before bricklayers use it?

☐ **A)** A single annual rope inspection by the supplier, on the basis that the scaffold itself needs no assessment for added lifting loads

☐ **B)** A single coupler clipped to a guardrail so the wheel can swing out, plus a rope the team judges strong enough by feel

☐ **C)** Correct fixings to the scaffold, a scaffold able to bear the load, and a rope in good order with a known safe working load

☐ **D)** No formal checks while buckets stay light, with the receiver leaning out to catch each load as it swings in



26. A painter is about to repaint the fascia at this house using the ladder shown. Which combination of faults in the ladder's positioning most increases the chance of a fall?

☐ **A)** The paint tin hangs from a hook, which makes the ladder unstable, and a second person must hold the tin at ground level

☐ **B)** It is an extension ladder, which cannot be used for painting, and a trestle platform should be set up on the soil instead

☐ **C)** Its top bears on plastic guttering that can crack or buckle, and its base sits on soft ground unsecured so a foot could sink or slip

☐ **D)** Its angle is too shallow for the height, and the stiles extend too far above the gutter so the climber has no handhold on the way off

27. A joiner wants to run his 230 V Class I router on a two-core extension lead because his Class II drill uses one. The supervisor asks what difference the equipment class makes. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Both classes are built the same way internally, so a two-core lead suits either tool, provided the extension lead plug fits the socket

☐ **B)** A Class I tool is made safe by an RCD alone, so the earth conductor can be dropped from the lead if the RCD is tested monthly

☐ **C)** Class II tools must be earthed through their metal casing for site use, so the drill needs a three-core lead with its earth wire connected

☐ **D)** Class I tools rely on a sound earth so need a three-core lead, while Class II tools are protected by reinforced insulation

28. A new 1.8 m deep drainage chamber has its cover removed ready for pipe connections, and a plywood sheet and one cone sit on top. A dumper route passes about 2 m away. What is the best way to protect people and plant from falling in?

☐ **A)** Place the plywood over the opening and park the dumper on it overnight to stop anyone from lifting the board off the chamber

☐ **B)** Leave the chamber open and let the dumper drivers know about it at the morning briefing, since all site plant operators will remember it

☐ **C)** Keep the plywood and add a second cone and a strip of hazard tape, since visible marking is enough to alert drivers and

walkers

☐ **D)** Fit a purpose-made cover rated for the loads and fixed against displacement, and route plant away behind a barrier with a stand-off

29. Dumpers must cross a drainage ditch daily to haul spoil to a stockpile. The foreman proposes driving through at the shallowest point and tipping hardcore into the bed to firm it up. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Tip the hardcore in to form a causeway, as inert stone does no harm and the water can pass between the pieces

☐ **B)** Drive through at the shallow point but use a banksman, since slow vehicles stir up little silt and a ditch is not a protected watercourse

☐ **C)** Install a temporary bridge or culvert built for the loads, check whether consent is needed, and keep silt and fuel out

☐ **D)** Cross at the shallow point and wash the wheels in the ditch afterwards, so soil stays out of the haul road and off the public highway

30. On a city site, a large diesel generator runs all night at low load for security lights, and excavators idle through breaks. Neighbours complain about fumes. Which action best reduces emissions and fuel use?

☐ **A)** Size the generator to its real load or use a mains or battery supply, switch off idling plant, and keep engines serviced

☐ **B)** Run the generator at light load to keep it reliable, because an oversized set is better for the engine than a matched one

☐ **C)** Leave the excavators idling so restarts are avoided, because frequent starting wears engines and creates more exhaust than idling does

☐ **D)** Fit a taller exhaust on the generator to disperse the fumes, since emissions released higher up no longer count as pollution

31. A self-employed plasterer with no employees skims ceilings alone in a client's occupied house, using his own mixer and a hired tower. He says health and safety law only covers people who employ others. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** He is exempt because working alone creates no risk to anyone else, though he would have to comply once he took on a labourer

☐ **B)** Construction is a prescribed activity, so he must protect others affected by his work and himself meet the work at height and work equipment rules

☐ **C)** He is covered only for the tower, because hired equipment carries the hire firm's duties while his own mixer falls outside the law

☐ **D)** He owes duties to the occupants but none towards himself, since the rules on his own safety belong to the client who engaged him

32. A 14-employee groundworks firm has no recognised trade union. Staff elect a colleague as their representative of employee safety, but the owner says he need only consult union-appointed representatives, and any training would be in the colleague's own time. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** He may consult only the foreman, who then passes decisions on, as long as the firm keeps a signed record that staff were told

☐ **B)** He must consult, though elected representatives have no right to paid time for their role and the owner alone decides what is discussed

☐ **C)** Consultation applies only where a union is recognised, but an elected colleague may attend training at his own expense if the firm gives approval first

☐ **D)** Staff must still be consulted, directly or through elected representatives, who get paid time off and training at the employer's cost

33. A painter will spray a two-pack polyurethane coating on steel in a small plant room. The data sheet names isocyanates. He says he will smell it if the level is harmful, so a dust mask and an open door will do. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** An open door gives enough dilution in a small room, provided the painter takes regular breaks in fresh air and wears cotton overalls

☐ **B)** Isocyanates matter only to the skin, so gloves and a barrier cream are the full control and no breathing protection is required

☐ **C)** Isocyanates can cause asthma and cannot be judged by smell, so use suitable air-fed or approved respirators with controlled ventilation and health surveillance

☐ **D)** A dust mask is enough for short jobs, because the smell gives early warning and sensitisation only develops after years of heavy use

34. After chasing brickwork in a small plant room, fine grey dust lies over the floor and pipework. A labourer proposes sweeping it with a dry brush while wearing a basic paper mask, saying the dust is plainly visible so it is easy to control. What is the best way to clean it?

☐ **A)** Sweep dry with a soft broom after the other trades have left so nobody else breathes the cloud, and prop the door open to ventilate the room

☐ **B)** Sweep dry but wear a half-mask respirator, since correctly fitted respiratory protection removes any need to change the cleaning method used

☐ **C)** Use a standard household vacuum cleaner, which collects the dust without lifting it and so needs no specialist filter

☐ **D)** Vacuum it with an industrial cleaner fitted with a high-efficiency filter, since the finest dust is invisible and sweeping lifts it again

35. A labourer rolls a foam earplug, pushes it in without touching his ear, and leaves it sitting half out. He says the plug is comfortable and the breaker sounds only slightly quieter, so it must be working. What should he do?

☐ **A)** Push it in as deep as possible with a fingertip, since the seal gets better the nearer the plug sits to the eardrum itself

☐ **B)** Keep it as fitted, because comfort shows the plug is sitting correctly and a little noise will always get past any earplug in a loud area

☐ **C)** Roll it thin, pull the ear up and back, insert it fully and hold until it expands, then refit it if sound is not clearly muffled

☐ **D)** Swap to a larger plug and leave it uncompressed, as soft foam fills the canal by itself without rolling or holding

36. A precast concrete stair has been craned into a new stairwell but the balustrades and landing edge protection are not yet fitted. Trades will use it for a fortnight, and the supervisor says firm treads make it a safe route. What is needed before use?

☐ **A)** Handrails on the wall side only, because the stair is a route rather than a work platform and open sides need no rails

☐ **B)** Painted edge markings on the treads and a notice, as fixed guards would obstruct materials being carried up the stair

☐ **C)** A warning sign at the foot limiting use to trained operatives, since edge protection is needed only once a task is being carried out on the stair

☐ **D)** Temporary handrails and guardrails at open sides and landings, treads kept clear of debris, and lighting so the route is visible

37. A hire company delivers a trench shield and hydraulic props, with a delivery check sheet signed as ready for use. The foreman says this satisfies the inspection rules, so the gang can enter once the shield is placed. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A competent person must inspect the excavation and supports at the start of each shift and after any event affecting stability

☐ **B)** The delivery sheet covers the equipment, so only the ground needs checking, and only before the first entry to the trench by the gang

☐ **C)** A competent person need inspect only when the shield is first placed, then again if the foreman changes the arrangement

☐ **D)** The hire firm's signature passes the inspection duty to them for as long as the shield remains on hire to the contractor



38. The picture shows a site pickup and plant trailer at the gate before joining a public road. The driver says the trip is only two miles and the machine's own parking brake will hold it. What must be done before he leaves?

☐ **A)** Apply the parking brake and chock the tracks on the deck, because chocks are enough to hold plant on a trailer

☐ **B)** Leave the machine as loaded but keep to low speed and send a banksman on foot behind the trailer to warn the following drivers on the road

☐ **C)** Isolate the hydraulics and remove the key, since an immobilised machine cannot move off the trailer during a short

trip

☐ **D)** Secure the machine to the trailer with chains or straps at its anchor points, lower the bucket, and check the towing limit is not exceeded

39. A hired lifting beam is to carry a 3-tonne precast lintel on a mobile crane. The beam's plate is badly faded, and the lift supervisor says that as the crane chart allows 4 tonnes at that radius, the lintel weight is the only figure to check. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Check the beam's working load limit and examination certificate but ignore its weight, since accessories are included within the crane's rated figure

☐ **B)** Accept the faded plate if the hire firm says verbally that it suits 3 tonnes, then count only the lintel against the crane chart figure

☐ **C)** The crane's rated capacity covers whatever it lifts, so accessories need no marking provided the lintel is within the chart

☐ **D)** Confirm the beam's working load limit is clearly marked and its examination is current, then add its weight to the load checked against the crane

40. A recycling wheel wash feeds a settlement tank, and the site manager wants the tank's excess water piped to the nearest surface-water drain, saying settling leaves it clear. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Recirculate the water, desilt the tank regularly, and send excess to foul sewer with the water company's written consent or by licensed carrier

☐ **B)** Add flocculant, test the pH, and discharge to the surface drain if the reading is in range, keeping a written record of every result

☐ **C)** Run the excess onto soft ground at the site edge, where the soil will filter it more effectively than any drain

☐ **D)** Discharge it to the drain once it looks clear, since settlement removes the silt and oil and the flow in the drain dilutes any cement

41. A firm introduces a battery stud driver with a new safety procedure. It offers an unpaid Saturday course that staff must pay for, and tells a carpenter with twenty years' experience to skip it. Which statement about the employer's duty to provide training is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Everyone exposed to the new risk needs training, given in working hours at no cost to them, however experienced

☐ **B)** Only employees without a recognised trade qualification need training, though it should still be given in working hours at the employer's cost

☐ **C)** Twenty years' experience is enough, so the employer need only hand over the leaflet and may charge staff for any course they want

☐ **D)** Weekend sessions are fine if attendance is voluntary, because the cost of safety training is normally shared between employer and employee

42. At completion of a refurbished office, a principal designer compiles the health and safety file. A colleague suggests adding the construction phase plan, all method statements and the accident log. Which approach to the file's content and keeping is correct?

☐ **A)** Include contract documents and insurance certificates as a record of procurement; the local authority building control office then holds it

☐ **B)** Include information for future work, such as as-built drawings, service locations and residual hazards like asbestos; the client then keeps it

☐ **C)** Include the construction phase plan and every method statement so later contractors see how work was done; the principal contractor then keeps it

☐ **D)** Include the project accident log and inspection results so future owners can judge contractor performance; the principal designer then keeps it

43. A fire alarm sounds on a four-storey fit-out. A fire marshal sweeps the third floor, sees smoke from a store room, and at the assembly point finds one joiner unaccounted for. The fire service is on its way. What should the marshal do?

☐ **A)** Re-enter wearing a dust mask to search the third floor, because he knows the layout better than the arriving fire crew does

☐ **B)** Wait for the joiner to appear and then finish the roll-call, since the fire service only needs a final headcount once the

building is empty

☐ **C)** Send two trained colleagues in with extinguishers to check the store and the floor, as early action is part of a marshal's role

☐ **D)** Tell the fire service the joiner's last known location and what the store holds, and keep everyone out of the building

44. An electrician makes about 600 terminations a shift with straight-handled side cutters, bending his wrist sharply to reach panel terminals. By week three his forearm aches constantly. Which change best deals with the cause?

☐ **A)** Swap to a heavier, thicker-handled tool for a firmer hold, since a firm grip needs fewer repeated squeezes

☐ **B)** Supply cutters with an angled head so the wrist stays straight, and rotate the task with other work

☐ **C)** Issue padded gloves and a wrist support so the same bent grip can continue, since the wrist then takes less strain

☐ **D)** Let him work longer on termination days so he has fully free weekends to recover from the aching

45. A 60-person site has two first aiders whose First Aid at Work certificates expire next month. The manager plans to wait for a spring annual refresher, saying refreshers are a legal requirement. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Expired certificates still count while the first aiders keep practising their skills, until the needs assessment is next reviewed

☐ **B)** Requalify them before the certificates expire to keep cover; annual refreshers are strongly recommended but not a legal duty

☐ **C)** Annual refreshers are a legal requirement, so a spring session keeps the expired certificates valid and fully satisfies the first aid regulations

☐ **D)** A refresher replaces requalification, so a short half-day course lets the certificates run on without any full course

46. An electrician will work close to exposed live low-voltage busbars in a switch room. He is issued a vented helmet with metal rivets through the shell, rated for impact only. The supervisor says helmets are all equivalent. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Allow the helmet, since it only protects against falling objects and rubber gloves deal with the electrical risk instead

☐ **B)** Keep the vented helmet but cover the rivets with insulating tape, since tape restores the shell's insulation against accidental contact with conductors

☐ **C)** Supply an electrically insulating helmet, such as to EN 50365, with no conductive fittings, and still isolate the busbars first

☐ **D)** Choose a heavier industrial helmet, since a thicker shell has more electrical resistance and so suits the live work



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the operative has all the PPE a petrol disc cutter needs. What is the most significant problem, and what should be done?

☐ **A)** His ear defenders cannot cope with a petrol cutter, so he should add foam earplugs under them and then restart the cut

☐ **B)** The water feed makes eye protection unnecessary, so the dust mask alone is enough and the cut can continue as it is

☐ **C)** His visor is raised, leaving eyes and face open to fragments, so he should stop and lower it before resuming

☐ **D)** His gloves are a risk near a spinning disc, so he should remove them and hold the slab with bare hands instead

48. A maintenance crew will clear gutters beside four old rooflights set in a sound flat roof. The supervisor proposes yellow warning signs and cones around each one. Which arrangement best controls the risk of falling through?

☐ **A)** Post a lookout to warn anyone who drifts near a rooflight, since a trained person watching acts as a dependable barrier

☐ **B)** Fit securely fixed covers or guardrails strong enough to bear a person around each rooflight, kept in place while working

☐ **C)** Rely on the signs and cones plus a briefing, since visible warnings let trained roofers keep clear of each rooflight

☐ **D)** Lay loose scaffold boards over each rooflight, since boards spread weight and remove any need to secure them in place

49. A surveyor must inspect an unlit basement store reached by a

steep ladder-stair. Fuel cans were once kept there and it smells of petrol. He plans to carry an ordinary torch in one hand. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Ventilate and test the air first, light the stair, and use hands-free lighting certified for flammable atmospheres so both hands stay on the stair

☐ **B)** Use the ordinary torch but switch it on before entering and leave it on, since sparks only come from the switch being operated

☐ **C)** Wear a brighter ordinary head torch with spare batteries, since hands-free light solves the stair problem and the smell will fade

☐ **D)** Open the hatch for ten minutes then enter with the ordinary torch, since the petrol smell proves vapour has dispersed

50. A three-person crew will close the nearside lane of a 40 mph single carriageway for pipe repairs. The foreman plans to place cones at the works first, then the signs, and says any operative with a CSCS card may lay them. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Signs can go out in any order, but removal should begin with the advance sign so drivers see the lane reopening as early as possible

☐ **B)** Advance warning signs go out first, then cones from the road edge out to the works, with removal in reverse; those laying must be trained and competent

☐ **C)** Cones go out at the works first to protect the crew, and then the signs follow, as a general CSCS card is enough proof of competence

☐ **D)** Put the signs out last and take them down first, since drivers need warning only once the cones are visible; training matters for signals only

Answer Key

1. B — Section 37 of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974 makes a director personally guilty where the company's offence was committed with his consent or connivance, or is attributable to his neglect.

A: Liability under section 37 arises from consent, connivance or neglect and does not require hands-on involvement with the machine. C: Directors can be convicted of health and safety offences personally, and the corporate manslaughter offence is a separate matter. D: Delegation does not remove an officer's own liability when he knew of the defect and failed to act.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a company's separate legal identity shields its directors and managers from personal prosecution.

2. D — Surveys must come before work starts, and the sequence must prevent uncontrolled collapse by keeping stabilising elements until last.

A: Taking out structural members early can cause an uncontrolled collapse, since the stability of a frame depends on its remaining members. B: Testing as suspect material appears risks disturbing asbestos before anyone knows where it is, and the survey must come before any work starts. C: Old buildings are often altered or built differently from the standard, so assumptions cannot replace a survey of the actual structure.

COMMON MISTAKE: Starting strip-out on the assumption that surprises can be dealt with as they appear.

3. C — Stopping and leaving removes the ignition and fuel feed and protects the operator, while opening the cover would feed the fire with air.

A: Driving on with a fire spreads it, risks the operator's life and keeps pumping fuel and oil to the source. B: Opening the cover lets in air, which can turn a smouldering fire into a fireball in the operator's face. D: A running engine keeps feeding fuel and oil to the fire, and remaining on the step puts people in the path of flames.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trying to find and fight an engine fire by opening the cover instead of stopping the machine and getting clear.

4. B — Occupied premises need escape routes that can be found and used if the power fails, so any removal must be covered by an agreed temporary equivalent.

A: An email does not give people a lit, signed escape route, and the staff above still need to use the same stairs. C: Emergency lighting works when the mains fails, which can happen at any hour, and also in areas where windows give little light. D: Torches are not a reliable standard for lighting routes used by the public or staff, and covered signs hide the way out.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the building's escape lighting and signs as part of the finishes to be removed or covered during the works.

5. A — Water left standing in warm pipework, tanks and dead legs can grow legionella, which is breathed in as a fine spray, so the system needs assessment, flushing and temperature control.

B: The risk builds up during the empty period, so action is needed before occupation, not after a year of use. C: Each outlet and dead leg holds its own stagnant water, so flushing one point does not clear the rest. D: Cold supplies that warm up above about 20 degrees while standing can also grow legionella, and new pipework is not sterile.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing legionella is only a hot-water problem in old buildings, when stagnant water in any new or unused system can grow it.

6. B — Compressed air re-suspends settled dust and can cause injection injuries, so vacuuming or damp cleaning is preferred.

A: Settled dust is not harmless, and a mask protects only the wearer while everyone else nearby breathes the cloud. C: Dust must be controlled on site, and the problem lies in the cleaning method rather than in what the clothes later pass through. D: Low pressure still raises a cloud, and wind does not guarantee dust leaves the work area or avoids other people.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that blowing dust away with an air line removes it, when it only moves it somewhere else.

7. C — Hanging motionless in a harness can quickly become life-threatening, so rescue must be fast and the casualty needs medical assessment afterwards.

A: A casualty who has been suspended needs a medical check whatever he says, because serious effects can develop later. B: A harness does not make suspension safe for long, and a hanging casualty can deteriorate in minutes. D: Waiting leaves him suspended and at risk of losing consciousness, and prompt rescue by trained site staff is needed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a worker hanging safely in a harness can wait for the emergency services without coming to

harm.

8. A — Climbing down facing the machine and holding on with two hands and one foot, or the reverse, prevents slips on the steps from becoming a fall.

B: The bucket is shown lowered flat on the ground, so this hazard is not present in the picture. C: The machine in the picture is stopped with the bucket grounded, so uncontrolled movement is not the main hazard shown. D: He is wearing both a hard hat and hi-vis clothing, so the main risk lies elsewhere in the picture.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a few steps down from a cab are too low to need the same care as a ladder.

9. A — Regulation 14 requires all three conditions to be met, and inconvenience or cost of isolating does not alone make it unreasonable to work dead.

B: The regulation applies to any live conductor where danger may arise, including ordinary mains voltage which can kill. C: A signature does not meet the legal conditions, and the duty for safe working remains with the person doing the work as well. D: Precautions are only the third condition, and the other two must also be met before any live work can start.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating live working as acceptable whenever isolation is inconvenient and the electrician is skilled.

10. C — An extended lever can overload the hoist and hide a fault, and lifting equipment not marked for people must never carry anyone.

A: Clipping a person to a hoist hook does not make it a safe means of lifting people, as the equipment is not designed or examined for that. B: Extending the lever can overload the hoist whatever the weight, and riding a load is never safe with equipment not designed for people. D: Extending the lever defeats the hoist's design and can mask a fault or overload, even with the load well within its rating.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a load well below the rated capacity allows any improvised leverage or a person to ride along.

11. C — Construction work is reserved to HSE, and a project lasting over thirty days is notifiable, so the shop's usual council regime does not apply; inspectors hold statutory powers of entry, sampling and questioning.

A: Enforcement follows the type of work and premises, not the employer, and inspectors may question any person and take samples without permission. B: Inspectors can enter and inspect without waiting for an accident, and can require documents without a warrant. D: Construction work stays with HSE whatever the type of premises, and inspectors need no owner consent to photograph or sample.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming the type of building decides who enforces, when construction work is usually enforced by HSE wherever it takes place.

12. D — Latex allergy can affect skin and breathing, and powder carries the allergen into the air, so the source must be substituted and the worker medically assessed.

A: Liners and cream leave latex exposure in place and wrongly dismiss two linked symptoms that point to an allergy. B: The allergen is the latex protein itself, and colleagues' powdered gloves would still spread it through the air. C: Symptoms that ease away from work often indicate a work-related allergy, so continued exposure risks lasting sensitisation.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a work-related rash or wheeze as a minor irritation instead of reporting it and removing the cause.

13. D — Construction welfare rules require separate rooms for men and women unless each room is for one person with a door secured from inside, and women need hygienic disposal.

A: The duty to provide separate or lockable rooms is not triggered by a headcount of women, and a notice does not give privacy. B: The first-aid room must stay available for treatment, and the regulations address separation and privacy as well as numbers. C: A rota does not create separate rooms, and flushing sanitary items blocks drainage and is no proper disposal.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting toilets per head and forgetting that privacy, separation and sanitary disposal are part of the welfare duty.

14. B — Jetting teams need protective boots with foot-bone protection, because a lance jet can cut skin and force water and slurry into the foot.

A: Waterproof gauntlets are the recommended hand protection for jetting, whereas leather soaks through and loses protection. C: Ear defenders are suitable for this noise when worn correctly, and plugs offer no extra protection. D: A visor is the correct guard against spray and splashback, and glasses leave the face and neck exposed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking head, eyes and hands on a PPE inspection and forgetting to look down at the feet.

15. B — Reusable masks must be cleaned and stored clean to prevent contamination and deterioration, and clogged or damaged filters cause breathing resistance and face-seal leaks.

A: Compressed air drives dust into the filter media and leaves the mask exposed to fresh contamination on an open hook. C: Particle

filters must never be washed, as water destroys the filter material and its efficiency. D: Filter life is independent of the facepiece seal, and a blocked or damaged filter can leak long before the seal fails.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a respirator by whether it still feels wearable instead of cleaning, storing and changing it by a routine.

16. A — A ladder should sit at about 75 degrees on stable level ground and extend roughly a metre above the landing to give a handhold when stepping off.

B: A plank on loose spoil is still unstable ground, and a top level with the coping gives nothing to hold when stepping off. C: A foot only 0.6 m out is too steep and may tip backwards, and one rung gives too little handhold. D: A base that far out makes the ladder slide and leaves no handhold above the landing.

COMMON MISTAKE: Fixing the ladder angle while ignoring the ground beneath the feet and the handhold at the top.

17. A — Loading classes set the design load per square metre and point load for a working platform, so a task needing heavier stacking requires a platform designed and handed over for that duty.

B: Materials load the boards directly, and the class covers workers, tools and materials together. C: Loading class is a design capacity, not a measure of the erectors' skill, and does not authorise heavy stacking. D: The class describes load capacity per platform and has nothing to do with how many lifts are in use.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading a scaffold notice as a pass for the structure instead of as the limit on what the platform carries.

18. C — Siting crossings where drivers and pedestrians can see each other in time, with a clearly marked and lit crossing, removes the hazard at source instead of compensating for it.

A: A speed hump and sign do not restore the missing sight lines, and a short walking route does not justify a blind crossing. B: A horn only warns people who are already in view, and relying on drivers rather than layout leaves the cause of the blind spot unmanaged. D: Paint and a priority rule cannot help a driver who cannot see the pedestrian until it is too late to stop.

COMMON MISTAKE: Adding warning devices to a bad crossing position instead of moving the crossing to where people can see each other.

19. A — An alarm only warns others and cannot detect anyone, so the main control is to design reversing out and exclude pedestrians, with the driver checking the way behind.

B: Low speed reduces severity but leaves the driver unaware of anyone behind, and open windows do not give a view. C: Warnings depend on people noticing and reacting, and they do nothing to show the driver who is behind. D: Hi-vis helps only if the driver can see the wearer, and it does not separate people from reversing traffic.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a working alarm lets the driver reverse with no need to look or to remove pedestrians from the area.

20. B — Tubes, batteries and aerosols with contents are hazardous, so they must be kept separate and unbroken and sent under a consignment note using an authorised carrier.

A: Crushing releases mercury vapour and dust, and hazardous status does not depend on a minimum quantity. C: Hazardous waste needs a consignment note, and the producer keeps the duty of care for classifying and describing it. D: Different hazardous wastes can react or contaminate each other, and mixing them without authorisation is not permitted.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming small items from a strip-out can go in the general skip because there are not many of them.

21. B — Employers must protect non-employees affected by their work, and vulnerable residents need specific controls such as secured tools, closed-off work areas and agreed access arrangements.

A: Duties to non-employees affected by the work remain with the contractor, and signs cannot protect people who may not understand them. C: Assessment is a prior, suitable and sufficient exercise that must anticipate foreseeable harm, not wait for an incident. D: Briefing cannot be relied on for residents with dementia, so physical controls and supervision are still needed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a risk assessment only has to protect the workers doing the job and not the people who live or work around it.

22. A — Early contact lets the fire and rescue service plan its response to the real site layout, hazards and access, which is far harder to arrange once a fire is already burning.

B: Site layouts, gates and hazards change as the building rises, so out-of-date information can mislead crews. C: Crews arriving without knowledge of access, water supplies or hazards respond more slowly and with more risk. D: Building control approval relates to the completed building and does not address construction-phase access, hazards or water supplies.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the site fire plan as an internal

document and leaving the fire and rescue service to find out the layout when they arrive.

23. A — Dried droppings can carry organisms that cause lung infections such as histoplasmosis, so dust must be suppressed and suitable respiratory protection, clothing and hygiene used under COSHH.

B: General ventilation does not control a dust and spore release in a confined void, so source controls and respirators are still needed. C: Dry sweeping throws fine infectious dust into the air, and a nuisance-dust mask is not suitable respiratory protection for a biological agent. D: Spraying alone does not remove the material, and disturbing it later still releases dust and organisms.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking old dry droppings are harmless dust that a basic mask and a quick sweep can deal with.

24. D — A planned, reviewed return with agreed adjustments protects against relapse, and the employer should review risk assessments for the individual rather than rely on the worker's own opinion.

A: Reasonable adjustments are encouraged, and waiting for full recovery with no support can prolong absence needlessly. B: Open-ended light duties without review fail to support recovery and ignore changes in his condition or ability. C: Employers still owe a duty of care, so the worker's confidence does not replace a planned return and review of the risks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a worker who says he is fine can go straight back to full duties without a planned, reviewed return.

25. C — A gin wheel is lifting equipment, so it must be properly fixed to a scaffold designed to bear the extra load and used with a sound rope of known capacity.

A: The scaffold must be checked for the additional loads, and the equipment needs inspection before use as well as periodic examination. B: A guardrail is not designed to carry lifting loads, and rope capacity must be known rather than judged by feel. D: Light loads still need a sound fixing and rope, and leaning out to catch a swinging load creates a fall risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating small lifting kit such as a gin wheel as too minor to need a proper fixing, a known rope capacity and a check of the scaffold.

26. C — A ladder must rest against a strong surface or use a stand-off, and stand on firm level ground and be secured against slipping.

A: A light tin hung from a hook is a minor issue compared with the unstable top and base, and holding the tin does nothing to secure the ladder. B: Extension ladders may be used for short, light work where the risk assessment justifies it, and a trestle platform would be worse on soft soil. D: The ladder in the picture is at a sensible angle, and extending above the landing point is correct practice.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking only the ladder's angle and condition and ignoring what its top rests on and what its feet stand on.

27. D — Class I equipment depends on its earth connection as well as basic insulation, so the lead must carry an earth, whereas Class II equipment has no earth and relies on double or reinforced insulation.

A: Class I tools have an earth conductor that a two-core lead cannot supply, so the protection would be lost. B: An RCD adds protection but does not replace the earth that a Class I tool depends on. C: Class II tools have no earth connection, and an earth wire should not be connected to them.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming all power tools need the same lead and that an RCD makes up for a missing earth on equipment that relies on it.

28. D — A strong, fixed cover removes the fall hazard itself, and a barrier with stand-off keeps vehicles from tracking too close to the opening.

A: Plant must never be parked on an unrated cover, which could collapse under the weight and drop the machine into the chamber. B: Relying on memory is a weak administrative control, and pedestrians and visitors would still be exposed to the open hole. C: Marking does not prevent a fall, and plywood that is not rated or fixed can slip or break under load.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a cone and a plywood sheet make an open chamber safe near moving plant.

29. C — A purpose-built crossing keeps vehicles out of the water and avoids silt and fuel pollution, and works in or near a watercourse may need consent from the Environment Agency or local authority.

A: Hardcore can block flow, add fines to the water and may need consent, so it is not a harmless fix. B: Fording stirs silt and drops oil into the water, and a ditch can still be a watercourse that must be protected. D: Washing wheels in the ditch puts mud and any oil straight into the watercourse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a small ditch as a drain rather than a watercourse that must be protected from silt and oil.

30. A — A lightly loaded oversized engine burns fuel

inefficiently and smokes, and switching off idling plant and servicing engines cut emissions at source.

B: Running a diesel engine at light load causes poor combustion, wet stacking and extra smoke. C: Idling burns fuel and emits exhaust for no work done, and normal restarts use far less than long idling. D: Raising the exhaust only moves the emissions, so the quantity of pollutants and fuel burned is unchanged.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming idling plant and a big generator on low load are harmless or save fuel.

31. B — Self-employed people in construction owe general duties to others under the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act, and the Work at Height and work equipment regulations apply to them for matters they control.

A: Construction work is prescribed, so the duties apply to a lone self-employed worker, and the occupants and passers-by can be affected by his work. C: Work equipment rules apply to a self-employed person for equipment he uses or controls, including his own mixer, not just hired items. D: A self-employed contractor in construction must meet the work at height and equipment rules for his own work, and the client's duties do not replace his.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that having no employees means health and safety law has little to say about your own work.

32. D — Where there is no union safety representative the employer must consult employees directly or through elected representatives of employee safety, who get reasonable training and paid time off to carry out the role.

A: Passing on decisions is information, not consultation, which means listening to employees' views before decisions are made. B: Elected representatives are entitled to paid time off, and consultation must cover set matters such as new equipment, training and competent persons. C: The duty to consult covers employees not represented by a union, and the employer must bear the cost of reasonable training.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking consultation on safety is a union matter that a non-union firm can skip or leave to one trusted supervisor.

33. C — Isocyanates are respiratory sensitisers, harmful levels are not reliably detected by smell, and a dust mask does not stop vapour, so proper respiratory protection and surveillance are needed.

A: A small room with one opening does not control vapour, and breaks do not prevent sensitisation. B: Skin contact is a risk, but the main danger is respiratory sensitisation, which gloves do not prevent. D: A dust mask does not filter vapour, smell is not a safe warning, and sensitisation can occur after short exposure.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting smell or a basic dust mask to warn of and stop a sensitising vapour such as isocyanate.

34. D — The most harmful respirable fraction cannot be seen, and dry sweeping lifts it into the breathing zone, whereas a suitably filtered industrial vacuum captures it.

A: This only moves the exposure to the sweeper and leaves airborne dust to settle again, so the method is still wrong. B: Respirators are a last resort after controlling the source, and they do not stop dust spreading to other workers. C: Ordinary vacuum filters pass the finest particles straight back out through the exhaust, so a suitable filter is needed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a dust problem by what can be seen and relying on a mask when a better cleaning method exists.

35. C — A foam plug gives protection only when it is fitted fully into the canal and allowed to expand to seal, and a poor seal shows as little drop in noise.

A: Pushing plugs deep risks injury to the ear and is not how the seal is achieved. B: Comfort does not show a seal, and a plug left half out gives much less protection than its rating suggests. D: Foam plugs must be rolled so they fit the canal and held while they expand, or they will not seal properly.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any earplug that is in the ear gives its full rated protection without checking how it fits.

36. D — A stair in use needs edge protection wherever a person could fall, plus a clear, lit route, because a firm tread does not stop a fall from an open side.

A: Open sides and landing edges are where falls occur, and the type of use does not remove the need to guard them. B: Markings and notices only warn, and materials handling is planned around the protection rather than by leaving edges open. C: A stair used as a route is still a place from which a person could fall, so a sign does not replace physical protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a stair as safe just because it is solid, and forgetting the open sides, landings and housekeeping.

37. A — The excavation rules require inspection by a competent person at the start of each shift and after events likely to affect strength, whatever the hire firm checked before delivery.

B: Support equipment is part of the shift inspection, and the ground and supports need re-checking at each shift and after events. C: Inspection is required at the start of every shift in which people work

in the trench, and also after events affecting stability. D: The contractor controlling the work keeps the duty to have the excavation inspected, and hiring does not transfer it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a supplier's delivery check as a substitute for the inspection of the trench on site each shift.

38. D — Plant must be restrained to the trailer so it cannot shift or fall on the road, and the combined load must be within the towing vehicle's limits, however short the journey.

A: Brakes and chocks resist movement but are not a recognised means of load restraint, and they can fail under braking forces. B: Slow speed and a banksman do nothing to stop an unrestrained machine moving or falling when braking or turning. C: Isolating the machine does not restrain it, because the whole machine can still slide or tip on the trailer deck.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a short journey, or the machine's own brake, makes proper load restraint unnecessary.

39. D — Lifting accessories must be clearly marked with their safe working load and be examined, and their own weight and that of slings count towards the load the crane carries.

A: Crane charts give capacity for the load on the hook, so the beam, slings and any hook block weight must be added by the planner. B: Marking must be clear on the equipment itself, and the beam's weight is part of the load the crane carries. C: Accessories have their own working load limits and marking duties, and the crane chart does not cover them.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking only the weight of the item being lifted and forgetting the lifting accessories and their markings.

40. A — Recirculation cuts water use, and wash water may carry silt, oil and alkaline contamination that surface drains must not receive, so it goes to sewer with consent or off site as waste.

B: A pH reading does not show oil, chemicals or other pollutants are absent, and treated wash water is still unsuitable for surface drains. C: Pollutants soak into soil and groundwater and can reach nearby watercourses, so it is not a safe disposal route. D: Clear-looking water can still carry oil and high alkalinity, and surface-water drains lead untreated to watercourses.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging wash water by how clear it looks rather than by what it contains and where the drain leads.

41. A — The employer must provide the training needed for safety, adapt it to new risks, give it during working hours and bear its cost, and experience does not remove that duty.

B: A trade qualification does not teach a new tool's procedure, so the duty covers everyone affected by the changed risk. C: Experience does not cover a new procedure, and the employer cannot pass the cost of required training to employees. D: Required training must take place in working hours and the employer must not charge employees for it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that long experience or a voluntary Saturday session satisfies the employer's duty to train people on a changed risk.

42. B — The file records what later builders and maintainers need to know about the structure, and it passes to the client, who keeps it and makes it available to those who need it.

A: Commercial paperwork is irrelevant to future safety, and no authority is responsible for holding the file. C: These documents describe the completed construction work rather than hazards for future work, and the client, not the contractor, keeps the file. D: Construction-phase accident records are not information needed for future work, and the file is not held by the designer afterwards.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the health and safety file as a general project archive instead of a short record of what future workers need to know about the building.

43. D — Marshals get people out and pass vital information to the fire service, who have the equipment and training for any search, so nobody should re-enter.

A: A marshal has no breathing apparatus or search training, and a dust mask gives no protection from smoke. B: Delay wastes time, because the fire service needs the missing person's likely position and hazards as soon as it arrives. C: Marshals are not expected to fight fires or send others back in once an alarm has sounded and a person is missing.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a fire marshal's job continues inside the building once everyone else has been evacuated.

44. B — Choosing a tool that suits the task keeps the wrist in a neutral position, and varying the work reduces the repetition that causes forearm strain.

A: A heavier tool adds load to the forearm, and a handle that does not suit the task keeps the wrist bent. C: Padding and supports leave the awkward wrist posture and repetition in place, so they do not remove the cause. D: Longer exposure on the same movement raises the strain, and recovery at weekends does not fix the tool or task design.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating hand-tool aches as a personal

fitness issue instead of choosing a tool whose shape suits the task.

45. B — A first aider whose certificate has lapsed no longer counts as qualified, and HSE strongly recommends but does not require annual refresher training.

A: Practice does not extend a certificate, so the site would lack qualified cover once the certificates lapse. C: Refresher courses are recommended rather than mandatory, and they do not revive an expired certificate. D: A short refresher is not a substitute for requalification when a certificate expires.

COMMON MISTAKE: Confusing an optional annual refresher with the renewal of a certificate that lets someone count as a qualified first aider.

46. C — An impact-only helmet with metal parts can conduct, so an electrically rated helmet is chosen for the hazard, and isolation remains the primary control.

A: Gloves do not protect the head from contact, and head protection must suit all the hazards present. B: Tape on the rivets does not make a vented, impact-only shell electrically rated. D: Shell thickness does not give a tested electrical rating, and live conductors should be isolated rather than approached.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any hard hat marked to the impact standard also protects against contact with live conductors.

47. C — A disc cutter throws fragments and spray at the face, so eye and face protection must be in place and worn correctly, not parked on the helmet.

A: The ear defenders are worn correctly, and the real gap is the unprotected face and eyes. B: Spray does not stop fragments or chips flying from the disc, so face protection is still required. D: Close-fitting gloves are acceptable here, and removing them would increase hand injuries without addressing the face.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that wearing a visor on the helmet counts as eye protection even when it is not lowered over the face.

48. B — Rooflights can fail under a person's weight, so a physical barrier or fixed load-bearing cover is needed, and signs or cones cannot stop a fall.

A: A lookout cannot physically stop a fall and can be distracted or too far away to react in time. C: Signs and cones only warn, and a lapse or a trip can still put someone through the glazing. D: Loose boards can slide or tip, and unsecured covers give a false sense of safety.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on signs, cones or a lookout to protect people from rooflights when a physical barrier or fixed cover is needed.

49. A — Ordinary torches can spark in flammable vapour, and carrying one prevents a safe hold on the stair, so atmosphere control and certified hands-free lighting are needed.

B: Ordinary torches are not certified for flammable atmospheres, and leaving one on does not make vapour safe. C: A non-certified head torch can still ignite vapour, and a fading smell does not prove the air is safe. D: A weaker smell is not a measurement of vapour, and an ordinary torch remains an ignition risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any torch is safe to take into a basement that may contain flammable vapour as long as the smell seems to have faded.

50. B — Following the traffic signs guidance, drivers need warning before they reach the cones, and only people trained in signing, lighting and guarding should set them out.

A: Removal should reverse the setting out, taking the advance sign last so warnings remain until the works are cleared. C: Drivers approach the cones with no warning in the meantime, and a general card does not prove traffic management competence. D: Signs must warn drivers ahead of the cones, and all signing, lighting and guarding needs trained, competent people.

COMMON MISTAKE: Setting out cones to protect the crew before the advance warning signs, and treating a general site card as enough for road signing.

PRACTICE TEST 12

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A groundworker sees the props removed from a deep excavation beside his work area and walks to the cabin to report it. The foreman threatens discipline for leaving without permission and orders him straight back. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** Procedures must let workers leave serious and imminent danger without waiting for instruction, keep them out, and protect those acting on a reasonable belief

☐ **B)** He should have waited for the foreman's permission first, because leaving a work area without authority breaks site rules whatever danger he believed he was in

☐ **C)** His protection applies once someone has actually been hurt, because the right to leave covers the aftermath of an accident rather than a danger not yet realised

☐ **D)** He may leave, but the foreman's own assessment decides when he returns, because a supervisor's judgement of the risk overrides the worker's belief about it

2. Overnight rain turns a pipe-laying task on a flat slab into one on a wet sloping ramp, and the planned two-person team is now one short. The operative says dynamic risk assessment lets him adapt as he goes. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Carry on at a slower pace with extra care, because a cautious approach offsets both the wet slope and the missing second person on the lift

☐ **B)** Stop and make the area safe, tell the supervisor, and restart once the method statement is revised and the team briefed, because the changes are significant

☐ **C)** Carry on using a quick mental assessment and write it up afterwards, because dynamic assessment replaces the written plan whenever conditions change on the day

☐ **D)** Ask the remaining operative to sign the original method statement again, because a fresh signature shows he accepts the changed conditions on site

3. During dusty cutting on one floor of an occupied office, a contractor bags every smoke detector in the building to stop false alarms. Staff are working on the floors above. Which arrangement best controls the fire risk?

☐ **A)** Cover them while the saws run and uncover them at breaks, because occupants would smell smoke and raise the alarm among themselves

☐ **B)** Bag all detectors but record it in the site diary, because a written note shows the risk was considered and call points will still sound the alarm

☐ **C)** Cover just the detectors in the dusty zone, for the shortest time, with the responsible person's agreement and interim cover, then uncover and test them

☐ **D)** Leave the detectors live and silence the sounders whenever they activate, because dust alarms are known nuisance signals and occupants would see a real fire

4. A joiner's hand is cut on a bench saw whose guard had been off for months. The manager's report says 'operator error'. Further enquiry shows a rushed programme, no supervisor checks and no replacement guard on site. What should the investigation do?

☐ **A)** Order a stronger replacement guard and close the report, because a hardware fix removes any need to look at pressure or supervision on this job

☐ **B)** Interview just the joiner and his gang, because managers and planners were away from the saw and could not have contributed to the injury here

☐ **C)** Look past the joiner to why removal was possible and tolerated, including pressure, supervision and supplies, and fix those causes too

☐ **D)** Accept the finding, because the joiner chose to work without the guard and that decision is the real cause, so retraining him closes the matter

5. A client's survey of a 1970s office lists no asbestos, but notes that the ceiling void and riser cupboards were 'not accessed'. A contractor plans to strip out both next week. How should he

proceed?

☐ **A)** Presume those areas contain asbestos until a refurbishment survey covering them shows otherwise, and keep work out of them until the results are known

☐ **B)** Rely on the client's word that the risk is low, because the other areas were clear and voids in the same building will be similar

☐ **C)** Strip both areas using wet methods and sample any suspect material afterwards, because test results will then show what the contractor should do next

☐ **D)** Proceed because a survey that lists no asbestos shows the building is clear, with the unvisited notes being routine caveats from the surveyor

6. Two labourers must move a half-full 45-litre sealed plastic drum of thick liquid across site by hand. The load shifts with each step. A colleague says a coordinated two-person lift deals with the weight. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Top the drum up until it is full and then lift as a pair, because a full drum cannot slosh and so is more predictable to carry across uneven ground

☐ **B)** Fit both labourers with back-support belts and carry it low and close, because the belts take the strain from the spine for the whole shift ahead

☐ **C)** Lift as a pair with one person calling each movement, because agreed signals remove the risk from contents that move during the long carry across site

☐ **D)** Avoid hand carrying by decanting into smaller containers or using a mechanical aid, as a shifting load is unpredictable even with two people

7. A hire company delivers a boom MEWP with a service sticker, and the operator completes his daily checks. The thorough examination report in the cab is dated seven months ago. The supervisor says the sticker and checks cover it. What is correct?

☐ **A)** The machine is fine, because a service sticker shows a competent engineer has checked it and the operator's daily check then confirms it is fit for use today

☐ **B)** The report is needed when a MEWP goes over eight metres, because lower machines are classed as access equipment rather than lifting equipment at work

☐ **C)** The report is out of date, as a MEWP needs thorough examination at least every six months and neither servicing nor daily checks replace it

☐ **D)** The report is in date, because the twelve-month interval for general lifting equipment applies to a hired MEWP in just the same way as to other plant



8. Look at the scene. The crew say the tower is safe because the castors are braked, the outriggers are fitted and the platform has full guardrails. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The base is levelled with loose bricks and timber under the castors, not adjustable legs on firm level ground, so the tower may shift

☐ **B)** The operative should be wearing a harness clipped to the guardrail, because a worker on a tower platform needs fall arrest while he is working

☐ **C)** The tower should be tied to the wall at every lift, because a tower standing next to a building has to be fixed back to it for stability

☐ **D)** The platform is too narrow for a roller, because a mobile tower used for painting needs a platform wide enough to hold a second person too

9. A haul route for excavators and dumpers must cross beneath an 11 kV overhead line. The planner proposes leaving the route open, trusting operators to keep their booms low and a banksman to watch the gap. What is the better control?

☐ **A)** Rely on the line being insulated, because covered conductors can be passed at any height by plant without any exclusion zone being set

☐ **B)** Keep the banksman's watch and ask drivers to go slowly, because a trained person on the spot can stop a vehicle that gets too close to the wires

☐ **C)** Mark the line with red and white bunting along the full route, since a visible warning lets experienced operators judge a safe gap for themselves

☐ **D)** Consult the line owner, fence off the zone, and allow one goalposted crossing with a clearance-height notice, so plant passes with booms lowered

10. A mobile crane lifts precast steps from the ground to a first-floor slab. The slinger signals while the load is at ground level, and a second person at the slab edge will receive it. The operator will respond to whoever signals. What is the best plan?

☐ **A)** Leave the operator to judge the landing alone from the cab, because the person who controls the crane is the best placed to put the load down safely

☐ **B)** Name one signaller at a time, hand over with a clear stop and confirm, keep the landing zone clear, and have the operator stop on an unclear signal

☐ **C)** Have the slinger keep signalling after the load rises out of sight, since the slinger knows the load best and can judge the landing from below the slab

☐ **D)** Let both signal together so the operator has two views, because duplicated signals give the operator a double check on each movement of the load

11. An HSE inspector finds an unsupported trench beside a footpath and sends a written notification of contravention, with no formal notice, because the contractor supports it the same day. The contractor refuses to pay, saying fees follow only enforcement notices. Which statement is accurate?

☐ **A)** A fee can still be charged, as a written notification of material breach triggers it and covers the inspector's time

☐ **B)** The fee covers only the inspector's time on the contractor's site, so office work and later calls with workers cannot be charged for

☐ **C)** A fee applies only if the case is prosecuted and the contractor is convicted, when the court orders the costs to be paid to HSE

☐ **D)** No fee arises because the breach was put right on the day, and fees apply only once an Improvement or Prohibition Notice is served

12. Tile-cutters and drain-layers wear waterproof gloves for most of each shift and wash their hands often. One reports itchy, sore skin between his fingers and says the gloves are keeping his hands safe. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Use a strong solvent hand cleaner during the shift, because it removes the irritant faster and more thoroughly than ordinary soap

☐ **B)** Report it early and cut glove time: use cotton liners, let hands dry between tasks, wash gently, and moisturise after each shift

☐ **C)** Wait a fortnight to see whether it settles before telling anyone, because mild soreness is normal and rarely gets any worse

☐ **D)** Switch to thicker waterproof gloves worn for longer, because the soreness comes from water leaking in and a tighter seal will stop it

13. During a six-week deadline push, a normally reliable steel fixer becomes short-tempered, arrives late and makes uncharacteristic errors. Two others in the gang are taking more sick days. What is the supervisor's best response?

☐ **A)** Issue a formal warning for his lateness and errors, because performance problems have to be dealt with before his wellbeing is considered

☐ **B)** Advise him to see his GP and leave it there, because stress is a personal health matter outside the employer's responsibility

☐ **C)** Wait for a medical note before acting, because stress counts as a workplace risk only once a doctor has formally diagnosed it

☐ **D)** Speak to him privately, ask what is affecting him, review the gang's workload as a possible stress hazard, and point to support



14. Look at the scene. A supervisor walks up to this cutting task

while it is in progress. What should the supervisor do first?

☐ **A)** Accept the glasses on his forehead, since he can drop them down in a moment if sparks begin to fly towards his face

☐ **B)** Stop the cutting, have eye protection worn over the eyes, and move the bystander clear of the sparks before restarting

☐ **C)** Replace his ear defenders with earplugs, because the hearing protection is the item most likely to let him down during grinding

☐ **D)** Let him finish the cut to avoid leaving a half-cut bar clamped in the vice, then remind him about his glasses at the next toolbox talk

15. A plant-room door shows a red circle with a diagonal bar across a naked flame, and beside it a blue circle containing safety goggles. A new starter asks what the two signs together require of anyone entering. Which reading is correct?

☐ **A)** The red sign binds contractors who use hot work, while the blue sign applies to visitors and is optional for trained site staff

☐ **B)** The red circle warns that a flame hazard exists inside the room, and the blue circle shows where spare goggles are stored

☐ **C)** Both are guidance signs: the red circle discourages flames where possible, and the blue circle suggests goggles for visitors without site training

☐ **D)** The red crossed circle prohibits naked flames, and the blue circle is a mandatory instruction that eye protection must be worn on entry

16. Edge protection on a flat roof has a top rail 1.0 m above the roof surface and one intermediate rail at 0.5 m, with a toe board at the base. The supervisor asks if the arrangement meets the Work at Height Regulations. Which comment is correct?

☐ **A)** It complies, because only the top rail height is controlled and the spacing of intermediate rails matters on scaffolds but not on roofs

☐ **B)** The 500 mm gap between top and intermediate rails exceeds the 470 mm limit so another rail is needed, but the 1.0 m top rail is adequate

☐ **C)** A gap of up to 600 mm is permitted when a toe board is fitted, since the toe board counts towards closing the opening

☐ **D)** The top rail is too low because roof edges need a 1.2 m rail, so the whole system must be raised before anyone is allowed to work there

17. An electrician must fit six light fittings along a corridor ceiling from fully guarded podium steps. To save time, his mate suggests he push on the ceiling to roll the podium to each fitting with the brakes off. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Rolling is acceptable on a smooth floor if the mate steadies the frame and the electrician holds the guardrail throughout every move

☐ **B)** Leave the brakes on and lean out to reach the next fitting, because the guardrails round the platform will stop him falling

☐ **C)** Keep the brakes on and gate closed while working, and step down to move the podium and re-brake it at each position

☐ **D)** Rolling is acceptable for short moves under two metres if he crouches in the centre and travels at walking pace

18. A telehandler driver must move a 1.8-tonne pack of blocks 50 m across a gently sloping, rutted yard to a scaffold. He plans to travel with the boom raised for visibility, saying the load moment indicator will warn him of instability. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Carry the pack just clear of the ground with the boom retracted and tilted back, go straight up or down slopes, and extend only to place it

☐ **B)** Carry the pack low but cross the slope diagonally, because that spreads the weight over all four wheels and gives better stability

☐ **C)** Travel with the boom raised as planned, because a working load moment indicator warns before instability and so removes the need to carry the load low

☐ **D)** Carry it low with the boom partly extended so the pack sits well ahead of the tyres and gives the driver a clearer view

19. A mobile crane on a quiet road will lift roof trusses over the site hoarding, and the slew path crosses the public footway. The crane supervisor proposes a banksman who stops pedestrians for each lift, with no barriers. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Plan the lifts so loads avoid the footway, or close and divert it with barriers while lifting, as part of the lift plan

☐ **B)** Lift only when the footway looks empty, judged by the operator from the cab, since no one can be harmed if nobody is there

☐ **C)** A banksman holding pedestrians back is enough, because each lift lasts only seconds and he can watch the load and the footway together

☐ **D)** Wrap the trusses in netting and use slings of a higher rating, so a dropped load cannot reach anyone on the footway

20. A contractor holds Section 61 consent for noisy demolition on weekdays in daytime hours. To catch up, the manager wants to run a breaker on Saturday afternoon, saying the council's consent covers the whole site. What should be done?

☐ **A)** Seek approval from the HSE for the Saturday hours, because it controls working times on construction sites for noise purposes

☐ **B)** Go ahead on Saturday, because consent covers the site for the whole contract and only complaints would justify further approval

☐ **C)** Ask the council to agree the extra hours before starting, show the quieter methods to be used, and tell the neighbours

☐ **D)** Post a letter to nearby homes and proceed, because notifying neighbours in advance removes the need to involve the council

21. A risk assessment for repainting a warehouse floor lists the hazards and says 'be careful' as the control, then is signed by the foreman and filed. The client asks how the paperwork helps the workers. What is the best answer?

☐ **A)** It does not, because controls must be specific and put in place, then communicated to the workers doing the job

☐ **B)** It does, provided the foreman has long experience, since experience can stand in for written controls on a routine task

☐ **C)** It does not, but only because the record is filed, so pinning it to the site notice board would make it effective

☐ **D)** It does, because a signed record shows the hazards were considered, which is the legal requirement for any job of this size

22. On a fit-out, a stair enclosure fire door is wedged open with a block so deliveries can be carried through quickly. The foreman says the building is only half-finished, so the door is not yet protecting anyone. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Leave it wedged but post a person nearby to close it if the alarm sounds, since a watcher gives the same protection as a closed door

☐ **B)** Remove the door leaf for the works, as an open frame gives better escape access than a door that people might find stiff

☐ **C)** Leave it wedged during working hours and remove the block at night, since fires on site mostly start when the building is empty

☐ **D)** Keep it closed, or fit an approved hold-open that releases on the alarm, because it protects the escape route and limits fire and smoke spread

23. A fabricator tack-welds mild steel brackets in an open yard for about twenty minutes at a time. The supervisor says no controls are needed, as it is outdoors, short work and mild steel rather than stainless. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Open-air work and short arc times keep exposure below the limit, so a note on the risk assessment is enough and no equipment is needed.

☐ **B)** Mild steel fume can cause lung cancer, so controls are expected for all welding, including respiratory protection outdoors.

☐ **C)** Health surveillance with regular lung function tests can replace controls, since any early harm would be picked up and the welder moved on.

☐ **D)** Only stainless steel fume is a carcinogen, so mild steel welding can proceed without controls provided the welder stays upwind of the plume.

24. Bricklayers work through a hot afternoon on an exposed scaffold wearing full hi-vis and long sleeves. One becomes dizzy, flushed and confused and stops sweating. His mate offers him a coffee and suggests he sits it out for ten minutes. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Take off his hi-vis only and keep him working at a slower pace in the sun until he stops feeling dizzy

☐ **B)** Let him rest for ten minutes with a hot drink, then send him back to work as most dizziness passes once he has sat down

☐ **C)** Treat it as possible heat illness: move him to shade, cool him, give water and call for medical help if he does not recover quickly

☐ **D)** Give him a cold energy drink and a salt tablet, then leave him lying on the boards in the sun to recover

25. Steel erectors must fix roof sheeting to a portal frame 9 m up, where edge protection cannot be fitted before the sheets go on. The contractor weighs harnesses clipped to a wire along the purlins against safety nets rigged below. Which choice follows the hierarchy for fall protection?

☐ **A)** Rig nets along the building perimeter only, leaving erectors in the middle of the roof to rely on harnesses and a short lanyard.

☐ **B)** Rig safety nets under the work area using competent riggers, because collective protection works for everyone without relying on each person to clip on.

☐ **C)** Choose harnesses because a person who lands in a net can still be injured, so only a lanyard that stops the fall at once is really safe.

☐ **D)** Use harnesses on a wire along the purlins, because a trained team on site can recover a fallen worker quickly and nets are then not needed at all.



26. Look at the open edge of the slab where the steel fixers are working. Which combination of faults most increases the severity of a fall from the edge?

☐ **A)** Bundles of rebar stacked tight against the open edge, and no safety netting rigged beneath the slab to catch a falling person.

☐ **B)** A guardrail that lacks an intermediate rail and a toe board, and fixers who are not wearing protective gloves for handling the steel.

☐ **C)** Vertical bars with bare, uncapped tops near the edge, and an edge guardrail that lacks an intermediate rail and a toe board.

☐ **D)** Vertical bars with bare, uncapped tops near the edge, and fixers who are not wearing full-body harnesses clipped to anchor points.

27. A labourer is told to enter a manhole chamber to clear a blockage. A colleague says it is only 1.5 m deep and smells normal, so he can go straight down after opening the cover and waiting a minute. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Enter after the wait, since a shallow chamber under two metres cannot build up harmful gas and counts as open ground

☐ **B)** Enter wearing a dust mask and tell a colleague nearby, since a sense of smell is enough to warn of harmful air

☐ **C)** Enter on a rope tied to his belt with a colleague holding it at the top, as this is as good as a rescue plan

☐ **D)** Treat it as a confined space: assess, test the air, and use a safe system including a rescue plan, as a normal smell proves nothing

28. An electrician isolates a sub-main with a personal padlock and tag, then goes to lunch. A site engineer needing power for a pump cuts off the padlock, saying the tag is only a courtesy and the circuit was proved dead earlier. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Removal is fine since the circuit was proved dead at the start of the job, so nothing downstream can have changed during a lunch break.

☐ **B)** Locks matter mainly on high-voltage equipment, so a low-voltage temporary supply for a pump needs just a verbal warning to other workers nearby.

☐ **C)** The engineer may remove it because a supervisor outranks an electrician, provided the tag is left on the board to show who cut the lock.

☐ **D)** Removal must follow the lock-off procedure, normally by whoever fitted it, once the work is done and the circuit is safe.

29. While digging foundations, an excavator exposes dark, oily-smelling soil and some buried drums that were not in the site survey. The supervisor wants the soil loaded into a skip with the clean spoil to keep the programme. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Keep digging round the drums with gloves and a mask, as the survey recorded the site as clean and the drums are probably all empty.

☐ **B)** Stop digging there, keep people clear and stop run-off, then report it so the soil can be assessed and handled separately as waste.

☐ **C)** Load it with the clean spoil, since mixing dilutes the

contamination to a level that will no longer be of any real concern to the tip.

☐ **D)** Stockpile the soil on bare ground beside the dig to air-dry for a few days, then decide later which tip or treatment site should take it.

30. After a pump pour, an operator washes the hopper and chute with a hose by the site gate. Grey cement water runs across the yard toward a surface-water gully. The supervisor says cement is natural and will simply dilute. Which response is correct?

☐ **A)** Stop the wash-down and contain the water, then move cleaning to a lined washout area so alkaline cement water stays out of drains.

☐ **B)** Let it run to the gully if a trap is fitted, because the settling of solids in the trap removes the harm from the water.

☐ **C)** Keep washing but add plenty more water from the hose, because greater dilution will reduce the alkalinity before it reaches the gully and beyond.

☐ **D)** Direct the wash water to a foul sewer gully without asking anyone, since sewage works can cope with cement washings from construction sites.

31. A bank is refurbishing one floor of its occupied head office through a principal contractor. A manager says CDM covers only the builders, so the bank's own staff, who share the lift lobby and fire escape, are the contractor's concern alone. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The client's arrangements must cover anyone affected, including its own staff, so it must share information on the occupied premises and co-ordinate its operations with the contractor

☐ **B)** The client may hand every duty to the principal contractor once it is appointed, so the bank keeps no further responsibility for risks created by the works

☐ **C)** CDM duties attach to those carrying out construction work, so the bank's staff are protected by general workplace law and the client need only appoint the contractor and pay

☐ **D)** The client's duty covers its staff only if the project is notifiable to HSE, so below the thresholds the contractor alone must manage the effect on them

32. A labourer fixes the lid switch of a pan mixer with a cable tie so it keeps running when the guard is lifted, to save time. A colleague saw this and said nothing, and the supervisor noticed and ignored it. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** No breach has occurred, because the guard is still physically in place and the cable tie affects only the speed at which the mixer can be run

☐ **B)** Only the labourer is accountable, because workers are responsible for how they use equipment once the employer has supplied a machine with a working guard fitted to it

☐ **C)** The colleague is the one in breach, because the duty to inform the employer of a danger is the main legal duty that applies in this situation

☐ **D)** The labourer has interfered with a safety device, and the employer, aware of it, has also failed in its duty by allowing the mixer to run with the guard defeated

33. A designer must choose how to join steel stair stringers in a small plant room. Site welding would need fume controls. Which option best follows the hierarchy of control when she decides what to specify?

☐ **A)** Specify a lower-fume welding process with a portable extraction arm, since this captures most of the fume at source and keeps the original design unchanged

☐ **B)** Keep the welded design and require welders to wear fit-tested FFP3 masks with rotation breaks, because masks protect the people carrying out the work

☐ **C)** Specify bolted connections so that no site welding takes place, then reassess the new bolting tasks, including fixing at height and the torque tools used

☐ **D)** Keep site welding but open the plant room doors and fit a fan, since dilution ventilation lowers fume levels enough to make the original design acceptable

34. A joiner trims oak doors with a router in a first-floor corridor, with no extraction fitted. The supervisor says his FFP3 mask deals with the dust, although decorators are working in the adjoining rooms. Which view is correct?

☐ **A)** The decorators should each wear a disposable mask while the joiner works, because protecting the receiving group is cheaper than controlling the source

☐ **B)** The mask is sufficient for the joiner, and the decorators

are protected as long as the doors between the rooms are kept closed while the joiner is cutting wood

☐ **C)** The mask protects only the wearer, so dust should be captured at the tool and the trades kept apart, as hardwood dust can cause asthma and nasal cancer

☐ **D)** The corridor's open windows will disperse the dust, so extraction is needed only where the same work is done repeatedly in a fixed workshop

35. A pipefitter must handle sharp-edged duct sections coated in oil and wipe them with a degreasing solvent. The store offers gloves marked only with the EN 388 mechanical-hazards pictogram, cut level D. How should the supervisor judge them?

☐ **A)** A high cut level gives broad protection, so these gloves suit both the sharp edges and a brief solvent wipe if they are changed when they become wet

☐ **B)** Wearing two pairs of the EN 388 gloves handles the solvent, because the extra layer roughly doubles the time before the chemical reaches the skin

☐ **C)** Any thick glove covers chemical contact, since the cut rating shows the material is dense enough to slow solvent from passing through to the skin

☐ **D)** The marking shows mechanical protection only, so choose a glove also rated for chemical resistance to that solvent, using supplier breakthrough data

36. A contractor proposes rope access to replace sealant on a 25 m facade. The technicians would use one anchored rope plus a fall-arrest lanyard clipped to facade brackets, and the assessment gives no reason a second rope cannot be used. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Rope access is not permitted where scaffolding or a cradle is feasible, whatever the assessment says, so the proposal fails on the choice of method alone

☐ **B)** Rope access can be acceptable after assessment, but it needs two separately anchored lines, trained technicians and rescue, so reject this proposal

☐ **C)** A single rope is acceptable where technicians hold a recognised rope access certificate, because certification replaces the need for a second line

☐ **D)** The lanyard clipped to the facade brackets counts as the safety line, so one anchored rope plus the lanyard forms an acceptable two-point system

37. A 110 V centre-tapped supply feeds tools in a rear yard. Its yellow cable lies across the dumper route into the yard, covered by two scaffold boards. The electrician says 110 V limits shock to 55 V to earth, so damage is no concern. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Re-route it clear of vehicles, for example overhead or in ducting, since the lower voltage reduces shock severity but does not stop vehicles damaging the cable

☐ **B)** Switch to a 230 V supply protected by an RCD, as the RCD would trip on cable damage faster than the reduced voltage would limit the harm

☐ **C)** Swap the scaffold boards for a rubber cable trip guard, since a guard stops people tripping and is also adequate protection against heavy dumper wheels

☐ **D)** Leave it in place, as 110 V centre-tapped supplies limit shock to 55 V to earth and the boards give enough extra protection on a low-risk supply



38. Look at the scene. The operator says the pallet is strapped and is only going a short distance across the yard. What is the most serious problem?

☐ **A)** The telehandler is travelling without a banksman, and a second person walking ahead would make carrying the raised load across the slope acceptable

☐ **B)** The pallet is secured by strapping rather than chains, which is the main failing because the load could slide off the forks even on level ground

☐ **C)** The forks are too long for the pallet, which is the principal cause of the instability and should be corrected before the machine moves any further

☐ **D)** The load is carried high while travelling across the slope,

raising the centre of gravity and risking overturn; lower it and drive straight

39. Delivery lorries queue on the public road outside a busy site, and drivers walk in through the vehicle gate to find the cabin and sign in, dodging site traffic. The manager proposes a speed-limit sign at the gate. Which change best controls the risk?

☐ **A)** Ask each driver to stay in the cab and wait for a banksman to walk out to the lorry, which avoids a gatehouse and any change to the road layout

☐ **B)** Provide a waiting area off the highway and a marked pedestrian entrance to a gatehouse, so drivers report in without walking through vehicle routes

☐ **C)** Require drivers to phone the cabin on arrival and wear hi-vis clothing, so staff know they are coming and can be seen while they walk through

☐ **D)** Fit a flashing beacon and a convex mirror at the gate, so site drivers can see walking drivers early enough to stop for them in the gateway

40. Soil excavated beside an old fuel store tests as hazardous waste because of hydrocarbons. To avoid the disposal cost, the foreman proposes blending it into 200 tonnes of clean soil so the mix tests below the threshold. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Blending would be unlawful mixing of hazardous waste; the soil must stay separate, be classified, and go with a consignment note to a permitted site

☐ **B)** Blending is lawful if it is done on site before the soil leaves, as the mixing prohibition applies once the waste is loaded into a carrier's vehicle

☐ **C)** Blending is unlawful, but the soil may go to an inert landfill with a standard transfer note once it has been kept covered and dry

☐ **D)** Blending is lawful because classification is judged on the final stockpile, and testing the blended soil is what the waste duty of care requires of the producer

41. A designer specifies 1.8-tonne precast lintels with no lifting points and says safe handling is the contractor's problem on site. The principal contractor objects. Which statement about the designer's duty under CDM 2015 is correct?

☐ **A)** The designer must act only if the client has asked in writing for a risk-reduced design, since component choice is otherwise treated as a commercial matter

☐ **B)** The designer takes over the contractor's lifting duties for any component they specify, including appointing the appointed person and planning every lift on site

☐ **C)** The designer must eliminate, reduce or control foreseeable risks through the design, such as adding lifting points, and pass on information about significant risks that remain

☐ **D)** The duty ends once drawings are issued, because the principal contractor alone decides handling methods, so no design change or risk information is needed from the designer

42. A newly promoted gang leader completes a 14-page generic risk assessment template for a short pipe-lagging job, listing trivial hazards in detail but omitting the live-plant isolation. His manager calls it thorough. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** It is acceptable provided the gang leader holds a formal risk assessment qualification, since the qualification alone proves the assessment itself is adequate

☐ **B)** It is sufficient for a short job, because short-duration tasks are exempt from needing significant risks identified or controlled in a written assessment

☐ **C)** It is suitable and sufficient, because the length and detail of a recorded assessment show the employer has taken reasonable care and satisfied the legal standard

☐ **D)** It is not suitable and sufficient: it must identify the significant risks and proportionate controls, and be done by someone able to spot them

43. A flashback burns out a hose in a fabrication bay, and an acetylene cylinder was engulfed in flames for several minutes. The fire is out and the cylinder now feels only warm. The supervisor wants it moved outside. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Open the valve slowly to vent the pressure outside the bay, which removes the stored gas and stops the cylinder from becoming dangerous again

☐ **B)** Leave it where it is, keep people clear, tell the fire service it was heated, and have it cooled and monitored until they declare it safe

☐ **C)** Spray it with the nearest water extinguisher until cool to

touch, then return it to the store because no flames remain and the cylinder feels cool

☐ **D)** Close the valve, wheel it carefully into open air away from the building, and leave it standing there until the supplier collects it on the next delivery

44. A gun-wash thinner for cleaning spray equipment carries a flame pictogram and hazard statements H225 and H336. The operative plans a dust mask because he has no dust task, and will clean the equipment beside the site heater. What should the supervisor say?

☐ **A)** The flame symbol covers storage only, so use it near the heater if the container is closed between uses and fit a dust mask to deal with the vapour

☐ **B)** The ignition risk is controlled once the heater is turned down to its lowest setting, so no further ventilation or respiratory protection is needed for the cleaning task

☐ **C)** H336 is a low-level warning for comfort only, so the operative can carry on if he feels well and keeps the thinner away from skin contact

☐ **D)** It is a highly flammable liquid whose vapour can cause drowsiness, so remove ignition sources, ventilate well, and use the respiratory protection that the data sheet specifies

45. A random test on a site with a drugs and alcohol policy returns a positive result for a prescribed sedating medication taken by a crane slinger. He had told nobody. Which response best fits good practice?

☐ **A)** Remove him from safety-critical duties, review the result confidentially with occupational health, and agree fitness and any duty changes first

☐ **B)** Take no action, because the drug is prescribed and legal, and assume the doctor has already judged him fit for slinging duties on a construction site

☐ **C)** Tell the whole gang about the result so everyone can watch for drowsiness, and keep him on his current duties under closer informal supervision

☐ **D)** Treat it as gross misconduct and dismiss him on the spot, because any positive result breaches the policy whether or not the drug was prescribed

46. A supplier replaces the FFP3 disposable masks a clean-shaven gang passed fit tests on with a different make of the same class. They look similar, so the supervisor says the earlier fit tests still apply. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** A fit test applies to a specific make, model and size, so each wearer needs a new test on the new mask, plus a fit check at each donning

☐ **B)** The earlier tests remain valid because both masks are the same FFP3 class, and the class marking guarantees an equivalent seal on every face shape

☐ **C)** A new test is needed only for workers who report a leak, as the others have shown they can achieve a seal and will notice any problem themselves

☐ **D)** A new test is unnecessary if the wearers are clean-shaven, since the absence of facial hair removes the main cause of a mask failing to seal



47. The picture shows an operative about to start work near a roof edge, relying on a fall-arrest system. What must be done before he is allowed to proceed?

☐ **A)** Let him carry on, because the lanyard is the part that stops a fall and the harness only needs to be worn, so its fit is a comfort matter

☐ **B)** Swap his harness for a larger size, because the loose straps show it is too small and the ring height will correct itself once a roomier harness is on

☐ **C)** Stop him and have the harness adjusted so the straps are snug and fastened and the back attachment sits between the shoulder blades, then check it before use

☐ **D)** Let him carry on after tightening only the leg straps, since an open chest strap and a low back attachment do not affect how the load is spread in a fall

48. Two scaffolders on a boarded lift 6 m up must pass podger spanners and boxes of fittings to each other while a labourer

works at ground level beneath the same bay. Which approach best controls the risk of dropped objects?

☐ **A)** Rely on the toe boards at the platform edge, because they stop items falling and make an exclusion zone or tethered tools unnecessary for hand-over work

☐ **B)** Tether tools to the wearer, carry fittings in closed pouches or bags, and keep people out of the area below with a barrier or exclusion zone

☐ **C)** Make sure the labourer wears a hard hat, since head protection is the standard control for people beneath overhead work and the scaffolders then need no extra measures

☐ **D)** Have the scaffolders shout a warning before each hand-over, since an audible alert gives the labourer time to move clear of any falling spanner or fitting

49. While digging a drainage run beside a neighbour's old boundary wall, a new diagonal crack appears in the wall and a little loose soil slips from the excavation face. The foreman suggests filling the crack with sealant and continuing. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Batter back the excavation face and carry on, since changing the slope of the side is enough to make the wall safe without anyone assessing the wall itself

☐ **B)** Seal the crack to stop water entering, then continue digging but at a slower pace, because a surface crack is only a cosmetic finish problem for the wall owner

☐ **C)** Continue digging but keep only the machine operator in the area, since reducing the number of people exposed removes the need for further assessment or support

☐ **D)** Stop work and clear people from the excavation, then have a competent person assess the wall and ground and arrange support and monitoring before digging resumes

50. A mini-excavator is chained onto a braked plant trailer with its tracks mostly behind the axle, because it is easier to reverse on. On the dual carriageway the trailer starts to snake and the tow-hitch lifts. What is the main cause and the correct correction?

☐ **A)** The nose weight is too high, so move the machine further back to take weight off the hitch and stop the front of the trailer lifting

☐ **B)** The chains are slack, so tighten them until the excavator no longer moves on the bed, which cures the snaking without any change to the load position

☐ **C)** The load is too far back so the nose weight is too low; reposition the machine ahead of the axle within the stated nose weight limit and re-secure it

☐ **D)** The towing speed is too low for the trailer brakes to work, so drive faster until the trailer settles and the hitch stays pressed down on the tow ball

Answer Key

1. A — Regulation 8 of the Management Regulations requires procedures for serious and imminent danger, and workers who leave in a reasonable belief of such danger are protected from detriment under employment law.

B: Procedures for serious and imminent danger must allow workers to leave without waiting for instruction. C: The right applies to serious and imminent danger before harm occurs, which is the whole purpose of leaving. D: Workers must be kept from resuming work while serious and imminent danger continues, whatever a supervisor claims.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a supervisor's instruction to carry on outranks a worker's reasonable belief that danger is serious and imminent.

2. B — Dynamic risk assessment suits small, unforeseen changes, but when conditions and resources change significantly the planned controls no longer fit and the plan must be formally reviewed.

A: Care and speed are not controls and do not replace the second person or the grip the original plan relied on. C: On-the-spot judgement supplements a plan and cannot replace review when the task and team have changed significantly. D: Signing a plan that no longer matches the work records acceptance without making the task any safer.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating dynamic risk assessment as a licence to keep working on the spot after a major change in conditions or resources.

3. C — Detection should be disabled only where and when essential, with agreed alternative arrangements, and then reinstated and tested, so occupants elsewhere still get an early warning.

A: Relying on people to smell smoke is not a managed substitute and nobody checks that the covers are removed. B: Disabling detection across occupied floors removes early warning, and a diary note provides no alternative cover. D: Silencing sounders defeats the warning for everyone, including people who cannot see the affected area.

COMMON MISTAKE: Blanking off fire detection across a whole building to avoid nuisance alarms from a localised dusty task.

4. C — A sound investigation seeks underlying and root causes in the management system, not only the immediate act, so that the failure cannot simply recur with another worker.

A: A new guard alone leaves the programme pressure and missing checks that let the old one stay off. B: Managers set the programme, supervision and supplies, so leaving them out hides the underlying causes. D: Stopping at the immediate act ignores the system failures that made the unsafe act likely and easy.

COMMON MISTAKE: Closing an investigation at the first person who did something unsafe instead of asking why the system allowed it.

5. A — Areas not inspected must be presumed to contain asbestos, and refurbishment work needs a survey that reaches the areas to be disturbed before it begins.

B: Different materials are used in voids and risers, and a client's assumption is not a survey result. C: Sampling after disturbance has already released any fibres, which defeats the purpose of identifying material first. D: The absence of listed asbestos says nothing about areas that were not inspected.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading a survey that lists no asbestos as proof that every part of the building is clear.

6. D — Under the manual handling hierarchy, an unstable load that moves is a hazard in itself, so avoiding hand carrying or reducing the load is better than relying on a coordinated team lift.

A: Filling it adds weight and makes the task heavier, and does not address carrying by hand over distance. B: Belts are not a recognised control for unstable loads and do not replace avoiding or reducing the hazard. C: Coordination helps with timing but cannot control a load whose centre of gravity keeps shifting underfoot.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that two people sharing a lift removes the hazard from a load that is awkward, unstable or shifting.

7. C — Equipment used to lift people needs a thorough examination by a competent person at least every six months under LOLER, and servicing and operator checks are separate duties.

A: A service is not a thorough examination, and daily checks cannot substitute for the examination interval. B: Thorough examination is required whatever the working height, because the platform lifts people. D: Equipment that lifts people has the shorter six-month interval, not the twelve months for other lifting equipment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a recent service or the operator's daily check as proof that the thorough examination is up to date.

8. A — A tower must stand plumb on firm level ground using its adjustable legs, since packing under the castors can slip or collapse and defeats the stability that brakes and outriggers are meant to provide.

B: Complete guardrails are the collective protection, and clipping onto a tower is not required and can add load. C: Mobile towers are normally free-standing and are kept stable by base ratio and outriggers, not by tying to walls. D: Platform width is not the issue shown and a single worker on a standard narrow tower is acceptable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a tower safe from its brakes, outriggers and guardrails without checking that its base is firm, level and set on its own adjustable legs.

9. D — HSE guidance says to keep plant out of the zone with ground-level barriers, to create a minimum number of marked passageways with non-conducting goalposts, and to consult the line owner.

A: Insulation on overhead lines cannot be relied on to protect against contact, so exclusion zones still apply. B: A banksman cannot reliably judge clearance to a high line, and people are not a physical barrier. C: Warning flags alone do not physically restrain plant, and judging distances by eye risks arcing.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on operator judgement or a spotter to keep plant clear of overhead lines instead of physical barriers and a controlled crossing.

10. B — Only one signaller should direct the operator at any time, handovers must be unambiguous, and the operator should stop on any signal that is unclear or lost.

A: The operator may not see the landing, which is why a signaller is used and the plan must name one. C: A signaller who cannot see the load or landing cannot direct it safely, so control must pass to someone who can. D: Competing signals confuse the operator, who needs a single clear source of instruction.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming several people can signal a crane at once, rather than naming one signaller who hands over clearly.

11. A — Fee for intervention is triggered by a notification of contravention for a material breach, not by an enforcement notice, and it covers the time HSE spends identifying the breach and helping put it right.

B: Chargeable time includes report writing, specialist advice and later discussions as well as time at the workplace. C: Fee for intervention is separate from prosecution and is invoiced on the strength of the notification of contravention. D: Fixing the problem quickly does not cancel the fee, and the trigger is the written notification, not a formal notice.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that putting a breach right quickly, or avoiding a formal notice, means the enforcing authority cannot recover its costs.

12. B — Long spells in waterproof gloves make hands sweat, and wet work damages the skin barrier, so reducing wet time, drying and moisturising with early reporting helps prevent dermatitis.

A: Solvent cleaners strip the skin's natural oils and are themselves a cause of dermatitis. C: Early dermatitis is easiest to reverse, and waiting allows the skin to break down and sometimes sensitise. D: Sealed gloves trap sweat against the skin, which can itself cause the damage, so longer wear makes it worse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that any glove worn all day protects the skin, when long wear in damp conditions can cause the damage.

13. D — Work-related stress must be managed like any other hazard, so the supervisor looks for causes such as workload as well as supporting the individual.

A: Discipline ignores the likely cause and may increase the stress, while the pattern across the gang points to a work factor. B: Employers must assess and control work-related stress, and a signpost alone leaves the cause untouched. C: Changes in behaviour and rising absence are warning signs that should be acted on without waiting for a diagnosis.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating changes in a worker's behaviour as a personal failing instead of asking whether workload or pressure is the cause.

14. B — The operative's eye protection is not covering his eyes and a colleague is in the path of the sparks, so the work must stop until both exposures are controlled.

A: Sparks and fragments start the instant the disc touches the steel, so the protection must already be in place and not be put on after the exposure has begun. C: His ear defenders are not the failing item, and swapping them does not address the uncovered eyes or the bystander. D: Allowing work to continue knowingly exposes unprotected eyes to sparks, and a later talk does nothing to remove that immediate danger.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting PPE as worn because it is on the person, when it is not positioned to protect the part of the body at

risk.

15. D — A red circle with a bar is a prohibition sign, and a blue circle with a white symbol is a mandatory sign that gives an instruction that must be followed.

A: Both signs apply to everyone entering, and trained staff are not exempt from a mandatory instruction. B: Warnings use yellow triangles and safe-condition information uses green, so this reverses the meanings of both signs. C: Prohibition and mandatory signs state firm requirements and are not advisory.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading safety signs by their pictures alone and overlooking that shape and colour show whether a sign warns, prohibits or commands.

16. B — Schedule 2 requires a top rail at least 950 mm high with no gap in the protection greater than 470 mm, so the top rail is fine but the gap is too large.

A: The regulations apply to any place where a person could fall, and they limit gaps wherever guardrails are used. C: The maximum gap is 470 mm, and a toe board does not widen that limit. D: The requirement is a top rail of at least 950 mm, so 1.0 m is acceptable and raising it would not cure the gap.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking only the height of the top rail and forgetting to check the size of the gaps beneath it.

17. C — Podium steps are stable only when braked and used within their guarded platform, so they must be moved when unoccupied.

A: Moving the podium with a person aboard is unsafe because it can tip or the castors can catch and throw him. B: Leaning beyond the guardrails shifts the centre of gravity and risks overturning, so the unit must be repositioned instead. D: Short distance and crouching do not remove the risk of tipping, and the rule is to move it empty.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking guardrails make a mobile platform safe to move or lean from while someone is standing on it.

18. A — A low, retracted, tilted-back load keeps the combined centre of gravity inside the wheelbase, and the load chart applies only when raising and extending to place it.

B: Crossing a slope puts the load's weight toward the downhill wheels and increases the risk of side overturn. C: An indicator is a last-line warning and cannot stop a raised load tipping the machine when it hits a rut or turns. D: Extending the boom moves the load further from the front axle and reduces stability and the rated capacity.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on an alarm or indicator to protect against instability instead of travelling with the load low and close.

19. A — The lift plan must remove people from the danger area, and physically closing or avoiding the footway is more reliable than relying on one person to stop pedestrians.

B: A pedestrian can step into the danger zone at any moment and the operator cannot see the whole footway from the cab. C: One person cannot reliably control passers-by while also directing a lift, and a short exposure still carries a serious consequence. D: Stronger slings and netting reduce some risks but do not prevent a load swinging or falling onto people below.

COMMON MISTAKE: Depending on one person or a quiet period to keep the public safe instead of keeping the public out of the lifting area.

20. C — Prior consent sets agreed hours and methods under best practicable means, so work outside them needs the council's agreement in advance.

A: Noise nuisance to neighbours is controlled by the local authority and not by the HSE. B: Consent is tied to the hours and methods agreed, so the manager cannot treat it as permission for any working pattern. D: Informing neighbours is good practice but does not replace the council's agreement to hours outside the consent.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a consent or permission obtained once covers any change to hours or methods later.

21. A — An assessment is useful only if it sets out specific controls that are implemented and explained to those affected, rather than a vague phrase and a signature.

B: Experience helps but the controls still have to be identified and passed on to the workers. C: Displaying the paper does not turn 'be careful' into a control, and the content is the real fault. D: The duty is to control the risks, and a record with no real controls does not do that.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking a signed and filed assessment protects people even when its controls are vague.

22. D — A fire door only works if it is shut when fire starts, and escape stairs on a live site must stay protected, so wedging it defeats the compartment.

A: A watcher cannot reliably close the door in smoke and panic, and the door would still be open until then. B: Removing the leaf destroys the fire and smoke barrier and the stair stops being protected. C: Fires can start at any time, and people on site during the day depend on a protected escape route.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a fire door on an unfinished

building as a nuisance rather than as part of the escape route.

23. B — HSE states there is no known safe exposure level to mild steel welding fume, so controls apply whatever the duration or location.

A: No safe level is recognised for mild steel fume, so short spells and open air cannot be relied on to avoid controls. C: Surveillance is a back-up that checks controls are working, and cannot be used as a substitute for preventing exposure. D: Mild steel fume is also classed as carcinogenic, and standing upwind does not remove exposure in changing air movement.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming fresh air and short welding spells make mild steel fume harmless.

24. C — Confusion and loss of sweating can be signs of serious heat illness, which needs rapid cooling and medical help rather than a short rest and caffeine.

A: He needs shade and cooling, and continued work in the sun risks collapse. B: A hot drink does not cool him, and a short rest is not enough if the signs are serious. D: Lying in the sun does not cool him and salt tablets can make matters worse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating confusion and stopped sweating in hot weather as simple tiredness.

25. B — Where a fall cannot be prevented, collective measures that limit the consequences of a fall are preferred over personal systems that depend on individual use.

A: Perimeter nets do not catch someone falling through the roof area, and the centre workers would still depend on personal systems. C: Nets are designed to catch falls at limited height, and a sudden stop on a lanyard can itself cause injury or suspension trauma. D: Personal systems depend on every worker clipping on correctly and need prompt rescue, so they rank below collective protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing harnesses because they are cheaper and easier to fit, rather than ranking collective measures first.

26. C — A person falling could be impaled on the exposed bar ends, and the missing intermediate rail and toe board leave gaps through which people and materials can fall.

A: The bundles are stored well back from the edge, so the stacking fault described is not present in the scene. B: The fixers wear gloves, and the picture shows no glove fault, so this pairs a real gap with something that is not present. D: The harness point is wrong because properly built edge protection is the primary control, and the image shows the real fault is incomplete rails.

COMMON MISTAKE: Looking only at the guardrail and forgetting that uncapped reinforcing bars turn a fall into an impalement hazard.

27. D — Chambers can hold toxic gas or lack oxygen with no warning smell, so entry needs assessment, testing and a rescue arrangement set up beforehand.

A: Depth does not decide the risk, as gas can collect in any chamber. B: A dust mask gives no protection against gas and smell is not a reliable warning. C: A person holding a rope cannot rescue an unconscious casualty and may be overcome by trying.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a chamber to be safe by its depth or smell instead of testing the air and arranging rescue.

28. D — A personal lock shows work may be in progress, and re-energising without checking could electrocute someone working downstream.

A: An earlier proving test says nothing about what is now connected or being worked on, and the lock exists to prevent this assumption. B: Lock-off applies to any circuit being worked on, whatever the voltage, and verbal warnings are easily missed or forgotten. C: Seniority gives no authority to override a personal lock, and leaving the tag in place does not show the circuit is safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a lock or tag as a courtesy that anyone with a reason can remove.

29. B — Unexpected contamination must be contained and assessed, because mixing it with clean spoil makes all of it contaminated waste.

A: A survey that missed the drums cannot be relied on, and disturbing unknown contents risks exposure and a pollution incident. C: Diluting waste by mixing is not an acceptable treatment and turns a small volume of problem material into a large one. D: Leaving it on bare ground lets contamination leach into soil and drains, and drying does not remove the contaminants.

COMMON MISTAKE: Carrying on digging because the survey said the ground was clean, instead of stopping when something unexpected appears.

30. A — Cement water is highly alkaline and harmful to aquatic life, and surface-water gullies usually drain directly to a watercourse.

B: A gully trap catches some solids but does not neutralise the alkalinity of the water that continues to the outfall. C: Diluting does not make a discharge lawful, and it increases the volume of polluting liquid that reaches the watercourse. D: Discharging trade effluent to the foul sewer needs the sewerage company's consent, and unauthorised cement water can damage the system.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking cement washings are harmless because cement is a natural-looking mineral product.

31. A — A client must make suitable arrangements so the work is done without risks to anyone affected by the project, which includes its own staff and visitors, and must pass on what it knows about the premises.

B: A client keeps its own duties and must take reasonable steps to check the arrangements are working. C: Client duties under CDM extend to people affected by the project, not just construction workers. D: The client's duty to make suitable arrangements applies to all projects, notifiable or not.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that appointing a principal contractor passes every client duty to the contractor, including those for the client's own occupied premises.

32. D — Workers must not interfere with anything provided for safety, while an employer who knows a safeguard is defeated must stop the machine being used until it is put right.

A: Defeating the interlock removes the protection the guard provides, which is interference with a safety device. B: The employer also breaches its duties by knowingly allowing use of equipment with a defeated safeguard. C: The labourer's act of interference is itself a breach, and the supervisor, as the employer's agent, already knew.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a defeated interlock as a minor shortcut when it is interference with safety equipment that both worker and employer must prevent.

33. C — Removing the welding task eliminates the fume hazard at source, and any new tasks created by the change must still be assessed.

A: Substitution and extraction reduce the hazard but leave welding fume present, so they rank below elimination. B: Respiratory protection is the last line of control and should not replace removing the task. D: General ventilation is a weak engineering control and does not remove the hazard that design could eliminate.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing a cleaner process or better extraction when a design change could remove the hazardous task entirely.

34. C — Controlling dust at source protects everyone nearby, whereas a mask protects one person and is a last-resort measure; hardwood dust is linked with asthma and nasal cancer.

A: Equipping the exposed group with masks puts protection ahead of control of the dust at source. B: Fine dust passes through gaps and settles on surfaces, so closed doors do not control the source. D: Ventilation does not remove dust at source and the need for extraction does not depend on a fixed workshop.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on a worker's mask to deal with dust that is still spreading to everyone else on the floor.

35. D — EN 388 covers cuts and abrasion, not chemicals, so chemical suitability must be shown separately for the substance used.

A: Cut level says nothing about resistance to a chemical, which can pass through or degrade the material. B: Doubling an unsuitable material does not make it resistant, and the solvent can degrade both layers. C: Thickness and cut rating do not indicate how a solvent permeates or degrades the glove.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a glove that resists cuts must also resist the chemicals on the job.

36. B — A rope access system normally comprises a working line and a separately anchored safety line, used by trained people with rescue arrangements in place.

A: Rope access can be used where assessment shows it is suitable, but the system must still meet its own requirements. C: Training is required in addition to the two-line system, not as a substitute for it. D: The safety line must be a separately anchored line that travels with the user, not a lanyard on facade brackets.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a trained technician on a single rope with a lanyard is equivalent to a two-rope system.

37. A — The 110 V centre-tapped system keeps voltage to earth to 55 V, but cable must still be protected from foreseeable mechanical damage so that it cannot cause danger.

B: A 230 V supply is a higher-risk choice for portable tools, and an RCD does not remove the crushing hazard. C: A pedestrian trip guard is not designed to resist dumper wheel loads and the cable stays on the vehicle route. D: A reduced voltage lowers shock severity but does not remove the need to protect cable from crushing.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a reduced-voltage supply as safe enough that the cable no longer needs protecting from vehicles.

38. D — A telehandler is most stable with the boom low and the load close to the ground, and it should not be driven across a slope.

A: A banksman does not make unstable travel acceptable, as the machine itself can still overturn. B: Load security matters, but the machine's stability on the slope with a raised load is the dominant hazard. C: Fork length can affect handling, but it does not explain the lean caused by travelling across a slope with a raised load.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a short move as low-risk when carrying a raised load across a slope can overturn a telehandler.

39. B — Separating pedestrians from vehicles at the entrance and getting queues off the public road tackles the hazard directly, whereas a sign relies on behaviour.

A: Waiting on the public road keeps queues on the highway, and one banksman cannot manage a queue safely. C: Phone calls and hi-vis leave drivers among moving vehicles and do not segregate them. D: Mirrors and beacons aid detection but leave pedestrians and vehicles sharing the same space.

COMMON MISTAKE: Adding signs, mirrors or hi-vis at an entrance instead of separating people on foot from vehicles.

40. A — Hazardous waste must not be mixed with non-hazardous waste or diluted to change its classification, so it is kept separate and sent to a suitably permitted site.

B: The mixing prohibition applies from where the waste is produced, not just in transit. C: Hazardous soil needs a consignment note and a site permitted for hazardous waste, not an inert landfill. D: Diluting waste to change its classification is prohibited, so the blended result cannot be used.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking waste can be diluted with clean material to bring it under a hazardous threshold.

41. C — CDM 2015 requires designers to take foreseeable risks into account, to eliminate or reduce them where possible, and to give the principal contractor information about the residual risks.

A: The designer's duty arises automatically under the Regulations and does not depend on a written request from the client. B: Planning and supervising lifts remains with the contractor; the designer's duty is to design out or reduce risk and to share information. D: Design decisions directly shape how safely a component can be handled, so the designer cannot pass the whole risk to the contractor.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that once a design leaves the drawing office, every risk it creates becomes the site contractor's problem alone.

42. D — A suitable and sufficient assessment focuses on the significant hazards for the actual task, and the assessor needs enough knowledge and experience to recognise them, not merely to complete a form.

A: Competence is about knowledge and experience of the work, and a qualification cannot make a flawed assessment adequate. B: There is no exemption for short jobs; the significant risks must still be identified and controlled. C: Length is not the test; an assessment that misses the main hazard is inadequate however much it records.

COMMON MISTAKE: Equating a long, neatly completed form with a good assessment, rather than checking whether it deals with the significant risks of the real task.

43. B — A heated acetylene cylinder can decompose internally and may heat up again or burst, so it must be left to the emergency services, who will cool it and monitor it.

A: Venting acetylene creates a flammable atmosphere and does not address possible decomposition inside the cylinder. C: Feeling cool does not show the contents are stable, and returning it to the store puts a potentially unstable cylinder among other gases. D: Moving a heated cylinder risks triggering internal decomposition, and the fire service must be told before anyone handles it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a cylinder safe because the flames are out and it is no longer hot to touch.

44. D — H225 means highly flammable liquid and vapour and H336 means it may cause drowsiness or dizziness, so both fire control and a vapour-appropriate control are needed.

A: Vapour released during use is the ignition hazard, and a dust mask does not protect against solvent vapour. B: A lowered heater is still an ignition source, and ventilation and suitable respiratory protection are still needed for the vapour. C: H336 signals a narcotic effect on the nervous system, which can impair judgement and is a real health risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading only the pictogram and missing that the hazard statements describe separate fire and health risks needing separate controls.

45. A — A prescribed medicine is not misuse, but its effect on safety-critical work must be assessed confidentially by a medical professional and duties adjusted if needed.

B: The prescriber may not know the work, and a legal medicine can still impair someone doing safety-critical tasks. C: Sharing private medical information is inappropriate, and informal watching does not remove an impaired worker from safety-critical work. D: A policy should distinguish prescribed medication from misuse, and automatic dismissal skips the fitness assessment the situation calls for.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a legally prescribed medicine is automatically safe to work on, or that a positive result automatically means misconduct.

46. A — Face shapes suit different masks differently, so a fit

test only validates the make, model and size tested, and a user seal check is still needed each time the mask is put on.

B: The class describes filter efficiency, not how well the mask seals on a given face. C: Wearers cannot reliably detect a poor seal by feel, so everyone using the new mask needs testing. D: Being clean-shaven helps but does not guarantee fit, as mask shape and size also determine the seal.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a passed fit test as a personal qualification rather than a check on one particular make, model and size of mask.

47. C — A poorly fitted harness can let the wearer slip out, injure them in a fall, or load the wrong attachment point, so it must be properly adjusted and checked before work.

A: The harness carries the load of the arrested fall, so its fit matters greatly for safety. B: Loose straps indicate a need for adjustment, and changing size does not by itself set the strap tension or attachment position. D: The chest strap and attachment position both affect how the body is held, so they must be correct as well.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the lanyard as the safety device and the harness as a vest that only needs to be worn, not fitted.

48. B — Preventing items falling by tethering and containing them, and keeping people away from the area where anything might still land, deals with both the cause and the consequence.

A: Toe boards stop rolling items but not tools dropped or knocked over the edge during hand-overs. C: A hard hat is the last line of defence and does not prevent heavy tools falling from 6 m or protect against serious injury. D: A shouted warning is unreliable and gives too little time for anyone to avoid an object falling from height.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on warnings and hard hats beneath overhead work, instead of stopping items falling and keeping people out of the drop zone.

49. D — Excavation must be controlled so that adjacent structures and the sides do not collapse, and fresh cracking with soil movement is a warning that needs competent assessment and support first.

A: Battering may help the face but does not show the adjacent wall is stable and needs a competent assessment first. B: A new diagonal crack during excavation may indicate movement, and sealing it ignores the structural and collapse risk. C: Reducing numbers does not remove the risk of collapse and a worker is still exposed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Regarding a new crack in a neighbouring structure as a cosmetic matter instead of evidence of movement caused by the digging.

50. C — A rear-biased load reduces nose weight, making the trailer unstable and prone to snaking, so the load must be repositioned to give correct downward weight on the hitch.

A: Moving the load back is the opposite of the fix, as the trailer is lifting at the hitch because there is too little nose weight. B: Tight chains hold the machine but do not correct a rear-biased load causing low nose weight. D: Higher speed makes snaking worse and does nothing to restore nose weight.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing a loading position for convenience and ignoring how the weight distribution affects towing stability.

PRACTICE TEST 13

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. On Monday an overheated charger starts a small cabin fire, put out with an extinguisher, and work resumes within the hour. On Wednesday an electrical fire destroys the site distribution unit and stops all work for three days. Nobody is hurt either time. Which reporting position is correct?

☐ **A)** Both fires are reportable because any fire at a place of work must be notified to the enforcing authority, whether or not work was stopped or the premises were damaged

☐ **B)** Wednesday's fire is reportable only if the fire and rescue service attended, because attendance by the brigade is what turns an ordinary fire into a dangerous occurrence

☐ **C)** Wednesday's fire is a reportable dangerous occurrence because normal work stopped for over 24 hours, while Monday's is not, though both deserve internal investigation

☐ **D)** Neither fire is reportable because a dangerous occurrence needs someone injured, and both fires were brought under control on site by the workforce without any outside help

2. A maintenance electrician is sent to swap a light fitting in a busy school corridor, a fifteen-minute job. The manager says risk assessments are for tasks lasting over a day and tells him to just be careful. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** A full new site-specific assessment has to be written from scratch for every job, because a generic assessment cannot cover any task in a public building

☐ **B)** No minimum duration applies, so the task must be assessed before starting, though a generic assessment for this routine job can serve if checked against the real corridor

☐ **C)** The assessment can wait until the job is finished, as the work is too brief to plan beforehand and the hazards are best identified by actually doing it

☐ **D)** Short tasks are exempt, because the duty applies to work programmes rather than individual jobs, and the electrician's own competence is the control needed for a quick fix

3. While refilling a hot petrol generator that is still running, a labourer spills about a litre onto the slab. A colleague is smoking five metres away and the liquid is creeping towards a drain. What should happen first?

☐ **A)** Wash the petrol into the drain with plenty of water, because it floats on water and will dilute and drift away harmlessly in the system

☐ **B)** Stop the engine and move people and ignition sources clear, then contain the spill with absorbent material and dispose of the contaminated waste safely

☐ **C)** Leave it to evaporate in the open air, since petrol disperses quickly outdoors, and restart the generator once the slab surface looks dry again

☐ **D)** Wipe the spill up quickly with rags while the generator keeps running, because the draught from the engine fan disperses the petrol vapour harmlessly

4. A scaffolder falls about 1.5 metres from a low platform onto his back and head. He stands up, says he is fine and asks the first aider if he can drive home early. His speech seems normal. What should the first aider do?

☐ **A)** Let him rest in the cabin and check on him hourly, advising hospital only if he vomits or becomes drowsy, since he seems well

☐ **B)** Give him a cold compress and light duties for the rest of the day, because a first aider's role is limited to treating visible wounds

☐ **C)** Treat the fall and head strike as potentially serious, call 999, and stay with him checking his responses until help arrives

☐ **D)** Record it in the accident book and let a colleague drive him home, where a family member can keep an eye on him overnight

5. A contractor will dismantle a 1950s steel gantry whose old red-oxide paint is thought to contain lead. The foreman plans to cut the members with oxy-propane torches while everyone wears FFP3 masks. Which advice best controls the lead risk?

☐ **A)** Keep the torches but soak the paint thoroughly with water before cutting, since wet paint cannot release any lead into the air as fume at all

☐ **B)** Avoid hot cutting by unbolting or cold mechanical cutting, because heating leaded paint creates fume, with the FFP3 masks as back-up

☐ **C)** Burn the paint off each cut line with a blowlamp first, so that the steel can then be torch-cut cleanly and without any leaded coating left behind

☐ **D)** Carry on with torches and FFP3 masks, and add blood tests for the gang, since respirators and health checks together control lead adequately

6. A road crew breaks out concrete with a petrol breaker for most of Monday, then does quiet kerb-setting from Tuesday to Friday. The adviser wants to rate their noise as a weekly average instead of daily. Which statement about this approach is correct?

☐ **A)** It is not allowed, because the regulations require daily exposure to be assessed in every case and a weekly figure cannot be used for any of the stated values

☐ **B)** It is allowed as exposure varies markedly by day, the weekly figure meets the same action values, and peak values still apply to single events

☐ **C)** It is allowed, and the weekly average also replaces the peak sound pressure values, so a very loud single bang can be ignored if the week averages low

☐ **D)** It is allowed for the lower action value but not for the upper action value or exposure limit value, which must be judged on the loudest day

7. Two installers will fit solar panels on a south-facing slope of a two-storey house, eaves at 6 metres, over three days. The firm proposes harnesses clipped to ridge anchors with no scaffold, and carrying the panels up by hand. What is the best plan?

☐ **A)** Accept the harnesses and ridge anchors, as trained installers clipped on throughout are equally protected, provided the anchors are inspected before each use

☐ **B)** Fit the scaffold to the eaves but allow installers to carry panels along the slope by hand, because edge protection removes any real concern about wind

☐ **C)** Erect a scaffold with edge protection at the eaves, move panels mechanically instead of carrying them, and stop lifting in wind that could catch them

☐ **D)** Use only a single guardrail on gutter brackets, since a pitched roof below 45 degrees does not need full edge protection for installers working on it



8. Look at the scene. The carpenters say every truss is already nailed securely to the wall plate. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The trusses stand without proper temporary bracing, and the carpenters work from the chords with no deck or fall protection

☐ **B)** The scaffold lacks a toe board along the eaves, which is the main fault because the trusses themselves are already fixed and therefore stable enough

☐ **C)** No roofing felt or tile battens have been fixed yet, so the trusses are exposed to the weather and should be covered before any work continues

☐ **D)** The carpenters are not wearing harnesses, and clipping onto the trusses would solve the fall risk since the roof structure is already fixed in place

9. On a winter afternoon the light fails while a crew lays pipe in a 1.4 metre supported trench. The foreman proposes head torches only, plus a portable floodlight on a long cable laid along the trench floor. What is the best arrangement?

☐ **A)** Fix guarded lighting at the trench edge and route cables overhead or clear of the floor, so the work area is lit and untangled

☐ **B)** Leave the cable on the floor but tape it down along the pipe run, since a taped cable cannot be tripped over or crushed easily

☐ **C)** Position the excavator so its work lights shine into the

trench, since machine lights are strong and can substitute for proper site lighting

☐ **D)** Rely on head torches alone, because each worker lights the exact spot he is working on and a shared floodlight is not needed

10. A fitter must replace worn bucket teeth on an excavator. The operator raises the bucket to waist height, switches off, and says the hydraulics will hold it up. The fitter plans to kneel underneath to work. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Engage the hydraulic lock and wedge a chock under the bucket lip, because two methods together make the support reliable

☐ **B)** Let the operator stay in the seat with the engine running so that he can lower the bucket quickly if it starts to sink while the fitter works

☐ **C)** Support the bucket on a stack of timber sleepers placed beneath it, since stacked timber is strong enough to take its weight if the hydraulics fail

☐ **D)** Rest the bucket on the ground, or if it must stay raised, fit a rated mechanical support, with the machine isolated and its key held by the fitter

11. A building firm has six employees, two of them part-time, plus three self-employed bricklayers. The owner keeps his safety arrangements in his head and says risks are covered in verbal morning chats. Which statement best describes his legal position?

☐ **A)** He must write the policy down, tell employees about it and record significant risk assessment findings, because he has five or more employees

☐ **B)** He must write the policy down, but need only show it to an HSE inspector on request, as the daily talks already inform his employees

☐ **C)** He may rely on verbal chats until he employs twenty or more people, since smaller firms are expected to write policies only when an inspector asks

☐ **D)** He must record the risk assessments, but the policy is optional because the morning chats already set out who does what and when

12. While clearing bracken for a ground investigation, a surveyor finds a tick attached to his calf. A colleague suggests burning it off with a lighter. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Squeeze the body and pull it off quickly, then ignore the bite unless it stays red, hot and itchy for more than a few days afterwards

☐ **B)** Burn it or smear it with petroleum jelly to make it drop off, then keep an eye on the bite for about a week and no longer

☐ **C)** Leave it until it falls off after feeding, because pulling it out risks leaving the mouthparts behind and causing a worse infection

☐ **D)** Remove it with fine tweezers or a tick tool close to the skin, clean the bite and watch for a rash or flu-like illness for three months

13. A joinery firm sends operatives who machine resin-bonded board for annual lung checks under its COSHH health surveillance. When a worker leaves after two years, the office shreds his file, saying records only matter while someone is employed. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** The file must be kept for six years after he leaves, matching the normal period for general business records and tax papers

☐ **B)** Three years is enough, as with accident book entries, because any later claim or enforcement action would fall outside that whole period

☐ **C)** The employer should give him the only copy on leaving and then has no further duty, because the file is his own personal property

☐ **D)** The record, or a copy, must be kept for at least 40 years from its last entry, as illness from exposure can appear long after he leaves



14. Look at the fencing operative drilling post holes with the petrol auger. The supervisor says he is properly equipped for the

task. Which problem with his clothing creates the most serious risk of injury?

☐ **A)** His helmet has no peak or neck cover, so falling soil thrown up by the auger could strike the back of his neck

☐ **B)** He wears no dust mask, so airborne soil dust from drilling in damp ground is the greatest threat to his health on this job

☐ **C)** Loose items such as the dangling scarf end and flapping open jacket can snag on the rotating auger and drag him into it

☐ **D)** His thick leather gloves reduce his feel and grip on the handles, so the machine could twist out of his hands when it snags

15. A traffic crew will work at night beside a 50 mph single carriageway behind a cone taper. The manager issues the cheapest Class 1 hi-vis waistcoats, saying the cones already give protection. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Keep the Class 1 waistcoats, as their retroreflective bands show up in headlights, provided the cones are positioned accurately by trained staff

☐ **B)** Use Class 3 only for daytime work, since at night the vehicle headlights make the garment class less important than the cone spacing

☐ **C)** Supply the highest class, with the largest fluorescent and retroreflective areas, for fast night traffic, and treat it as an extra layer beside the cones

☐ **D)** Choose Class 2 garments because the class number only describes fabric strength, and any fluorescent colour is equally visible at night

16. A joiner collects a leaning ladder from the site store on Monday. A tag shows a recorded detailed inspection last month, and he says it needs nothing further until the next one. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** He need only check the feet, since the monthly inspection already covers the stiles and rungs and the ladder will be tied

☐ **B)** He must have it inspected and recorded every seven days like all site ladders, so the monthly tag does not meet the requirement

☐ **C)** The tag is enough, as pre-use checks are only needed for ladders that have been left outdoors overnight or stored in poor conditions

☐ **D)** He should still check it before use each working day, because a recorded periodic inspection does not replace a look at feet, stiles and rungs

17. Gusts are rising as two roofers carry 3 m profiled steel sheets along a flat roof with guardrails fitted, both clipped to a line. A sheet lifts and swings one man off balance. The supervisor says the harnesses make it safe. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Stop carrying sheets until the wind eases, since weather must not endanger safety at height, and plan handling to limit exposed sheets

☐ **B)** Keep carrying along the centre of the roof, away from the edge, because wind affects only people working close to the roof edge

☐ **C)** Carry on until an anemometer reads a set speed, since weather limits apply only above a figure that the law fixes for every roof

☐ **D)** Carry on but add a third person to steady each sheet, since the harnesses and guardrails already control the fall risk adequately for everyone

18. A 14-tonne excavator is to lift a 1.2-tonne concrete pipe with a chain hooked over the bucket teeth. The operator says the pipe is well inside the cab load chart at that reach and, as it is a one-off, needs no special arrangements. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Proceed because a thorough examination is needed only for machines lifting regularly, and the earthmoving maintenance regime covers a one-off lift

☐ **B)** Use a rated lifting point, count the bucket and hitch weight in the load on the chart, and have the machine thoroughly examined for lifting

☐ **C)** Let the slinger hook on while the operator keeps the boom moving to save time, as long as the load is under the chart value

☐ **D)** Hook the chain on the teeth if the pipe weight is under the chart figure, because only the pipe counts and the bucket is part of the machine

19. Workers park private cars along the haul road beside the gate, and a single 10 mph sign at the entrance is the only speed control. Loaded dumpers brake hard to avoid the parked cars. What is the best improvement?

☐ **A)** Lower the limit to 5 mph at the gate and tell drivers at induction, since induction is a stronger control than anything built into the site

☐ **B)** Provide a marked parking area clear of plant routes, and back the limit with repeated signs and physical measures like chicanes

☐ **C)** Keep the parking where it is but paint lines to mark the car spaces, since the 10 mph sign already controls dumper speeds sufficiently

☐ **D)** Ask the dumper drivers to sound their horns on approach, so that parked car owners know to keep clear of the moving machines

20. Clearing scrub for a new access road, an operator finds large holes with fresh spoil, flattened bedding and worn paths on a bank, which look like a badger sett. The manager proposes starting near it at dawn, when the animals should be asleep. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Tell the local planning authority and then carry on, because that notification alone gives the contractor permission to work close to the sett

☐ **B)** Block the holes in the evening once the badgers have gone out to feed, since a sett with no animals inside has no legal protection

☐ **C)** Stop work near the bank, get an ecologist to assess it, and obtain a Natural England licence before work that could disturb the sett

☐ **D)** Proceed as long as no badger is seen or harmed, because the offences cover only injuring or killing the animals themselves

21. A contractor seals a room in polythene sheeting to stop dust reaching a live corridor, leaving one taped flap as the exit. The task's risk assessment was written before the enclosure was planned and is unchanged. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Review the assessment, as the enclosure may add risks such as restricted escape, poor light and heat build-up, then amend the controls and brief the gang

☐ **B)** Leave the assessment as written, because sheeting is a control measure in its own right and cannot raise the level of risk for the gang inside the room

☐ **C)** Ask the gang to report any problems at the end of each shift, since they know the task best and can judge the new risks for themselves

☐ **D)** Record the enclosure as a note on the method statement and review the assessment after an incident, since reviews are only triggered by harm

22. Cordless tool batteries charge overnight on a foam mattress in a cabin beside the stair. At 05:30 one pack is swelling, hissing and smoking as the gang arrive. A labourer offers to carry it outside by hand. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Raise the alarm, evacuate and call 999 without touching the pack, then charge packs supervised, on hard surfaces and clear of escape routes

☐ **B)** Unplug the charger, cover the pack with a fire blanket and let it cool in the cabin while work starts, as removing power ends the danger

☐ **C)** Carry it outside wearing heavy gloves and drop it on bare ground well away from the cabin, because moving a hot pack removes the fire risk

☐ **D)** Move the other charging packs to a different room and carry on, because only the one swollen pack is faulty and the rest can charge overnight

23. To boost cleaning power, an operative pours a bleach-based mould remover into a bucket of acidic brick cleaner in a small tiled WC. Within a minute he is coughing, with stinging eyes. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Tip the mixture down the WC and flush it repeatedly, then return to the task once the smell has gone, as the drain removes the hazard

☐ **B)** Finish the rinse quickly with the door open, because the irritation is mild and the gas will clear within a few minutes of ventilation in the room

☐ **C)** Open the window, pour in plenty of water to dilute the mixture and carry on once the coughing has eased, wearing a paper dust mask for the rinse

☐ **D)** Get out into fresh air at once, keep others away, and have the products and COSHH assessment checked before anyone uses them again

24. For several weeks an electrician has soldered with rosin-cored solder in a small plant room. He now wheezes and coughs at

night, but thinks it is a cold. He borrows a colleague's inhaler and keeps working as before. What should happen?

☐ **A)** He should tell his employer and see a doctor, mentioning the soldering, so the fume exposure is reviewed and the controls are improved

☐ **B)** He should wait a few weeks to see whether the cough clears, as reporting is only worthwhile once a doctor has confirmed a diagnosis

☐ **C)** He should keep using the inhaler and monitor the cough himself, since symptoms that begin at night cannot be caused by the work done by day

☐ **D)** He should change to a stronger disposable mask and carry on, because a better mask removes the need to report symptoms to anyone else

25. Five stock handlers will carry boxes up a leaning ladder to a new mezzanine deck all day for three weeks. The supervisor says ladders are lawful for access and that tying the top makes the arrangement acceptable. Which view is correct?

☐ **A)** Carrying loads in a rucksack with three points of contact makes the ladder acceptable, so a toolbox talk is all the change that is needed here

☐ **B)** Constant loaded climbing is not low-risk, short-duration use, so a temporary stair with handrails is needed and materials should be hoisted

☐ **C)** Swapping the leaning ladder for a large stepladder pushed against the deck edge is the answer, as stepladders suit heavy daily traffic

☐ **D)** A ladder suits any access once it is tied at the top and footed at the base, because securing it makes it suitable whatever the volume or loads



26. Look at the scene. The joiner says the platform is wide, level and standing on a clean floor, so it is as safe as anything he has used. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The trestles are too far apart, so the boards will bend, and spacing them closer would make the arrangement fully safe for this kind of work

☐ **B)** The stepladder is not tied to anything, so lashing its stiles to a trestle leg would be enough to make the set-up acceptable for the work

☐ **C)** The platform has no guardrails, so fitting a top rail and toe boards would fix the problem, whatever else is standing on the boards

☐ **D)** A stepladder stands on the trestle platform for extra height, making an unstable stack with a longer fall, so use a platform of the right height

27. A mini-excavator bucket splits a yellow polyethylene gas main in a footpath trench and gas hisses loudly. Two groundworkers stand 2 m away and a van with its engine running is at the kerb. What should the supervisor do first?

☐ **A)** Get everyone clear and upwind, keep ignition sources away, then ring the National Gas Emergency Service on 0800 111 999 and keep the public out

☐ **B)** Backfill the trench over the split with spoil to smother the leak, then ring the gas emergency number once the hissing has stopped altogether

☐ **C)** Try to squeeze the split pipe shut with the bucket or a clamp to stop the flow, and phone the gas emergency number once that is done properly

☐ **D)** Ring the gas emergency number but keep the crew by the trench so they can tell the engineers exactly how and where the pipe was damaged

28. A 2.2 m deep drainage trench will be dug on a former landfill site whose ground investigation notes ground gas. The supervisor plans normal trench support and a no-smoking rule, with a petrol pump available for water. Which plan is best?

☐ **A)** Treat the trench as a possible confined space, monitor its bottom for flammable gas and oxygen during entry, and keep out ignition sources

☐ **B)** Rely on the open air to disperse any gas, because a trench that is open at the top cannot become a confined space whatever the ground contains

☐ **C)** Issue disposable dust masks to everyone entering, as a mask protects against ground gas and no atmospheric monitoring is then required

☐ **D)** Test the air once at the start of the shift and allow the petrol pump if the reading is clear, since gas conditions do not change during the day

29. A bulk diesel delivery is due at a site's 2,000-litre bunded tank, which is close to a surface-water gully. The driver will fill it while the labourer who ordered it is away, and the tank gauge is known to stick. What is the best arrangement?

☐ **A)** Let the driver fill it alone, because the bund will hold any overflow and a bunded tank means no checks on the delivery are required at all

☐ **B)** Place a drip tray under the nozzle and let the driver fill the tank unattended, as the tray will contain any drips from the nozzle

☐ **C)** Trust the gauge and have the driver stop when it reads full, then record the volume afterwards, since the paperwork shows what was delivered to site

☐ **D)** Check the tank's spare capacity, have a trained person present throughout, and cover the gully with a spill kit to hand before filling

30. A contractor's consent for demolition near homes sets working hours and a noise trigger level at the nearest facade. A boundary monitor now reads above the trigger at 11:00, well inside the permitted hours. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Move the monitor to a quieter position on the site boundary, as a lower reading will show that the work is meeting the limits set

☐ **B)** Wait for a neighbour to complain before acting, since the monitor is only an advisory tool and does not bind the contractor to the conditions

☐ **C)** Investigate the cause, cut the noise with quieter methods, screening or relocated plant, and inform the local authority as the consent requires

☐ **D)** Carry on unchanged, because the work is inside the permitted hours and the hours are the only condition that affects whether noise is acceptable

31. An inspector serves an Improvement Notice on a Monday, giving 28 days to repair a faulty guard. On day 24 the contractor says he will now appeal, and that the notice will pause while the appeal is heard. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** An appeal can be lodged at any point but never suspends an Improvement Notice, so the guard must be repaired by the original deadline either way

☐ **B)** The appeal period is 21 days from service, so he is outside it, the notice is not suspended and the 28-day deadline stands

☐ **C)** Appeals go to the magistrates' court within 28 days of service, and the notice stays suspended until the court has reached a final decision on it

☐ **D)** The appeal period runs for the whole 28 days of the notice, so he can still appeal today and the notice will pause once the appeal has been lodged

32. A labourer is injured by an unguarded saw. HSE tells him it will take no enforcement action. His employer says that without enforcement there was no breach, so no compensation claim can succeed. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A claim can proceed only after HSE has prosecuted or served a notice, because courts award compensation just where a regulator has found a breach of the law

☐ **B)** A claim is possible, but the labourer must prove the breach beyond reasonable doubt, which is the standard HSE would have needed in any prosecution of the firm

☐ **C)** A claim can succeed only if HSE releases its investigation file, since a court cannot properly assess the employer's duties without the regulator's findings

☐ **D)** A civil claim is separate from enforcement, is decided on the balance of probabilities, and is not barred by HSE choosing not to act

33. A risk assessment rates a rare but severe hazard, a pallet fork load falling from height, as 'low' because it has never happened on this firm's sites. The manager signs it off on that basis. Which comment is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The rating is sound because severity matters only when an accident has already taken place on the site in question

☐ **B)** The rating should reflect both likelihood and severity, so a potentially fatal hazard needs controls even where it is rare

☐ **C)** The rating should be raised only if the pallet is heavier

than a tonne, since weight alone decides the level of risk

☐ **D)** The rating is sound because risk depends on past events only, and an event that has never occurred cannot be a significant risk

34. An operative uses a disc cutter measured at 100 dB(A) for 30 minutes a day, and works in quiet conditions the rest of the shift. His supervisor says half an hour is too short to matter. Which view is correct?

☐ **A)** The daily exposure is about 88 dB(A), but protectors become necessary only once it passes the exposure limit value of 87 dB(A) for the whole day

☐ **B)** Only peak sound counts for brief tasks, so one 100 dB(A) reading that is well below the 135 dB peak action value leaves nothing to be done

☐ **C)** Averaged over the shift the half hour falls below 80 dB(A), the lower action value, so no assessment or protection is needed for this short task

☐ **D)** That half hour alone averages about 88 dB(A) over the day, above the upper action value of 85, so noise must be reduced and protectors worn

35. Labourers on a wet, polished concrete floor wear safety boots with steel toecaps and penetration-resistant midsoles, yet two slip in one week. The supervisor says the toecaps and midsoles make the boots suitable. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** An SRA or SRB marking proves grip on every surface, so once the boots carry it the wet floor needs no cleaning, mats or other controls

☐ **B)** Slips come from carelessness rather than footwear, because any boot meeting the toecap and midsole standard has been tested for grip on all common floors

☐ **C)** Toecaps and midsoles protect against impact and sharp objects, not slipping, so the boots need a slip-resistance marking such as SRC

☐ **D)** A stiffer steel midsole increases the contact area with the floor, so it improves grip on smooth wet surfaces and the boots are therefore suitable

36. A scaffold lift has bricks stacked in three tall piles on the boards beside the toe board, and a labourer works on the pavement below. The bricklayer says the toe board holds everything in. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Cover the piles with sheeting so they cannot be knocked, while the labourer carries on working on the pavement below

☐ **B)** Move the piles to the outside edge so they are easy to reach, and warn people below with a sign on the scaffold

☐ **C)** Leave the stacks as they are, because a toe board is designed to hold any material stored at the edge of the platform

☐ **D)** Keep the stacks below the toe board height, use brick guards or netting where higher, and keep people out of the area below

37. An electrician has isolated and locked off a circuit and must replace a socket. He holds a non-contact voltage stick near the cable, hears no beep and starts work. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** A stick is acceptable when its battery light is on, and a plug-in socket tester used afterwards on the same circuit is enough to confirm that it is dead

☐ **B)** Absence of voltage must be proved with an approved voltage indicator, itself checked on a known live source or proving unit before and after

☐ **C)** A multimeter on its bare probes is better than any voltage indicator, because a numeric reading proves the conductors are dead without further checks

☐ **D)** Locking off the isolator proves the circuit dead, so testing is needed only where the isolation was not locked or was done by someone else



38. Look at the scene in the yard. The driver says he is only travelling a short distance to the stack. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The forks are carried high while the truck moves, which affects stability and view, and a pedestrian is walking close behind it on the vehicle route

☐ **B)** The pedestrian is on foot in a vehicle yard without safety glasses, which is the only significant issue, as the truck is being driven correctly

☐ **C)** The truck has no flashing beacon to warn the pedestrian that it is moving, which is the main failing, as forks and positions are acceptable

☐ **D)** The truck is travelling unloaded, which makes it less stable than carrying a load, so it should always carry a pallet while moving

39. A housing site backs onto a play area. At finish, a telehandler is left beside the hoarding with its engine off and brake on, but the forks are raised and the key stays in the cab to save time at 7 am. What is wrong?

☐ **A)** Nothing, because the brake being on and the engine being off make it safe, and leaving the key in lets the early crew move it quickly in an emergency

☐ **B)** The forks need lowering, but the key may stay in the cab if the site gate is locked, since a locked gate keeps all unauthorised people out

☐ **C)** The forks should be lowered and the key removed and secured, so that unauthorised people, including children, cannot start or climb on it

☐ **D)** The key must be removed, but the forks may stay raised, since raised forks are harder for a trespasser or a child to climb onto from the ground

40. For culvert works, an excavator and a diesel generator stand on a stream bank. The foreman plans to refuel both from a bowser on the bank to save carrying, with the generator sitting on bare ground. Which approach best prevents pollution?

☐ **A)** Fill both machines to the brim each morning so that refuelling is not needed during the day, and keep the spill kit in the site office

☐ **B)** Refuel on an impermeable area well back from the stream, stand the generator on a drip tray, and keep a spill kit close by

☐ **C)** Refuel on the bank but lay a plastic sheet beneath the nozzle only, since small drips cannot reach the water once that ground is covered

☐ **D)** Place a floating boom across the stream before work starts and refuel on the bank, because a boom will contain any fuel that is spilled

41. At a 60-person contractor, two trade-union-appointed safety representatives send the director a signed letter asking for a safety committee. He says he will consider it at the year-end review, and that a committee is compulsory only when the HSE orders one. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A written request from at least two safety representatives obliges him to set one up, and it must be in place within three months of the request

☐ **B)** A committee becomes compulsory only when three representatives ask, so he may defer to the annual review and consult the representatives informally until then

☐ **C)** The duty arises only when the trade union itself asks in writing, and the committee must then be established within twelve months of that request

☐ **D)** He may decline if he consults the representatives and records his reasons, because the regulations leave the decision on a committee to his judgement

42. Roofers torch-on bitumen felt to a flat roof while joiners fit foam insulation boards on the deck below in the same bay. Each subcontractor's assessment rates its own work as low risk. Which approach is most appropriate?

☐ **A)** Let the roofers sign a hot work permit and keep an extinguisher on the roof, since the permit also covers the joiners working beneath them

☐ **B)** Treat the overlap as a combined risk, with the principal contractor coordinating through the construction phase plan so the tasks are separated or sequenced

☐ **C)** Raise the score on both assessments by one level and let the work continue, because a higher rating shows that the overlap has been properly considered

☐ **D)** Accept both assessments, since each employer answers only for its own workers and the combined effect lies outside what either firm must consider here

43. A fire alarm sounds on a site with five contractors and several visitors. At the assembly point the marshal finds the visitor sign-in book is in the locked gatehouse, and each firm has only its own list. What is the best arrangement for next time?

☐ **A)** Keep a single up-to-date register of everyone on site, including visitors, that the marshal can carry to the assembly point

☐ **B)** Keep the sign-in book in the gatehouse and let the fire service ask around when they arrive, as they are trained to search

☐ **C)** Rely on the marshals' memory of who arrived that day, because a written register goes out of date within hours

☐ **D)** Leave each firm to count its own people, since the visitors will leave with their hosts and need no separate record

44. A painter pours solvent-based primer from a labelled 5-litre can into an empty water bottle to carry less up the ladder, then leaves the bottle on the cabin table. He says he is the only person using it. What is the main problem?

☐ **A)** The bottle is acceptable while it stays in his sight all day, since an accident needs someone else to find it and he is the only user

☐ **B)** A screw-top drink bottle is acceptable if it is kept in a locked cabin drawer overnight, because secure storage replaces the need for any label

☐ **C)** A drink bottle could be swallowed by mistake and hides the hazard information, so he should use a sturdy container made for it and labelled

☐ **D)** Writing the product name on the bottle with a marker is enough, because the hazard details are in the safety data sheet in the site office

45. A labourer who breaks out slabs most days notices ringing in his ears each evening and has started turning the television up. He says it always fades by morning, so it is nothing to worry about. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Ignore it because the ringing fades overnight, which shows the ears have recovered fully and no lasting harm is being done

☐ **B)** Report it, as ringing after noise is an early warning of damage, and ask for the noise controls and his hearing checks to be reviewed

☐ **C)** Keep working but avoid loud music at home, because noise away from work is the usual cause of ringing in the ears

☐ **D)** Wear thicker ear defenders only on the days it happens, since the hearing loss only builds up on the loudest days of work

46. A fitter cuts out a corroded pipe with an oxy-propane torch that throws molten globules and hot spatter near his face. He is given clear spectacles marked '3 F' and told they are rated for splashes. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Field-of-use numbers rank the protection, so a '9' lens resists everything and the '3' is a weaker version suitable only for lighter spatter

☐ **B)** The '3' covers every liquid hazard including molten metal, and the 'F' shows the lenses are heat resistant, so the spectacles suit the task

☐ **C)** The '3' covers liquid droplets and splashes, not molten metal, so he needs eye protection marked '9' for molten metals and hot solids

☐ **D)** Any eyewear with an impact rating is adequate for hot work, provided the lenses are tinted dark enough to cut the glare from the torch flame



47. Look at the welder fixing the steel stair stringer. Which change to what he is wearing would most reduce the risk of injury from this task?

☐ **A)** Soak the trouser turn-ups with water before each weld so that falling sparks are put out the moment they land on the cloth

☐ **B)** Add a disposable plastic apron over the trousers so that spatter slides off the surface and away from the welder's legs

☐ **C)** Change the leather safety boots for rubber wellingtons, which shed sparks and spatter more easily than leather and are quicker to take off

☐ **D)** Swap the turned-up trousers for flame-resistant ones with no cuffs, worn over the boot tops, so sparks and spatter have nowhere to collect

48. A roofer works from a low platform 3 m above a concrete yard. His 2 m lanyard with energy absorber is clipped to an anchor

at foot level, and the supervisor says the harness makes the job safe. What is the main weakness?

☐ **A)** A 2 m lanyard is too short for fall arrest, so a longer lanyard on the same anchor would let the system stop him before he reached the ground

☐ **B)** The foot-level anchor is satisfactory, but a second lanyard should be fitted because two connections would halve the distance he could fall in a slip

☐ **C)** The harness stops a fall before he reaches the ground once the absorber is fitted, so the only gap is the plan to rescue him afterwards

☐ **D)** The clear space below may be too small, since lanyard, absorber and harness stretch could let him hit the ground, so edge protection is preferable

49. Inside a ventilated, gas-tested tank, a fitter cuts out a corroded pipe with oxy-fuel kit, its cylinders on a trolley beside him. At lunch he shuts the cylinder valves and leaves the torch and hoses coiled inside. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The cylinders may stay inside if they are chained upright to the trolley, since securing them prevents falls and so removes any leak risk

☐ **B)** Closing the cylinder valves is enough, because gas can no longer reach the hose or torch once the supply has been shut off at the source

☐ **C)** Cylinders should stay outside with gas fed in by hose, and the hoses must be removed or disconnected at the cylinder whenever work stops

☐ **D)** The set-up is fine while the gas test is still in date, since a valid test shows that the atmosphere is safe for hot work throughout the whole day

50. An agency driver trained only on a different make of tail lift rides the platform with a loaded roll cage, pulling it back from the vehicle floor toward himself. He says his licence and a manual handling course are enough. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** He needs training on that type of tail lift, and loads should be pushed off the vehicle with him clear of the open platform edge

☐ **B)** His licence and manual handling course cover it, since all tail lifts work in much the same way and extra familiarisation is only a company preference

☐ **C)** Pulling the cage toward himself keeps it under better control, and a platform resting at ground level makes training and edge awareness unnecessary

☐ **D)** Standing on the ground and steadying the cage beneath the lowering platform is safer, because it keeps him off the platform edge altogether and away from the vehicle

Answer Key

1. C — A fire that suspends normal work for more than 24 hours is a dangerous occurrence under RIDDOR even when nobody is injured, whereas a brief fire that stops work for less than that is not reportable.

A: Only a fire that causes the stated disruption, such as suspension of normal work for over 24 hours, falls within the list, so a minor fire is not reportable. B: Attendance by the fire service is not the test, since the length of the work stoppage decides whether the fire is reportable. D: Dangerous occurrences are defined by the event and its potential, so an injury is not required for a report.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that an incident only needs reporting if someone was hurt, or that every fire must be reported whatever its effect.

2. B — A risk assessment must be done for any work that creates risk, however short, and a generic assessment for a routine task is acceptable once it has been checked and adapted to the actual conditions, such as pupils passing beneath.

A: Generic assessments for routine, repeated tasks are acceptable if they are checked and adapted, so rewriting each one from scratch is not a legal requirement. C: An assessment must come before the work so that controls are in place at the start, not after any harm has occurred. D: There is no duration threshold in the duty, and competence does not replace identifying the hazards of the particular location.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a job is too quick or too routine to need any thought about the risks before starting.

3. B — Petrol gives off flammable vapour that is heavier than air and travels to low points such as drains, so ignition sources must be removed before the spill is contained and safely disposed of.

A: Flushing petrol into a drain pollutes and lets flammable vapour collect in the drainage system, so it is neither safe nor lawful. C: Vapour lingers and travels along the ground, and the damp area can still ignite when the engine or a cigarette is nearby. D: A running engine, its hot exhaust and electrics are ignition sources, and rags soaked in petrol add a fire hazard of their own.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a petrol spill outdoors as a mess to tidy rather than a fire hazard whose ignition sources must be removed first.

4. C — A first aider assesses and preserves life rather than diagnosing, and a fall of more than about a metre with a blow to the head warrants an emergency call because serious injury can develop after the casualty appears well.

A: Waiting for symptoms to appear delays assessment of a possibly serious head injury that can worsen without obvious early signs. B: A first aider's role includes recognising when emergency help is needed, and the casualty's own assurance does not make a head strike minor. D: Recording and passing him on does not replace a proper medical assessment, and sending him home leaves any deterioration unwatched by trained people.

COMMON MISTAKE: Accepting a casualty's statement that he is fine after a head knock instead of getting him properly assessed.

5. B — Hot cutting of leaded paint is a high-risk task, so removing the source of fume by using a different method is better than relying on respirators, which remain a supplementary measure.

A: Wetting does not stop heated paint producing fume, and it does not remove the need to avoid hot cutting where an alternative exists. C: Overheating leaded paint with a blowlamp or torch is itself a major source of lead fume, so it creates the hazard it claims to remove. D: Respirators and health surveillance sit at the bottom of the control hierarchy and do not justify choosing a method that produces avoidable fume.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a good respirator makes any method safe, instead of first choosing a method that does not create the fume.

6. B — The Noise Regulations allow weekly exposure to replace daily exposure where it varies markedly, against the same values, but peak sound pressure is judged on individual events and is not averaged away.

A: The regulations expressly permit a weekly personal noise exposure where daily exposure varies markedly from day to day. C: Peak sound pressure values apply to individual events, so a loud impulsive noise is not cancelled by quiet days. D: The weekly option applies to the action values and the exposure limit value alike, not just the lowest.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that averaging over a quiet week cancels out a loud day or a loud single bang.

7. C — Collective protection such as scaffold edge protection comes before personal fall protection, and large panels can act as sails, so wind limits and mechanical handling are part of planning the work.

A: Work at height rules require collective measures that protect everyone to be preferred over personal systems that depend on each person's behaviour. B: Edge protection does not stop a gust catching a panel and pulling the carrier off balance, so handling and wind still need controlling. D: There is no pitch below which edge protection is not needed, and a single gutter-fixed rail would not be strong enough or complete.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing harnesses because they look quicker than scaffold, forgetting that collective protection should come first.

8. A — Trusses must be braced as they are erected to keep them stable, and people working on them need a deck or other fall protection below, because nailing to the wall plate alone does not hold them upright.

B: The trusses are not stable without bracing, so treating the toe board as the main fault misses the collapse and fall risks above it. C: Weather exposure is not the pressing safety issue, since covering comes after the structure is braced and the work at height is protected. D: Unbraced trusses are not a reliable anchor and could fall over with the wearer, so a harness on its own does not solve the problem.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging that a roof frame is safe to work on because each member has been nailed down, rather than because it is braced and protected.

9. A — Excavations need adequate lighting to be inspected and worked in safely, and keeping cables off the floor and away from edges avoids trips and damage to the cable in a confined, wet working space.

B: Cables on the floor of a trench remain a trip and damage hazard, and taping does not protect against being crushed or cut by tools. C: Machine lights are aimed for the operator, shine unevenly, and leave the shaded trench sides and access ladder poorly lit, especially when the machine moves. D: Head torches light only a narrow beam and do not show the trench sides or the access route, and they leave the shared work area poorly lit.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating personal torches or the plant's own lamps as an adequate substitute for planned lighting of the whole work area.

10. D — Hydraulic systems can lose pressure and let a raised bucket drop, so a safe system of work uses the ground or a rated mechanical support and prevents anyone starting the machine.

A: Neither a hydraulic lock nor a small chock is a rated mechanical support, so combining them does not remove the risk of the bucket falling. B: A running machine with a person at the controls adds a risk of unintended movement and cannot react in time to a sudden drop. C: Improvised stacks can shift or crush, and they are not a rated support, so they are not an acceptable safeguard.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting that a switched-off hydraulic system will keep holding a raised attachment while someone works beneath it.

11. A — Employers with five or more employees must have a written health and safety policy that employees are told about, and must record the significant findings of their risk assessments.

B: The policy, and any changes to it, must be brought to the attention of employees and not just held for inspectors. C: The written-policy threshold is five or more employees, so verbal chats alone do not satisfy the law for this firm. D: A written policy is itself a legal requirement at this size, and chats are not a substitute for a recorded statement.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a small firm with good daily communication does not need written arrangements.

12. D — Prompt careful removal reduces the chance of infection, and Lyme disease can show as a spreading rash or flu-like symptoms weeks or even months after a bite, so early medical advice matters.

A: Squeezing the body can push infected contents into the skin, and the Lyme rash is usually neither hot nor itchy. B: Heat and smothering are not recommended, and watching for only a week misses symptoms that can appear up to three months later. C: The longer a tick stays attached the greater the infection risk, so correct early removal is recommended rather than waiting.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a tick bite is only a concern if the bite site itself becomes sore or itchy.

13. D — COSHH requires the employer to keep each health record, or a copy, for at least 40 years from the last entry, because many work-related diseases take decades to develop.

A: Health records have their own much longer retention period, and general business record periods do not apply. B: Three years applies to accident records, but diseases with long latency need the far longer health-record period. C: The employer must keep the record or a copy itself, and handing over the only copy ends the duty to keep it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating health surveillance records like ordinary employment paperwork that can be discarded once someone leaves.

14. C — Clothing, scarves and anything loose near rotating parts can be caught and wound in, so close-fitting, fastened clothing with nothing dangling is needed.

A: Thrown soil is a minor concern and the helmet fits properly, whereas entanglement could cause severe or fatal injury. B: Damp ground in a short task produces little hazardous dust, and long-term dust exposure is a smaller risk than being pulled into a rotating tool. D: Gloves help with grip, vibration and abrasion on this task, and the picture shows no reason they cause the main danger.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking only that the listed PPE is worn and overlooking loose clothing, scarves and drawstrings near rotating machinery.

15. C — Higher classes carry more fluorescent and retroreflective material, which suits high-speed roads and night work, and hi-vis clothing supports rather than replaces physical traffic control.

A: Class 1 has the smallest areas of material and is meant for low-risk settings, not fast traffic at night. B: Retroreflective material works with headlights at night, so the highest class matters most for night work beside fast traffic. D: The class is set by minimum areas of fluorescent and reflective material, not strength, and fluorescent colour alone adds little in darkness.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any hi-vis garment is as good as another, or that cones alone make the choice of garment unimportant.

16. D — Ladders need a pre-use check before each day's use as well as a recorded periodic detailed inspection, because damage can occur at any time between inspections.

A: Stiles, rungs and locks can be damaged between inspections, and tying the top does not make a damaged ladder safe. B: The seven-day inspection applies to ladders forming part of a scaffold and is not a rule for every ladder on site. C: Pre-use checks apply to every ladder before use, wherever and however it was stored.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on a periodic inspection tag instead of checking the ladder yourself before each day's use.

17. A — The Work at Height Regulations require work to proceed only when weather does not jeopardise safety, and a large sheet acts like a sail whatever protects the worker from a fall.

B: Wind acts on a sheet wherever it is carried, and a loss of balance can still cause injury or a fall through the system. C: No single legal wind speed applies to all roofs, so the duty is to judge whether conditions endanger the task. D: Fall protection does not stop a sail-like sheet from knocking people over, and more people increase exposure to the same problem.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that harnesses and edge protection make it acceptable to keep handling large sheets in worsening wind.

18. B — Attachments count towards the load on the chart, the load must hang from a proper lifting point rather than the teeth, and even occasional lifting needs a thorough examination under LOLER.

A: Even occasional lifting by an excavator needs a thorough examination by a competent person. C: The operator must not move the machine or load until the slinger is in a safe position, whatever the weight. D: The bucket and hitch weight must be included in the load, and teeth are not a rated lifting point.

COMMON MISTAKE: Comparing only the weight of the load with the chart and forgetting the bucket, hitch and lifting-point requirements.

19. B — Parking areas should be provided wherever practical, and limits are best supported by repeated signs and physical features that drivers cannot easily ignore.

A: Very low limits tend to be ignored, and instruction alone is weaker than physical features that make speeding difficult. C: A painted line does not move people or cars away from plant routes, and a single sign is a weak speed control. D: Horns warn people but leave the cars and the speed problem in place, so the hazard is not removed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on a single speed sign and driver instructions rather than layout and physical speed control.

20. C — Badgers and their setts are protected, so interfering with a sett without a licence is an offence even if no animal is hurt, and an ecologist must advise first.

A: Telling the council is not a licence, and work that could affect the sett needs a licence from Natural England. B: Setts are protected whether or not animals are inside, and blocking holes without a licence is itself an offence. D: Disturbing, damaging or obstructing a sett is also an offence, even when no animal is injured.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that wildlife law only applies when an animal is actually seen or harmed.

21. A — A control measure can create new hazards, so the assessment must be reviewed when the way a task is set up changes, and the revised controls must reach the people doing the work.

B: Controls can introduce new hazards, and here the enclosure restricts escape, light and ventilation, so assuming it only reduces risk skips the review. C: Waiting for end-of-shift feedback leaves people exposed meanwhile, and the employer, not the workforce, must assess and control the new risks beforehand. D: Assessments must be reviewed when circumstances change, not only after someone has been hurt, and a method statement note does not reassess the new risks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a control measure as automatically safe and forgetting to check what new hazards it brings into the task.

22. A — A venting lithium-ion pack can burst into flame with no warning, so people should leave and call the fire service rather than handle it, and the cause is addressed by changing how charging is arranged.

B: A damaged cell can overheat and ignite without any external power, and leaving it in an occupied cabin keeps people at risk. C: Handling a venting pack puts the carrier within reach of a sudden flare or toxic smoke, and it does nothing about how charging was arranged. D: This ignores the immediate hazard from the smoking pack and leaves the unsafe charging arrangement that allowed the problem unchanged.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a smoking battery pack is safe to pick up and move, or that disconnecting the charger stops it.

23. D — Mixing hypochlorite bleach with an acid releases chlorine gas, so the priority is to get away from the fumes and then fix the cause, which is the product use and the assessment.

A: Disposing of the mixture does not remove the gas already released, and flushing in the same room keeps him breathing the fumes. B: Chlorine irritation can worsen without warning in a small space, and continuing the task keeps the operative exposed to the hazard. C: A dust mask gives no protection against chlorine gas, and stirring or diluting the mixture in a small room keeps releasing fumes.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that two cleaning products will work better when combined, rather than checking labels and safety data sheets before mixing.

24. A — Rosin flux fume can cause occupational asthma, which may show hours after exposure, so early reporting lets the employer reassess controls under COSHH before permanent lung damage develops.

B: Early reporting is what allows exposure to be reduced, and waiting for a confirmed diagnosis risks him becoming permanently sensitised. C: Asthma symptoms from a workplace sensitiser can appear several hours after exposure, including at night, and masking them delays action. D: A mask is not a substitute for assessing exposure, and once sensitised he may react to very low levels that a mask does not stop.

COMMON MISTAKE: Writing off a work-related cough or wheeze as a cold because it appears at night instead of during the shift.

25. B — A ladder is justified only where the assessment shows low risk and short use, or unalterable site features, so frequent loaded access to a deck calls for a stair with materials lifted separately.

A: Good technique helps, but frequent loaded climbing remains a higher risk than a stair, and training does not replace more suitable equipment. C: Stepladders are for short, light tasks and are not intended as access to another level, so this is a less suitable choice, not a safer one. D: Securing a ladder does not make it suitable for sustained use or for people carrying loads, and the assessment must justify the choice of equipment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a ladder as acceptable access for any job once it is tied, however many people use it or what they carry.

26. D — Placing a ladder on a working platform adds height and instability to a set-up designed for a fixed level, so the platform should be built or chosen to reach the work.

A: The boards are supported at a sensible spacing and the main fault is the ladder stacked on top, which closer trestles would not correct. B: Tying a ladder to a trestle does not stabilise the stack, since the base itself can still move and the extra height remains. C: At about one metre high guardrails are not the main control here, and rails would not stop a fall from the ladder standing above the platform.

COMMON MISTAKE: Stacking one piece of access equipment on another to reach a bit higher instead of choosing equipment of the correct height.

27. A — Escaping gas can ignite from any spark, so people are moved away and ignition sources kept out of the area while the gas emergency service is called to make the pipe safe.

B: Burying the leak allows gas to travel through the ground into nearby buildings and drains, and it leaves people at the scene. C: Working at a leaking pipe leaves people close to the gas and risks sparks or further damage, and only the gas emergency engineers should attempt to stop the flow. D: Keeping people next to an escape

puts them at risk of fire or explosion, and details can be given from a safe distance.

COMMON MISTAKE: Staying near a gas leak to try to stop it, instead of moving everyone away and calling the gas emergency service.

28. A — Gases such as methane and carbon dioxide collect in deep excavations on landfill, so monitoring, entry controls and exclusion of ignition sources are needed alongside normal trench support.

B: Heavier gases can pool at the bottom of a trench even though it is open to the sky, so being open at the top does not prevent a dangerous atmosphere. C: A dust mask does not filter gas or replace oxygen, so it gives no protection against methane or carbon dioxide. D: Ground gas can vary with weather and pressure and may appear later, so a single start-of-shift reading does not protect people for the whole shift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming an open-topped trench cannot hold a harmful atmosphere because the sky is above it.

29. D — Overfilling and hose leaks are common causes of pollution, so the delivery should be matched to the capacity, supervised, and protected by drain covers and a spill kit.

A: A bund is a last line of defence, and overfilling or hose spills can still run over its edge or reach the gully before anyone responds. B: A drip tray catches only small drips and does not deal with overfilling, and nobody is present to raise the alarm quickly. C: The gauge is known to stick, so it cannot be relied on, and a record made afterwards will not prevent an overfill.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a bunded tank makes oil deliveries safe without anyone checking capacity or watching the filling.

30. C — Consent conditions usually cover noise levels as well as hours, so a reading above the trigger needs prompt investigation, control measures and notification, even within permitted times.

A: Relocating the monitor to get a better reading misrepresents the impact on neighbours and does nothing to reduce the actual noise. B: Monitoring against agreed triggers exists so that problems are found early, and the conditions bind the contractor without a complaint. D: Hours are only one condition, and a level above the agreed trigger signals that the noise controls have failed whatever time it is.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that working within permitted hours means the noise is acceptable, regardless of the measured level.

31. B — An appeal against an Improvement Notice must be lodged with the employment tribunal within 21 days of service, and only a valid appeal suspends the notice, so the compliance date stands.

A: A valid and timely appeal does suspend an Improvement Notice until it is heard or withdrawn, unlike a Prohibition Notice. C: Appeals against notices go to the employment tribunal, and the time limit is 21 days rather than 28. D: The appeal window is 21 days from service and is shorter than the compliance period, so day 24 is too late.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming the appeal window is the same length as the time given to put the problem right.

32. D — Enforcement and civil compensation are independent routes, and a claimant only has to show negligence or breach of duty is more likely than not, whatever HSE decided.

A: A civil court makes its own findings, and no prosecution or notice is needed before a compensation claim. B: Beyond reasonable doubt is the criminal standard, whereas civil claims are decided on the balance of probabilities. C: The court decides the case on the evidence presented, and a claimant does not depend on an HSE file to bring a claim.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that if the regulator takes no action then the employer cannot be held responsible to the injured person.

33. B — Risk combines how likely harm is with how severe it could be, and a lack of past incidents does not make a potentially fatal outcome low risk.

A: Severity must be considered in advance, not after harm has occurred. C: Many factors, not one weight, decide the risk. D: Absence of past accidents does not remove the possibility of a serious one.

COMMON MISTAKE: Rating a severe hazard as low simply because nothing has gone wrong so far.

34. D — Every 3 dB doubles the noise energy, so 30 minutes at 100 dB(A) equals roughly 88 dB(A) for a full day, which is over the upper action value of 85 dB(A).

A: Protectors must be provided at the upper action value of 85 dB(A), and the 87 dB(A) limit already assumes the protectors are being worn. B: Daily or weekly average exposure and peak sound pressure are separate tests, and passing the peak value does not clear the average. C: Daily exposure is energy-weighted, so a short burst of

very loud noise raises the average far more than the simple arithmetic suggests.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a short noisy task is harmless because most of the day is quiet.

35. C — Slip resistance depends on sole compound and tread, tested separately with SRA, SRB or SRC markings, so toe and midsole protection says nothing about grip on wet polished concrete.

A: The test surfaces do not represent every floor, so footwear choice supports but does not replace floor management. B: Safety footwear standards test toe and sole protection, while slip resistance is tested and marked separately and floor conditions differ. D: A midsole stops sharp objects penetrating the sole and does nothing for friction between sole and floor.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing boots by their toe and sole protection alone without checking grip for the floor they will be used on.

36. D — Toe boards stop only low items from rolling off, so materials need to be limited in height, guarded where higher and the area beneath controlled.

A: Sheeting does not stop bricks falling and leaves people exposed below. B: Stacking at the edge increases the chance of bricks falling and a sign does not prevent harm. C: A toe board only stops low items, not tall stacks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a toe board makes it safe to stack tall piles of material at a platform edge.

37. B — A tester can fail without warning, so it must be shown to work immediately before and after use, and non-contact sticks are not suitable for proving a circuit dead.

A: A lit battery indicator does not show the stick can detect voltage, and a socket tester is not a means of proving a circuit dead. C: An unproved multimeter with unshrouded probes can fail or give a false zero and is itself a shock and short-circuit hazard. D: Isolation and proving dead are separate steps, and the test is still needed after a lock is applied.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a silent tester or a lock-off without proving the tester itself works.

38. A — Forks should travel low, as raising them lifts the centre of gravity and blocks the driver's view, and a pedestrian sharing the route directly behind a moving truck is at risk of being struck.

B: Eye protection is not the main danger shown, as the forks are raised and the pedestrian is in the truck's path. C: The truck does have a beacon, and a beacon would not remove the pedestrian from the route or lower the forks. D: An empty truck is not made safer by adding a load, and the real issue is the raised forks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a short trip does not need forks lowered or pedestrians separated from the truck.

39. C — Unattended plant should be left with brakes on, engine off, equipment lowered and keys removed and secured, which stops unauthorised use and removes a fall and crush hazard.

A: Leaving the key in and the forks raised allows unauthorised use and climbing, and an early start is not a reason to relax security. B: Gates and hoardings can be climbed or breached, so the key still needs to be secured as a second barrier. D: Raised forks can fall or be climbed, and attachments should be lowered to the ground to remove stored energy and access.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a locked gate, a brake and an off engine are enough to secure plant overnight.

40. B — Spills are best prevented by keeping fuel handling away from water, putting secondary containment under static plant and having a spill kit ready, rather than relying on cleaning up afterwards.

A: Overfilling increases spill risk and a spill kit kept far from the work cannot be used quickly enough. C: A sheet under the nozzle does not contain larger spills or leaks from the generator, and the bank is too close to the stream. D: A boom is a last line of defence that does not catch all fuel, so it cannot replace preventing spills near the water.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating fuel handling beside a watercourse as acceptable provided that a clean-up can follow any spill.

41. A — Under the Safety Representatives and Safety Committees Regulations 1977, a written request from two or more safety representatives requires the employer to establish a committee no later than three months after the request.

B: The trigger is a written request from two representatives, and the law sets a three-month limit that a review date cannot override. C: The request comes from at least two safety representatives rather than the union, and the time limit is three months, not twelve. D: Once two safety representatives request one in writing, establishing the committee is a duty and not a matter of employer discretion.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a safety committee is a favour the employer can schedule or refuse, rather than a duty triggered by a written request from two representatives.

42. B — Two activities that are low risk alone can create a

serious fire risk together, so the principal contractor must coordinate the trades and the assessments must reflect the interaction.

A: A permit and extinguisher respond to a fire but do not separate hot work from flammable insulation and the people below it. C: Changing a score is not a control measure, and nothing in the work method or sequence has altered. D: Contractors must cooperate and coordinate because one trade's work creates risks for others, so the interaction cannot be ignored.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that if every subcontractor's own assessment looks acceptable, the combined activity on the same part of the building must be acceptable too.

43. A — A roll call is only reliable if there is one current record of everyone present, kept where it can be taken to the assembly point, so nobody is wrongly assumed to be out.

B: The service needs to know quickly who may be missing, and the book is out of reach. C: Memory is unreliable and a register can be kept current. D: Separate counts miss visitors and anyone whose firm has not recorded them.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming each contractor's own list is enough to account for everyone on a shared site.

44. C — Hazardous substances must stay in suitable containers that identify the contents and hazards, because food or drink containers invite accidental swallowing and mislead anyone who finds them.

A: Containers get left, moved and found by others, and one person's watchfulness is not a control. B: Locked storage does not replace labelling, which matters at the point of use as well as when the substance is stored. D: The container itself must show the hazards so people and emergency responders can see them without finding another document.

COMMON MISTAKE: Decanting a hazardous product into a handy drink bottle because only one person will use it.

45. B — Temporary ringing and muffled hearing after noise show the ears are being harmed, and repeated exposure can cause permanent loss, so the symptoms should trigger a review of controls and health surveillance.

A: Symptoms that fade can still mean cumulative damage that becomes permanent. C: Work noise is the likely cause here and it should be controlled at source. D: Protection is needed whenever exposure is high, not just after symptoms appear.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating ringing ears that clear overnight as a sign of recovery instead of an early warning.

46. C — In EN 166 the field-of-use symbol 3 means liquid droplets or splashes, while 9 means molten metals and hot solids, and the F only shows resistance to low-energy impact.

A: The numbers identify different fields of use and are not a scale, so a higher number is not a stronger version. B: The F marks low-energy impact resistance only and says nothing about heat, and the 3 does not cover molten metal. D: Impact resistance and tint do not give protection from molten metal, which needs the field-of-use symbol 9.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading a lens marking as a general quality rating instead of checking that the symbol matches the actual hazard.

47. D — Turn-ups and open pockets trap sparks and molten spatter against the skin, so welders should wear cuffless flame-resistant trousers that cover the tops of the boots.

A: Wetting clothing is not a control, and damp fabric can cause steam burns and increase the risk of electric shock. B: Plastic melts and sticks to skin when spatter lands on it, and it does nothing about the turn-ups that trap sparks. C: Rubber melts and sticks to the skin when hit by spatter, whereas leather resists it, so wellingtons would make injury worse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking that a welder has a helmet and gauntlets while overlooking turn-ups, pockets and gaps that collect sparks.

48. D — A fall-arrest system needs enough clearance below for the lanyard, the absorber to extend and the harness to stretch, and collective edge protection prevents the fall altogether.

A: A longer lanyard lengthens the fall, which makes it more likely he hits the ground before the system stops him. B: Adding a second lanyard does not shorten the fall distance, which depends on lanyard length, absorber extension and anchor position. C: Rescue planning matters, but the absorber lengthens the fall, so he may hit the ground before the system stops him.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that wearing a harness and lanyard means a fall will always be stopped, without checking the clearance beneath the worker.

49. C — Leaking hoses or torches can enrich the air with oxygen or fill the space with fuel gas, so cylinders stay outside and hoses are taken out or disconnected whenever work is suspended.

A: Chaining prevents toppling but does nothing about leaks, and cylinders should not be taken into the confined space. B: Gas remains

in the hoses and fittings after the valves close, and a leak there can still escape into the confined space. D: A test records conditions only at the moment it was taken, so it cannot protect against a leak that begins afterwards.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a clean gas test at the start of the shift covers hot work equipment left in the space during breaks.

50. A — Operators need training on the specific tail lift they use, and pulling a load back toward oneself on the platform risks the load toppling or the operator stepping off the open edge.

B: Controls and residual hazards differ between tail-lift types, so training specific to the lift in use is expected. C: Pulling a load toward the operator makes it more likely to topple onto him, and a platform edge remains a fall hazard. D: Standing under or beside a moving platform creates a crushing risk, and steadying a load by hand does not control it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a driving licence and general manual handling training qualify someone to use any tail lift.

PRACTICE TEST 14

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A groundworks contractor on a multi-contractor project wants to sublet its drainage package to a firm it has never used. The site manager says the principal contractor's own vetting covers everyone. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Once the package is sublet, the duty to plan and manage that work passes to the new firm, which becomes solely answerable for its own workers

☐ **B)** The principal contractor's induction is sufficient, so the contractor need not give the firm any information about hazards in the drainage package

☐ **C)** Only the client may check competence on a project, so the contractor need only ask the sublet firm for its insurance certificate before it starts work

☐ **D)** The contractor must itself take reasonable steps to confirm the firm's skills, knowledge, experience and capability, and then pass on the information it needs

2. A client invites three contractors to tender for refurbishing a 1960s warehouse. One asks for existing drawings and past survey reports. The client replies that the winner will find any hazards when it arrives, so nothing will be issued before the contract. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The client must give the relevant pre-construction information as soon as practicable to every contractor being considered, so each can price and plan the risks

☐ **B)** The contractor is responsible for discovering hazards on arrival, because a client with no construction experience cannot be expected to hold such information at all

☐ **C)** The client need only issue it to the winning contractor, since unsuccessful tenderers have no part in the project and are owed no duty of care at all

☐ **D)** A short verbal briefing at the start of the work is enough, provided the principal contractor writes down any hazards found in the first week

3. A site beside a river receives an Environment Agency flood warning, meaning flooding is expected, with the river rising and perhaps an hour before the access road floods. A crane is parked and a concrete pour is half finished. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Keep everyone on site above the ground floor of the cabins, since the cabins are raised and the river level will drop again within hours

☐ **B)** Stop work, make safe what can be done quickly, and take everyone by the agreed route to higher ground, leaving plant behind if time runs short

☐ **C)** Finish the pour to avoid wasting concrete, then move the crew out, because a severe flood warning is the point at which sites should properly stop work

☐ **D)** Send the whole crew to move fuel, plant and chemicals to high ground first, then evacuate people once the site has been fully secured

4. A rubbish bin of paper and wrapping smoulders in an open-fronted store. The alarm has been raised and a trained worker takes a suitable extinguisher. The fire is waist height, with a clear exit behind him. How should he use it?

☐ **A)** Stand a few metres back with the exit behind him, sweep the jet across the base of the flames, and withdraw if the fire is not quickly controlled

☐ **B)** Carry on discharging even if the fire grows, because the alarm has been raised and the fire service will arrive to take over from him shortly

☐ **C)** Stand between the fire and the only exit so that it cannot spread, and aim at the flames from above while crouching low to avoid the smoke

☐ **D)** Move in until the flames are within arm's reach so the jet is accurate, aim at the top of the flames, and keep discharging until the extinguisher is empty

5. A flooring crew applies fast-curing methyl methacrylate resin in a below-ground plant room. They shut the doors to keep it warm, run a halogen work lamp and plan to wear dust masks. The

vapour smells strongly. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Remove ignition sources such as the halogen lamp, ventilate with extraction low down, and use suitable respiratory protection if vapour remains

☐ **B)** Swap the dust masks for FFP3 disposable masks, since a higher-grade particle filter will also remove the resin vapour from the air breathed in

☐ **C)** Add a fan heater to speed the cure and shorten exposure, provided it is switched on before the crew begin and left running until the floor sets

☐ **D)** Keep the doors shut and rely on the smell as a warning, because a strong odour tells the crew when the vapour has risen to a harmful level in the room

6. Two plasterers of very different heights carry a 2.4 m board along a corridor, one walking backwards, with no word spoken and a pallet jack parked in the route. The board bends and they nearly drop it. What is the best way to improve the lift?

☐ **A)** Let the taller person take the heavier end and the shorter one steer, because the two will adjust to each other as they walk along the corridor together

☐ **B)** Clear the route, pair similar heights, carry the board on edge facing forward, and have one person give commands to lift, move and lower

☐ **C)** Use the same method but each wear gloves and back support belts, so that any slip is less likely to cause an injury to either of them during the carry

☐ **D)** Lift the board flat at waist height between them with both facing inwards, since this keeps the load close to the body and supports the whole sheet

7. A materials hoist platform carries a notice showing a 500 kg safe working load. A labourer loads two pallets of blocks of 320 kg each, then lays 6 m tubes across the top with one metre sticking out beyond the platform. What is wrong?

☐ **A)** Nothing, as each pallet is under 500 kg and the hoist motor will cope, provided the tubes are laid on top of a pallet and the landing gates are shut

☐ **B)** The 640 kg is acceptable for a short trip with nobody at the landing, as the limit only applies when people are standing below the hoist

☐ **C)** The 640 kg total exceeds the safe working load, and loose tubes projecting past the platform can snag on landings or fall out

☐ **D)** Only the tubes are the issue, since pallets can exceed the notice by a margin if the hoist is serviced regularly and its cable is checked daily by the operator



8. Look at the scene. A painter needs to reach a high soffit. Which feature of the set-up most increases the chance of a serious fall?

☐ **A)** The tower stands on a smooth concrete floor, which cannot hold castors in position even when every brake is firmly applied

☐ **B)** A paint tray and bucket on the platform floor will slide off the edge unless every item is tied to the guardrail with rope

☐ **C)** A second worker stands at the base looking up, so he is likely to be struck by falling tools from the platform above him

☐ **D)** A stepladder is opened on the tower platform, so he works above the guardrails on an unsteady, extended footing

9. A mechanical contractor will replace a pipe section directly beneath the runway of a live overhead travelling crane in a client's factory bay. The crane's power runs along conductor bars on the runway. The client suggests hazard tape and a radio call to the crane driver. Which arrangement is best?

☐ **A)** Rely on a radio call to the driver before each lift and post a banksman in the bay, since the crane can then keep working elsewhere in the bay

☐ **B)** Switch the crane off at its pendant and keep the key with the driver, so that nobody else can start it while the pipe is being replaced

☐ **C)** Agree a permit with the client so the crane is isolated and locked off, parked clear of the work area, with the contractor's own lock on the isolator

☐ **D)** Fence the zone with hazard tape and a sign and have the crane driver promise not to travel over it, as the tape marks a clear exclusion area

10. A public footpath crosses a housing site between the compound and the dig area, and a dumper must cross it about every ten minutes. The manager plans a "plant crossing" sign, a flashing beacon and a banksman who waves pedestrians through. Which option best follows good practice?

☐ **A)** Rely on the sign and stop the dumper only when the driver spots someone, because members of the public have a duty to watch for site traffic

☐ **B)** Leave the path open but fit the dumper with a reversing alarm and an audible horn that sounds whenever it nears the crossing point

☐ **C)** Divert the public along a fenced alternative route agreed with the highway authority, so plant and pedestrians never share a crossing

☐ **D)** Keep the footpath open and add speed limits, a second beacon and a trained banksman who stops the public whenever plant needs to cross

11. A school asks a groundworks firm to host a 15-year-old for a week of work experience. The manager plans to use the site's general risk assessment, place him with the crew breaking out a slab, and tell his teacher the details afterwards. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The school stays responsible for him throughout the placement, so the firm need only give the normal site induction and rules, since he is not on its payroll

☐ **B)** Briefing his teacher at the end of the week is enough, with a parent told only if he is kept on afterwards, because the information duty protects long-term staff

☐ **C)** A competent supervisor may keep him beside the slab-breaking crew, because close supervision lifts the legal limits on work for anyone under school-leaving age

☐ **D)** A specific assessment for a child must be made before he starts, he must be kept off tasks whose risks he cannot recognise, and his parent must be told the risks beforehand

12. Two operatives strip loft insulation in July wearing disposable coveralls and respirators. After 90 minutes one is dizzy and nauseous with a headache, pale and clammy with heavy sweating, but he answers questions clearly. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Let him rest in the shaded van for ten minutes with the coveralls still on, then put him back to work since a short break should reset him

☐ **B)** Give him an energy drink and a salt tablet, then let him resume lighter loft work once the nausea settles, keeping the pair on the same schedule

☐ **C)** Wrap him in a blanket in the cabin so that he sweats it out, and ring 999 only if he vomits, changing nothing else if he recovers

☐ **D)** Move him somewhere cool, take off the coveralls, give water and cool his skin, call 999 if he is no better in 30 minutes, then revise work-rest times

13. A first aid box on a 25-person site holds plasters, dressings, a bottle of paracetamol tablets and some out-of-date eyewash. A worker gets dust in his eye. The manager says the tablets are a kindness and the box is checked once a year. What is the better approach?

☐ **A)** Keep tablets out of the kit, check contents regularly and replace anything used or out of date, with sterile eyewash available

☐ **B)** Empty the box and rely on the nearest pharmacy, as a site below 50 people does not need any first aid kit

☐ **C)** Keep the box as it is because dust in the eye needs only tap water, so expired eyewash is irrelevant to the site



14. Look at the labourer in the foreground, working beneath an overhead hoist on a cold morning. The foreman says he is wearing everything the site rules require. What is the most significant problem, and the right fix?

☐ **A)** His hi-vis vest is worn over a padded coat, so it should go

under the coat to stop the coat from covering its reflective bands

☐ **B)** His helmet colour is wrong for his trade, so it should be swapped for the issued colour so that other workers can identify his role

☐ **C)** His gloves look too thin for handling pallets of blocks, so he should swap them for cut-resistant gloves before moving any more material today

☐ **D)** His helmet sits on a woolly hat with the strap loose, so swap the hat for a helmet liner and refit the helmet snugly

15. A fitter must steady a pipe flange at about 250 degrees C while a colleague fits a clip, taking roughly 20 seconds. The store holds nitrile gloves, knitted cut-resistant EN 388 gloves, and EN 407 gloves rated contact heat level 2 and level 4. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Use tongs or a clamp to keep hands clear, and if gloves are needed choose contact heat level 3 or higher, as ratings prove just 15 seconds

☐ **B)** Wear the level 2 heat gloves, because 250 degrees C is exactly their rated temperature and the clip fitting is short enough to stay within that limit

☐ **C)** Wear two pairs of thin nitrile gloves, because layers give the same insulation as one thermal glove and keep enough feel to fit the clip

☐ **D)** Wear the knitted gloves with the highest cut level, because a top EN 388 score shows strong resistance to heat as well as to sharp edges and abrasion

16. A scaffolder hands over the lower two lifts of a facade scaffold with a green tag at the base, then leaves for the weekend. The top lift has boards laid but no guardrails or toe boards. Bricklayers want to start on it on Saturday. What is correct?

☐ **A)** They may fit the missing guardrails and toe boards themselves, because the scaffolder's job is done once the boards are laid and a bricklayer can finish it

☐ **B)** The top lift is not handed over, so it must be barred off with a barrier and prohibition sign and used only once the scaffolder completes it and it is inspected

☐ **C)** The green tag at the base covers the whole scaffold, so they may use the top lift if they clip their lanyards to the standards while the rails are missing

☐ **D)** A supervisor can accept the whole scaffold by signing the handover form for the lower lifts, since that signature transfers responsibility for the rest to the user

17. Two operatives will dismantle a brick chimney stack on a pitched roof with eaves 7 m up. The foreman proposes harnesses clipped to the stack itself, with crawling boards underfoot, saying solid brick makes a good anchor. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Accept the plan once the stack is checked for loose mortar, because sound brickwork is a reliable anchor and a harness is enough for a job lasting only two days

☐ **B)** Rig a safety net below the eaves instead of harnesses, since a net removes the need for any platform or edge protection at the stack

☐ **C)** Add a second anchor by looping a line round the ridge tiles, since two attachment points share the load if the stack gives way during the work itself

☐ **D)** Provide a scaffold platform with edge protection around the stack, because collective protection comes first and a stack being dismantled cannot be trusted as an anchor

18. A high-lift skip dumper must tip into a feed hopper. The driver, standing on a gentle cross-fall, raises the skip and edges forward the last metre to line up, saying speed saves time. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Raise the skip only halfway while moving, because stability falls only once the skip is fully vertical, so a half-raised skip stays within the safe limits

☐ **B)** Creep forward in low gear with the skip raised on the cross-fall, because the danger comes from speed and walking pace removes the risk of overturning

☐ **C)** Raise the skip only on level ground with the brake on, then lower it fully before repositioning, since a raised skip greatly reduces stability

☐ **D)** Tip from the cross-fall if the downhill wheels sit on firmer ground, since firm contact on the low side stops the dumper from rolling over

19. A flatbed lorry carries a bundle of 6 m reinforcing bars placed 300 mm behind the headboard and held by two ratchet straps pulled tight. The driver says tight straps are all that is needed for

the short trip. Which action best secures the load?

☐ **A)** Leave the bundle where it is, since the headboard catches forward movement and the straps resist sideways movement, so the gap is harmless

☐ **B)** Slide the bundle tight against the headboard, strap it to stop movement in every direction, and recheck the tension soon after setting off

☐ **C)** Add a third strap pulled hard at the rear, since extra tension grips the bundle by friction and the gap to the headboard matters very little

☐ **D)** Swap the straps for chains at both ends, since chains are stronger than straps and the gap to the headboard then needs no attention

20. Japanese knotweed grows on the bank of a drainage ditch on a housing site. The contractor plans to spray garden-centre weedkiller along the bank, then strip the topsoil and reuse it as fill on a second site. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Obtain Environment Agency agreement before using any herbicide near water, use a competent applicator, and handle the soil as controlled waste for authorised management or disposal

☐ **B)** Hire a contractor holding a pesticide certificate to spray, then send the topsoil to the second site, since a treated plant is no longer invasive

☐ **C)** Strip the bank and spread the soil as fill on the second site under a layer of hardcore, because covering it means the soil is no longer waste

☐ **D)** Spray a standard glyphosate product kept a metre back from the water, then reuse the soil elsewhere once visible stems are cut, as rhizome fragments rarely regrow

21. A firm's method statement for roof sheeting sets out sound controls, but nobody checks that the gangs follow them. After a near miss, the director says the paperwork proves the risk is managed. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** The gang leaders should sign a statement each month that they followed the plan, and no supervision is then needed

☐ **B)** The paperwork is enough because the law requires the plan to exist, and gangs are assumed to follow what is written

☐ **C)** Checks are needed only after an injury, so the near miss changes nothing until somebody is actually harmed

☐ **D)** Controls must be monitored on site by supervision and checks, then reviewed, because a written plan alone does not show it is working

22. A self-employed delivery driver crossing a site is hit by a falling board and taken straight from the site to hospital, where his wrist is put in plaster. The manager has told the insurer and logged the incident, and considers it closed. What is missing?

☐ **A)** A RIDDOR report once the driver's own firm confirms he was off work for more than seven days, because that threshold decides when reporting is needed.

☐ **B)** A RIDDOR report, because a non-worker taken directly from the scene to hospital for treatment is reportable; telling the insurer does not discharge that duty.

☐ **C)** A signed accident book entry from the driver, which satisfies the reporting duty if the injury is also covered by the site's public liability policy.

☐ **D)** Nothing further, since RIDDOR covers the site's own employees and an injured visitor's claim is a civil matter that the insurer handles through its normal process.

23. Carpenters spray mould release oil onto steel wall formwork in an unventilated basement and wipe it off with bare hands. The safety data sheet lists mist inhalation and skin irritation. Which control should be considered first under COSHH?

☐ **A)** Spray from the basement doorway and leave the area for ten minutes afterwards, as natural airing clears the mist and removes the need to change the product.

☐ **B)** Check whether a lower-hazard release agent, such as a water-based or vegetable-oil type, can be used and applied by brush or roller, so no mist is created.

☐ **C)** Provide barrier cream and a wash station and carry on spraying, because skin contact is the main route of harm and a mist at this level is a nuisance.

☐ **D)** Keep the current product and issue FFP3 masks and nitrile gloves, since suitable PPE gives equivalent protection to changing the product or the application method.

24. On a small refurbishment, workers fill bottles from a hose tap on the bowser beside the mixer wash-down area. The manager says water is water and that no sign or cups are needed. Which

statement best reflects the CDM welfare requirement?

☐ **A)** Drinking water must be provided when the work is hot or dusty, and in that case a labelled tap on the wash-down hose is acceptable for the crew.

☐ **B)** Any mains-fed tap meets the duty if workers can reach it, since marking and cups appear in guidance but are not required on short refurbishment jobs.

☐ **C)** Wholesome drinking water must be readily accessible at a suitable place, marked where necessary, with cups provided unless the supply is a drinking jet.

☐ **D)** Bottled water bought by each worker satisfies the duty, because the contractor's obligation ends once workers have the chance to buy drinks during their breaks.

25. Joiners finish a timber-frame first floor containing a stair void. Barrier tape and a "Danger - void" sign are fixed round it, and materials are stacked beside it. The supervisor says everyone has been told. What protection is needed at the void?

☐ **A)** Barrier tape on posts with a banksman posted at the void during working hours, since supervision is as effective as physical edge protection while someone is watching.

☐ **B)** Two tensioned ropes at about 1 m and 500 mm with hazard flags, because rope barriers are accepted for short-term protection of internal voids.

☐ **C)** A single rigid top rail at about 1 m with a hazard sign, because a solid rail and a clear warning together stop anyone walking into the void.

☐ **D)** Rigid edge protection with a top rail at least 950 mm high, an intermediate rail leaving gaps of no more than 470 mm, and a toe board to stop materials falling.



26. Look at the scene. The scaffolder says it is ready for handover because the platforms, rails, ties and ladder all look complete. Which problem must be corrected before anyone uses it?

☐ **A)** The outer face has no debris netting, which must be fitted before the next shift because falling material cannot otherwise be controlled.

☐ **B)** The working platform is too narrow for materials and must be widened with extra boards before any bricklaying starts on the upper lift of the scaffold.

☐ **C)** The standards bear on loose bricks and a cracked slab, not base plates on firm sole boards, so the base could slip or settle.

☐ **D)** The access ladder should stop level with the platform edge so that workers can step across the guardrail without a gap at the top.

27. A 2.5 m deep service trench will be dug 1.5 m from the edge of a live road used by buses and lorries. The foreman plans to use the support supplier's standard strut table for firm ground. What should be done before digging starts?

☐ **A)** Have the support designed for the actual ground, groundwater and traffic loading by a competent person, with inspection at the start of each shift.

☐ **B)** Wait until cracks or water appear in the sides before fitting support, as made-up road base stands unsupported while it remains compacted.

☐ **C)** Use the standard table and add one extra strut level for safety, since traffic adds a small load that the table's margin already absorbs.

☐ **D)** Use the standard table and rely on a weekly inspection to catch any movement, because the road structure carries traffic loads away from the trench.

28. A 110 V reel feeds a mixer, with the cable passing through the gap of a hinged temporary site door that is closed against it each evening, then looped over a scaffold coupler. The sheath looks intact. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Leave it in place, because an intact sheath shows the insulation is sound and the 110 V supply keeps any shock risk to a harmless level.

☐ **B)** Coil the surplus cable on the reel to shorten the exposed run, since a fully wound reel limits the length at risk of damage.

☐ **C)** Re-route the cable clear of the closing door and sharp fittings, using a hook or protector, and include its routing in routine checks.

☐ **D)** Tape the cable to the door frame and over the coupler so it cannot move, because a fixed cable suffers less wear than one that slides.

29. A vibratory roller compacts hardcore for a car park 8 m from a terrace of old houses. Residents report rattling windows and one shows a new hairline plaster crack. The contractor says the roller is within its operator exposure rating. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Fit damping pads to the operator seat and reassess the operator's exposure, since reducing vibration at the machine reduces it at the houses too.

☐ **B)** Give residents a notice of rolling times and keep to normal working hours, since vibration complaints are handled in the same way as noise, through hours alone.

☐ **C)** Take no action unless a surveyor proves the roller caused the crack, because hairline plaster cracks in old houses usually come from age and settlement over many years.

☐ **D)** Treat it as a separate off-site effect: monitor vibration at the nearest house, review roller settings and method, and record nearby property condition.

30. A bowser dosed with a salt-based dust suppressant is sprayed along a sloping haul road. The data sheet lists a hazard to aquatic life, and the road falls towards a surface-water gully. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Spray more heavily so the surface stays damp all day, since rain dilutes the product before it can reach any watercourse.

☐ **B)** Use the lowest effective rate, keep it off areas draining to the gully, and consider whether plain water spraying achieves the same dust control.

☐ **C)** Carry on as planned, because chemicals used for dust control fall under health and safety rules, and site drains are the council's concern.

☐ **D)** Cover the gully with a plastic sheet and spray as planned, since a covered drain cannot receive the product from the sloping road.

31. A contractor's engineer prepares the propping scheme for a heavy precast beam lift and says CDM designer duties belong only to the architect and the permanent-works engineer. A principal designer is appointed. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The engineer must design every risk out before issue, which leaves no residual-risk information to pass to the principal designer or anyone else on the project

☐ **B)** The engineer should give notes on remaining risks to the lifting crew on the day, since only the people doing the work need them, not the principal designer

☐ **C)** The engineer is a designer of this temporary structure, so must reduce foreseeable risks in the scheme and pass information on remaining risks to the principal designer

☐ **D)** Designer duties attach to the permanent works alone, so the propping scheme becomes a site matter and the engineer need only issue drawings for the lifting crew to follow

32. After a gang member is seriously injured, HSE investigates a site supervisor who knowingly ignored the agreed method. A colleague says magistrates can fine no more than 20,000 pounds and only the company can be prosecuted. Which statement is correct in England and Wales?

☐ **A)** The cap applies in magistrates' courts, and the supervisor is protected as an employee, since personal prosecution is restricted to directors who control company decisions

☐ **B)** A cap of 20,000 pounds applies in magistrates' courts, though the supervisor can be prosecuted and the case can be sent to the Crown Court for greater penalties

☐ **C)** Fines are unlimited in either court, and an individual such as the supervisor can be prosecuted personally, facing a fine and up to two years' imprisonment

☐ **D)** Fines are unlimited but fall on the company, while the supervisor risks only dismissal or a civil claim and imprisonment is reserved for manslaughter cases

33. Midway through a ceiling-board job, the access route and lifting method change. The supervisor tells only the day gang by word of mouth. The night crew and a neighbouring trade are unaware, and the old method statement stays pinned in the cabin. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Revise and re-issue the method statement, brief everyone affected, including the night crew and neighbouring trade, before the new method starts, and remove the superseded copies

☐ **B)** Leave the old statement displayed for reference and add a

handwritten note beside it, since removing it would leave the cabin without any statement

☐ **C)** Update the method statement at the end of the week and rely on the day gang to pass the new method on to anyone affected as they happen to meet them on site

☐ **D)** Brief the night crew because they work for the same firm, since the neighbouring trade has its own method statement and is responsible for its own safety

34. An operative seals pipe gaps behind a boiler in a small cupboard using cans of expanding gun foam. The door is shut to stop draughts, the boiler's pilot light is lit, and he wears only thin cotton gloves. Which change deals best with the hazards?

☐ **A)** Leave the pilot light burning for warmth, because cured foam is not flammable, and swap to nitrile gloves to guard against any skin contact with the wet foam

☐ **B)** Use a larger can to cut the number of applications, work quickly with the door slightly ajar, and rely on the small quantity of foam to keep any vapour harmless

☐ **C)** Keep the door shut to stop vapour spreading into the house, switch the pilot light off only when the job ends, and wear a basic dust mask against the fumes

☐ **D)** Isolate the boiler and other ignition sources, ventilate well, and wear suitable gloves and eye protection, as the foam holds flammable gas and a sensitiser

35. A 'Danger: overhead crane operations' sign is cable-tied to the entrance gate, 80 m from the lifting area. It is faded and half hidden behind a poster. The manager says it covers the hazard, so no new sign is needed. What is the right response?

☐ **A)** Add a second gate sign and rely on induction to cover the lifting area, because more signs inside the site would clutter it and distract the crane crew

☐ **B)** Replace it with a clean, legible sign where people approach the lifting area, and keep it maintained as a supplement to barriers and a signaller

☐ **C)** Keep the gate sign but enlarge it, since a sign read on entry will be remembered by everyone when they later pass near the lifting area on their rounds

☐ **D)** Leave the faded sign until the next monthly inspection, as a displayed warning sign gives legal cover provided it was in place when lifting began

36. Maintenance staff reach a flat roof by a fixed ladder inside a plant room, then climb out through a hinged hatch. The roof has no parapet, the hatch is propped open between trips, and the edge is 3 m away. Which control best prevents falls?

☐ **A)** Provide harnesses and lanyards clipped to an anchor at the hatch, since the users are trained and the opening is only open while someone is actually climbing through it

☐ **B)** Fit permanent guardrails round the hatch opening and the roof edge, with a self-closing gate where people step out, rather than personal gear

☐ **C)** Add a handhold at the ladder's top and a non-slip step by the hatch, since falls are most likely on the ladder rather than at the opening

☐ **D)** Mark a painted line on the roof 2 m from the edge and brief users to keep inside it, closing the hatch whenever anyone is up there

37. In the site workshop, a joiner is about to use a 230 V bench saw when he notices coloured wires showing where the lead enters the plug and a brown scorch mark on the plug cover. The saw runs normally. What should he do?

☐ **A)** Disconnect it and take it out of use for repair by a competent person, since visible wires mean the cord grip has failed and scorching suggests overheating

☐ **B)** Push the cable back into the plug, tighten the cord grip screws and carry on, because the saw runs normally and the scorch mark is only cosmetic

☐ **C)** Keep using it on the RCD-protected socket for the day and report it at finish, as the RCD would trip if the fault were dangerous

☐ **D)** Swap in a plug from stores without a continuity check, then carry on, because the fault appears to be limited to the plug itself



38. Look at the scene. The mixer driver is reversing towards the pump hopper and says his mirrors are set and the beacon is on. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The access is surfaced with hardcore, which risks the pump legs sinking and the boom moving while concrete is placed

☐ **B)** The drum is turning while the lorry moves, which risks the load shifting and unbalancing the vehicle during the reversing manoeuvre

☐ **C)** A person stands in the gap behind the lorry, outside the driver's view, with no signaller controlling the reverse

☐ **D)** The second worker stands beside the pump, which risks him being struck by the boom when the pour starts

39. A 30-tonne wheel loader reverses all day on a site beside houses, and neighbours complain about its high-pitched beeper. The manager wants the alarm switched off, saying a rear camera gives the driver full sight. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Keep an audible alarm but change to a broadband type that is less intrusive off site, and keep the banksman and exclusion zone because cameras leave blind spots

☐ **B)** Switch the alarm off during early hours only, since the camera covers the rear, and ask the driver to reverse at a slower speed with extra care and patience

☐ **C)** Fit a louder alarm and add sound baffles round the loader, so that the warning is still heard by workers wearing ear defenders on site

☐ **D)** Replace the alarm with a flashing beacon, since pedestrians in hi-vis can easily see lights, and the beacon causes no noise nuisance to the neighbours at all

40. A site keeps torn bags of cement and part-used tins of emulsion paint on pallets in a yard sloping to a surface-water gully. A labourer says emulsion is water-based and cement is only dust, so no cover is needed. What is the better approach?

☐ **A)** Treat only the paint as a pollutant by bunding the tins, while the bags stay on pallets since cement is harmless once it has gone off

☐ **B)** Keep them where they are but lay a plastic sheet underneath, because the sheet will catch any liquid and keep any runoff well away from the gully

☐ **C)** Place a rubber mat over the gully and keep a spill kit beside the pallets, since a covered gully cannot receive any runoff from the yard

☐ **D)** Store both under cover on a hard base away from the gully, in a bunded or tray area with lids on, as runoff from either can pollute drains

41. A site needs an agency slinger-signaller for a three-week lifting package. The manager gives the agency only the start date and pay rate, saying the agency has vetted the worker and the site induction will cover everything else. Which statement about the site's duties is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The agency alone must judge suitability because it employs him, so the site only has to cover its own hazards, welfare and emergency arrangements in the induction

☐ **B)** The site must give the agency the skills, qualifications and health surveillance details the job needs, and the worker still needs a site induction first

☐ **C)** Giving the worker the required skills and health details on arrival at induction satisfies the duty, because he will then know them before lifting starts

☐ **D)** Only workers on fixed-term contracts are covered by the information duty, so agency workers fall under the agency's own arrangements for the whole placement

42. A groundworker must dig a pit in a factory yard owned by the client. The electricity company's plan shows nothing there, but the client supplies its own old cable layout. He proposes machine-digging to the depth marked on that layout. Which approach is most appropriate?

☐ **A)** Treat both plans as a rough guide because private cables may be unrecorded, then trace routes with a trained locator user and confirm by hand-dug trial holes

☐ **B)** Follow the client's layout to its marked depth, because the

owner's own record is more reliable than a locator and needs no further checking before digging

☐ **C)** Rely on the electricity company's plan showing nothing, because statutory undertakers must record every cable in the area including those owned privately by the client

☐ **D)** Dig by machine to half the marked depth and then change to hand tools, because the drawn depth gives a safe margin above the buried cable

43. A city site has one vehicle gate, often blocked by delivery vans and padlocked at night with the key held off site. The manager says an ambulance can simply meet a casualty at the front hoarding. Which arrangement best provides for emergency access?

☐ **A)** Arrange for the keyholder to attend within an hour of any call, since crews can wait at the gate while the casualty is carried out to them

☐ **B)** Rely on the 999 caller giving the postcode, since ambulance crews carry cutting tools and can open the padlock when they arrive on site

☐ **C)** Keep a route to each work area clear at all times, with the entry quickly openable, and name someone to meet and guide responders

☐ **D)** Put a no-parking sign at the gate and leave night security to arrange access, because the vehicle gate is needed only for planned deliveries

44. A caulker applies a solvent-based sealant for six hours in thin disposable gloves that show no tears. He rinses them at lunch and wears them again in the afternoon. Which approach to glove selection and use is most appropriate?

☐ **A)** Match the glove material and breakthrough time to the solvent in the safety data sheet, change before that time passes, and never reuse

☐ **B)** Wear two pairs of the same thin gloves and rinse theouter pair at lunch, because the doubled layer will block the solvent for the full shift

☐ **C)** Switch to thick general-purpose work gloves, because thickness is what resists solvents and any heavy glove will cover him safely through a whole working shift

☐ **D)** Keep the thin gloves because an absence of tears shows no solvent has passed through, and replace them only when visible damage appears during the shift

45. A 40-person site buys a defibrillator. The manager now plans to cut the number of first aiders from two to none, because the device covers the heart risk, and to keep it locked in his office. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Provision is voluntary, so it can stay locked in the manager's office with no routine checks, because first aiders will fetch it whenever needed

☐ **B)** The law requires one on sites above 25 workers, which meets the first-aid duty, so first-aider numbers may fall once the device is installed

☐ **C)** Once bought it counts as medical equipment outside PUWER, so the supplier handles upkeep and no written instructions are needed for would-be users

☐ **D)** The needs assessment sets first-aider numbers, and a provided defibrillator is work equipment, so it needs accessible siting, upkeep and written user instructions

46. A fencer sprays a solvent-based timber preservative in a garage workshop, creating both vapour and fine mist. He wears a half-mask with brown gas filters only, and a colleague says white filters are better. Which advice is correct?

☐ **A)** Stay with the brown gas filters alone, because white only denotes dust and the carbon in a brown filter also traps liquid mist as well as vapour in the air

☐ **B)** Use combination filters such as A2P3, where brown handles organic vapour and white stops the mist particles, with a suitable face fit

☐ **C)** Choose grey B filters, because grey is the standard colour for chemical vapours and is the correct choice for any solvent-based liquid

☐ **D)** Swap to white P3 filters alone, because P3 is the highest class and its pleated medium will also absorb the solvent vapours in the air



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the operator is well protected because he wears head, face, hearing and hand protection. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** His high-visibility jacket is the main fault, because reflective strips are a snagging risk and a plain close-fitting jacket must be worn for tree cutting

☐ **B)** Helmet-mounted ear defenders cannot protect hearing while a visor is down, so earplugs must replace them for any chainsaw work in the open

☐ **C)** His legs have no cut-resistant protection, so a kickback or slip of the running chain could cause a severe injury that his other PPE cannot prevent

☐ **D)** His gloves should be removed because they can snag the chain, so bare hands on the handles are the safer arrangement for controlled cutting

48. A rubble chute is fixed from a second-floor opening into a skip. It is loosely tied at the top, has a gap at one joint and the skip stands uncovered in a pedestrian route. A labourer says the chute is just a way to tip waste safely. What is needed?

☐ **A)** Leave the arrangement as it is, since any chute is accepted as proof that debris is being safely lowered to the skip

☐ **B)** Have someone watch the pedestrian route and shout when waste is tipped, instead of fixing the chute and fencing the skip

☐ **C)** Secure and join the chute properly, enclose the skip area with a barrier and control the loading, so debris cannot fall on people

☐ **D)** Put a sign beside the skip warning pedestrians, because a sign is enough to keep people out of a drop zone

49. Scaffolders working beside a fenced 11 kV substation drop a hand tool that lands inside the locked compound near equipment. The foreman proposes climbing the fence to grab it because the unit is silent. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Push a scaffold tube through the fence to drag the tool clear, because the tube never enters the equipment area and nobody has to climb in

☐ **B)** Keep everyone out and report it to the operator via the notice contact, so an authorised person retrieves the tool once the area is safe

☐ **C)** Send the site electrician in to fetch it, because a qualified electrician is competent to work safely around any high-voltage equipment on any premises

☐ **D)** Climb in and retrieve it only while the equipment is silent, since the absence of any humming shows the apparatus is dead and the whole compound is safe

50. A storm warning forecasts gusts above a tower crane's in-service wind limit tonight. The operator plans to apply the slew brake to keep the jib over the site and lower the empty hook to the ground for security. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Release the slew brake so the jib can weathervane freely into the wind, leaving the crane as the manufacturer's out-of-service instructions state

☐ **B)** Carry on lifting through the evening with light loads until a gust actually passes the limit, since a forecast alone gives no reason to stop work

☐ **C)** Lower the hook onto a heavy kentledge block and tie it off, because anchoring the hook to the ground holds the jib steady against wind loading

☐ **D)** Keep the brake applied so the jib cannot swing into neighbouring property, because a jib held in one position resists wind better than one free to turn with it

Answer Key

1. D — Anyone who appoints a contractor under CDM 2015 must take reasonable steps to check it meets the competence condition, and must provide the information the firm needs, regardless of the principal contractor's own checks.

A: The contractor keeps its duty to plan, manage and monitor work under its control, and cannot hand it off by subletting. B: An induction covers general site matters, whereas the appointing contractor must still give the firm the information it needs for its own work. C: The duty to check falls on every person who appoints a contractor, not only the client, and insurance says nothing about competence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a principal contractor's checks or an induction replace your own duty to be satisfied about a firm you bring in.

2. A — CDM 2015 requires the client to provide pre-construction information as soon as practicable to every designer and contractor appointed or being considered for appointment.

B: The client must give what it has or can reasonably obtain, and a lack of experience does not remove the duty. C: The duty extends to contractors being considered for appointment, so tenderers must receive it to plan and price safely. D: Information must be provided early enough to influence pricing and planning, not discovered after work starts, and verbal briefings leave gaps.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating hazard information as something the winning contractor finds out for itself rather than something the client must supply early.

3. B — A flood warning means act now, so the emergency plan is triggered and the priority is getting people out before the access road floods, with property secondary to life.

A: Sheltering in place risks being trapped, and the agreed plan is to leave by a safe route before access floods. C: A flood warning already means flooding is expected, so waiting for a severe warning risks losing the only access route. D: Protecting property before people puts workers at risk of being cut off, and life must come before equipment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Waiting for flood water to arrive, or for the worst warning level, before moving people out of a site.

4. A — Keeping an escape route at his back, aiming at the base of the fire and retreating if it grows keeps a small fire fight safe, with the alarm already raised.

B: Fighting an uncontrolled fire puts him at serious risk, since extinguishers are only for small fires and he must be ready to leave. C: Standing between a fire and the exit removes his escape route and traps him if the fire grows. D: Standing too close risks burns, flame tips are not the fuel, and he should retreat if the fire is not controlled.

COMMON MISTAKE: Staying to fight a fire for longer than is safe because an extinguisher is in your hands.

5. A — The resin vapour is flammable and heavier than air, so ignition sources must go and ventilation must clear low points, with correct respiratory protection if exposure remains.

B: Particle filters do not remove organic vapour, which needs a suitable gas or organic vapour filter or fresh-air supply. C: A heater adds an ignition source in a space where flammable vapour collects, and warming also increases evaporation. D: Smell is not a reliable measure of exposure or of flammable concentration, and closing the doors lets vapour build up.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging whether vapour is safe by how strongly it smells and not by the product's hazards.

6. B — Team lifting works when the route is planned, partners suit each other, the load is held steadily, and one person coordinates every movement.

A: Unplanned adjustment causes sudden load shifts, and uneven height makes the load tilt and unbalances both people. C: Gloves and belts do not fix the planning, route or coordination faults, and back belts are not proven to prevent injury. D: A long flat board sags, cannot be gripped well and makes walking backwards or sideways likely, which raises the risk of a trip.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming two people automatically make a heavy or awkward load safe without agreeing who leads and how it will move.

7. C — The safe working load applies to everything on the platform together, and loads must be contained and secured within the platform so they cannot catch or fall.

A: The rating covers the combined load, and closed gates cannot hold tubes projecting past the platform. B: The rated load is a structural and braking limit for every journey, not a guide that depends on whether people are nearby. D: The posted safe working load is a limit that must not be exceeded, whatever the hoist's condition.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking each item against the load limit instead of adding up everything that goes on the platform.

8. D — Adding a stepladder to a tower platform lifts him above the guardrail protection and adds instability, so the correct fix is to build the tower higher or use a suitable platform.

A: Braked castors on a level concrete floor are acceptable, and the floor is not the main problem shown. B: Tools and containers can be managed with toe boards, so this is a lesser matter than standing above the guardrails. C: The colleague at the base is a minor risk compared with the painter's own exposure to a fall from a ladder on a platform.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a tower's guardrails still protect you when you stand on something to gain extra height.

9. C — Isolating and locking off the crane removes both the moving load and the live conductors, and the contractor's own lock gives personal control over reinstating power.

A: Radio and a banksman still leave a live crane able to travel over the work, and they depend on communication that can fail. B: A pendant stop does not isolate the supply, and the key held by the driver gives the contractor no control over reinstating it. D: Tape and a promise are administrative, and do not physically prevent travel or remove the live conductors above the work.

COMMON MISTAKE: Accepting warnings and promises in place of a physical isolation that the person at risk controls.

10. C — Separating pedestrians from vehicles removes the conflict altogether, which is stronger than any warning, signal or person trying to control a shared crossing.

A: The public owe no such duty on a site, and the contractor must protect people affected by its work. B: Alarms and horns only warn, and they depend on pedestrians noticing and reacting in time. D: A shared crossing still relies on people obeying a banksman, which is weaker than removing the conflict by separation.

COMMON MISTAKE: Controlling a shared crossing with signs and beacons when the public could be kept out of the plant's path altogether.

11. D — The Management Regulations require an assessment that considers a young person's inexperience before employment, bar a child from work with unrecognisable accident risks, and require risk information to reach a parent before a child starts.

A: The host controls the site and its hazards, so it carries its own duties to assess risks and protect the pupil while he is there. B: The duty is to give a parent comprehensible risk information before a child starts work, whether or not the placement continues. C: The supervised-training exception applies only to a young person who is no longer a child, not to a 15-year-old pupil.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that supervision, or the school's involvement, replaces the host firm's own assessment and the duty to inform a child's parent.

12. D — These are signs of heat exhaustion, which is treated by cooling, removing clothing and fluids, with 999 if there is no improvement in 30 minutes, and the work pattern must change to stop a repeat.

A: Keeping the coveralls on stops body heat escaping, and ten minutes without active cooling or fluids is not adequate recovery. B: Stimulant drinks and salt tablets do not cool him, and returning him to the same hot conditions invites a worse heat illness. C: Wrapping him up traps heat when he needs cooling, and waiting for vomiting delays the emergency call.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating dizziness and heavy sweating in a hot space as tiredness that a short break and a sugary drink will cure.

13. A — First aid kits should hold items first aiders are trained to use, be checked and restocked regularly, and have in-date sterile eyewash where eye injury is possible.

B: Every workplace needs first aid provision based on its assessed needs. C: Where eye hazards exist, sterile in-date eyewash should be on hand. D: Medication is not recommended in a kit and yearly checks are too infrequent.

COMMON MISTAKE: Leaving a first aid box unchecked and stocking it with medicines that first aiders are not trained to give.

14. D — A helmet perched on a bulky hat can fall off or shift on impact and loses its protection, so thermal comfort should come from a liner designed for the helmet.

A: A vest worn on the outside is what keeps the reflective bands visible, so this is correct, not a fault. B: Helmet colour is a site convention and has no bearing on how well the helmet protects him. C: Glove choice is a lesser concern than a helmet that is unlikely to stay in place beneath a load, and cut resistance is not the issue shown.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that wearing a hard hat in any fashion satisfies the rule, even when it is perched on other headwear with its strap loose.

15. A — Removing hand contact comes first, and a contact heat level is tested only for a threshold time of 15 seconds at its temperature, so a 20-second hold needs a higher level and a

margin.

B: Level 2 is tested only to a 15-second threshold at that temperature, so a 20-second hold leaves no margin and exceeds what the rating proves. C: Thin nitrile melts and sticks to skin at that temperature and offers no tested heat insulation, however many layers are worn. D: EN 388 rates mechanical hazards such as cuts and abrasion and gives no contact heat protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Picking a glove because it matches the temperature number on the label, without allowing for contact time or removing the need to touch the hot item.

16. B — A tag covers only what was completed and inspected, work equipment must be inspected in position before use, and falling-risk areas must be closed to anyone not authorised.

A: Completing or altering a scaffold is work for competent scaffolders, and the result still needs inspection before anyone uses it. C: The tag certifies only the completed lifts, and standards are not designed or checked as personal fall protection anchors. D: A signature for the lower lifts cannot make the unfinished lift safe, and the user cannot take over a scaffold that has not been inspected.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading a tag at the foot of a scaffold as proof that every lift above it is safe to use.

17. D — The work at height hierarchy puts collective measures such as a platform with edge protection ahead of personal systems, and a structure being taken apart cannot be a reliable anchor.

A: A stack being dismantled loses strength as it comes down, so it cannot serve as an anchor however sound it looks at the start. B: A net at the eaves does not protect someone working at the stack, and it still sits below a working platform with edge protection in the hierarchy. C: Ridge tiles are not designed to take fall loads, and a personal system is still being used where collective protection is practicable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing the harness first and then hunting for something solid to clip to, instead of designing out the fall with a platform.

18. C — A high-lift skip must be raised only on substantially level ground and never driven while raised, because stability falls sharply once the skip is elevated.

A: Stability reduces as soon as the skip is lifted, so moving with it partly raised is also unsafe. B: A raised skip on a cross-fall can overturn at any speed, and low gear does not restore stability. D: Firmer ground on one side does not make a cross-fall safe, because raising the skip shifts weight and can still tip the machine.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that slow speed, or only part-raising the skip, makes it safe to move or work on uneven ground with the skip up.

19. B — A load should be blocked against the headboard to remove the gap it could accelerate across, restrained in all directions, and rechecked early because loads settle and straps loosen.

A: A bundle sliding across a gap hits the headboard with a damaging shock load, so the gap is not harmless. C: Friction from strap tension cannot be relied on in emergency braking, and the gap lets the bundle build up momentum before it hits the headboard. D: Stronger restraint does not remove the need to block the load forward, and chains are no substitute for correct positioning.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on how tight the straps feel rather than on blocking the load and restraining it in every direction.

20. A — Herbicide use in or near water needs Environment Agency agreement, and soil containing knotweed rhizome is controlled waste that must not be spread where it could grow.

B: A certificate does not replace agreement for work near water, and treated soil can still hold living rhizome. C: Covering does not change the soil's status, and moving knotweed soil to another site without controls can cause spread and offences. D: Herbicide near water needs agreement whatever the offset, and small rhizome fragments in soil can regrow.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating knotweed as a gardening problem solved by weedkiller, instead of a controlled-waste and watercourse issue.

21. D — Risk assessment does not end with writing controls down: supervisors must check they are in place and effective, and findings should feed a review.

A: A signed statement without observation does not check that controls are working. B: Having a plan does not show it is followed, and the duty is to manage the risk in practice. C: Monitoring should be continuing and a near miss is a prompt to review.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a written method statement as proof that the risk is controlled without checking the work.

22. B — Accidents to people not at work are reportable under RIDDOR where they are taken directly from the scene to hospital for treatment of the injury, and an insurance notification is a separate matter.

A: The seven-day test applies to injured workers, whereas for non-workers the test is direct removal from the scene to hospital for

treatment. C: An accident book entry is an internal record, and neither it nor the existence of insurance cover satisfies the duty to report to the authorities. D: RIDDOR also covers people not at work, and an insurance claim does not replace the duty to notify the enforcing authority.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating notification to the insurer as if it were the same as the legal duty to report to the enforcing authority.

23. B — COSHH expects elimination or substitution of the hazardous substance, and changing the method to avoid mist, before relying on PPE or personal hygiene measures.

A: Brief airing of an unventilated basement does not reliably clear mist, and it leaves skin contact and the hazardous product itself unaddressed. C: Barrier cream is a weak control, and treating the mist as a nuisance ignores the inhalation hazard identified on the data sheet. D: PPE is the last line of defence in the control hierarchy and cannot be treated as equivalent to eliminating or substituting the hazard.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reaching for gloves and masks before asking whether a less hazardous product or a mist-free method could be used.

24. C — CDM 2015 Schedule 2 requires an adequate supply of wholesome drinking water at suitable places, conspicuously marked where necessary, with sufficient cups unless people can drink easily from a jet.

A: The duty applies on every site regardless of conditions, and a tap beside a wash-down area risks contamination. B: The marking and cup provisions are part of the regulations, with no exemption for short jobs, and the location must also be suitable. D: The duty is to provide or make available the supply, and leaving workers to buy their own does not meet it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any tap on site counts as drinking water, regardless of where it is or what the water is used for.

25. D — The Work at Height Regulations require guard-rails of sufficient strength and rigidity, with a top rail of at least 950 mm and no gap above 470 mm, plus toe-boards to prevent persons or materials falling.

A: Tape and supervision are not collective physical protection and give nothing when the banksman is absent or distracted. B: Ropes lack the strength and rigidity needed to stop a person falling and give no protection against falling materials. C: A single rail leaves a gap greater than 470 mm below it and gives no toe board to stop materials being kicked into the void.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on tape, signs and a briefing where a rigid guard-rail and toe board are needed.

26. C — A scaffold's loads pass down through its standards, so each needs a base plate on a sound sole board or firm base, as loose bricks and cracked slabs can shift or crush.

A: Netting is a separate control that depends on the work and does not address the visible instability of the supports. B: The deck is boarded at a suitable width, so this is not the significant fault in the scene. D: A ladder should project well above the platform to give a handhold, so stopping it level would introduce a fault.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a scaffold safe from its platforms and rails without checking what the standards stand on.

27. A — Support must suit the real ground, water and loads from adjacent vehicles, and HSE guidance expects a competent person to inspect it at the start of each shift.

B: Support must be decided and in place before people enter, since collapse can happen without warning. C: A table for firm ground does not account for traffic loading or groundwater, and an extra strut level does not replace a design for the real conditions. D: Traffic loads can reach the trench sides through the ground, and inspections are needed at the start of every shift, not weekly.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a generic support table without checking whether traffic loading and groundwater are covered.

28. C — Cables must be protected from mechanical damage such as crushing and abrasion, and an intact sheath today does not show the insulation survives repeated trapping and rubbing.

A: A 110 V supply reduces but does not remove the risk, and repeated crushing damages cables in ways not visible from the sheath. B: A reel left wound under load can overheat, and a shorter run still passes through the same pinch point and over the same edge. D: Taping holds the cable against the pinch point and sharp edge, so it does not remove the cause of damage.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a cable safe because its outer sheath looks intact, while ignoring where it is routed.

29. D — Operator exposure limits do not protect neighbours, and vibration affecting nearby premises can be a statutory nuisance, so monitoring and changes to the method are needed.

A: Seat damping protects the driver but has little effect on the ground-borne vibration transmitted to neighbouring properties. B:

Limiting hours may help but does not measure or reduce the vibration reaching the houses. C: Waiting for proof of damage ignores the nuisance already reported, and ageing buildings are more sensitive to vibration.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that meeting the operator's exposure limits means neighbours are protected from the same vibration.

30. B — Substances hazardous to aquatic life must not reach surface-water drains, so the quantity, the application area and the choice of product all need controlling.

A: Heavier application increases the pollutant load and run-off, and dilution does not make a harmful discharge to a surface-water drain acceptable. C: Polluting a surface-water drain is an environmental matter for the contractor, regardless of whose drain it is. D: A sheet does not stop the product running off, and it may pool or flow elsewhere, so the source still needs controlling.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating dust suppression water and additives as harmless because they are applied to stop a nuisance.

31. C — CDM 2015 treats falsework and other temporary supports as structures, so anyone preparing their design is a designer who must pass information on residual risks to the principal designer for the health and safety file.

A: The duty is to eliminate foreseeable risks so far as reasonably practicable and to give information about those that remain. B: Information on remaining risks must go to the principal designer and into the health and safety file, not just to people present. D: The CDM definition of a structure includes falsework and temporary supports, so temporary designs carry designer duties.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming CDM designer duties apply only to architects and engineers working on the permanent structure.

32. C — Duty holders, both individuals and organisations, can be prosecuted, and in England and Wales fines are unlimited with imprisonment of up to two years available against individuals.

A: The 20,000 pound cap is not the rule in England and Wales, and individuals at any level can be prosecuted for their own breaches. B: The cap is wrong for England and Wales, where magistrates' fines are also unlimited. D: Individuals can be prosecuted under health and safety law itself and imprisonment is available beyond manslaughter.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming health and safety prosecution is something that happens only to the company and that magistrates' fines are small and capped.

33. A — When the work changes, the arrangements must be reviewed and the new method communicated to everyone it affects before it starts, with old versions withdrawn so nobody follows them.

B: A superseded document left in circulation invites people to follow the old method and should be withdrawn. C: Changes must reach affected people before the new method begins, not by chance conversation after the event. D: The neighbouring trade is affected by the change, so coordination and information must reach it as well.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that briefing whoever attends the morning meeting is enough when a method changes part way through a job.

34. D — Cans of gun foam contain flammable propellant gases and isocyanate, a sensitiser, so ignition sources must be removed, fresh air provided and skin and eyes properly protected.

A: The propellant is flammable while the foam is being applied, so a lit pilot light is an ignition source. B: A sensitiser can affect a person after repeated small exposures, so ventilation and control of ignition sources cannot be skipped. C: A shut cupboard traps flammable gas beside the ignition source, and a dust mask gives no protection against vapour.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a can of expanding foam as an ordinary household product instead of reading its safety data sheet for flammable and sensitising ingredients.

35. B — Safety signs must be clear and legible and provided and maintained where a significant risk remains, so they need to be seen in time at the hazard and supplement other controls.

A: Induction does not replace a legible sign where the risk exists, and the problem here is placement and condition, not volume. C: Size does not fix its position, and a warning must be seen at the point of risk, not recalled from 80 m away. D: Signs have to be maintained so they remain legible, and a faded, half-hidden sign cannot warn anyone.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a sign has done its job once it is fixed to the site gate, wherever the hazard is and however faded the sign becomes.

36. B — Collective protection such as fixed guardrails guards both the opening and the edge for everyone, and ranks above personal fall protection in the hierarchy for work at height.

A: Personal equipment ranks below collective guardrails, and it

leaves the open hatch hole unguarded for everyone else. C: A better handhold does nothing about the open hatch or the unprotected edge, which are the fall hazards described. D: A painted line and a briefing depend on behaviour and do not physically stop anyone falling from the edge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on harnesses, painted lines or briefings where a fixed guardrail around the opening and edge would remove the risk.

37. A — Coloured wires at the plug show the cord grip is not holding the cable, and burn marks point to a loose connection or overheating, so the item is removed from use until a competent person repairs it.

B: A scorch mark signals overheating at the connections, and a quick push-back leaves a possibly damaged plug in service. C: An RCD detects earth leakage and does not protect against overheating or loose connections. D: A replacement plug fitted without checks may be wired wrongly, and the damage to the lead and terminations has not been assessed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a power tool by whether it still runs rather than by what its plug, lead and cord grip show.

38. C — A pedestrian between the tail of a reversing vehicle and a fixed object can be crushed, and mirrors and a beacon cannot protect someone in a blind area.

A: Ground bearing is not what the picture highlights, and it does not outweigh a person in a vehicle's path. B: A turning drum is normal for delivery and is not the hazard the scene shows. D: His position at the far side is not the most significant danger shown.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a driver who has set the mirrors and switched on the beacon has covered the danger to anyone behind the vehicle.

39. A — A camera covers only part of the area around large plant, so the audible warning and banksman remain necessary, and a broadband alarm reduces the nuisance without removing the warning.

B: Cameras leave blind areas, and an alarm warns people the driver cannot see on any shift. C: A louder alarm worsens the nuisance and does nothing about blind spots or the lack of segregation. D: A beacon warns only people who happen to look at it, so it is not a full substitute.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a rear camera makes the other warning measures redundant, even though it leaves areas around large plant unseen.

40. D — Rain on cement and spilt emulsion paint can carry alkaline or polluting liquid into drains, so both need cover, containment and distance from the gully.

A: Rain-washed cement is strongly alkaline and polluting, so the bags also need cover. B: A loose sheet on a slope does not contain liquid and leaves rain and spills free to flow downhill. C: Covering a gully and using a spill kit is a response to releases, and storage should prevent them in the first place.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing water-based paint and cement are too harmless to need cover or bunding because they are not oils or solvents.

41. B — Regulation 15 of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999 requires the user of agency workers to give the agency this information so it can pass it on, and induction on site hazards is a separate duty.

A: The site using the worker must supply the required skills, qualifications and health surveillance details to the agency, so the duty is not left with the agency alone. C: The information must reach the agency so it can match and brief the worker beforehand, and handing it over at the gate comes too late to do that. D: Regulation 15 deals separately with agency workers and with those supplying them, so being supplied by an agency does not remove the user's duty.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming an agency worker's suitability and health needs are the agency's problem once the site has run its own induction.

42. A — Plans only indicate location and number of services, and private cables may not appear on a utility plan, so locating by a competent person and confirming with hand-dug trial holes comes before mechanical digging.

B: An old layout shows only an approximate position and depth, and it can be wrong or out of date, so it still has to be checked on the ground. C: A utility plan covers that company's own apparatus and not necessarily the client's private cables, so a blank plan does not prove the ground is clear. D: Cables are not always at the drawn depth or position, so mechanical digging before locating and trial holes can still strike a cable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a drawing or a blank utility plan as proof about what lies underground, rather than as a rough guide to be checked.

43. C — Emergency routes and access must stay clear and usable at all times, and someone must meet and guide the ambulance, so a padlocked or blocked gate defeats the plan.

A: An hour's delay for access is far too long in an emergency, and moving a casualty to the hoarding is not a substitute for a clear and openable entry. B: Responders should not be expected to force entry, and a locked gate delays treatment when the plan should have ensured quick, clear access. D: A sign does not keep the route clear, and emergency access is needed at any hour regardless of the delivery programme.

COMMON MISTAKE: Planning for emergency vehicles by assuming they can work around locked gates and blocked routes when the time comes.

44. A — Solvents can pass through a glove that looks intact, so the material must be matched to the substance, replaced within its breakthrough time, and not reused after rinsing.

B: Two layers of the same unsuitable material only slow permeation slightly, and rinsing does not restore a glove that has already been affected. C: Resistance depends on the glove material against the specific solvent and not on thickness, and some heavy gloves absorb solvents and hold them against the skin. D: Permeation happens through intact material, so the lack of visible damage does not show that the glove is still protecting the skin.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging whether a glove is protecting you by how it looks and feels rather than by its material and breakthrough time.

45. D — HSE states that no law requires a defibrillator and that first aider numbers come from the needs assessment, while one that is provided falls under PUWER, including instructions and maintenance.

A: Equipment meant for an emergency has to be readily accessible and in working order, which a locked office and an absence of checks cannot ensure. B: Health and safety law does not require a defibrillator at any workforce size, and it does not replace the first-aid arrangements the needs assessment calls for. C: HSE says PUWER applies to a defibrillator that is provided, so the employer must ensure maintenance and give users information and instructions.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that buying a defibrillator reduces the need for trained first aiders and other first-aid provision.

46. B — Type A (brown) filters deal with organic vapours of higher boiling point and P (white) filters deal with particles and mist, so spray work with both hazards needs both functions.

A: A gas filter does not capture airborne droplets, so the mist needs the white particle filter in addition to the brown vapour filter. C: Grey type B is for certain inorganic gases and vapours, whereas organic solvent vapour needs brown type A. D: A particle filter does nothing against vapours, and so he would breathe the solvent unprotected through a filter that looks high-grade.

COMMON MISTAKE: Choosing a respirator filter by its class number or familiarity without matching its type and colour to both the vapour and particle hazards.

47. C — Chainsaw work needs leg protection designed to stop or clog the chain, and the operator's ordinary trousers and boots leave the most exposed part of the body unprotected.

A: The jacket is the lesser concern, and the real danger is the unprotected legs next to the running chain, so this does not address the greatest risk. B: Helmet-mounted ear defenders and visors are a standard combination for this work, and the visor does not stop the defenders attenuating noise. D: Gloves suited to chainsaw use are recommended for protection, and removing them would leave the hands exposed without reducing the chain hazard.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting the number of PPE items worn instead of asking whether the part of the body most at risk from the task is actually protected.

48. C — A chute reduces falling debris only if it is secure, free of gaps and discharges into a controlled area, so the zone beneath needs to be fenced and managed.

A: A poorly fixed chute with gaps can still drop debris onto a route used by people. B: A watcher cannot stop debris leaving through a gap and shouting is unreliable. D: A sign does not physically prevent people being struck.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that fitting a chute is enough without checking its joints, fixings and the area where it discharges.

49. B — Only persons authorised by the operator may enter a substation, and silence does not show equipment is dead, so the operator must be told and must arrange safe recovery.

A: A long metal tube close to high-voltage apparatus can cause flashover or contact, and it still amounts to unauthorised work inside the operator's compound. C: Competence on the site's own installation does not give authority to enter the operator's substation, which only the operator can grant. D: Silence proves nothing about whether equipment is live, and entering without the operator's authority is the danger itself.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that quiet equipment behind a fence is safe to enter for a quick job.

50. A — A tower crane out of service must be free to weathervane so the jib aligns with the wind, and a brake left on

can cause structural damage as HSE found in incident investigations.

B: Work should stop and the crane be put out of service before the forecast conditions arrive, rather than waiting for the limit to be exceeded. C: Tying the hook to the ground restrains the structure in a way it was not designed for and can overload the crane when it is hit by the wind. D: A held jib faces wind from any side and can be overloaded, which is why out-of-service cranes must be left free to turn into the wind.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trying to lock a tower crane in place against a storm instead of leaving it free to weathervane as instructed.

PRACTICE TEST 15

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. After a fall from a mobile tower, an HSE inspector asks the bricklayer who witnessed it to answer questions in private and sign a declaration of truth. He refuses, saying his answers could be used against him if his employer is prosecuted. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** He may stay silent as he would under a police caution, because an inspector's questions are voluntary until a formal notice has been served on his employer

☐ **B)** He must answer, but anything he says can be used against him in court, so his best protection is to give short answers and decline to sign

☐ **C)** He must answer only if his employer's solicitor is present, because an inspector cannot question a worker without the agreement of the company

☐ **D)** He must answer and sign, because an answer given under this inspector's power cannot be used as evidence against him or his spouse or civil partner

2. A client's investors, none with construction experience, will tour a live frame site for an hour. The site manager says the risk assessments cover only the workforce, so visitors need only hi-vis jackets and must stay close to their escort. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Risks to visitors must be assessed too, giving a planned route clear of plant and overhead work, with suitable PPE, a safety briefing and a competent escort

☐ **B)** Visitors are a client matter, so the client's insurer assesses the tour while the contractor's assessments cover people it employs on site

☐ **C)** A formal assessment is needed only if the visit lasts more than a day, because short visits to a site fall below the usual threshold for any assessment

☐ **D)** A signed waiver accepts the risks on the visitors' own behalf, which relieves the site of its duty to assess the hazards they might meet on the tour

3. A joiner drilling a ceiling in a 1970s school hits a hidden grey board and fine dust falls; it could be asbestos insulating board. A colleague fetches a brush and an ordinary vacuum to tidy up at once. What should happen first?

☐ **A)** Stop work, move everyone out and keep others from entering, then report to the supervisor so the area is assessed and cleaned under the emergency procedure

☐ **B)** Open the windows and switch on the portable extractor fans to clear the air, then carry on drilling elsewhere in the room once the visible dust has settled

☐ **C)** Sweep the dust gently into a bag with a damp brush while wearing a paper mask, because a quick clean-up stops any fibres from reaching other rooms nearby

☐ **D)** Remove the dusty overalls and shake them outside before resuming work, because fibres cling to clothing and cannot be released in the room

4. On a fit-out, the alarm sounds. After two minutes the panel operator silences it because nobody has seen smoke or flames, and workers who gathered at the assembly point start drifting back inside. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Workers may return to ground-floor areas after ten minutes, since a fire that has not grown by then is very unlikely to threaten the lower floors of the building

☐ **B)** Workers may return once the bell stops, because a silenced alarm with no visible smoke indicates a false alarm and carrying on saves a good deal of lost time

☐ **C)** Everyone stays at the assembly point until the person in charge has checked the cause and gives a clear all-clear, with the fire service called if none is found

☐ **D)** Each firm's supervisor decides for his own gang, because contractors know their own areas best and can judge whether it is safe to go back

5. A conservation mason switches from cement to hydrated lime mortar and tells the crew that, as a natural, traditional material,

lime needs no gloves or eye protection. The safety data sheet says it irritates skin and causes serious eye damage. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Issue protection only after a crew member shows symptoms of burns or dermatitis, then record the first case in the accident book before reviewing the controls

☐ **B)** Provide goggles but allow bare forearms, since lime damages only the eyes and wet lime on the skin washes off harmlessly at the end of the shift

☐ **C)** Treat it as hazardous, following the data sheet with dust control at the mixer, eye protection, waterproof gloves and skin washing facilities

☐ **D)** Accept the claim, because lime is milder than cement and a dust mask alone is enough to keep the crew safe while they are mixing and laying it

6. Tilers carry 20 kg tubs of adhesive up four flights because the permanent lift is not yet working. The manager's only measure is a manual handling training session for the gang. Which statement best describes the position?

☐ **A)** The task is acceptable if each worker is limited to one tub per trip, since that keeps every single lift under the 25 kg guideline figure

☐ **B)** Only the supplier can change the load, so the site can do nothing about tub size until the next order is placed, apart from rotating the carriers between floors

☐ **C)** Training is a sufficient control on its own, because a trained worker can lift any commonly supplied tub weight safely if he uses the correct technique each time he lifts

☐ **D)** Avoiding the carry should be considered first, for example by a hoist or delivery to each floor, then smaller tubs and aids, with training supporting those measures

7. A scissor-type MEWP will be used to repair a ceiling 8 m up in a public atrium, while staff continue to walk beneath it to reach the lifts. The supervisor plans cones, a shouted warning and a sign. Which arrangement best controls the risks?

☐ **A)** Restrict walkers to the far side of the atrium with cones, because the operator can see people below and will stop work at once if anyone approaches the area

☐ **B)** Permit walking beneath the platform while the operator keeps all tools in a bag, since small items cannot injure anyone from eight metres up

☐ **C)** Close off the area beneath with physical barriers sized for the work zone and any falling items, and station a trained ground person to manage the MEWP

☐ **D)** Leave the area open but work only in the quiet early morning, because fewer people use the atrium and the risk becomes acceptable



8. Look at the scene. Which feature creates the most serious risk of a fatal injury to the operator?

☐ **A)** His body is trapped between the beam and the controls if he is pushed forward, and nobody at ground level is placed to lower the basket

☐ **B)** The cordless drill is held above head height, which could cause an overreaching strain and a risk of the drill or its battery being dropped

☐ **C)** The harness is clipped to the basket anchor point, which will drag the operator out of the basket if the boom suddenly moves

☐ **D)** The boom is not set on outriggers, so the whole machine will overturn when the operator moves around inside the raised basket

9. A trench is being dug to the side of a disused underground oil tank, and the groundworker proposes bracing the trench side by wedging struts against the tank shell, saying it is solid steel. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The ground must be supported by designed supports that do not depend on the tank, and the tank treated as a possible source of flammable vapour

☐ **B)** Bracing off the tank is fine once it has been drained, because an empty tank no longer holds any vapour or flammable residue inside it

☐ **C)** No support is needed beside the tank, since the tank shields that side and only the opposite trench wall has to be timbered

☐ **D)** A solid steel tank is strong enough to take the thrust, provided the foreman checks the shell for visible corrosion before any struts are fitted

10. A hire firm delivers an 8-tonne excavator, and its driver gives a five-minute talk and leaves. The site's operator is experienced but has only used machines with the other joystick control pattern. The foreman wants digging to begin straight away. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Let the operator start, because his years of experience prove competence on any excavator and only a quick demonstration of the bucket is needed

☐ **B)** Check the control pattern and give documented familiarisation using the manual, with a supervised trial away from people, before any work begins

☐ **C)** Have a labourer stand beside the machine to shout corrections during the first shift, while the operator digs normally in the working area of the site

☐ **D)** Rely on the hire driver's short talk, because the duty to instruct passes to the hire firm and the hirer has no further duty after handover of the machine

11. A 12-person groundworks firm has an office manager who holds a recognised health and safety qualification and knows the work well. The owner instead pays an outside consultancy to take care of safety, saying that transfers his legal duties to it. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** The office manager can assist only if the owner first gains a chartered safety qualification himself, since the employer must hold one personally

☐ **B)** Paying a competent external consultancy passes the legal duty to it, because an accepted specialist takes over the employer's responsibilities for the work

☐ **C)** Both can be used, but the consultancy must be chosen first, because an independent outsider is more objective than anyone employed by the firm

☐ **D)** The owner stays responsible, and should appoint the trained office manager as competent person in preference to an outsider, who can only assist

12. After a wet fortnight, a drainage labourer working in a flooded trench in leaking wellingtons reports cold, numb, swollen and painful feet by evening. The foreman says it is just tiredness and the crew can carry on. Which response is best?

☐ **A)** Rub the feet briskly with a towel and apply a hot pad, because strong warming restores circulation and prevents lasting tissue damage in the toes

☐ **B)** Treat it as possible trench foot: get him out of the wet, dry and gently warm his feet, and arrange medical advice and better boots and socks

☐ **C)** Let him finish the shift in dry socks, since a symptom that eases by the next morning cannot be a lasting cold or wet injury to the feet

☐ **D)** Advise thicker waterproof boots worn all day and treat it as solved, because keeping feet warm matters more than drying them regularly

13. While a gang clears an overgrown boundary, a labourer is stung by a wasp, then reports a tight chest, swollen lips and dizziness. He mentioned a known allergy at induction and carries an adrenaline auto-injector. What should his colleagues do?

☐ **A)** Seat him in the cabin with an antihistamine tablet, and call 999 only if the swelling spreads beyond his lips or he worsens within the next hour

☐ **B)** Keep him walking about to stop him fainting, and use the injector only once the ambulance crew arrive and confirm the diagnosis themselves

☐ **C)** Drive him to hospital in a site vehicle with the injector left in his pocket, since a colleague driving would be quicker than an ambulance

☐ **D)** Call 999, help him use the auto-injector, lie him down with legs raised (or sit up if breathless), and use a second dose if no better in five minutes



14. Look at the scene. The foreman says the operative is correctly dressed because he wears a hard hat, face shield, gauntlets and the hi-vis the site rules require. What is the most significant problem with what he is wearing?

☐ **A)** Washing the waistcoat regularly makes it acceptable, because laundering restores the flame resistance of the ordinary polyester fabric used in hi-vis

☐ **B)** The ordinary polyester hi-vis waistcoat can melt or ignite under sparks, so he needs flame-resistant hi-vis garments suited to hot work

☐ **C)** His face shield should be swapped for tinted goggles, because a shield lets sparks reach his eyes from below and goggles seal better around them

☐ **D)** The bright yellow-green colour is the problem, because vivid fabric attracts hot sparks while darker material would shed them more safely

15. On a frosty morning, a gate marshal at a vehicle entrance wears his issued hi-vis waistcoat under a dark padded parka because it is too small to go over it. He says he will unzip the parka if a vehicle approaches. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Swap the parka for a thin jacket so the waistcoat fits over it, since being cold is a matter of comfort that has no bearing on safety

☐ **B)** Provide hi-vis weather clothing, such as a hi-vis coat or larger outer waistcoat, so the conspicuous layer is outside and he stays warm

☐ **C)** Accept the parka if it is clean and has reflective tape on it, since the waistcoat beneath still meets the standard if unzipped in time

☐ **D)** Let him wear the parka and add a bright chest torch, because a lit torch is a recognised substitute for hi-vis clothing at site gates

16. A crew will install pipework in a 1.5 m deep concrete pump sump in a basement slab, reached by stepping over its open edge. The supervisor says the Work at Height Regulations only apply above 2 m, so extra care is enough. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Treat it as work at height with no minimum drop: assess the fall risk and provide edge protection or a secure cover and safe access first

☐ **B)** Apply the regulations only to work done from above ground level, since a place below ground level falls outside the legal definition of height

☐ **C)** Issue harnesses clipped to the existing pipework and skip edge protection, because personal fall protection satisfies the duty at any depth

☐ **D)** Accept the supervisor's view, as falls of under two metres count as slips and trips, so normal housekeeping controls are all that is required

17. A hired 6 m mobile access tower arrives one brace short. The foreman fetches a similar-looking brace from another maker's tower, saying the clips fit and the length is right. The erectors are PASMA-trained. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Use it, because trained erectors can judge a safe fit, and have the finished tower checked at the next inspection afterwards by a competent person

☐ **B)** Do not use the borrowed brace unless compatibility is independently verified and documented; get the correct part from the hire company

☐ **C)** Use it on the lowest lift only, since stresses on bracing are lowest near the base, which makes mixing parts acceptable at that level of the tower

☐ **D)** Use it with a second brace on the opposite face for extra stiffness, as doubling up compensates for any mismatch in the design of the parts

18. A housing-site haul road for loaded dumpers is planned to cross a live gas main and a cable duct laid just below the surface. The plan says operators know where the services run, so no works are needed. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Locate the lines with a cable avoidance tool before each crossing and then allow free travel, since knowing their position

prevents damage to them

☐ **B)** Let dumpers cross anywhere along the line when empty, since lightly loaded wheels cannot damage a service buried just below the surface of the road

☐ **C)** Spread a thin layer of loose spoil over the line and mark it with tape, since a little extra cover is enough to carry the passing vehicles

☐ **D)** Limit crossing to one marked point, agree temporary protection such as plates or a raft with the service owners, and keep vehicles off elsewhere

19. A forklift driver must carry a pallet of kerbs down a short gradient to a lower yard. To see ahead he plans to drive down forwards with the load pointing downhill, then turn on the slope to line up at the bottom. What should the supervisor require?

☐ **A)** Face the forks uphill for the descent, then turn on the slope to line up with the yard, since the gradient is only a short one

☐ **B)** Drive down forwards with the mast tilted fully forward to hold the kerbs on the pallet, because keeping the load in view matters most

☐ **C)** Allow forwards travel down the slope at walking pace, since a low speed removes the stability risk from the load being carried facing downhill

☐ **D)** Reverse down with the forks facing uphill, slowly and with a signaller for view, forks low but clear of the ground, and turn only on level ground

20. A fit-out finishes with 40 unopened, undamaged plasterboard sheets and a heap of clean offcuts. The manager wants the cheapest disposal, with everything going into the general waste skip. Applying the waste hierarchy, what should happen?

☐ **A)** Put everything in the general skip, since the hierarchy only requires that a registered carrier removes the waste and not that it is sorted first

☐ **B)** Return or reuse the unopened sheets first, and send clean offcuts to a plasterboard recycler, kept dry and apart from other waste

☐ **C)** Send the offcuts for energy recovery as the next best option after reuse, since burning board recovers more value than recycling it does

☐ **D)** Tip the offcuts into the timber skip, since both are non-hazardous and the recycling contractor will sort them out later on

21. A sub-contractor is hired for a two-day job fitting glazed roof panels. Its owner, a fitter with thirty years' experience but no assessment training, writes the risk assessment alone without speaking to his two operatives, saying a short job needs little. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** The principal contractor's generic site assessment can stand in for it, since the two operatives will be working under that company's control on site

☐ **B)** A brief assessment is acceptable for jobs of under three days, provided the owner signs it and tells the operatives about the controls on the first morning

☐ **C)** The assessor needs knowledge of the work plus an understanding of risk assessment, and should talk to the people doing the job, however short

☐ **D)** Thirty years of practical experience makes him competent to assess it alone, because nobody understands the hazards of glazing better than the fitter himself

22. A plumber must braze copper pipes in a roof void lined with timber joists and loose fibre insulation, directly above a stock of packaging. A press-fit joint system is available and suits the installation. Which approach best follows the principles for controlling fire risk from hot work?

☐ **A)** Braze as planned with a damp cloth laid over the insulation and an extinguisher on the ladder, since a wet cloth makes the timber and fibre non-combustible

☐ **B)** Soak the joists with a water spray before brazing and let the plumber leave as soon as the torch is out, since wet timber cannot smoulder later

☐ **C)** Use press-fit joints to avoid the flame, and if hot work proves unavoidable, use a permit, shield the timber and insulation, and check the void afterwards

☐ **D)** Braze each joint using the smallest torch flame, with no permit needed because a brief flame under ten minutes cannot ignite roof timbers or insulation

23. Joiners machine large quantities of urea-formaldehyde bonded MDF in a small workshop cabin. The supervisor plans

FFP3 masks for everyone and a window fan. A buyer points out that a no-added-formaldehyde board is available at slightly higher cost. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Keep the cheaper board and open the window wider, since formaldehyde is released from MDF only when the boards are heated or wet, not when cut

☐ **B)** Specify the no-added-formaldehyde board where suitable and connect the machines to local exhaust ventilation, keeping masks as the last line of protection

☐ **C)** Keep the cheaper board and rely on the FFP3 masks, since a tight-fitting respirator removes dust and vapour exposure for every worker in the cabin

☐ **D)** Switch to the alternative board and cut it by hand indoors, since hand tools produce no harmful dust and so need no extraction

24. A joiner with a long-term shoulder condition tells his supervisor that sustained overhead drilling is painful. The supervisor proposes moving him to the gatehouse permanently, saying anyone with that condition should avoid all manual tasks. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Ask him to sign a waiver accepting the pain as a personal risk, then leave his tasks unchanged because he chose to carry on working

☐ **B)** Move him to the gatehouse as proposed, since a blanket restriction for the condition is the safest option and avoids any need to assess him as an individual

☐ **C)** Discuss the specific tasks with him, check the assessment covers him, and try adjustments such as a lighter tool, a platform or task rotation

☐ **D)** Keep him on full duties unless he produces a medical certificate, since the employer has no duty to alter tasks until sickness absence has been recorded

25. Roofers will strip and re-slate a house from a scaffold whose working platform sits 1.2 m below the eaves. It has top rails at 950 mm, intermediate rails and toe boards. The foreman says the rails and toe boards meet the standard. What is the main flaw?

☐ **A)** The roofers should wear harnesses clipped to the roofing battens, which will give the missing protection without any change to the scaffold

☐ **B)** None, because rails at 950 mm with a toe board and intermediate rails are all the standard asks, and platform height relative to the eaves is a matter of convenience

☐ **C)** Debris netting should be fitted over the gap between the scaffold and the eaves, because netting will catch anyone sliding off the lower roof slope

☐ **D)** The platform is too far below the eaves for the rails to stop someone sliding down the slope, so scaffolders should raise it close to the eaves



26. Look at the scene. The painter says he is only on the third step with the spreader bar locked and the floor is clean and level. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The stepladder is too short for the ceiling height, so he should swap to a longer leaning ladder and tie it securely at the top

☐ **B)** The ladder legs are splayed too narrowly on the floor, so a wider stance or a stabilising brace is needed before anyone uses it again

☐ **C)** He is working from the top platform of the stepladder, which should be used only as a handhold, so he ought to stand lower to be stable

☐ **D)** The ladder stands where a door can swing into it and people are passing, with no barrier, door lock-off or lookout protecting the working area

27. Pipelayers dig a 3.5 m deep square pit in firm clay for a new manhole. They plan to dig to full depth, then climb down to fit struts and sheets from inside because the sides look stable. The pit was inspected on Monday. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Fit supports only to the lower half of the pit, since falling soil from above a depth of 2 m is unlikely to injure a person standing below

☐ **B)** Fit support as the pit deepens, or place a system from the

surface, so nobody enters unsupported ground, with inspection at each shift start

☐ **C)** Dig to full depth and then fit supports from inside, because the Monday inspection covers the whole week while the clay remains dry

☐ **D)** Climb down once the clay feels sound, since firm clay stands unsupported for as long as it has not been disturbed by vibration or weather

28. A dry underground attenuation tank, 4 m deep with a single 600 mm access, is to be inspected. The supervisor holds a gas detector at arm's length inside the opening, gets normal readings and declares the space clear for entry. What is wrong with this check?

☐ **A)** Nothing is wrong, because a reading at the opening shows the air throughout the tank, which mixes evenly once the cover has been lifted

☐ **B)** The reading must be repeated by a second person at the opening, since a different operator gives a more reliable result from the same air

☐ **C)** Gases can layer, so readings are needed at several depths, ideally with a long probe from outside before entry, and monitoring should continue during the work

☐ **D)** The reading is valid, but he should also smell the air at the foot of the ladder, since the absence of any smell shows there is no toxic gas

29. A contractor clears small broken asbestos cement fragments from a garage roof. He puts them in one black bin bag, tapes it shut, writes nothing on it and leaves it by the gate for the next general skip. What is wrong?

☐ **A)** A single heavy-duty bag is enough if it is taped shut, because sealing prevents fibres escaping and labels are only needed at the disposal site

☐ **B)** The waste should be double wrapped, typically a red inner bag with asbestos warning labels in a clear outer bag, and stored securely until sent to a licensed site

☐ **C)** Double-bag the fragments in clear polythene and place them in the general rubble skip, since fully wrapped waste no longer counts as hazardous

☐ **D)** Mark the bag "asbestos" in pen and leave it at the gate, since a marked bag will be collected by the council as ordinary household waste

30. A site beside a river keeps forty lidded 20-litre cans of diesel and petrol for pumps on grass 6 m from the bank, under a tarpaulin with a spill kit beside them. The foreman says lids and a kit are enough. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Stand the cans on pallets above likely flood level, as raising them off the ground stops any spilt fuel from reaching the water below

☐ **B)** Leave them where they are, since lidded containers cannot leak and a spill kit within reach satisfies the guidance on storing fuel close to water

☐ **C)** Keep the cans in place but add a silt fence between the store and the bank, which will filter out any fuel leaving the area

☐ **D)** Move the store at least 10 m from the river onto an impermeable surface in trays or a bund that holds a spill, locked and labelled

31. A site manager says the Health and Safety at Work Act is the only real law, that regulations such as the Work at Height Regulations are just HSE opinion, and that HSE guidance leaflets are binding on everyone. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Regulations and guidance carry the same legal force as the Act itself, so any departure from the wording of an HSE leaflet is a criminal offence in its own right

☐ **B)** Regulations bind only employers with five or more staff, and guidance becomes law once the employer has been handed a copy of the relevant leaflet by an HSE inspector

☐ **C)** Only the Act creates offences, regulations are enforced through civil claims alone, and guidance must be followed to the letter on every single job to avoid prosecution

☐ **D)** Regulations are made under the Act and breaching them is an offence, whereas HSE guidance is optional and a different method that meets the law is allowed

32. A shopping centre owner lets a lift contractor's engineers reach a rooftop motor room across a roof with an unguarded edge, which the owner knows about. He says the engineers are the contractor's employees, so their safety is not his concern. What is the position?

☐ **A)** As the person controlling the premises he owes duties for

safe access and plant so far as reasonably practicable, and must share risk information

☐ **B)** A signed contract passing responsibility for the work to the lift firm ends the owner's duty for the access route, even where the edge protection is missing altogether

☐ **C)** The duty rests with the contractor as the engineers' employer, and the owner only has to warn them verbally about the roof edge if they happen to ask about it

☐ **D)** Premises duties protect only people the owner employs, so a roof used by outside contractors falls outside his responsibility whatever he knows about the unguarded edge

33. A contractor will core-drill 150 mm holes through a first-floor slab for new ducts above a working office. The risk assessment names only the drill operator as at risk and gives 'wear PPE' as the control. Which improvement is most important?

☐ **A)** Name the staff below as exposed, scan the slab for reinforcement and services, and cordon off the area underneath before any drilling begins

☐ **B)** Keep PPE as the main control but add a second operative to watch the drill, since the office staff are outside the contractor's work area

☐ **C)** Add only a dust and slurry control, because falling cores and hidden cables in the slab are matters for the rig manufacturer rather than for the assessment

☐ **D)** Ask the office manager to tell staff to avoid their desks, because the occupier's own rules cover anyone who is not employed by the drilling contractor

34. Floor finishers power-float a ground-floor slab in a closed-up building using a petrol-engined float, with doors shut to slow the drying. By mid-afternoon two have headaches, nausea and drowsiness, which they blame on a long day. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Swap to a half-mask with organic vapour cartridges, as these remove the exhaust gases from the air the finishers are breathing

☐ **B)** Suspect carbon monoxide from the engine, get them into fresh air for medical advice, and switch to electric tools or extract the exhaust outdoors

☐ **C)** Open one door a little and resume when the symptoms ease, since a single opening dilutes the exhaust enough for the float to keep running

☐ **D)** Treat it as heat and tiredness, so allow water and rest breaks and carry on with the petrol float once the finishers put on disposable dust masks

35. A 'Danger: hot work' sign has hung on a stair door for a week since the welding ended, while a new floor opening on the same landing has only a 'Warning: floor opening' sign propped against it. The supervisor says the two signs cover both hazards. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Both signs should stay, because an extra sign does no harm and the opening sign meets the duty provided it is large and placed where it can be easily seen

☐ **B)** Both signs should be swapped for red and white tape, which is a recognised legal alternative to safety signs and is much quicker to renew on a busy landing

☐ **C)** The hot work sign should go because it now misleads people, and the opening needs a cover or guardrail, as signs do not replace physical controls

☐ **D)** The hot work sign should go, but a sign alone is enough for the opening because only a few trades are using that landing this week

36. Two fitters want to clip their harness lanyards to one anchor plate bolted to a steel purlin. The plate is marked for a single user. The supervisor says a fall by both at once is unlikely, so sharing is fine. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Sharing is acceptable because the chance of both falling together is small, and the energy absorbers on the lanyards would share the load between the two users

☐ **B)** Sharing is fine provided both fitters keep their lanyards short, because a short lanyard cuts the fall distance and so halves the force on the plate

☐ **C)** Each anchor must be strong enough for the loads expected, so a one-user anchor suits one person unless a competent person confirms more users

☐ **D)** The marking is guidance for the installer only, and workers may clip on once the plate has been bolted to a structural steel member

37. A newly laid 150 mm water main is to be pressure tested with

compressed air to save water. The gang plans to stand beside the pipe ends while the test runs. A senior engineer objects. What is the main reason for the objection?

☐ **A)** Air tests take longer than water tests, so the gang would be exposed to the pipe for more of the day than necessary

☐ **B)** Air cannot find leaks as well as water, so the main would need re-testing, and that is mainly a cost issue

☐ **C)** Compressed air is a flammable gas, so the test needs a hot work permit and a fire watch for the duration of the test

☐ **D)** Air stores far more energy than water, so a failure can throw parts violently; hydraulic testing is safer or exclusion zones are needed



38. Look at the scene. The driver holds a valid operator card and is travelling at walking pace. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The driver should sound the horn continuously, because an audible warning makes a shared route safe when the load hides the way ahead

☐ **B)** The heaped skip blocks the driver's forward view while a pedestrian walks unsegregated on the same route directly ahead of the machine

☐ **C)** The skip is loaded above its rim, so spilled brick and soil on the route is the main concern at walking pace, and the pedestrian is a lesser one

☐ **D)** The pedestrian needs gloves and eye protection, because personal protective equipment is what protects people who walk near dumpers moving slowly

39. A mobile crane lifts a 6 m precast beam. As it rises, a steelfixer with no slinger training loops the tag line round his wrist to stop the spin and stands under the swing path. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** He should be stopped; a trained slinger-signaller should steer the load with tag lines held clear of the body, from outside its path

☐ **B)** Wrapping gives better grip, so it is acceptable provided he wears gloves and a second person stands beside him to share the pull on the line

☐ **C)** Tag lines should not be used because they bring people near the load, so the operator should steady the beam by slewing against the spin

☐ **D)** His method is acceptable if the line is kept short, since a short line gives the closest control of a rotating beam while it is being lifted

40. After wet-cutting a floor slab inside a building, a contractor collects the grey slurry in buckets and wants to tip it down a site toilet, reasoning that it is only water and cement dust and the sewage works will cope. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** It can be spread thinly on the access road to bind the dust, since the cement sets hard and nothing then reaches any drain or watercourse

☐ **B)** It can go down the building's rainwater downpipe, because that pipe is separate from the sewage system and therefore carries no sewage at all

☐ **C)** The foul drain is the right place for the liquid once it has been diluted about ten times with tap water, and only the solids need to go in a skip

☐ **D)** Contaminated wash water needs the water company's permission to enter the foul sewer, so collect and settle it and dispose of the solids as waste

41. A joiner sees a basement ceiling prop buckle and a crack open above his head. He leaves the area and refuses to return until it is checked. The engineer later finds the load was not critical, and the contractor docks his pay and issues a warning. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** He is protected if the danger proves real, because the law judges his belief by what the engineer later found rather than by what he saw at the time

☐ **B)** The employer may deduct pay because work stopped, since the right to leave dangerous work belongs to appointed safety representatives acting for the whole site

☐ **C)** He is protected if his belief in serious, imminent danger was reasonable, even though the engineer found otherwise, so the deduction and warning may be unlawful

☐ **D)** He should have obtained a supervisor's permission first, because leaving a work area without authority is a breach of contract that no statutory protection can override

42. Over six weeks a site log records seven near-hits, five involving pedestrians stepping into a dumper route through the same gap in the fencing beside the welfare cabins. The manager plans to speak to each driver and file the log. What is the best use of this information?

☐ **A)** Treat the five as a pattern pointing to one shared cause, review the assessment and layout at that gap, then brief every contractor

☐ **B)** Reassess the route for each dumper driver separately, since individual behaviour is the likely common cause and group changes should wait for an injury

☐ **C)** Brief the drivers involved on awareness and revisit the assessment if an actual injury occurs, since near-hits without harm carry no weight in reviewing risk

☐ **D)** Add a warning sign at the gap and close the log entries, because a sign is the cheapest control and the pattern shows pedestrians ignored the rules

43. Operatives repair a quay wall beside a tidal river, working from a pontoon with no lifebuoy on site. A labourer slips into the water, surfaces and shouts. A colleague wants to dive in after him. What is the best planning and response?

☐ **A)** Wait for the labourer to swim to the bank by himself, since he has surfaced, and call 999 only if he goes under again

☐ **B)** Fetch a rope from the van and tie it to the colleague so he can wade in from the quay edge and drag the labourer out

☐ **C)** Let the colleague dive in at once, because the quickest rescue is a swimmer, and cold water is dangerous only after several minutes

☐ **D)** Provide throwable rescue equipment and a rescue plan beforehand, then throw a lifebuoy and call 999, without anyone entering the water

44. Air sampling shows a floor sealer applicator's exposure to a xylene-based solvent is well below its workplace exposure limit, which carries an 'Sk' notation. He works in thin disposable gloves with solvent-splashed forearms, and the supervisor says no further control is needed. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The limit already includes an allowance for skin uptake, so wearing any glove satisfies the duty without a check that the material resists the solvent

☐ **B)** Air results below the limit show the whole dose is controlled, so skin controls are optional extras that matter unless a rash appears

☐ **C)** The Sk notation warns that skin absorption can add to the dose, so air results cannot show adequate control and skin contact must be prevented too

☐ **D)** Skin exposure counts if the product is labelled corrosive, so the Sk notation is a labelling point for the supplier rather than a duty for the employer

45. A crew repairing a foul sewer cleans up with the van's alcohol gel before lunch. One man vomited and had diarrhoea overnight, but feels better and wants to return the next morning, twelve hours after his last symptoms. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Allow his return on lighter duties away from the sewer, because the infection spreads through sewage contact and keeping him from the sewer protects colleagues

☐ **B)** Keep him off site until he has been symptom-free for 48 hours, and provide soap, running water and a clean eating area rather than relying on gel

☐ **C)** Allow his return, as twelve symptom-free hours is enough once he uses the alcohol gel, since gel kills the viruses behind sewage-related stomach bugs

☐ **D)** Keep him off site for 48 hours but accept alcohol gel as the crew's handwashing method, as gel is quicker and copes with visible dirt on the hands

46. A roofer's harness webbing is caked with cement slurry and bitumen smears. Overnight he scrubs it with a strong solvent cleaner and bleach, dries it on a cabin heater and plans to use it again. His colleague says it looks cleaner than ever. What is the main concern?

☐ **A)** Solvents, bleach and direct heat can weaken webbing and stitching without showing, so it should be cleaned per the maker's instructions and checked before use

☐ **B)** The harness must go to a competent person for a formal

thorough examination each time it is washed, because cleaning resets its examination interval

☐ **C)** The risk comes from the heater, since bleach and solvents rinse out of polyester completely, so air drying indoors would have made the harness fit for use

☐ **D)** The harness is now in better condition, because strong cleaning removes contamination that hides damage and heat drying prevents mildew in the fabric



47. Look at the scene. The operative says his visor, ear defenders and safety boots mean he has all the protection a petrol brushcutter needs. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** His ear defenders are clipped to a hard hat and will not seal against his head, so he needs foam earplugs worn instead for brushcutter noise

☐ **B)** His hi-vis vest could snag in the cutting head, so it should be removed while he works with the machine beside the fence

☐ **C)** His lower legs are bare, so thrown stones or the cutting head could injure them; he needs protective trousers or leg guards

☐ **D)** His mesh visor is the wrong type for flying stones, so he needs sealed chemical goggles worn in place of it for the whole task

48. A concrete slab is propped from below by falsework. The slab has been cast for five days and the programme is slipping. The foreman wants the props struck today because the concrete has gone hard to the touch. What is needed before striking?

☐ **A)** The temporary works coordinator must confirm the concrete strength and the striking sequence in writing, and only authorised people do it

☐ **B)** Nothing more, because hardness to the touch shows the slab is strong enough, and the foreman may order the props out

☐ **C)** Removal of every prop at once to avoid uneven loads, with the gang standing clear of the slab edge as a precaution

☐ **D)** A count of five days, because five days after pouring is a fixed legal minimum before any falsework can be removed

49. A 110 V transformer in the compound feeds a 3 kW mixer motor through several long, thin reels 90 m away. The motor hums, starts slowly and the cable feels warm. The operator suggests fitting an RCD to cure it. What explains the fault, and what is the sensible fix?

☐ **A)** An RCD limits overload current as well as earth leakage, so fitting one at the transformer would stop the motor drawing excess current in the cable

☐ **B)** Warm thin cable shows the supply is under-rated, so switching the mixer to a 230 V socket on the same reels would halve the current and clear the fault

☐ **C)** Voltage drops along long, thin cable at high current, so the motor overheats; move the transformer near the work and use heavier cable

☐ **D)** Joining another reel in series will lower the resistance of the circuit, because more copper carries the current and gives the motor a stronger supply

50. A mobile crane will lift a 3.4 t precast unit from a lorry at 8 m radius and set it at 13 m. The chart shows capacity before deducting 0.4 t of slings and hook block: 4.5 t at 8 m and 3.6 t at 13 m. The operator says the unit weighs less than both. Is the lift acceptable?

☐ **A)** No, the unit plus 0.4 t of accessories is 3.8 t, above the 3.6 t chart value at the largest radius, so it must be re-planned

☐ **B)** No, though it becomes acceptable if the operator travels the load slowly, since low speed reduces the dynamic load that the chart assumes

☐ **C)** Yes, because the lift starts at 8 m where the chart allows 4.5 t, and capacity needs checking where the load is first raised

☐ **D)** Yes, because the unit weighs less than the chart value at both the pick-up and set-down radii, and the slings are covered by the crane's safety margin

Answer Key

1. D — Section 20 of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act lets an inspector require answers and a signed declaration, but section 20(7) bars those answers from being used in evidence against that person or their spouse or civil partner.

A: An inspector's power to require answers is statutory and does not depend on a notice, so the police right to silence does not apply here. B: The statute prevents these answers being used against him, and refusing to sign the declaration is itself a failure to comply with the requirement. C: He may nominate a person to be present, but the inspector does not need the employer's agreement and a solicitor is not a condition of answering.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that talking to an HSE inspector carries the same risk of self-incrimination as being interviewed under police caution.

2. A — Employers must assess risks to other people affected by their undertaking, so a tour needs its own controls, including route, PPE, briefing and escort, rather than relying on a jacket alone.

B: An insurer does not carry the legal duty, which stays with the contractor controlling the site and extends beyond its own employees. C: There is no time threshold, and a short visit by untrained people to a live site can expose them to serious hazards. D: A duty to people not in your employment cannot be signed away, so a waiver does not replace assessment and control of the risks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that risk assessments only need to cover your own workers and that visitors can be managed with a hi-vis jacket and an escort.

3. A — Preventing further exposure comes first, so stopping, evacuating and restricting access stops fibres spreading before competent people assess and clean up using proper methods.

B: Moving air carries fibres to other areas, and staying in the room keeps people exposed to possible contamination. C: Brushing and a paper mask disturb and fail to filter fibres, so untrained clean-up spreads contamination and exposes the cleaner. D: Shaking out clothing releases fibres into the air and onto other people, and work must not resume until the area is assessed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Rushing to clean up suspected asbestos dust yourself rather than stopping, clearing the area and reporting it.

4. C — An alarm must be treated as a real fire until the cause is confirmed, so re-entry waits for an authorised all-clear, and silencing the sounder does not remove the possible danger.

A: A fixed waiting time is not a safety check, and smoke and fire can spread to any level without being seen. B: Silencing a sounder says nothing about the cause, and a fire can be developing out of sight in a void or store. D: Re-entry needs one coordinated decision by the person in charge, not separate judgements made by several firms without checking the cause.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a silenced fire alarm as proof that there is no fire.

5. C — Under COSHH a natural or traditional material can still be harmful, and lime is alkaline, so the assessment follows the data sheet and sets controls for dust, skin and eyes.

A: Controls must be in place before exposure, and waiting for harm to appear reverses the purpose of the COSHH assessment. B: Wet lime can burn or irritate skin and should be removed promptly, so leaving it on exposed arms for a shift is not acceptable. D: Lime is strongly alkaline and can damage eyes and skin, so a dust mask does nothing for the splash and contact risks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a natural or traditional building material must be safer than a modern one.

6. D — The Manual Handling Operations Regulations require hazardous handling to be avoided where reasonably practicable, then assessed and reduced, so training alone is the weakest control.

A: Guideline figures are not safe limits, and repeated carrying up four flights adds fatigue and a fall risk that a single-trip rule ignores. B: The site can order smaller tubs, change delivery points or use a hoist, and rotation does not reduce the risk in the task itself. C: Technique does not remove the load, the stairs or the repetition, and training sits below avoidance and reduction in the order of controls.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that training in lifting technique is enough, instead of first trying to remove or reduce the load.

7. C — Controlling people below by physical segregation protects against falling objects and MEWP movement, while a ground person provides supervision and rescue backup that cones and shouting cannot.

A: Cones are easily crossed or moved, and an operator concentrating on the task above cannot reliably watch the whole area below. B: Even small items gain energy in an 8 m drop and can seriously injure someone, so bagging tools alone does not remove the risk to those below. D: Fewer people lowers the chance of harm but does not

control it, and anyone arriving early could still walk under the work.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on cones, signs or warnings to keep the public out from beneath overhead work.

8. A — Operators have been crushed between an overhead obstruction and the basket controls, and a trained person at the base controls can lower the platform quickly in an emergency.

B: Overhead drilling carries ergonomic and dropped-object risks, but these are minor compared with entrapment against the structure. C: Clipping to the basket anchor is normal practice for a boom MEWP and is not the most serious hazard in the scene. D: A boom MEWP of this type on firm level concrete does not need outriggers to be used safely, and the operator's movement within the basket is not the main danger.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a harness and intact guardrails make a MEWP basket safe, when the structure overhead can crush the operator.

9. A — A buried tank is not designed to take trench thrust and may hold residues, so independent supports are needed and ignition sources must be controlled until its contents are known.

B: A drained tank can still hold residue and vapour, and draining does not make the shell suitable as a support. C: A tank gives no guaranteed shielding, and the soil above and beside it can still collapse onto people working in the trench. D: A tank is not designed to carry trench loads, and corrosion not visible from the outside can still allow it to buckle or leak.

COMMON MISTAKE: Using a nearby buried object as a convenient trench support, or treating an empty tank as automatically safe.

10. B — The user of work equipment must make sure operators have the information, instruction and training they need, which includes the machine's actual control layout, not just general experience.

A: Experience on a different control pattern can lead to wrong movements, which is a serious danger when working near people. C: Placing a person beside a working machine exposes him to danger and does not replace proper familiarisation. D: The hirer remains responsible for making sure its own operator is competent on the specific machine in use.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a short handover from the hire firm or general experience means an operator is ready to use a particular machine.

11. D — Under the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations, an employer must appoint competent persons to assist him, choosing a suitable employee in preference to someone from outside, and appointing an adviser never transfers the employer's own duties.

A: No personal qualification is required of the owner, and competence is judged on training, experience, knowledge and other qualities. B: An adviser only assists the employer, who keeps the legal responsibility for health and safety however capable the consultancy is. C: The regulations require a suitable employee to be appointed in preference to an outsider, not the other way round.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that hiring a safety consultant hands the employer's legal responsibility over to the consultant.

12. B — Long exposure of the feet to cold and wet damages nerves and tissue, so he needs prompt dry conditions and medical advice, and the site must remove the cause by fixing footwear and drying arrangements.

A: Numb, chilled tissue is easily damaged by rubbing or fierce heat, so warming must be gentle and followed by medical advice. C: Tissue and nerve damage can persist or worsen after the pain eases, and the wet conditions causing it would be unchanged. D: Sealed boots hold sweat and water against the skin, so feet still need regular drying and clean dry socks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Dismissing numb, swollen, painful feet after long wet shifts as ordinary tiredness that will pass.

13. D — These are signs of anaphylaxis, where adrenaline and an immediate 999 call matter most, and a second auto-injector is used if there is no improvement after five minutes.

A: Anaphylaxis can worsen within minutes, and an antihistamine is no substitute for adrenaline and an immediate emergency call. B: Standing or walking can cause collapse, and adrenaline must be given promptly rather than held back for confirmation. C: Treatment is delayed and he may deteriorate unattended, so 999 should be called and adrenaline given where he is.

COMMON MISTAKE: Waiting to see whether swelling and breathing trouble settle instead of calling 999 and giving adrenaline straight away.

14. B — Standard synthetic hi-vis fabric melts and burns when sparks land on it, so garments worn for cutting must be flame resistant while still keeping the wearer conspicuous.

A: Washing does not give ordinary polyester flame-resistant properties, and the material would still melt under sparks. C: A face

shield protects more of the face than goggles, and eye protection is not where the picture shows the gap. D: Sparks are not drawn to colour, and it is the fibre and its treatment that decide whether fabric ignites or melts.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that any hi-vis garment that meets the site rule is also suitable for hot work.

15. B — Cold-weather clothing should either carry suitable hi-vis features or be worn under the hi-vis garment, and the employer must supply items that fit and work in the conditions.

A: Cold affects alertness and the employer should provide suitable clothing for the weather as well as for visibility. C: A garment hidden under a dark coat does not make him visible, and relying on him unzipping in time puts the control on a split-second action. D: A torch is not equivalent to conspicuous garments that are visible from all sides and in all light conditions.

COMMON MISTAKE: Letting workers cover their hi-vis with bulky coats because the issued vest does not fit over them.

16. A — The regulations cover any place, including at or below ground level, from which a person could fall a distance liable to cause injury, so a 1.5 m sump is covered and needs planned protection.

B: The definition expressly includes places at or below ground level, so a sump or pit is covered. C: Collective measures such as edge protection or covers come before personal protection, and installed pipework is not a tested anchor. D: There is no two-metre threshold, and the duty applies wherever a fall could cause personal injury.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that falls only matter above a fixed height such as two metres.

17. B — Tower components from different manufacturers are normally not compatible even if they appear to fit, so mixing is acceptable only where compatibility has been independently verified and documented.

A: A part fitting physically does not prove it is designed to work with the system, and an inspection cannot verify design compatibility. C: There is no low-level exception, and a mismatched brace can still alter how the whole tower resists racking. D: Extra parts do not prove compatibility and can create loads and spacings that the manufacturer never designed for.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that scaffold components from different makers are interchangeable if they physically fit together.

18. D — Vehicle crossings over buried services should be kept to a minimum at marked places with temporary protection agreed with the owners, because shallow services are easily damaged by wheel loads.

A: Locating a service shows where it is but does nothing to protect it from the weight of passing vehicles. B: An empty dumper is still heavy, shallow services are vulnerable, and crossings should be restricted to protected places. C: Loose spoil gives no controlled load spreading and tape only marks the position without protecting the service.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that knowing where a buried service lies is the same as protecting it from vehicle loads.

19. D — With a load, the forks should face uphill on a gradient to keep the load stable, travel should be slow with the forks lowered but clear of the ground, and turning on a slope risks overturning.

A: Turning on a slope risks overturning however short the gradient, so the turn must be made on level ground. B: Tilting forward on a descent lets the load slide off and moves the centre of gravity towards the front wheels. C: Slow speed does not cure a load carried facing downhill, which can still slide or tip the truck forward.

COMMON MISTAKE: Putting a clear view ahead before the load's position on a gradient.

20. B — The waste hierarchy puts prevention and reuse before recycling, and plasterboard must be segregated so it can be recycled and kept out of landfill with biodegradable waste.

A: The hierarchy requires reasonable steps to prevent, reuse and recycle waste before it is disposed of. C: Recycling ranks above energy recovery in the hierarchy, and plasterboard is not suitable for burning. D: Gypsum contaminates timber recycling, and plasterboard must be kept apart from biodegradable waste.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the cheapest skip as the compliant option because a licensed carrier collects it.

21. C — Competence means enough training, knowledge and experience for the task in hand, and assessments must reflect how the work is really done, so involving the operatives matters on a short job as much as a long one.

A: A generic site document cannot cover the specific hazards of the sub-contractor's own task, so the employer must still assess its own work. B: The duty to assess does not depend on how long a job lasts, and a briefing after the event does not replace gathering their input beforehand. D: Task experience does not by itself give the skill to identify hazards systematically, rank risks and record controls, and it ignores what the operatives can add.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that years of practical experience, or the shortness of a job, can stand in for assessment skills and input from the people doing the work.

22. C — The best control is to remove the ignition source by using a cold method, and only where that is impossible should hot work go ahead under a permit with shielding and a check after the work.

A: A damp cloth soon dries and does not make the fuel non-combustible, and relying on an extinguisher ignores the option of avoiding the flame altogether. B: Wet surfaces dry quickly and insulation can smoulder unseen, so leaving at once without any check afterwards risks a delayed fire. D: Small or brief flames still ignite dry timber and fibre, and no time threshold removes the need to control hot work properly.

COMMON MISTAKE: Jumping straight to permits and extinguishers without first asking whether the hot work can be avoided with a cold method.

23. B — Substituting a less hazardous material and capturing dust at source come before respirators in the control hierarchy, and MDF dust from machining remains harmful whichever binder is used.

A: Machining MDF releases dust carrying formaldehyde, so general airflow from a window is not a proper control. C: Respirators are the last resort, depend on fit and a clean-shaven face, and do not remove the need to substitute or extract at source. D: Hand cutting and sanding still create wood dust that can harm the lungs, so extraction is still needed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating respirators and open windows as the main control and overlooking cheaper-to-fix options at the source.

24. C — Disabilities affect people differently, so employers should talk to the worker, assess the real tasks and make reasonable adjustments rather than apply blanket restrictions.

A: Employer duties under health and safety and equality law cannot be signed away by the worker. B: Blanket restrictions based on assumptions can be unnecessary and discriminatory, because symptoms and abilities vary between individuals. D: The duty to consider adjustments arises once the employer knows of the problem, and does not wait for a certificate or absence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that everyone with the same condition needs the same restriction, instead of asking the individual what the real task demands.

25. D — Eaves guidance expects the platform to be within about 300 mm of the eaves, and no more than 450 mm in some cases, otherwise rails sit too low to catch a roofer who slips.

A: Loose battens and slates are unreliable anchors, and this swaps a collective measure for a weaker personal one. B: The rails only work if the platform height relates properly to the eaves, which here leaves the roof edge above the protection. C: Debris netting is meant for catching small falling items and is not designed or tested to stop a falling person.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking rail heights and toe boards in isolation without asking where the platform sits relative to the roof edge.

26. D — A ladder in a doorway or traffic route can be struck by an opening door or a passing load, so the area should be guarded or the door secured before work starts.

A: The task is light work within reach from the third step, and swapping to a leaning ladder would not address the door and passers-by. B: The spreader bar is locked and the floor is level, so stability of the ladder itself is not the weakness shown. C: He is on the third step, not the top platform, so this does not describe the picture.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking only the ladder and the person on it, and forgetting doors, traffic and other people around the work area.

27. B — No ground can be relied on to stand unsupported, so support must go in before people enter, and a competent person must inspect at the start of each shift and after any event.

A: Collapse from any height can bury or crush a worker, so there is no safe depth for leaving the sides partly unsupported. C: Inspection is required at the start of each working shift and after events affecting stability, not once a week. D: No ground can be relied on to stand unsupported in all circumstances, so appearance and feel do not make entry safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging an excavation safe by how firm the ground looks rather than by what supports it and when it was last inspected.

28. C — Heavier and lighter gases collect at different levels, so a reading at the opening may not represent the air where people will work, and conditions can change during the task.

A: Air in a deep enclosed space does not necessarily mix, and gas pockets can persist at the bottom or the roof. B: Repeating the same flawed sampling point does not fix it, because the problem is where the sample is taken, not who takes it. D: Many dangerous gases are

odourless, and some deaden the sense of smell, so smell is not a safe test.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a single reading taken at the opening as proof that the whole space is safe to breathe.

29. B — Asbestos waste must be double wrapped and labelled so that fibres stay contained and handlers know what it is, then kept secure and sent only to a licensed disposal site.

A: A single bag can split and unlabelled waste can be handled unknowingly, so double wrapping and labelling are needed from the start. C: Wrapping does not change the hazardous nature of asbestos waste, which must not be mixed with general waste. D: Asbestos waste is not accepted as household rubbish and needs proper packaging and a licensed disposal route.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a taped bag or a quick pen mark is enough packaging for asbestos waste.

30. D — Fuel stores should be sited at least 10 m from watercourses on a sealed surface with secondary containment, because a spill kit only helps after fuel has already escaped.

A: Height off the ground does not contain a spill, and fuel running off pallets would still flow across grass towards the river. B: Lids do not stop leaks from damage or knocks, and a spill kit is a response measure that does not provide containment or distance. C: A silt fence traps soil particles, not oil or fuel, so it gives no real protection against a fuel spill.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on a spill kit and lids as the main protection instead of distance and containment.

31. D — Regulations have full legal force under section 33 of the Act, whereas HSE guidance is advice that normally demonstrates compliance but may be replaced by an alternative that still meets the legal duty.

A: Guidance is not compulsory, so departing from it is not itself an offence if the law is still met. B: Regulations apply regardless of headcount, and handing over guidance does not turn it into law. C: Contravening health and safety regulations is itself a criminal offence, and guidance can be replaced by an equivalent method.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that only the Act counts as law, or that every HSE leaflet is a legal command.

32. A — Section 4 of the Act covers non-employees using non-domestic premises as a place of work, extends to anyone with any control of them, and is supported by the duty to cooperate and coordinate with other employers.

B: A contract cannot remove a statutory duty tied to the owner's control of the access and premises. C: The owner's own duty arises from his control of the premises and cannot be reduced to answering questions. D: The premises duty is specifically owed to people who are not the controller's employees.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that only the employer of a worker has legal duties towards that worker's safety.

33. A — A suitable assessment considers everyone who could be harmed, including people below, and uses physical controls such as scanning and exclusion zones ahead of PPE.

B: A second watcher does nothing to protect people below, who remain unassessed. C: Dropped cores and drilling into hidden services are foreseeable hazards that the assessment must cover. D: The contractor must plan and control the risk it creates and cannot hand it to the occupier.

COMMON MISTAKE: Listing only the people doing the work when the assessment should cover everyone the work could harm.

34. B — Carbon monoxide gives flu-like symptoms, cannot be seen or smelt, and is best prevented by avoiding petrol equipment indoors unless ventilation has been properly assessed.

A: Vapour cartridges do not remove carbon monoxide, so the exposure would continue. C: Ventilation must be assessed and is rarely adequate indoors, and a single opening gives no assurance. D: Dust masks do nothing to stop carbon monoxide, and the symptoms point to exhaust gas.

COMMON MISTAKE: Putting headaches and drowsiness down to tiredness instead of suspecting exhaust fumes from petrol equipment.

35. C — A sign must be removed when the situation ceases to exist, and signs warn only of significant risk that remains after other controls have been applied.

A: A sign for a finished hazard misleads people, and a sign cannot stand in for a cover or guardrail. B: Tape is not a substitute for a physical barrier or for a compliant safety sign. D: The number of people exposed does not remove the need to guard a fall hazard.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a safety sign as a control in its own right rather than a warning of risk that remains after other controls.

36. C — The Work at Height Regulations require every anchor and its connection to withstand foreseeable loads, and the marked user number reflects what the anchor was designed and tested to carry.

A: Likelihood does not change the rated capacity, and absorbers do not reduce the load on the anchor to a shareable level. B: Shortening the lanyard does not turn a one-user anchor into a two-user anchor. D: The marking tells users the number of people the anchor was designed for, and being fixed to steel does not override it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging an anchor by how solid it looks instead of by what it is rated and marked to carry.

37. D — Compressed air is compressible and stores energy that is released suddenly in a failure, so water testing is preferred or people must be kept clear with restrained ends.

A: The duration is not the main hazard; the stored energy is. B: The objection concerns safety, not test accuracy. C: Compressed air is not flammable and no hot work permit applies.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a compressed air test as equal in safety to a water test.

38. B — Loads must not obstruct the driver's view, and vehicles and pedestrians should be kept apart, because a driver who cannot see ahead cannot avoid someone in the path.

A: A horn does not restore the driver's view, and a pedestrian carrying a long timber with his head down may not react. C: Spillage matters, but the loss of forward view with a person in the path is the dominant hazard. D: PPE does not prevent being struck by a vehicle whose driver cannot see ahead.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a vehicle task safe because the driver is licensed and slow, without checking what he can actually see.

39. A — Lifting is controlled by trained people, tag lines are a normal way of controlling rotation, and operatives must stay clear of the load and its tag lines because wrapped lines can drag people up.

B: Gloves and a second person do not remove the risk of being dragged off the ground. C: Tag lines are a standard control, and slewing against a spin can make the load swing more. D: Wrapping a line round the body is dangerous at any length, and he is also untrained and standing in the swing path.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a hand or a wrapped line is a fine way to steady a suspended load if the person is strong enough.

40. D — Businesses need the water company's consent to discharge contaminated water to foul sewer, and settled solids are waste that must be consigned lawfully.

A: Slurry on a road is washed into drains by rain and is still an unpermitted disposal. B: Rainwater pipes usually lead to surface water or a watercourse, where alkaline slurry causes pollution. C: Dilution does not replace the need for consent, and cement slurry remains a polluting discharge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming cement slurry is harmless because it is only water, sand and cement, and that any drain will do.

41. C — Employment law protects a worker who leaves or refuses to return to a place of work in circumstances they reasonably believed to be serious and imminent danger, and the test is the reasonableness of that belief, not what is found afterwards.

A: The test is whether his belief was reasonable when he formed it, so a later finding that the load was not critical does not remove protection. B: The protection applies to individual workers, not just to representatives, and is not removed by a general loss of working time. D: The protection exists precisely so that a worker need not wait for authority before moving away from reasonably perceived serious danger.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a worker who walks away from a danger is only safe from discipline if the danger is later proved to have been real.

42. A — Repeated near-hits at one location suggest the existing controls may no longer be valid, which calls for a review of the assessment and layout and for sharing the outcome with everyone affected.

B: Five events at one location point to a system or layout cause, not to five individual lapses. C: A review is triggered when there is reason to suspect an assessment is no longer valid, which repeated near-hits supply without waiting for harm. D: A sign is a weak control that ranks below physical separation, and blaming pedestrians ignores the shared cause.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating each near-hit as a separate event to be dealt with person by person instead of looking for the pattern across the log.

43. D — Water rescue kit and a plan should be in place before work starts; throwing a line or buoy and calling for help avoids a second casualty from cold water shock.

A: He may be affected by cold water, so help and rescue equipment are needed straight away. B: Sending a person into the water on a rope is dangerous without training and equipment. C: Cold water shock can overcome a rescuer within seconds, so entering the water risks a second casualty.

COMMON MISTAKE: Planning to rescue a person from water by entering it, rather than by throwing equipment and calling for help.

44. C — A skin notation means the substance can be absorbed through the skin enough to matter, so a good air result does not prove control and skin exposure must be assessed and controlled separately.

A: Limits cover inhaled air only, and gloves must be chosen for resistance to the specific solvent, not just worn. B: Absorption through intact skin can raise the body's dose with no rash, which is exactly what the notation warns about. D: The notation concerns systemic absorption by any route, and it informs the employer's own COSHH assessment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a below-limit air reading as proof that a solvent is under control when it can also pass through the skin.

45. B — Stomach bugs spread easily by the faecal-oral route and alcohol gel does not kill norovirus, so exclusion for two days after symptoms stop and proper soap-and-water washing both matter.

A: He can still spread infection through shared surfaces, tools, food and the cabin, regardless of where he works. C: Gel does not kill norovirus and twelve hours is too short, as people stay infectious after symptoms stop. D: Gel is ineffective on visibly soiled hands and against norovirus, so it cannot replace soap and running water.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming hand gel and a few symptom-free hours are enough protection against stomach bugs in sewer work.

46. A — Harness fibres are degraded by harsh chemicals and heat in ways the eye cannot detect, so manufacturer cleaning and drying instructions must be followed and the harness inspected before it is used.

B: Thorough examination follows a set interval or specific events and is separate from the user's pre-use check, and cleaning does not restart it. C: Bleach and solvents can also degrade the fibres, and any harness cleaned against the maker's instructions needs inspection before use. D: Appearance is no guide to strength, and the harsh chemicals and heat may have caused the very damage that cannot be seen.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a harness by how clean it looks instead of by how it was cleaned and then checked.

47. C — A brushcutter throws stones and debris at ground level and the cutting head can strike the legs, so legs need protective trousers or guards in addition to visor, hearing and foot protection.

A: Hat-mounted defenders suit this task, and replacing them with earplugs would not address the visible gap in protection. B: A close-fitting hi-vis vest is not the main hazard, and removing it would reduce visibility to plant working nearby. D: A mesh visor is the usual face protection for brushcutting, and goggles would not give the same coverage against debris.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that protecting the head, ears and feet means the whole body is covered when a machine throws debris at leg height.

48. A — Falsework should be struck only when the designer's criteria are met and the temporary works coordinator has permitted it, since concrete that feels hard may not carry its load.

B: Hardness to the touch does not prove the concrete has gained design strength. C: Striking all together without a planned sequence can overload the slab and cause collapse. D: No fixed number of days applies; it depends on strength and design.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging concrete to be ready for striking by touch or by the number of days since casting.

49. C — Resistance rises with cable length and falls with conductor size, and at 110 V the current for a given power is higher, so the voltage drop starves the motor and heats the cable.

A: An RCD detects earth leakage, not overload or voltage drop, and does not cure the underlying problem. B: Moving a hand-held or site tool to 230 V removes the reduced-voltage protection that site supplies rely on. D: Extra length adds resistance, which increases the voltage drop and makes the problem worse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a long lead delivers the same voltage at the tool as at the supply, and that an RCD protects against every electrical fault.

50. A — Capacity falls as radius increases, and the whole gross load including slings and hook block must be checked against the chart at the greatest radius reached anywhere along the lift.

B: Slow movement does not change the chart capacity at a given radius and cannot make an overloaded lift acceptable. C: The largest radius on the path, here the set-down point, governs the lift, not the start. D: Accessories count towards the load and the chart's safety margin is not available to cover them.

COMMON MISTAKE: Comparing only the weight of the item with the chart figure at the pick-up point and forgetting accessories and the set-down radius.

PRACTICE TEST 16

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A contractor recognises a union whose appointed safety representatives cover its labourers, but its ten directly employed joiners are non-members. Before moving a refurbishment to night shifts, the manager plans to consult the union representatives only. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Union recognition means the appointed representatives speak for the whole workforce, so consulting them alone satisfies the duty towards the non-member joiners as well

☐ **B)** Union representatives are consulted for their members, and the joiners must be consulted, directly or via elected representatives, before the decision

☐ **C)** Consultation with the joiners is only required if they ask for it in writing, because without an elected representative there is no right to be consulted

☐ **D)** The joiners are informed of the night-shift decision at a toolbox talk once it has been agreed with the union, which is sufficient as notification under the law

2. A groundworks firm will drive piles for a retaining wall beside a live electrified railway, using a rig taller than its distance from the boundary fence. The risk assessment covers only its own operatives and members of the public. What is the most important gap?

☐ **A)** The railway is the infrastructure owner's responsibility, so the firm only needs to assess hazards on its own side of the boundary and keep its workers away from the fence

☐ **B)** Risks to the railway, such as the rig toppling or items dropping onto the line, are unassessed, and the railway owner's asset protection team must be engaged

☐ **C)** Piling can safely proceed if it is timed between scheduled trains, since the line is only at risk while a train is actually passing the site

☐ **D)** The boundary fence is a sufficient barrier against anything falling or toppling, so only noise and vibration to railway neighbours remain to be assessed

3. A scaffolder falls from a mobile tower onto concrete and is unresponsive but breathing, with snoring sounds, and a first-aider suspects a neck injury. A colleague says nobody should touch his head until paramedics arrive. After 999 is called, what should the first-aider do?

☐ **A)** Hold the head and neck in line and open the airway with a jaw thrust, using the recovery position only if the airway cannot be kept clear

☐ **B)** Leave him exactly as found with the head untouched until the ambulance crew arrive, because any movement could worsen a possible injury to the spine

☐ **C)** Tilt the head fully back and lift the chin firmly to clear the tongue, since this is the quickest way to open the airway of any unresponsive casualty

☐ **D)** Roll him onto his side straight away with the help of a bystander, because the recovery position is required for every unresponsive breathing casualty

4. A fabrication yard keeps acetylene, oxygen and LPG cylinders in a fenced compound by the gate. Its fire plan puts the assembly point at the gate and tells staff to cool nearby cylinders with hoses in a fire. How should the plan change?

☐ **A)** Move all the cylinders into the main workshop overnight and in an emergency, so that the compound is empty and no risk is left at the gate

☐ **B)** Keep the assembly point at the gate and form a trained cooling team in protective clothing, so that the cylinders stay cold until the fire service arrives

☐ **C)** Move the assembly point well clear, forbid staff from approaching the cylinders, and have a named person give the fire service the cylinder types and positions

☐ **D)** Leave the layout alone but display a sign at the gate showing cylinder contents, so that fire crews know the hazard when they arrive at the site

5. A joiner sprays solvent-based lacquer on doors in a portable

cross-draught booth. He stands beyond the doors, between them and the filter wall, and the filter-blockage gauge reads in the red. He says the booth makes his position and the gauge irrelevant. What is correct?

☐ **A)** His position makes no difference because the extraction is strong enough to catch all mist, and the gauge is only relevant to the annual service contractor

☐ **B)** Only the position needs correcting, as the gauge reading shows how much dust has collected and the filters can be changed at the end of the shift

☐ **C)** He should stand on the intake side so air carries mist away from his face, and the blocked filters must be replaced before spraying resumes

☐ **D)** He may continue provided he sprays in short bursts, since brief exposures with a running fan keep the vapour concentration below the exposure limit

6. A canopied air compressor stands in the corner of a concrete stairwell with its canopy doors propped open for cooling. Two plasterers work 3 m away. Which approach best reduces their noise exposure?

☐ **A)** Close the canopy doors, put the compressor outside or in an open area, and use a longer hose so it sits further from the plasterers

☐ **B)** Move the compressor closer to the plasterers to shorten the hose, as a shorter air line reduces pressure losses and so makes the machine quieter

☐ **C)** Leave the layout as it is because the stairwell walls enclose the noise, so the sound level cannot rise beyond that of the canopy alone

☐ **D)** Keep the doors open for cooling and issue ear defenders to both plasterers, which brings their exposure down to a safe level without moving any equipment

7. After handover, bricklayers prop the self-closing gate at each scaffold ladder opening with a brick, so labourers can pass bricks up by hand. The foreman says the handover record shows the gates fitted. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The gate is the scaffolder's responsibility, and users need take no action beyond reporting to the scaffolder at the next weekly inspection

☐ **B)** Gates only need to be closed at the end of the shift, because the handover record covers their use as long as someone stays at each opening

☐ **C)** Propping is acceptable for light loads, since a brick holds the gate in a position where operatives can still see the opening and avoid stepping into it

☐ **D)** A propped gate gives no protection at the opening, so gates must close after each use and materials be moved by hoist or another method



8. Look at the scene. The site supervisor says the ladder is secure because the man is using both hands and it has been set at a proper angle. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The ladder top rests against plastic guttering, which cannot carry its load, so a stand-off or another form of support is needed

☐ **B)** The man should be wearing a full-body harness clipped to the ladder rungs, since a fall from 3 m could cause serious injury without fall arrest

☐ **C)** The base needs a second person footing it, because a ladder on paving is stable only if someone is standing on the bottom rung at all times

☐ **D)** The ladder is set too shallow for safe use, so the base should be moved closer to the wall to reduce the chance of the ladder sliding outwards

9. Two crews pull a new low-voltage cable through an underground duct from a drum at one pit to a winch at another, 80 m away. The winch operator cannot see the drum and relies on shouted signals, and a fitter plans to guide the cable by hand at the duct mouth. What best reduces injury risk?

☐ **A)** Replace the pulling rope with a heavier one to prevent it snapping, so that the crew can safely stand beside the pit while the cable is moving

☐ **B)** Use shouted signals but have the winch run at its slowest speed throughout, because slow pulling reduces the tension and so removes the need for communication

☐ **C)** Provide reliable two-way radio contact with a stop signal, fit a guide at the duct mouth, and keep hands and bodies clear of the cable and rope under tension

☐ **D)** Let the fitter steady the cable at the duct mouth wearing thick gloves, since gloves protect the hands from friction and from being drawn into the duct

10. A lorry-mounted loader crane keeps stopping as the driver extends the boom to place a pallet of blocks over a hoarding, and its load-moment limiter alarm sounds. He holds the override key to finish, saying the delivery note weight is within the crane's maximum rating. What is correct?

☐ **A)** Overriding is acceptable because the pallet weighs less than the stated maximum capacity, and the limiter is only an advisory warning for newer drivers

☐ **B)** Overriding is acceptable if a banksman watches the lorry while he places the load, and signals to stop when the vehicle begins to lift or tilt

☐ **C)** Overriding is acceptable once every stabiliser is fully extended and pinned, because the lorry then cannot tip however far the boom is extended

☐ **D)** He should not override it, because capacity falls as outreach grows; the lorry should be moved nearer, the load split, or a larger crane used

11. An inspector finds a hired-in concrete pump being run with its boom hose clamp visibly worn, and fears a hose could whip loose. The site manager says no notice can be served because no regulation is named and only the employer can receive one. What is correct?

☐ **A)** The inspector may only serve an Improvement Notice with a compliance period, since the pump is hired and the hire company holds the legal duty

☐ **B)** A notice needs a proven breach of a named regulation and must go to the employer, so the inspector can only give verbal advice until one is found

☐ **C)** A Prohibition Notice can be served only after an injury has happened, because the inspector must show the risk has already caused serious harm

☐ **D)** A Prohibition Notice goes to whoever controls the activity if the inspector sees a risk of serious personal injury, with no breach needed

12. Six operatives grind concrete floors under a COSHH assessment that requires annual lung function tests. One worker's results show a clear drop since last year, though he feels fine. The manager proposes keeping his job as it is and retesting him alone next year. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Move him to lighter duties and leave the controls alone, because a drop in one person suggests personal susceptibility and not a workplace problem

☐ **B)** Refer him to occupational health, and review the dust controls and the other workers' exposure, as the result may show failing controls

☐ **C)** Wait for him to report symptoms before acting, since lung test results mean nothing until he coughs or becomes breathless at work

☐ **D)** Issue him a tighter-fitting mask and retest next year, because respiratory protection is accepted as the answer to any adverse lung result

13. A telehandler's lead-acid battery is topped up by a fitter. Electrolyte splashes his forearm through a soaked sleeve, and he feels only mild tingling. He wants to finish the job and wash later. What is the best immediate action?

☐ **A)** Remove the wet sleeve while flooding the skin with running water for twenty minutes, then get medical advice and give the product details

☐ **B)** Wipe the skin with a dry cloth, finish the repair and wash at the break, because mild tingling shows the splash was too weak to cause burns

☐ **C)** Dab bicarbonate paste on the area to neutralise the acid, then rinse briefly, because neutralising is quicker and gentler than water alone

☐ **D)** Rinse for about a minute under the cabin tap, cover the area with a plaster and carry on, because the rest is left to heal by itself



14. Look at the operative breaking out the slab. The hearing protection is the right type for this noise. Which statement best identifies the main problem with how it is being worn?

☐ **A)** The ear defenders should be worn loosely so the operator can still hear instructions from the second worker standing nearby with the barrow

☐ **B)** The thick woollen hat between the cushions and his head stops them sealing, so the protection is much lower than the rating suggests

☐ **C)** The defenders should not be worn with a hard hat at all, because the headband pushes the helmet shell forward and loosens its fit

☐ **D)** Defenders are too heavy for a breaker operator, and foam earplugs would meet the same duty while keeping his head warm and comfortable

15. Strip-out workers wear white disposable Type 5/6 coveralls to clear dusty ceiling voids. Later the same crew use angle grinders to cut brackets, throwing sparks onto their sleeves. The supervisor says the coveralls cover them fully and are already the right protection. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Standard disposable coveralls resist dust but can melt or ignite from sparks, so the grinding needs flame-resistant garments

☐ **B)** The coveralls suit both jobs, because the Type 5 marking proves protection against any hazard where the whole body is covered by the suit

☐ **C)** Reusable cotton overalls are always weaker than disposable suits, so the crew should wear a second disposable suit over the first for the grinding

☐ **D)** The sleeves can be taped shut at the cuffs, since a taped seal stops sparks entering and removes any need for flame-resistant clothing

16. A supplier's trained fixers are to clamp a lightweight temporary edge system around a new roof of 22 degrees pitch and 7 m eaves height. The kit offered is rated Class A under EN 13374. The site manager says fixer training means the system is suitable. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Class A is acceptable on any roof once the fixers are trained, because the class only matters for roofs steeper than forty-five degrees

☐ **B)** Class A suits slopes up to 10 degrees, so a Class B system rated for slopes under 30 degrees is needed, whatever the training

☐ **C)** A Class C system is needed, since any roof over fifteen degrees counts as a steep slope and requires the highest class available

☐ **D)** Class A is fine if a harness is added for the roofers, since personal protection replaces the need for the edge system to match the pitch

17. A site store has a loading bay 1.2 m above the yard, fitted with a hydraulic dock leveller. Once a trailer leaves, the roller door stays open and the leveller is left lowered. A forklift also loads a docked trailer that has no restraint. What is the best set of controls?

☐ **A)** Keep the door open so the forklift driver can see the yard, and paint a yellow line at the bay edge to mark where the fall begins

☐ **B)** Rely on the driver's handbrake while loading, and tell staff to keep clear of the edge since 1.2 m is too low to need any protection

☐ **C)** Restrain docked trailers with chocks or a restraint device, and close the door or barrier the open edge with the leveller stowed

☐ **D)** Leave the leveller lowered when idle so it fills the gap, and station a banksman at the bay while loading to watch for movement

18. A loaded dumper is bogged to its axles in soft clay. The foreman wants to pull it out with a chain from an excavator, looped round the dumper's front axle, and tells two labourers to guide the chain from beside the dumper. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Use designated recovery points with rated tackle, pull in

line slowly without jerking, and keep everyone clear of the pulling line

☐ **B)** Loop the chain round the axle but have the labourers stand behind a plant-mounted guard while the excavator takes up the slack with a sharp tug to free it

☐ **C)** Let the labourers stay close to the dumper to watch the chain, since they can warn the driver sooner if the chain begins to slip or the tackle shifts

☐ **D)** Empty the dumper first, then pull from any strong part of the frame using an old chain, since the lighter load removes the need for special care

19. A trench excavator has a tilt rotator and a bucket. A groundworker with a level staff stands beside the bucket as the cab is stationary, thinking the machine is not slewing. The operator then rotates and tilts the bucket in place. What principle best explains the risk?

☐ **A)** The risk is limited to the tail swing of the cab, so the standard fence around the rear counterweight is enough to protect the groundworker

☐ **B)** The risk is only present when the bucket is loaded, so a groundworker may stand beside an empty bucket if he wears a hard hat

☐ **C)** The tool can swing and tilt without the machine moving, so the exclusion zone must cover the tool's full reach, and entry needs the operator's agreement

☐ **D)** A groundworker is safe beside a bucket whenever the operator can see him through the cab window and has been told where he is

20. Conversion work on an old farm involves emptying a slurry pit into open skips that sit in the yard for days in warm weather. Neighbours complain of a strong smell, and the contractor says it is only a natural odour and not a legal issue. What is the right response?

☐ **A)** Wait until the council issues an abatement notice before doing anything, since the law only starts to apply once a notice has been served on the site

☐ **B)** Treat it as a possible statutory nuisance, and use practicable controls such as covered skips and prompt removal, and record them

☐ **C)** Ask neighbours to sign a note accepting the smell for the project length, since their agreement removes the legal risk of the nuisance

☐ **D)** Continue as before because smells are only a legal matter if they harm health, and a farm job is expected to smell of slurry in summer

21. A crane lift of a 1.2 tonne air-handling unit onto a roof has a risk assessment giving a numeric wind limit from the crane manual. It has no plan for what happens if the limit is passed with the load in the air. What is the best improvement?

☐ **A)** Have a competent person add a stop-and-land procedure with a cleared set-down point and a named person with authority to halt the lift

☐ **B)** Brief only the crane operator on abandoning the lift, since sharing the plan with the slinger and signaller would create conflicting instructions

☐ **C)** Leave the numeric limit as the only control, because an experienced operator can decide where to land the load if conditions worsen once it is airborne

☐ **D)** Start the lift only when the forecast shows no wind at all, which removes the need to plan for stopping part-way through the operation

22. A groundworker is pulled, coughing and shivering, from a flooded 1.5 m deep chamber after slipping in. He is breathing normally and talking, says he swallowed water but feels fine, and wants to carry on working. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Get him into dry clothes and keep him warm and watched, and arrange hospital assessment because inhaled water can cause delayed breathing problems

☐ **B)** Give him a hot sweet drink and a hot shower to rewarm him quickly, then reassess him next morning if symptoms have not settled

☐ **C)** Press firmly on his abdomen to force swallowed water out, then send him home if he is alert and talking normally afterwards

☐ **D)** Let him rest in the warm cabin for an hour and return to work if the cough stops, since coughing shows his airway has cleared the water by itself

23. On a sunny day a labourer brushes coal-tar creosote onto post ends in a T-shirt and fabric gloves. By evening his forearms are

red and sore. A colleague says it is ordinary sunburn that moisturiser will fix. Which response is correct?

☐ **A)** Creosote is harmful only if swallowed or inhaled, so the redness is plain sunburn needing after-sun cream and a sun hat for the next shift ahead

☐ **B)** Creosote on skin can heighten sunlight sensitivity and cause burns, so he should wash it off, report it and use sleeves and chemical-resistant gloves

☐ **C)** The only risk is vapour, so a dust mask and working in the shade would remove the hazard, with no need to change the way he handles it

☐ **D)** Thicker fabric gloves would keep the product off his skin, and the redness is a normal reaction to sun that does not need to be reported

24. A new joiner has existing hearing loss shown in a pre-employment test. His average daily noise exposure at the machines is 82 dB(A), below the upper action value. The employer says hearing surveillance applies only above 85 dB(A). What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** He should be included, since existing hearing loss puts him at risk even below the upper value, and early tests give a baseline

☐ **B)** Surveillance can wait until he reports hearing difficulty, since testing is triggered by symptoms and not by exposure level or individual susceptibility

☐ **C)** He must be moved off all noisy work immediately, as a person with hearing loss cannot lawfully be exposed to any noise at work

☐ **D)** Surveillance is optional below 85 dB(A), but ear protectors must then be compulsory for him, which removes the exposure risk and any need for testing

25. A fitter must use a braced mobile tower on a gentle concrete ramp between two warehouse bays. The crew apply all four castor brakes and say stabilisers are unnecessary because the wheels are locked. What is the main flaw?

☐ **A)** A ramp is acceptable if the tower is half-height and cross-braced, since the height-to-base ratio is the only measure of stability on any surface

☐ **B)** Stabilisers should be left off on a ramp because they lift the castors clear and leave the brakes carrying less of the tower's weight

☐ **C)** Locked castors do not stop tipping on a slope; check the maker's gradient limits, use adjustable legs on base plates and fit the specified stabilisers

☐ **D)** Locked castors prevent movement in every direction, so on a ramp the only extra check needed is that the platform boards are secured to the frame



26. Look at the scene. The slinger says the work is quick and the containers are an everyday sight, so no special precautions are needed. Which statement best describes the hazard?

☐ **A)** The task is brief and routine, so the main risk is the swinging hook, which can be managed by the ground worker watching the crane and warning him

☐ **B)** The ladder is the only fault, and a second person footing it is sufficient, since a person holding the base removes the need for edge protection

☐ **C)** A fall of about 5 m from an unprotected edge is possible, and the ladder gives no handhold at the top, so a safer way of hooking on is needed

☐ **D)** A hard hat and hi-vis vest are adequate for roof access this low, because height rules apply only when the work is above two metres

27. A mobile crane will set out loads on a plot where bare overhead lines run along the far boundary. The operator plans to keep an eye on the jib as it slews, and nobody has yet contacted the line owner. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Regard the lines as the owner's concern because they sit outside the working area, and rely on the crane's rubber tyres to protect the driver

☐ **B)** Consult the line owner on safe clearance, then fit restraints or barriers so the jib cannot reach it, since contact is

not needed for a flashover

☐ **C)** Keep the jib about 3 m clear by eye, a distance that suits lines of any voltage, with the signaller watching the boom tip and shouting if it drifts

☐ **D)** Treat the lines as dead if no humming or buzzing is heard, and slew freely while the load stays beneath them and the operator stays seated

28. Hand-digging a footpath trench, an operator exposes yellow plastic warning tape 450 mm down. He says yellow means gas, so any pipe is just below it and he can bring in the mini-excavator and take the bucket down to the tape. What is wrong?

☐ **A)** Tape only warns that a service lies somewhere below, so colour is not proof of type, and digging should stay by hand until it is confirmed

☐ **B)** The problem is only that he removed the tape, so the proper step is to re-lay it above the service and continue digging mechanically

☐ **C)** Yellow tape reliably identifies gas and sits directly above the pipe, so the bucket can go down to the tape and only then switch to hand tools

☐ **D)** The tape means the area is safe to dig to the tape depth, because services below it are always protected by a concrete or plastic cover

29. On a sloping site, runoff reaches a road gully protected by a silt-filter mat. The foreman adds a silt fence with its fabric simply laid on the ground across the flow path and checks it weekly. Which improvement is best?

☐ **A)** Let silt build up against the fence, since a deeper layer filters finer particles and a weekly check is enough whatever the weather

☐ **B)** Place the fence directly across the swale where runoff concentrates, because the biggest flow needs the biggest barrier to hold the sediment back

☐ **C)** Trench in the fabric foot, run the fence along the contour, inspect after heavy rain and clear silt, and limit soil washing off at source

☐ **D)** Swap the mat for a finer-weave fabric so no silt can pass, which makes extra measures upstream of the gully unnecessary on a sloping site

30. A mechanic puts engine-oil-soaked rags and used oil filters in a lidded drum marked "oily waste". The manager books the registered skip firm to collect it, with no consignment note because the quantity is small. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** The rags can go in general waste once wrung out, because only free-flowing liquid oil makes waste hazardous, not material soaked in it

☐ **B)** Oily rags and filters are hazardous waste, so a consignment note is completed and kept in the register for three years at the premises

☐ **C)** The note can be skipped because the drum is lidded and labelled, since proper storage already shows that the duty of care has been met

☐ **D)** A waste transfer note is enough because the carrier is registered, as consignment notes apply only to hazardous waste that is exported abroad

31. A school appoints one electrical contractor, working alone, to rewire a classroom block over six weeks. The contractor says no construction phase plan is needed because there is no principal contractor and the job is small. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** No plan is needed, because the duty sits only with a principal contractor, who is appointed when several contractors work on the same project

☐ **B)** As the only contractor, it must draw up a construction phase plan before work starts, kept proportionate to the size and risks of the job

☐ **C)** The school's designer must write the plan, because without a principal contractor the contractor simply follows the designer's arrangements

☐ **D)** A plan is needed only if the project is notifiable to HSE, so the contractor should first check the thresholds for sending an F10

32. A notifiable office refurbishment will start on Monday. The client asked her principal designer to send the F10 to HSE, but it was never sent and nobody noticed. Which statement about responsibility is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The duty to notify stays with the client even though a colleague was asked to send it, and notice was due before the construction phase began

☐ **B)** The principal designer alone is responsible, because once

the client delegated the task the legal duty to notify transferred to the person who agreed

☐ **C)** The principal contractor is responsible, because it controls the construction site and so inherits the client's notification duty once it is appointed

☐ **D)** Nobody is yet in breach, because notice is only required once the project has actually run for thirty working days on site

33. A permit to work for maintenance on a roof-mounted extract fan is valid from 07:00 to 15:00. At 14:30 the engineer says the job needs another two hours, and the isolation is still in place. What should happen?

☐ **A)** The engineer can carry on to finish, since the isolation is unchanged, and then note the overrun on his own copy when he hands the permit back

☐ **B)** The engineer can extend it himself by writing a later time on his copy, because as the holder he best knows how long the task will take

☐ **C)** Work can continue until 17:00 because a permit stays valid until the task it describes is complete, whatever times are written on it

☐ **D)** Work should stop at expiry unless the issuing authorised person re-checks the area and signs an extension with a new expiry time

34. A flooring crew dry-grinds old rubber-backed floor covering in an occupied school corridor. The foreman says rubber is not labelled hazardous and no data sheet applies, so no COSHH assessment is needed. What is the most accurate response?

☐ **A)** An assessment is needed only after air monitoring shows the dust is above a limit, so grinding should start and be measured on day one

☐ **B)** An assessment is needed only where the supplier's data sheet classes the product as hazardous, so the missing label means the task is outside COSHH

☐ **C)** The task is covered, but a disposable mask is enough because rubber dust is non-toxic, so extraction is for silica or wood dust only

☐ **D)** COSHH covers dust created by the work itself, so the task needs assessing and the dust controlling at source, for example with on-tool extraction

35. A hired gas cylinder arrives with its paint faded and a label peeling off. A fitter says he knows an acetylene cylinder by its maroon colour and starts to connect it to a regulator. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Ask a colleague what he thinks it is and connect it if they agree, since two opinions are as good as a label

☐ **B)** Use the colour, since cylinder colours are fixed by law so that any gas can be identified safely from the paint alone

☐ **C)** Identify the contents from the supplier's label or marking, not the colour, and return the cylinder if it cannot be identified

☐ **D)** Connect it and check for a smell of the gas, since each gas has a distinct smell which would show the contents

36. A birdcage scaffold inside a heated church hall carries a plastering platform over the whole floor. No wind or rain reaches it, and ten days have passed since its first inspection. The manager says weekly inspections are unnecessary indoors. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Inspection is needed only before first use and after alterations, because weather is what causes the deterioration that the weekly rule addresses

☐ **B)** The scaffolder's handover check is enough, with the plasterers glancing at the platform each morning and no written report being needed

☐ **C)** Inspection is required, but monthly is enough indoors, since loading and exposure are lower than on an external facade scaffold

☐ **D)** Inspection at intervals not exceeding seven days still applies indoors, as well as after any alteration or event affecting stability, with a written report

37. A ground-investigation team has traced a live electricity cable with a locator and will expose it in a hand-dug trial hole before drilling. A labourer plans to dig straight down on the traced line, scanning once more at the end. What is the best correction?

☐ **A)** Dig straight down but only with insulated tools, because a located cable is a known hazard and the insulated handles give the protection

☐ **B)** Drive a steel probe down vertically along the traced line to find the depth first, then hand-dig directly above the contact point

☐ **C)** Break the top 300 mm with a hydraulic breaker for speed and hand-dig below that, since cables are rarely laid shallower than that

☐ **D)** Dig alongside the line with insulated hand tools, repeat the locator checks as the hole deepens, and finish exposing the cable horizontally



38. Look at the scene at the crushing area. The loader driver says he is fully trained and the crusher has its own emergency stop. What is the most serious problem?

☐ **A)** The stockpile behind the crusher is too tall, because large heaps are the main cause of fatal injuries around mobile crushing plant

☐ **B)** The loading shovel is working too close to the crusher, because machines this size need a clear zone of at least 12 metres between them

☐ **C)** A labourer clears spillage beside the moving belt and drum while the plant runs, with no guard and out of the loader driver's view

☐ **D)** Dust at the discharge point is the main hazard, because it will cause serious lung disease within a day if no respirator is worn

39. A site manager hires a mobile crane and driver from a plant firm on a plain crane-hire basis for one lift of precast units. He says the hire firm's driver owns the lift and its planning. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The operator is responsible for planning, because he is the crane expert, and the hirer's duties finish once the hire charge is agreed

☐ **B)** A planner is needed only where the load exceeds half the crane's capacity, with smaller lifts being planned by the operator on the day

☐ **C)** On crane hire the hirer takes control, so it must appoint a competent appointed person to plan the lift, with the operator working to their direction

☐ **D)** Responsibility moves automatically to the hire firm because it supplies both crane and driver, so the hirer need only give an address

40. A 6 m stockpile of crushed concrete is planned beside the boundary of a housing estate, with a loading shovel working it from 7 am. The manager will spray water only after residents complain. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Put up a plain site fence on the boundary, since a solid barrier stops windblown dust and shovel noise from reaching the houses

☐ **B)** Site it well away from homes and as low as practicable, keep it damp and sheeted when idle, and limit drop heights and hours

☐ **C)** Rely on the crew wearing FFP3 masks, since the main legal duty concerns workers' health and not neighbours' amenity

☐ **D)** Spraying on complaint is adequate, because nuisance only arises once residents report it and waiting keeps water use and costs down

41. A carpenter passing through a corridor used by several trades sees the cover missing from a temporary lighting junction box, with conductors exposed. He wraps tape round it and says nothing, as he is not an electrician. Which statement best describes his duties?

☐ **A)** He should keep others clear and promptly tell his supervisor or the site electrician, so a competent person repairs it; his own taping is not a proper fix

☐ **B)** He should raise it at the next weekly safety meeting, because the duty to inform is met by mentioning the hazard through the normal scheduled channel on site

☐ **C)** He has no duty to act, because reporting electrical faults is for the electrical contractor and other trades only need to report equipment they own

☐ **D)** He has done enough by taping the box, because employees must take reasonable care and a quick fix removes the immediate danger without bothering anyone

42. After adding every practicable control, a rope-lowering task

for heavy glazing still leaves a high residual risk of a dropped load. The gang leader says the controls are listed, so work can begin and the remaining risk is just the job. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** Proceed once the gang signs the assessment to show they understand the remaining risk and accept it as part of the job

☐ **B)** A high residual risk is not acceptable as it stands, so stop, escalate and redesign the method before work starts

☐ **C)** Proceed because all practicable controls are listed, and the remaining risk belongs to the people carrying out the task

☐ **D)** Proceed but only in dry weather, since weather is the main factor in whether a heavy glazing load can be dropped

43. At the end of a cold day a manager leaves a thermostatic electric fan heater running in the empty drying room. Cardboard boxes of fixings are stacked against its grille. He says the tip-over switch and thermal cut-out make this safe. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Plug it into a timer socket so it runs for a limited period, because shorter running time reduces the fire load and the cardboard can then stay put

☐ **B)** Fit a wire guard over the grille and leave it running, because a guard stops the boxes touching the element so the stack can stay exactly where it is

☐ **C)** Move the boxes back about 100 mm and leave it running overnight, since the cut-outs make unattended use acceptable once nothing is touching the grille

☐ **D)** Switch it off when the room is unattended and keep combustibles well clear, because built-in cut-outs are a backup and do not justify stacking stock against it

44. Floor layers spend six hours a day kneeling and bending to lay vinyl tiles in a long corridor. After two weeks several have sore knees and lower backs. The foreman suggests they simply take longer breaks and buy their own knee pads. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Redesign the task to cut awkward postures, using long-handled tools and rotation, with knee protection supplied and complaints reviewed

☐ **B)** Leave it to the workers, as longer breaks and self-bought pads are enough, because kneeling is a normal part of floor laying

☐ **C)** Move the same people to the same task on alternate days only, because the pain comes from tiredness and not from the posture

☐ **D)** Issue back supports for everyone, since a support belt removes the strain and so the working method needs no change

45. Eight operatives work twelve-hour night shifts resurfacing a city road. The site cabin has a kettle and a cold tap, and the manager says welfare is covered, so the crew can bring their own food. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Welfare duties relax at night because fewer people are on site, so a kettle and a cold tap are enough until the day shift returns in the morning

☐ **B)** Arranging takeaway deliveries to the gate meets the duty, because the employer has then ensured that meals can be eaten on site each night

☐ **C)** The night crew need a rest area with food preparation and eating facilities, a way to boil water, seating and winter heating, as any day shift does

☐ **D)** The kettle satisfies the rule, since only boiling water is required and preparing food is a private matter for each worker on their own time

46. Pipelayers lever 400 kg concrete pipe sections into a trench, all wearing S3 steel-toecap boots. One has his instep crushed when a pipe rolls onto his foot, though his toes are unhurt. What should the manager do next?

☐ **A)** Issue boots with a higher-rated steel toecap, because the instep injury shows the toecaps in use were not strong enough for the load

☐ **B)** Retrain the injured pipelayer in foot placement, as the boots met the standard and the fault lay with the way he positioned himself

☐ **C)** Switch to higher-ankle boots with extra support, because a taller upper protects the instep against a rolling load better than low boots do

☐ **D)** Review the task assessment and issue boots marked M for metatarsal protection as well as a toecap, and review the pipe-handling method too



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the labourer is correctly equipped for working next to the roller. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** He is not wearing a dust mask while raking, so respiratory protection is the largest gap in his equipment for the task shown

☐ **B)** His work gloves are too light for the task, so thick leather gauntlets are the single greatest gap in his protection on this kind of job done by hand

☐ **C)** His safety glasses give too little side protection for raking stone, so a full-face visor is the main gap in his equipment for this job

☐ **D)** He wears wireless earbuds instead of ear defenders; they give no rated hearing protection and mask the sounds of plant warning of danger

48. A trained operator in a boom MEWP basket 10 m up slumps over the controls, unconscious but breathing. The machine is working, the basket is clear of structures, and a trained colleague is at the base. What should happen first?

☐ **A)** Climb the boom or a ladder wearing a harness to reach him, because direct contact is the quickest way to start first aid and check his breathing

☐ **B)** A trained ground person uses the ground controls to lower the platform under the rescue plan with care, then gives first aid and calls 999

☐ **C)** Call 999 and wait for the fire service, because only emergency crews should bring a platform down when the operator is incapacitated and could be hurt by it

☐ **D)** Raise a second MEWP or a telehandler cradle to the basket and transfer him across, so the first machine stays undisturbed

49. A fitter must drill and fix brackets in a damp plant room 60 m from the nearest 110 V outlet, with other trades walking through. Which choice of drill is best?

☐ **A)** A battery drill with no further controls, as removing the lead eliminates the main hazards of the job, so dust and noise need no assessment

☐ **B)** A 230 V drill through a portable RCD, as a fast-acting trip means mains voltage can be used safely in damp areas without other precautions

☐ **C)** A 110 V drill on two 30 m extension leads joined mid-run, since reduced voltage makes damp conditions and a trailing cable acceptable

☐ **D)** A battery SDS drill, as it removes the trailing lead and shock source, though dust extraction and eye protection are still needed

50. After a hot three-hour haul to site, a flatbed driver finds one rear tyre reading 0.4 bar above the cold figure on the vehicle plate, with a bulge in its sidewall. A colleague says to bleed it to the plate figure and carry on unloading. What is correct?

☐ **A)** Log the bulge in the defect report but drive on site slowly, because a lower speed reduces the stress on the tyre until the delivery has been finished

☐ **B)** Leave it as it is, since the bulge is minor and extra pressure is safer than too little, so it need only be reported at the end of the working day

☐ **C)** Bleed it down to the plate figure now, because a reading above the cold figure means overinflation, and the bulge is cosmetic once the pressure is corrected

☐ **D)** Do not bleed the hot tyre, as the rise is normal, but the bulge shows internal damage, so take the vehicle out of use until a competent fitter replaces it

Answer Key

1. B — Where some employees are not covered by union-appointed representatives, the employer must consult them under the 1996 Regulations, so that both groups are heard before the change is made.

A: Union-appointed representatives only represent the employees they cover, so the joiners remain a separate group to consult. C: The duty to consult rests on the employer and does not depend on employees requesting it or electing anyone. D: Telling people after a decision is made is information, not consultation, which must happen in good time beforehand.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that having recognised union representatives means the whole workforce has been consulted.

2. B — A risk assessment must cover everyone affected by the work, including train crews and passengers, and the infrastructure owner must agree measures where plant could foul the line.

A: The firm's duty extends to anyone affected by its work, including the railway and its users beyond the boundary. C: A rig or object foul of the line is hazardous at any time, and train timetables change, so timing alone is not a control. D: A fence does not stop a rig or dropped materials reaching the line, so it is not an adequate control for that risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assessing only the people on your own site and treating a neighbouring railway as someone else's problem.

3. A — Keeping the airway open takes priority, and a jaw thrust does so with least neck movement; the recovery position is a last resort when the airway cannot be maintained.

B: Snoring signals a partly blocked airway, and an obstructed airway is more immediately life-threatening than a suspected spinal injury. C: Tilting the neck back is avoided with a suspected spinal injury, where a jaw thrust is the preferred technique. D: Rolling is reserved for when the airway cannot be kept open by other means, as it risks moving the spine unnecessarily.

COMMON MISTAKE: Freezing in the belief that a possible spinal injury means nothing can be done about a blocked airway.

4. C — Cylinders can burst or explode when heated, so people must be kept away and responders need to know what is stored and where.

A: Storing cylinders inside a workshop increases the fire and explosion risk to people, and it does not remove the need for a plan. B: Staff should never approach heated cylinders, as they may fail without warning and cooling is a task for the fire service. D: A sign does not move people out of the danger zone and does not replace a person briefing the crew on the quantities and positions.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that staff cooling heated cylinders with a hose is a brave and sensible first response.

5. C — A booth only controls exposure while air flows past the work away from the operator, so position and filter condition are both essential.

A: Standing downstream puts his breathing zone in the contaminated airflow, and a blocked filter reduces airflow when it matters. B: A blocked filter cuts the airflow that carries mist and vapour away, so continuing to spray with it is itself a failure. D: Short bursts do not compensate for reduced airflow, and nothing here shows that the concentration has been measured.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a spray booth protects the operator wherever he stands and whatever state the filters are in.

6. A — Enclosures only attenuate noise when closed, corners and hard walls reflect it, and levels fall with distance from the source, so ear protection is the last control.

B: A shorter hose does not make the compressor quieter and bringing it nearer increases exposure. C: Hard enclosed walls reflect sound and raise levels, which is the opposite of containing the noise. D: Hearing protection is the last resort, and relying on it ignores the cheap controls that reduce noise at the source and on its path.

COMMON MISTAKE: Propping open a noise enclosure for convenience and relying on ear defenders to make up the difference.

7. D — A fitted gate protects against a fall through the ladder opening only when it is closed, so the handover record does not excuse defeating it.

A: Everyone using the scaffold must keep protection in place and may not alter it, and defects need prompt reporting rather than waiting. B: The opening is a fall hazard whenever people work nearby, so the gate must close after every passage, not just overnight. C: Whether or not the opening is visible, an open gate leaves a gap that someone can fall through.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a paper handover record as proof that protection will still be working once other trades are using the scaffold.

8. A — Guttering is not a suitable support, as it may deform or

crack and let the ladder slip, so a stand-off frame or a different access method is needed.

B: Harnesses are not normally clipped to ladder rungs, which are not designed as an anchor point. C: The base is on firm level paving with a stabiliser bar, so the fault in the picture is at the top. D: The ladder is shown at a correct angle of about one in four, so the angle is not the problem.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking the angle and the footing of a ladder but never looking at what the top is resting against.

9. C — Cable and rope under tension can crush hands at the duct mouth and snap back, so a guide, clear communication and exclusion from the danger zone are needed.

A: A heavier rope still stores energy and can recoil, and people should stay out of the danger zone whatever the rope size. B: Slow speed does not remove the hazard, and shouted signals over a long distance and machinery noise are unreliable. D: Gloves do not prevent a hand being pulled in or crushed, so the hands must be kept away from the mouth altogether.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting gloves and a loud voice to manage the hazards of pulling a cable under tension.

10. D — The maximum rating applies only at short outreach, and the limiter warns that the overturning moment is exceeded, so the lift needs re-planning rather than defeating the safety device.

A: The limiter works on load multiplied by outreach, so a load under the maximum rating can still exceed capacity at that reach. B: A tipping lorry gives little warning, so watching for movement is no substitute for the limiter that prevents the overload. C: Fully set stabilisers do not make the rated capacity at long outreach unlimited, and overriding defeats the protection against overload.

COMMON MISTAKE: Comparing the load only with the crane's maximum rating and ignoring how far it is being reached out.

11. D — The test for a Prohibition Notice is the inspector's opinion of a risk of serious personal injury, and it goes to the person in control of the activity, which may be an operator rather than the employer.

A: An Improvement Notice needs a contravention and gives time to comply, whereas a serious risk can be stopped at once whoever owns the equipment. B: Both halves are wrong, because a breach is not a precondition and the notice goes to whoever controls the activity. C: The power exists to stop a risk before harm occurs, so no injury is required.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming an inspector needs a named legal breach, or must deal only with the employer, before stopping a dangerous activity.

12. B — Health surveillance results must feed back into the risk assessment, because one worker's decline can signal inadequate controls that put everyone doing the same work at risk.

A: Removing one person without checking the controls leaves the others exposed to the same dust. C: Surveillance exists to find early changes before symptoms show, so waiting defeats its purpose. D: PPE is the last resort, and an adverse result should prompt a review of the whole control strategy and not just a change of mask.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating an adverse health check as one person's problem instead of evidence about how well the controls work for everyone.

13. A — Acid keeps burning while it stays in contact, so prolonged flushing with removal of contaminated clothing is needed even when pain is slight, and the chemical details help treatment.

B: Wiping spreads the acid, and a chemical burn can be serious before it hurts. C: Neutralising generates heat and is slow, whereas copious water dilutes and removes the acid safely. D: A minute of rinsing is far too short to remove the chemical, and covering it traps residue against the skin.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a chemical splash by how much it hurts rather than by what it is and how long it stayed on the skin.

14. B — Ear defender cushions must seal directly against the skin, and bulky material in the way leaves gaps that can cut the attenuation sharply.

A: Loose cups give less protection, and communication needs are met by other arrangements, not by reducing attenuation. C: Headband defenders and helmets are routinely worn together, and helmet-mounted types exist for the purpose. D: Weight is not the fault shown, and swapping type does not fix the issue of poor fit.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing any ear defender works as rated no matter what is worn underneath it.

15. A — Coverall type marks the particle and splash category, not the flame performance, so a task adding sparks needs a flame-resistant garment chosen for that hazard.

B: A Type 5 marking covers airborne particles only, and says nothing about sparks. C: Doubling a suit that can melt adds fuel and does not make it flame-resistant. D: Tape does not stop the outer fabric

melting or burning, and it can make the injury worse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming one type of protective suit covers every hazard in a mixed task because it covers the whole body.

16. B — EN 13374 classes reflect roof pitch, and Class A is designed only for surfaces up to 10 degrees, so the equipment must match the slope and not rely on installer skill alone.

A: The class limit begins at 10 degrees, and training cannot make a system stop someone sliding. C: Class C is for steeper pitches of 30 to 45 degrees, so 22 degrees falls under Class B. D: Collective edge protection must itself suit the slope, and a harness does not make an unsuitable system acceptable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating installer training or a certificate as proof that a system suits the specific roof it is fitted to.

17. C — A trailer can creep away during loading, and the open bay edge is a fall risk whatever its height, so both need controlling by restraint and edge protection.

A: A painted line warns but does not stop a person or truck from going over the edge. B: A handbrake alone does not prevent creep, and the Work at Height Regulations apply to any height where a fall could cause injury. D: A lowered leveller does not close off the drop at its sides, and a banksman cannot hold a trailer or guard the open edge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking a fall of about a metre does not need edge protection because it is less than two metres.

18. A — Recovery loads can be high and a failed link or chain can recoil, so rated gear on designated points and an exclusion zone along the line protect people.

B: A sharp tug increases shock loading, and axles and unrated chain are not designed as recovery points. C: People near a loaded chain are in the recoil path, and signalling should come from a safe distance outside the line. D: A lighter load does not make unrated tackle or an unsuitable fixing point safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating recovery of stuck plant as a quick improvised job where any chain and any strong-looking part will do.

19. C — A tilt rotator moves the attachment independently of the body, so a stationary cab is no sign of safety and people must stay outside the tool's reach until the operator has grounded it.

A: The danger here is from the attachment, which moves well beyond the tail swing area. B: An empty bucket on a rotating tool can still strike or crush, and a hard hat is no defence against it. D: Visibility does not remove the risk, because rapid unexpected tool movement can still strike a person who is within reach.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging safe distance by whether the machine body is moving rather than by where the attachment can reach.

20. B — Smells from trade or business premises can be a statutory nuisance, and showing best practicable means were used is the recognised defence, so prompt controls and records both matter.

A: The duty to avoid the nuisance exists beforehand, and acting early prevents a notice and enforcement. C: Informal consent does not stop a nuisance being established or the council acting on later complaints. D: A statutory nuisance can arise from interference with comfort and enjoyment, not only from proven harm.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a nuisance smell only matters if it can be proven to harm health.

21. A — Regulation 8 of LOLER requires lifting operations to be properly planned by a competent person, so the plan must cover abandoning the lift safely, not just the conditions for starting it.

B: Everyone involved in the lift must know the stop criteria and the landing area, or the plan cannot be followed. C: Improvising a landing mid-lift is the opposite of proper planning and leaves the crew without a rehearsed response. D: Forecasts are unreliable and local gusts at roof height can differ, so conditions can still change during the lift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a risk assessment is complete once it sets a start condition, without planning how to stop the operation safely part-way.

22. A — Water in the lungs can cause problems hours later even when a casualty looks well, so medical assessment is advised after any near-drowning while he is kept warm and monitored.

B: Rapid rewarming alone ignores the lung risk and delays medical assessment until a deterioration may already have begun. C: Abdominal pressure is not recommended, risks vomiting and inhalation, and does not remove the need for medical assessment. D: A settled cough does not show the lungs are undamaged, and delayed breathing difficulty can follow.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a rescued casualty by how well they look and talk, rather than by what they may have inhaled.

23. B — Skin contact with creosote can increase sensitivity to light and cause burns and irritation, so exposure must be

controlled at the skin and the incident reported for review.

A: Skin is a significant route of exposure for creosote and sunlight can worsen the damage. C: A dust mask does not stop vapour or skin contact, so neither route is controlled by shade and a paper mask. D: Fabric absorbs creosote and holds it against the skin, and the injury should still be reported and investigated.

COMMON MISTAKE: Putting skin reactions down to sunburn or weather instead of asking what substance was on the skin.

24. A — Hearing surveillance covers workers likely to be regularly exposed above the upper action value and those at risk for other reasons, such as existing hearing loss.

B: Surveillance exists to detect damage early, before the worker notices symptoms. C: There is no ban on such work; the duty is to control the risk and monitor his hearing. D: Hearing protection does not remove the need for surveillance for a worker already at risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the upper action value as the only trigger for hearing checks, ignoring workers who are more vulnerable.

25. C — Brakes only stop rolling, whereas stability on a slope depends on the manufacturer's gradient limits, levelling and stabilisers, and base plates are safer than castors on a slope.

A: Stability also depends on the slope, the ground and the manufacturer's instructions, not height alone. B: Stabilisers are fitted as the manufacturer's schedule requires and help to prevent the tower overturning. D: Brakes cannot prevent overturning, which is the main danger on a slope.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that locking the castor brakes makes a mobile tower safe on any surface.

26. C — Working at the open edge of a high roof with an unsecured ladder creates a serious fall risk, and the work should be avoided or done from a proper platform with edge protection.

A: Duration and familiarity do not remove the fall risk from an unprotected edge. B: Footing a ladder does not fix a missing handhold at the top, and the open roof edge is still unprotected. D: There is no minimum height in the Work at Height Regulations, and a 5 m fall is serious in any case.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating familiar, short tasks as low risk although the person is standing at an unprotected edge.

27. B — HSE guidance says to consult the line owner, treat lines as live, and use physical restraints and barriers because close approach alone can cause arcing.

A: Plant can reach lines beyond the working area, and tyres do not protect against arcing or a step potential. C: Judging distance by eye is unreliable, and safe clearance depends on the line owner's advice. D: Silence does not prove a line is dead; all lines are assumed live unless the owner proves otherwise.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on operator skill and watching by eye instead of physical controls that stop the jib reaching the lines.

28. A — Warning tape shows that a service is present beneath but not its exact depth or position, and colours cannot be relied upon, so safe digging practice continues with hand tools and confirmation.

B: Re-laying tape does nothing to locate the service, and mechanical digging near it risks a strike. C: Colour is not a reliable identifier, and a bucket at tape level may already be too close to the service. D: Tape is a warning of presence, not a protective barrier, and nothing guarantees a cover over the service.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading the colour of a warning tape as a full description of what is beneath it and where.

29. C — Silt fences work when the fabric is trenched in and set along the contour, and they need inspection after rain, with measures that limit soil washing off at source.

A: Excess silt reduces capacity and causes overtopping, and checks are needed after rain. B: Fences are not suited to concentrated, continuous flow and are overwhelmed or undercut. D: Finer filters clog quickly and cannot replace controlling soil loss at source.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a drain mat or silt fence will cope with any sediment, instead of keeping soil out of runoff at source.

30. B — Hazardous waste leaving site needs a consignment note, and the producer must keep the register of notes for three years at the premises that produced or stored the waste.

A: Oil-soaked material remains contaminated and hazardous even without free liquid. C: Storage and labelling do not replace the required paperwork when the waste is collected. D: Consignment notes apply to hazardous waste moved within the country, not just exports.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking a registered carrier or a small quantity removes the need for hazardous waste paperwork.

31. B — Under CDM 2015 a construction phase plan is needed for every project, and where there is a single contractor that contractor is the one who must prepare it before the construction phase begins.

A: A plan is required on every project, and a sole contractor takes on the drawing-up duty itself. C: Designers supply pre-construction information, but the plan for the work itself comes from the contractor or principal contractor. D: The plan duty does not depend on notification thresholds, which only decide whether HSE must be told.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a small job with one firm on it is too minor to need a written plan before work begins.

32. A — CDM 2015 places the duty to notify HSE on the client; the client may ask someone else to submit it, but doing so does not pass the legal duty on.

B: Delegating the task does not transfer the client's legal duty to the person who accepted it. C: The principal contractor has no automatic duty to notify; that duty belongs to the client. D: Notice must be given as soon as practicable before the construction phase begins, not after thirty days of work.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that asking someone else to send the F10 also hands them the client's legal responsibility for it.

33. D — A permit is time-limited, and it can only be extended by the person who issued it after confirming the area is still safe and that everyone working under it knows the details.

A: An expired permit gives no authority to work, and noting the overrun afterwards does not replace the issuer's check. B: Only the authorised person who issued the permit may extend it, not the person holding it. C: A permit is a time-limited document, and the stated expiry time is part of the control.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the end time on a permit as a rough guide that the holder can stretch when a job runs late.

34. D — COSHH applies to hazardous dust generated by work activity even where the material carries no label, and controls at source come before reliance on masks.

A: The assessment must come before exposure, not after monitoring has shown a problem. B: Dust produced by grinding is covered whether or not the original product was labelled. C: Rubber dust can harm lungs and skin, and masks are the last control, not the first.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a material without a hazard label cannot create a COSHH problem when it is cut, sanded or ground.

35. C — Cylinder colours vary and fade, so contents must be confirmed from the label or marking; an unidentified cylinder should be returned to the supplier.

A: Opinions are no substitute for the supplier's label. B: Colour is not a reliable identifier and cannot replace the label. D: Smelling for a gas is dangerous and not a reliable method.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting the paint colour of a cylinder when the label is missing.

36. D — The Work at Height Regulations require scaffold inspection by a competent person before use, at intervals of up to seven days and after events that may affect stability, wherever it stands.

A: The seven-day inspection applies to scaffolds generally and is not limited to those exposed to weather. B: Informal user glances do not replace a recorded inspection by a competent person. C: The maximum interval is seven days and is not extended for indoor scaffolds.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a scaffold sheltered from the weather can go without its regular recorded inspections.

37. D — HSE advises excavating alongside a service rather than above it, using insulated hand tools, scanning repeatedly during the work and exposing the service finally by horizontal digging.

A: Digging directly on top of the cable is what risks striking it, and insulated handles do not make a strike safe. B: Driving a steel probe into the line risks piercing a live cable and does not remove the need to dig alongside. C: Cable depth varies and cannot be assumed, so mechanical breaking over a live service risks a strike.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that once a cable has been traced the only remaining job is to dig down on it until it appears.

38. C — Clearing material next to running, unguarded conveyor parts risks entanglement, and standing where the loader driver cannot see him adds a risk of being struck.

A: The stockpile is a secondary concern compared with a person working at unguarded moving machinery. B: The loader's distance is not the key hazard, and no such fixed separation figure applies. D: Dust is a real health risk but it is managed by suppression and does not match the immediate danger of the moving parts.

COMMON MISTAKE: Letting someone clean or clear material near running plant on the strength of an emergency stop being nearby.

39. C — Under a crane-hire arrangement responsibility for planning and controlling the lift rests with the hirer's appointed person, whereas a contract lift passes it to the crane firm.

A: The hirer cannot hand the planning duty to the operator under hire terms, since a separate appointed person takes control. B: Every lifting operation must be properly planned by a competent person, whatever the load's proportion of capacity. D: Only a contract lift

transfers planning to the crane firm, and plain hire leaves it with the hirer.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that hiring a crane with a driver also hires in someone else's responsibility for the lift.

40. B — Dust and noise are best prevented at source through siting, height, damping and covering, rather than dealt with after neighbours have been affected.

A: A fence cannot stop fine dust and noise travelling, and does not replace control at source. C: Masks protect only the wearer, and the contractor also has duties to limit dust and noise affecting neighbours. D: Controls must be in place before the problem arises, and a complaint shows harm has already occurred.

COMMON MISTAKE: Waiting for a complaint before controlling dust and noise that the layout of the site could have prevented.

41. A — Employees must report serious dangers and shortcomings in protection to their employer and take reasonable care of others, and electrical repairs belong to someone competent to make them.

B: An exposed live conductor is a serious and immediate danger that must be reported promptly, not held for a meeting. C: The duty to report and to care for others applies to any danger he encounters at work, whoever owns the equipment. D: Tape is not a competent repair, and the shortcoming still has to be reported so the circuit is checked.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a hazard in someone else's trade is not your business to report, or that a quick personal fix discharges your duty.

42. B — Listing controls does not make a risk acceptable. If a high risk remains, the method should be redesigned, for example with mechanical handling, and the decision referred to someone with authority.

A: A signature does not reduce the risk, and workers cannot accept a hazard that the employer must control. C: A high risk that remains is not accepted just because controls are listed, and it cannot be passed to the workers. D: Weather is one factor, but the method still leaves a high risk of dropping the load.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a task as ready to start once controls are listed, even when a high risk remains.

43. D — Safety devices can fail, and unattended heating with combustible materials touching it is a clear ignition and fire-spread risk that is controlled by separation and switching off.

A: A timer still leaves the heater running unattended next to combustibles during the period it is on. B: A guard does not stop radiated heat or airflow blockage igniting cardboard stored right beside the heater. C: A token gap is not adequate separation, and leaving a heater running unattended still relies on devices that can fail.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a heater's built-in safety cut-outs instead of keeping combustibles away and switching it off when nobody is there.

44. A — Posture and repetitive kneeling are manual handling and ergonomic risks to be reduced by changing the task and equipment, with protection provided by the employer and early symptoms acted on.

B: The employer must reduce the risk and provide equipment, not rely on workers to buy their own. C: The posture is the cause and alternating days does not change the way the work is done. D: Back supports do not remove the risk and are not a substitute for improving the method.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on breaks and personal protection to cope with kneeling and bending instead of changing how the work is done.

45. C — Welfare duties apply on every shift, and a rest area should let workers prepare and eat food and boil water, with enough seating and heating.

A: Welfare duties do not reduce after dark, and night workers often have fewer alternatives. B: Deliveries do not provide the preparation, seating and heating facilities that a suitable rest area needs. D: A rest area must also let workers prepare and eat food, not merely boil water.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking welfare is a day-shift requirement that can be scaled back for night work.

46. D — A toecap protects only the toes, so a crushing risk to the top of the foot calls for a metatarsal guard, and the handling method should still be improved.

A: A stronger toecap still leaves the instep uncovered, so the risk remains. B: Blaming the worker ignores the foreseeable risk to the instep that the PPE selection did not cover. C: Ankle height gives support, not crush protection over the top of the foot.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that any safety boot with a toecap protects the whole foot from heavy rolling or dropped loads.

47. D — Earbuds are not hearing protection, so the noise exposure is uncontrolled, and listening through them also reduces his awareness of plant moving nearby.

A: The stone is damp, so little dust is produced and the mask is not the main problem. B: Close-fitting leather-palmed gloves suit raking stone, and gauntlets would reduce his dexterity. C: The glasses shown have side shields, which suit raking damp stone.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting any device in or on the ears as hearing protection, and forgetting that it blocks warning sounds from plant.

48. B — Ground controls are provided for emergency descent as part of a rescue plan, and a trained person should bring the casualty down quickly while controlling the movement.

A: Climbing a boom puts a second person at risk, and the ground controls give a quicker, safer rescue. C: A casualty cannot wait at height, and the plan should enable trained site staff to lower the platform. D: A transfer between machines at height is hazardous and slow compared with lowering the first machine.

COMMON MISTAKE: Improvising a rescue at height, or waiting for outside help, instead of using the ground controls named in the rescue plan.

49. D — Battery tools remove the supply cable, and so the shock and trip hazards, though dust, noise and vibration from the task still need their own controls.

A: Battery power removes only the electrical hazards, and drilling still creates dust, noise and vibration. B: An RCD is a last line of defence, and mains voltage is not appropriate where safer options exist. C: Reduced voltage lowers the shock risk but leaves a long trailing cable, vulnerable joints and trip hazards for the passing trades.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a battery tool makes a task low-risk and needs no further assessment of the other hazards.

50. D — Tyre pressure rises with heat and should be set when cold, while a sidewall bulge indicates structural failure that makes the tyre unsafe to use.

A: Slow speed does not remove the burst risk, and a defect of this kind needs the tyre taken out of use. B: A bulge means damaged internal cords, and delaying the report allows continued use of a tyre liable to burst. C: Releasing air from a hot tyre leaves it underinflated when cold, and a bulge is not cosmetic.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a high hot-tyre reading as a fault to bleed, while treating a sidewall bulge as something that can wait.

PRACTICE TEST 17

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A principal contractor's site rules ban work under suspended loads and require permits for hot work, but they are shown only on the gate noticeboard. A subcontractor's crew start work without being told, saying their own firm's rules are good enough. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Induction must cover the rules before work starts, and contractors must follow the principal contractor's directions and relevant plan as well as their own rules

☐ **B)** The rules bind only the principal contractor's directly employed staff, because subcontractors' workers are covered by their own employer's duties and procedures on site

☐ **C)** A noticeboard at the gate is enough notice, because workers are expected to read the displayed site rules for themselves before they begin any work

☐ **D)** Each contractor may follow its own rules where they are broadly similar, because only the client can require compliance with another firm's site rules

2. A contractor will take the only passenger lift serving a hospital's day-surgery floor out of service for ten days of modernisation. Its risk assessment covers only the lift engineers' entrapment and fall risks. Which omission is most significant?

☐ **A)** Patient risks matter only if the contractor works inside a clinical room, so a lift shaft and machine room are outside the assessment's scope

☐ **B)** The assessment should be repeated only after the lift is back in service, once patients can be seen using the new equipment safely again

☐ **C)** Nothing is missing, because the hospital assesses risks to its own patients and the contractor assesses only the risks to its own operatives at work

☐ **D)** People affected by the closure, such as bed moves and urgent patient access, are not assessed or agreed with hospital managers

3. In a depot charging bay, three electric forklifts with lead-acid batteries are on overnight charge. The roller door is shut for security, and a fitter is about to unclip a charger lead from a battery. Which action best reduces the fire and explosion risk?

☐ **A)** Keep the bay ventilated so hydrogen cannot collect, and switch each charger off before disconnecting its leads

☐ **B)** Keep the door shut to hold the heat in, and place a dry-powder extinguisher beside the chargers to fight any flash fire quickly

☐ **C)** Disconnect the leads while the charger is running to stop the gas at once, and wear antistatic clothing so that no spark can occur

☐ **D)** Charge with the battery compartment covers closed to contain any gas, and top up the electrolyte only after charging has finished

4. Fire breaks out in a site store holding paints, thinners and resin drums, 15 m from a surface-water drain that leads to a stream. Everyone is out and the fire service is called. What should the site manager do before crews start firefighting?

☐ **A)** Open the nearest drain covers so firewater leaves the compound quickly and does not flood the cabins or the road outside it

☐ **B)** Tell the crews what chemicals are stored and where drains run, so they can block them and contain the contaminated firewater

☐ **C)** Start diverting the run-off by hand into the foul sewer, because the sewage works can treat any liquid that enters it

☐ **D)** Wait until the fire is out before mentioning the drains, since pollution is dealt with only after the emergency is over

5. Two workers dry-sand plasterboard joint filler throughout a 40-room refurbishment over three weeks. The supervisor says gypsum is not silica, so it is only nuisance dust and masks are optional. Which approach best follows the control hierarchy?

☐ **A)** Issue disposable dust masks to both workers, because protecting each person is the quickest way to deal with the dust

problem

☐ **B)** Agree that no controls are needed as gypsum is not silica, and open the windows while the dry sanding of filler continues

☐ **C)** Avoid sanding where the finish allows, otherwise use on-tool extraction, and add suitable RPE only if assessment shows exposure remains

☐ **D)** Limit each worker to short bursts of sanding and rotate them hourly, so that nobody exceeds the eight-hour exposure limit

6. Two labourers push a hand pallet truck carrying 900 kg of tile adhesive up a ramp to a basement store, about 25 m, leaning hard into the handle. They say the wheels do the work, so no assessment is needed. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Add a third person pulling from the front of the truck, so the effort is shared and nobody has to lean on the handle

☐ **B)** Reduce the pallet to what two people can start moving, then swap the pair over every ten minutes to avoid fatigue

☐ **C)** Accept the task, because wheeled equipment carries the weight and only the effort needed to start the load moving really counts

☐ **D)** The slope and distance need a detailed assessment, and a powered truck or a level route should replace hard pushing

7. On a facade lift, 38 mm boards project about 350 mm beyond the last transom, and across one bay the boards sag underfoot because the transoms are far apart. The scaffolder says the boards are tied, so they are safe. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Paint the overhang as a warning and limit the bay to one person at a time, since such light use will not overstress the boards

☐ **B)** Accept the overhang as tying prevents any tipping, and lay a second layer of boards over the sagging bay to stiffen it up

☐ **C)** Cut the overhang to no more than four times board thickness and support the boards on transoms at each end and between

☐ **D)** Fit a toe board along the overhang and keep people out of the sagging bay until the next scheduled inspection of the lift is done



8. Look at the scene. The roofer says he is safe because the parapet wall is solid brick and he is only leaning on it for a few minutes. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The scraper is too long for one person, so a colleague should hold it while he works from the same position at the wall

☐ **B)** The parapet is too low to act as edge protection, so he could topple over it, and proper guardrails or a restraint system are needed

☐ **C)** The roof deck is wet and slippery, so he should wear boots with a better sole before working near the roof edge

☐ **D)** The brick wall might crumble under his weight, so he should stand further back and use a longer scraper to reach the gutter

9. A groundworker digging a 1.2 m trench for a new water service uncovers a dark grey pipe crossing the trench. It is on no drawing. A colleague says it looks old and disused, so they can cut it out with an angle grinder. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Stop work there, treat the pipe as live, have the owner identify and isolate it, and support it while exposed

☐ **B)** Cut a small slot in the pipe first, since a little leakage will show whether it carries anything under pressure

☐ **C)** Backfill around it and carry on past, since a pipe missing from the drawings cannot belong to a service that is in use

☐ **D)** Tap the pipe with a hammer and cut it if it sounds hollow, since an empty-sounding pipe cannot hold anything dangerous

10. At a materials loading bay, delivery drivers park, then walk across the unloading area to sign in at the cabin while a telehandler works and a lorry reverses. The manager proposes hi-vis for drivers and a wave from the operator. Which control best fits the hierarchy?

☐ **A)** Provide a barrier-protected walkway and a driver waiting

area clear of the working zone, so that nobody has to cross it

☐ **B)** Sound horns more often and slow the vehicles in the bay to walking pace, so that a driver can step clear in time

☐ **C)** Brief each driver on the dangers at the gate, since an informed pedestrian can then judge the gaps in the traffic safely

☐ **D)** Rely on hi-vis and a wave from the telehandler operator, as a visible driver can cross when the operator stops

11. On his third day, a new labourer tells the site manager that edge protection is missing on a roof. The site has no safety representative. He is dismissed the next morning, and the employer says he has under two years' service, so no claim is possible. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** The employer may dismiss freely in the first month, because protection for raising concerns starts only after a formal probation period ends

☐ **B)** If raising the concern was the reason, the dismissal is automatically unfair and needs no minimum service, so he can claim at an employment tribunal

☐ **C)** The HSE can serve a notice ordering his reinstatement, because victimisation for a safety complaint is dealt with by enforcement officers

☐ **D)** He needs two years' service for any unfair dismissal claim, so his only remedy is to report the missing edge protection to the HSE

12. On a frosty 7 am start, a gang begins hand-laying heavy kerbs straight away in thin clothing. By mid-morning two workers report stiff, aching backs, and the manager points out that lifting technique training was given. Which response best addresses the risk?

☐ **A)** Issue back support belts to every worker, because supports let stiff muscles take heavy loads safely when the temperature is low

☐ **B)** Let workers set their own pace and start later, since cold mainly affects people who already have a history of back trouble

☐ **C)** Reassess the task including the cold, provide lifting aids, rotate the gang, and allow a gentle warm-up and layered clothing that does not restrict movement

☐ **D)** Repeat the lifting technique training and keep the same gang on kerbs all day, since good technique removes the extra strain that cold causes

13. A contractor tells a drainage crew working in live sewers that anyone wanting hepatitis A vaccination must book a GP appointment and pay for it, and that workers who decline will be treated as having accepted the risk. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Vaccination is compulsory for sewer work, so workers who decline can be removed from the task, because it is the main control for the infection

☐ **B)** After risk assessment the employer should offer the vaccine at its own cost, workers may decline, and other controls stay in place for all

☐ **C)** The employer need only pay for vaccines once a worker has been ill, because immunisation is treated as a personal health matter until then

☐ **D)** Offering vaccination is needed only for hepatitis B, because hepatitis A spreads through food and has no recognised link with work in sewers



14. Look at the scene. The labourer wears a helmet, hi-vis, gloves and boots, and says all of it is in good order. What is the most significant problem, and the correct action?

☐ **A)** The lamp's battery pack hangs from the back of the helmet, so he should move it to his belt and keep using the same helmet

☐ **B)** The helmet colour does not match his role as a labourer, so he should swap to the colour for labourers, as colour shows the level of protection

☐ **C)** The lamp is bright enough to dazzle colleagues, so he should fit a dimmer one, as holes only matter after the helmet takes a heavy impact

☐ **D)** The helmet shell has been drilled for a lamp bracket, which weakens it; replace it with a helmet whose maker supplies approved lamp fittings

15. A plasterer passed a face fit test on one make of valved FFP3 disposable mask. The site buys a cheaper unvalved FFP3 from another maker, and the supervisor says his test still counts because both are FFP3 and he is clean-shaven. What is correct?

☐ **A)** The test carries over to any FFP3 mask, since the standard class sets the same filter performance and fit is judged by that class

☐ **B)** A pass covers only the make, model and size tested, so he needs a new fit test on the unvalved mask before relying on it

☐ **C)** The unvalved mask will fit at least as well as a valved one, so a seal check at each use is enough without a further test

☐ **D)** The test carries over while he stays clean-shaven and checks the seal, since facial hair matters more than which mask is used

16. Maintenance staff must reseal the glazing bars on top of a lantern light standing 1.5 m proud of a flat roof 10 m up. The roof has a solid deck and edge protection round its perimeter. A technician proposes leaning a ladder against the lantern frame. Which approach best controls the risk?

☐ **A)** Lean the ladder on the frame, tie it to the glazing bars and have a colleague foot it, since the perimeter edge protection covers the roof

☐ **B)** Lay a crawling board across the lantern top to spread his weight, since the board prevents any fall through the glazing

☐ **C)** Use a small guarded platform, such as a low access tower, on the solid deck, with nothing resting on the lantern glazing or frame

☐ **D)** Anchor his harness to the lantern frame and work from the ladder, because the harness would arrest a fall from the lantern

17. Scaffolders stripping a scaffold beside a public footway stack 6.4 m tubes and loose couplers on the top lift to lower later. The tube ends project beyond the guardrail over the footway, and the stack sits at the access ladder. Which change best controls the risk?

☐ **A)** Keep tubes inside the guardrail line, lash them in bundles and bag the fittings, then lower them as stripping goes on, not stockpile them

☐ **B)** Pile the tubes at the ladder access, because it keeps them away from the edge and makes them quickest to lower at the end of the shift

☐ **C)** Leave the stack as it is but cone off the footway beneath it, since the toe boards stop any tube or coupler from falling off the lift edge

☐ **D)** Push the stack back until the ends clear the guardrail, and leave the couplers loose on the boards where they are within easy reach

18. A fitter must clear a jammed rock from a tracked crusher's jaw. He stops the engine, locks the isolator with his padlock, removes the key and reaches in. A colleague says the isolation is complete. What important step is missing?

☐ **A)** Fit a second padlock owned by the supervisor, because two locks on the isolator remove the risk from any stored hydraulic pressure

☐ **B)** Prove the isolation by trying to start the machine, then release residual hydraulic pressure and secure the jammed rock first

☐ **C)** Nothing, because a locked isolator with the key held by the fitter guarantees that the jaw and the rock have no movement left in them

☐ **D)** Ask the operator to stay at the controls so he can stop the jaw if it moves, since locked isolators can still fail in service

19. A telehandler's forks are replaced with a jib and hook to place steel beams. The driver, whose view of the hook is blocked by the boom, relies on the fork load chart in the cab and checks the load indicator is switched on. What is the main concern?

☐ **A)** None if the beam is within the fork chart, because the machine rating governs whichever attachment is fitted and the indicator adjusts automatically

☐ **B)** The indicator should be switched off with a jib fitted, because it gives readings for forks only, and he should rely on his own judgment

☐ **C)** The beam should be lifted on the forks instead, because a hook may only be used on a crane and never on a telehandler

☐ **D)** The chart and indicator setting must match the jib attachment, and a signaller should guide him because his view of the load is restricted

20. A fit-out crew washes emulsion-paint brushes and a small

cement mixer at an outside tap near the site gate. The grey water runs toward a surface-water gully. Which arrangement best controls pollution?

☐ **A)** Pour the washings onto bare ground away from the gully so they soak in, since soil filters out the cement and the paint

☐ **B)** Wash in the cabin sink so it reaches the foul sewer, since any foul drain accepts site washings without needing permission from anyone

☐ **C)** Let it flow to the gully, as emulsion is water-based and the tap water dilutes the cement enough to cause no harm to a watercourse

☐ **D)** Provide a contained washing area away from drains, with the water collected and removed by a registered carrier or sent to foul sewer with consent

21. A 23-year-old with an NVQ and good references is promoted to supervise a crew forming an opening in a load-bearing wall using needles and props. His experience is in decorating teams. The manager says his qualification proves competence. How should his competence for this task be judged?

☐ **A)** Replace him with the longest-serving worker available, since years in the industry reliably show the ability to supervise temporary support work on any structure

☐ **B)** Assess his knowledge, skills, experience and attitude against this specific task, then limit his role or add supervised mentoring until he proves it

☐ **C)** Accept the qualification and references as proof of competence, because a recognised award already covers every task within the wider trade and its related duties

☐ **D)** Let him run the job from the method statement, because a competent supervisor will ask for help whenever he reaches the limit of his knowledge and skill

22. A pipe rolls onto a labourer's forearm, crushing it and tearing a deep wound. Blood is pumping out and soaks through two pressure dressings within minutes. The first aider has a commercial tourniquet in the kit. What should he do?

☐ **A)** Keep adding dressings and raise the arm, because a tourniquet risks the limb and should be left until a paramedic arrives to decide on it

☐ **B)** Peel off the soaked dressings to inspect the wound, then re-dress it and press with a fresh pad before deciding on any other step

☐ **C)** Apply the tourniquet but loosen it every ten minutes to restore circulation, which stops the limb from dying while help is on its way to the site

☐ **D)** Call 999, fit the tourniquet above the wound and tighten until the bleeding stops, note the time, and leave it on for the ambulance crew

23. Fitters in a small plant room bond insulation using a hot-melt adhesive applicator. To speed the flow, one sets the heater to maximum, and a sharp vapour begins irritating their throats. Which response best applies the COSHH approach?

☐ **A)** Treat throat irritation as the warning sign and stop only if it continues for several days, because the vapour is a nuisance rather than a hazard to health

☐ **B)** Set the applicator to the safety data sheet temperature, provide extraction or fresh air, and keep the hot adhesive off bare skin to avoid fume and burns

☐ **C)** Rotate the fitters every hour at maximum temperature, which keeps individual exposure low enough without altering the equipment settings or the ventilation

☐ **D)** Issue dust masks and carry on at maximum heat, since a mask removes irritant vapours as well as particles and heat only affects how fast the glue flows

24. Roofers cutting lead flashing clean their hands with alcohol gel and eat lunch beside the lead stack, as the welfare cabin is a short walk away. One says lead is only a problem when it is heated. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Wear gloves while eating and wash at home after the shift, because dust left on the skin during the working day cannot be swallowed by mistake

☐ **B)** Move the lunch spot only on cutting days, since cold sheet and loose offcuts leave nothing on the hands that could be harmful if swallowed

☐ **C)** Accept the gel as a substitute for washing, since it clears contamination from skin quickly provided lunch is eaten upwind of the work area

☐ **D)** Wash hands and face with soap and water in the welfare cabin before eating, drinking or smoking, and keep food away

from the work area

25. Free-standing counterweighted guardrails are to be placed around a flat roof's perimeter before roofers start. The installers plan to walk right up to the open edge, and use whatever bricks are to hand as ballast. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Stack extra bricks at each base to compensate for any roof slope, because added weight can make up for the system not being set out as the designer intended

☐ **B)** Use the guardrail as an anchor for the installers' harness lanyards, since a complete guardrail is rated to hold the load of a falling person

☐ **C)** Fit them quickly at the open edge without protection, since the guardrail is the control, and add more bricks later if the wind rises

☐ **D)** Install to the designer's instructions with the specified ballast and set-back, using trained fitters working from a protected position until it is stable



26. Look at the wall-pour platform. The foreman says the guardrails are in place and the crew are experienced. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The top guardrail is below the required height and nobody is wearing a harness, so a fall over the outer edge is most likely

☐ **B)** The access ladder is tied at the wrong angle and cannot be climbed safely, so users are likely to fall while reaching the platform

☐ **C)** A board is missing, leaving an open gap in the platform, and the edge has no toe board, so people or tools could fall through or off

☐ **D)** The formwork has too few ties and will burst under the pressure of concrete, which would drop the platform and the whole crew

27. A 2.2 m deep, 12 m long drainage trench is to be dug in firm clay using hydraulic props and sheets. To save time, the gang plan to dig the whole length to full depth, then climb in to fit the supports. Which sequence is correct?

☐ **A)** Dig the full length first because firm clay stands up while props are fitted, with a lookout at one end to shout out if the sides begin to move

☐ **B)** Fit supports after the first operative climbs down, so the person installing them can judge exactly where each prop and sheet is needed

☐ **C)** Dig in short lengths but fit support only if cracks appear, since clay gives visible signs before it moves and so can be watched by the gang

☐ **D)** Excavate and support in stages, fitting supports from the top or a protected position, and let nobody enter a length until it is supported and inspected

28. A hired floating-earth generator powers a mixer and a cutting saw, both Class I tools, on a paved yard. The foreman wants to fit a link between the generator's neutral and earth terminals so it will behave like the mains. What is the best course?

☐ **A)** Drive an earth rod beside the generator and bond it to both tool bodies, which gives any fault current a clear path back to the source of supply

☐ **B)** Leave the generator's connections as supplied, follow the hire firm's instructions, and run one Class I tool at a time or use Class II tools

☐ **C)** Fit the link, since linking neutral to earth is how every supply is earthed, and the saw and mixer will then be safe to run together on it

☐ **D)** Leave the generator as supplied but run both tools together, because the circuit RCD makes sure that any fault is cut off at once and safely

29. A housing site has a swale designed to take surface water along its boundary. The manager wants to use the swale footprint as a haul route and silt-settling channel now, then tidy it up before handover. Which approach protects its function?

☐ **A)** Leave it open for use but sweep the silt out at handover, as removal at the end restores the original condition of the whole swale

☐ **B)** Fence the swale off from traffic and stockpiles, route

runoff through separate silt controls, and finish the swale late in the programme

☐ **C)** Lay a geotextile and thin stone layer for the haul route, and plant the swale early so the roots stabilise it before the vehicles pass

☐ **D)** Use the footprint as a haul route and settlement channel, since a swale is made to carry dirty water and the grass will recover afterwards

30. At a plant yard wash-down area, the oil separator's high-level alarm sounds. The yard supervisor suggests flushing it through with hot water and a degreaser so the oil is pushed out into the surface-water drain. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Carry on using the wash area and check it again at the next six-monthly inspection, since the alarm only warns that oil is near its limit

☐ **B)** Skim the oil off the top with a bucket and tip it into the site's general waste skip, then reuse the separator without refilling it with water

☐ **C)** Stop using the wash area, have a registered waste carrier empty it and refill it with clean water, and log the work and hazardous waste paperwork

☐ **D)** Flush it with hot water and degreaser to disperse the oil to the drain, since detergent breaks the oil down so it does little harm to the watercourse

31. Midway through a build, the client says the principal designer should have supervised the contractors daily after a worker was hurt fixing cladding. The principal contractor had never told the designer about a changed fixing detail. Which statement best describes the principal designer's role during construction?

☐ **A)** It includes supervising contractors' work on site every day, because the appointment lasts for the whole project and carries overall authority over site health and safety

☐ **B)** It ends once the construction phase plan is accepted, because design decisions and site control then pass entirely to the principal contractor and the contractors

☐ **C)** It is to liaise with the principal contractor and share information, including on design changes, while the principal contractor manages the site work

☐ **D)** It requires approving each contractor's method statement before the task starts, because the principal designer signs off how every activity is to be carried out

32. Before a client audit, a site manager writes the last three weeks of fire-alarm tests into the log, although nobody carried them out. Nothing has happened, and he says no harm is done. Which statement about his position is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Knowingly making a false entry in a required record is itself an offence under the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act, and he can be prosecuted personally

☐ **B)** Only the company can be prosecuted, because he acted as its employee, so he faces at most internal discipline from his employer for the false log

☐ **C)** It is only a paperwork breach, which matters if the alarm later fails and someone is hurt, because enforcement action needs actual harm to follow from it

☐ **D)** It is acceptable if the missed tests are carried out in the following week, because the log then ends up accurate and nothing misleading remains

33. A day crew rated removing a plant-room boiler as medium risk, then leave at 18:00 with the pipework half cut and drained. The night crew, three instead of six, are told the job is assessed, so carry on. Which approach best manages the risk at changeover?

☐ **A)** Keep the medium rating, because the task and method are unchanged and the day supervisor has already approved the assessment for the night crew to use

☐ **B)** Pass on the day crew's method statement alone, because it describes every step and the incoming crew can work out what is already done from it

☐ **C)** Lower the rating, because fewer people are exposed overnight with the building empty and so the likelihood of anyone being harmed is reduced

☐ **D)** Re-rate the task against its partly finished state and smaller crew, with a face-to-face handover of what is isolated, drained or cut

34. An installer sprays aerosol adhesive onto wall panels in a windowless 6 m2 lobby with the door shut and a gas boiler with a pilot flame in the cupboard. He plans a P2 dust mask, short bursts and a fan blowing into the corridor. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Replace the P2 dust mask with a P3 filter mask, which is the highest standard of protection and so suits fine mist from spray products

☐ **B)** Keep the aerosol but fit an organic-vapour filter and run the fan, because the correct filter handles the health risk and the airflow takes out the fire risk

☐ **C)** Switch to a roller-applied water-based adhesive, which removes both the flammable propellant vapour and the inhalation hazard at source

☐ **D)** Spray in short bursts with the door propped open, because propellant gas disperses quickly in the corridor and does not build up in the lobby

35. A fabricator wearing vented goggles to grind weld spatter is about to pour a 5-litre container of acid descaler into a bucket. He says the goggles stopped sparks so they will stop splashes. Which action is correct?

☐ **A)** Wear the face shield alone, because a full-face visor covers more of the face than goggles and so stops splashes arriving from all directions

☐ **B)** Wear safety spectacles with side shields, because they meet the impact standard and block liquid coming from the front and from both sides

☐ **C)** Carry on with the vented goggles, because impact-rated lenses resist liquid as well as particles and the lens strength matters more than the venting

☐ **D)** Swap to indirectly vented or sealed goggles suitable for liquids, with a face shield over them for pouring, keeping the vented pair for grinding

36. Debris has built up in the pit under a material hoist, whose platform is parked at third-floor level. A labourer plans to climb in and shovel it out, saying the hoist is switched off and the gate is shut. What should happen first?

☐ **A)** Finish the clean-out quickly with the platform parked, because the pit is entered for only a few minutes and the brake is holding the load

☐ **B)** Station a colleague at the control with a radio, so he can stop the platform at once if it starts to move while the pit is being cleared

☐ **C)** Isolate and lock off the hoist, then mechanically support the raised platform so it cannot descend, before anyone enters the pit

☐ **D)** Switch off at the hoist control and close the landing gate, because an unpowered platform stays where it was left and cannot fall on someone

37. A fitter must hang cable tray in a plant room with 2.4 m headroom, where bare live busbars run across the ceiling. He plans a fibreglass stepladder, saying fibreglass does not conduct, and a colleague will warn him if his head gets close. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Neither measure is adequate; work within reach should wait until the busbars are made dead or physically barriered so nobody can come into contact

☐ **B)** The fibreglass ladder makes the job acceptable, provided he uses plastic-handled tools and takes care not to touch the busbars with his hands

☐ **C)** The spotter is a sufficient control if he is competent, because a verbal warning gives the fitter time to move away before any contact

☐ **D)** A shorter stepladder solves the problem, because keeping his head below 2 m leaves a clear gap to the busbars at 2.4 m



38. Look at the scene. The operator is trained and the cab is fully enclosed. Which is the most serious problem?

☐ **A)** A second worker is holding a shovel near the fence, so tools are being used within the work area during breaking

☐ **B)** The breaker is working on a slab rather than from a stable base, which risks the excavator rocking and hitting the cab

☐ **C)** Dust is hanging in the air and the hose is unused, which alone makes the operation unacceptable until suppression is running

☐ **D)** A labourer stands within reach of flying fragments and the

moving machine, with no exclusion zone set up

39. A mini-dumper operator tops up from a bowser with the engine idling to save restart time, wedges the nozzle trigger open and walks off for a delivery ticket. Diesel overflows onto the hot exhaust. What should have been done?

☐ **A)** Fill slowly with the engine running and with the exhaust covered by a wet cloth, since cooling the manifold removes any ignition risk

☐ **B)** Stop the engine and let hot parts cool before filling, and stay at the nozzle throughout so the flow can be stopped at once

☐ **C)** Keep the engine idling and use the wedge only while a spill kit stands beside the machine, since a kit contains any overflow before it can ignite

☐ **D)** Fill the tank to the brim before shutting down, since a full tank leaves no air space for vapour and so cannot burn

40. A contractor works nights beside a hedgerow and housing. Two tower floodlights are aimed horizontally to light the work, and light floods bedroom windows and the hedge where bats and birds feed. Residents complain. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Leave the lights as they are because night work needs strong lighting, and tell residents to close their curtains if they object

☐ **B)** Aim lights downward, shield and lower them, use only the lighting needed and switch off when not working, keeping spill off the hedge

☐ **C)** Keep the lights on all night so that the hedge and the work area stay lit, which is said to deter bats and birds from nesting

☐ **D)** Raise the lights higher on the towers to reach more of the site, since a wider beam spreads the light thinner over homes

41. A principal contractor launches a phone-app system for reporting hazards and consults only its direct employees, because 14 of the 40 labourers are agency staff who, it assumes, can raise concerns through their agency. What is the best course before launch?

☐ **A)** Leave the agency labourers out, since consultation is limited to elected safety representatives, and show the app to them during their arrival induction

☐ **B)** Consult the direct employees now and the agency labourers after launch, because a few weeks of use shows which problems really affect them

☐ **C)** Include the agency labourers in the consultation, with the agency cooperating, so those who must use the system can say whether it works for them

☐ **D)** Brief the agency's account manager by email, since the agency holds the whole duty to consult its workers and the site only has to host them

42. A supplier's competent team finishes erecting a hired tower crane at 11 am. The contractor's assessment records 'competent crew, low risk', and the manager wants lifting to start at noon with the erectors choosing the operator. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Wait for the independent thorough examination, and check operator, slinger and lift plan for this site, since skill in erecting is not skill in using

☐ **B)** Begin with light loads while the operator tests the controls, since that proves the crane and a written examination is needed only at the yearly interval

☐ **C)** Start at noon, because the people who built the crane are best placed to judge it safe, and their own commissioning checks serve as the examination

☐ **D)** Obtain the examination report, then start, because the erectors' competence also covers choosing the operator and the lifts, so no site checks follow

43. A plumbed emergency eyewash in a chemical store has not been run since installation six weeks ago. A test run gives rust-brown, cloudy water for several seconds before clearing. The foreman signs the tag, saying it clearly works. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Treat it as not ready: run it regularly as the maker directs to clear stagnant water, check flow and temperature, and keep records

☐ **B)** Arrange an annual engineer service only, because frequent running wastes water and wears the valve, and a yearly check shows whether it works

☐ **C)** Accept the tag, because water that clears shows the pipework is clean, so flushing is needed only after a unit has actually been used

☐ **D)** Swap it for a sterile saline bottle and stop running the

unit, since stagnant water is only a risk to drinking supplies and not to eyes

44. A floor layer scrapes old adhesive from a screed using a short-handled hand scraper, kneeling with the wrist cocked upward for hours, and now has forearm pain. The supervisor offers wrist supports. Which change best controls the cause?

☐ **A)** Issue elasticated wrist supports to every floor layer, because limiting wrist movement removes the strain while the same short scraper is used

☐ **B)** Provide a long-handled scraper used standing so the wrist stays straight and the body supplies the force, and mix the task with other work

☐ **C)** Rotate a colleague onto the scraper each hour, so total exposure is shared between two people although the short tool and kneeling remain

☐ **D)** Supply thick padded gloves, to cushion the handle and spread pressure over the palm, which relieves the strain on the wrist joint

45. Two workers clear silt from a warm, humid 1.2 m culvert in planned three-hour entries. The supervisor lets them carry water bottles to sip at the work face and eat lunch inside to save time. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Plan shorter entries with rest, drinks and food in a clean area outside, since heat builds up inside and silt on hands can be swallowed

☐ **B)** Have them drink well before entering and after leaving only, because sipping inside would raise toilet needs and distract from the task

☐ **C)** Keep three-hour entries and allow both inside, because time saved by not leaving means less total exposure and fewer awkward re-entries

☐ **D)** Allow bottles but ban food inside, because water helps cooling at the work face and the contamination risk comes only from eating a meal

46. Operatives repair a canal bank, working within a metre of deep water. Foam-filled lifejackets are kept in the van. The supervisor says nobody has fallen in so far and that the jackets can stay stowed until someone does. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Wear them only on days with a visible current, because still water poses little risk of drowning to workers on the bank

☐ **B)** Make them optional for confident swimmers, as a good swimmer can reach the bank unaided after falling in cold water

☐ **C)** Assess the risk of falling in, then provide lifejackets that fit and are worn, checked before use, with a rescue plan

☐ **D)** Keep them in the van and fetch them if someone falls in, since stowed equipment is quicker to use than clothing worn all day



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the operative's PPE is fine, since he has glasses, a dust mask and gloves. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The bucket sits on the floor, and bending to mix creates a manual handling hazard that outweighs any hazard from the spinning paddle

☐ **B)** His nitrile-coated gloves should be leather gauntlets for mixing, because thicker gloves are always the safer choice around powered tools

☐ **C)** His FFP2 dust mask is inadequate for tile adhesive, which needs an air-fed hood, so respiratory protection is the most serious failing

☐ **D)** Something hanging from his neck could be caught by the rotating paddle and pull him in, so it should be removed or be a breakaway type

48. Forecast gusts will exceed those assumed in the design of an 18 m scaffold fully clad in sheeting. A labourer suggests slitting the sheets with a knife to let the wind through. Which action is correct?

☐ **A)** Do not cut them; ask the scaffold designer or contractor to advise on removing sheeting in a controlled way before the wind, then inspect afterwards

☐ **B)** Leave the cladding as it is, because ties designed for sheeting cope with any forecast gust, and an inspection after the wind is unnecessary

☐ **C)** Slit every bay at mid-height, since the cut area cuts the load and the ties designed for sheets will then be well oversized for the wind

☐ **D)** Let the bricklayers pull the sheets off from the lifts in the morning wind, since less sheeting means less load and they can refix it later

49. The foreman logs that a 30 mA RCD on the board feeding the welfare cabins passes its test button every morning and says nothing more is needed. An electrician disagrees. What is the best position?

☐ **A)** Stop pressing the button and rely on instrument tests, since repeated button use wears out the device and shortens its working life

☐ **B)** Test with an instrument only after a trip incident, because a daily pass shows the RCD would trip at the rated residual current

☐ **C)** Keep the daily check, but the button proves only the mechanism, so a competent person must also instrument-test trip current and time

☐ **D)** The daily button check is the only test required on sites, and instrument testing applies to domestic installations rather than construction supplies

50. A contractor resurfaces half of a busy supermarket car park while the rest stays open. A dumper must cross open parking aisles to the works. The manager plans cones, a 5 mph limit and a banksman waving it through. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Provide a fenced haul route with controlled crossings and trained marshals, with plant movements timed away from peak customer hours

☐ **B)** Rely on high-visibility vests for the dumper driver and banksman, since being seen by shoppers is the main way to avoid collisions

☐ **C)** Run the dumper at the busiest time with two banksmen, since a busier car park makes drivers slower and shoppers more watchful

☐ **D)** Keep the plan, adding a flashing beacon and a sign at each aisle, because the speed limit and banksman already control the main risk

Answer Key

1. A — The principal contractor must ensure a suitable site induction is provided under CDM 2015 regulation 13, and on multi-contractor projects each contractor must comply with its directions and the relevant parts of the construction phase plan under regulation 15.

B: The principal contractor coordinates everyone on the project, and subcontractors' workers must follow its site rules as well as their employer's. C: A displayed notice is not a suitable site induction, so the principal contractor has not met its duty to ensure one is provided. D: Regulation 15 requires contractors to comply with the principal contractor's directions, so similarity to their own rules is no defence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a rule displayed on a board or followed in the contractor's own firm counts as the induction and compliance the principal contractor must secure.

2. D — Employers must assess risks to others affected by their work, and co-ordinate with the premises controller, so the loss of the lift for patients and staff must be considered and planned.

A: The risk comes from loss of the lift route for patients, not from where the engineers physically work. B: Assessment must come before the work starts so controls can be planned, not after the changes have been made. C: A contractor's duty extends to non-employees affected by its work, and the closure is a risk the contractor creates.

COMMON MISTAKE: Limiting the assessment to the contractor's own operatives and forgetting people elsewhere in the building who are affected by the work.

3. A — Charging releases hydrogen, which is explosive in air, so ventilation prevents a build-up and isolating the charger first avoids a spark at the terminals.

B: An extinguisher responds to a fire but does nothing to stop the hydrogen building up in a closed bay. C: Breaking a live charging connection creates the very spark that can ignite hydrogen around the battery. D: Covers should be open during charging so gas can disperse, and trapped hydrogen under a closed lid raises the explosion risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a battery bay as a place where heat is the only fire danger and forgetting that charging gives off explosive hydrogen.

4. B — Firewater from a chemical fire is potentially polluting, so the fire service needs the information to choose its tactics and to block drains and contain run-off.

A: Opening drains sends contaminated firewater straight to the stream, when drains should be blocked and the water contained. C: Discharge to the foul sewer needs the water company's permission and cannot be treated as a quick fix for contaminated firewater. D: Containment must be in place while the water is being used, because most of the polluting run-off is produced during firefighting.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that firefighting water is harmless and that pollution is a clean-up task for afterwards.

5. C — Dust must be controlled under COSHH at source first, so avoiding sanding or using on-tool extraction comes before respiratory protection, which is the last line of defence.

A: Masks only protect the wearer and sit at the bottom of the hierarchy, leaving dust in the air for everyone else. B: Gypsum dust has its own exposure limits and breathing it in at high levels is harmful, so open windows are not a substitute for assessment. D: Rotating people shares the dust exposure rather than reducing it, and short bursts still produce high peak concentrations.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming dust is harmless unless it contains silica, and reaching for a mask before controlling the dust at source.

6. D — Slopes, long distances and leaning to generate force take a push-pull task beyond the low-risk filter, so it should be assessed and the force removed with powered aids or a better route.

A: Pulling a loaded truck up a ramp introduces new risks, including being struck if the load runs back. B: Swapping workers only spreads the strain around, while the awkward force and slope remain unchanged. C: Wheels reduce friction but the slope still demands large sustained force, and leaning to apply it signals significant risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that putting a load on wheels removes the need to assess the push-pull force and the route.

7. C — HSE guidance says boards must be properly supported and not overhang excessively, with four times the board thickness as the example, and a sagging span shows inadequate intermediate support.

A: A warning and fewer users leave the defect in place, and a board can still tip or break under a single person. B: Tying does not make a long overhang safe, and doubling boards across a poorly supported span only adds load. D: A toe board does not support the board end,

and leaving a known defect in use is not an acceptable control.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a platform safe because it feels firm or is tied, without checking that every board is properly supported along its length.

8. B — A parapet below guardrail height does not stop a person leaning or overbalancing over it, so edge protection to the required height, or a restraint system, is needed.

A: Sharing the tool does not prevent a fall over the low wall. C: The deck is dry, and better soles do not deal with a low edge. D: The main risk is falling over a low wall, not the wall crumbling.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any solid parapet wall counts as edge protection, whatever its height.

9. A — Unidentified services must be treated as live until disconnected and proven safe at the point of work, and exposed services may need supporting while the owner is contacted.

B: Cutting an unidentified pipe is itself the hazard and could release gas or pressurised liquid or damage a cable duct. C: Drawings are often incomplete, so a pipe being unrecorded is no evidence that it is abandoned. D: Sound does not show what a pipe contains, and a hollow-sounding pipe could still carry gas, water or fuel.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that an unmarked pipe or one missing from the plans is disused and therefore safe to cut.

10. A — Physically separating pedestrians from vehicles removes the conflict, and this ranks above reliance on visibility or signals from operators.

B: Reduced speed lowers the risk a little but still leaves pedestrians and vehicles sharing the same space. C: Information alone is a weak control and cannot be relied on to prevent people entering the working zone. D: This depends on one operator's attention and a signal, and visibility does not prevent someone being struck in a blind spot.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on hi-vis, signals and briefings to manage pedestrians who could instead be kept physically apart from vehicles.

11. B — Dismissal for reasonably raising a health and safety concern, where no safety representative exists, is automatically unfair under the Employment Rights Act, and the two-year qualifying period does not apply to it.

A: The protection applies from the first day of employment and does not depend on any probation period. C: The HSE enforces safety standards but cannot order reinstatement, which is a matter for an employment tribunal. D: Health and safety dismissals are exempt from the two-year qualifying period, so a tribunal claim is open to him from day one.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a short-serving worker has no employment protection when he raises a safety concern.

12. C — Cold is an environmental factor that raises manual handling risk, so the assessment should be revisited and the load, task and conditions improved rather than relying on technique alone.

A: Back belts are not proven to prevent injury and can give false confidence while the load and cold conditions remain unchanged. B: Cold affects all workers, and leaving it to individuals does not reduce the load or the exposure for the gang. D: Training alone does not remove the load or the effect of cold on muscles, and it ranks below changing the task.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating manual handling risk as a matter of technique and ignoring the weather and the working conditions.

13. B — Vaccination is offered, not forced, and paid for by the employer as a supplement to other controls, which must protect all workers whether or not they accept it.

A: Immunisation is offered rather than imposed, and it supplements other controls instead of being the main one. C: Where the risk assessment calls for vaccination, the employer must provide it at its cost before any illness occurs. D: Hepatitis A is caught from raw sewage on hands, clothing or splashes, so sewer workers are at recognised risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a worker who declines a vaccine has taken over the employer's duty to control the infection risk.

14. D — Drilling or bolting through a helmet shell can crack it and reduce its impact protection, so a damaged or modified helmet must be replaced by one with manufacturer-approved accessories.

A: Moving the battery leaves the drilled and cracked shell in use, which is the actual weakness. B: Helmet colours identify roles by site convention only and do not indicate protection, and the shell damage is the real problem. C: A hole weakens the shell before any impact, so a dimmer lamp does not fix the damaged helmet.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a helmet can be adapted or drilled to suit the job as long as it still looks like a helmet.

15. B — Fit testing matches a person to a specific facepiece, so a change of make or model requires a repeat test, whatever the

filter class or valve type.

A: The class describes filter performance only, while face seal depends on the shape of each particular make and model. C: A pre-use seal check does not replace a fit test on the new model, since the valve does not decide how the mask seals. D: Being clean-shaven is needed in addition to a fit test, not as a substitute for one on the new model.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the FFP3 rating as proof that any FFP3 mask will seal on a worker who has passed a test on one.

16. C — A guarded platform on the solid deck gives collective protection, and the lantern glazing and frame are not designed to carry a ladder or a person.

A: A ladder tied to glazing bars relies on a component not designed to take the load, and perimeter protection does not stop a fall through the lantern. B: A board placed over glazing is unsupported and unguarded, so a slip or a break could still drop him through. D: The frame is not an adequate anchor point, and a harness anchored to it could fail or fall with him.

COMMON MISTAKE: Using the nearest roof structure as a ladder rest or anchor when it was never designed to take a person's weight.

17. A — Keeping materials to a small, secured quantity inside the guardrails, clear of the access and the public, limits both the dropped-object and the trip hazard.

B: A stack at the access blocks the way on and off the lift and creates a trip hazard in the escape route. C: Toe boards do not hold projecting tubes or loose couplers, and cones do not stop an object hitting someone who walks past. D: Loose couplers still roll or get kicked over the edge, and the stack still blocks the access ladder.

COMMON MISTAKE: Stockpiling stripped scaffold materials on a lift as if the platform were a store.

18. B — Isolation must be proved effective and any stored energy, such as hydraulic pressure or a rock held by gravity, must be released or blocked before anyone puts a hand in.

A: Extra locks do not release stored pressure, which needs a deliberate procedure after the energy source is isolated. C: A lock stops the energy supply but does not remove energy already stored in the system or held by the jammed rock. D: Relying on a person at the controls is a weaker control than proving isolation, and a person at the controls could start the machine.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that once a machine is locked off it holds no energy and is safe to reach into.

19. D — Each attachment has its own rated capacity and indicator configuration, and a restricted view of the load needs a trained signaller to guide the lift.

A: A jib changes the load geometry and capacity, so the fork chart and a fork-set indicator would give wrong limits. B: Disabling the safety system removes the warning of overload, and the correct step is to set it for the attachment. C: A suitable jib and hook can be used on a telehandler when the attachment, chart and lifting arrangements are correct.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming the load chart for the forks applies to every attachment that can be fitted to the same machine.

20. D — Surface-water drains discharge to the environment, so contaminated washings must be contained and either removed by a registered carrier or discharged to the foul sewer with the water company's consent.

A: Alkaline cement and paint washings can pollute soil and groundwater, and soil does not filter them out safely. B: Discharging contaminated site washings to foul sewer needs the water company's consent, and sinks are not designed for cement. C: Paint and cement washings are polluting even when diluted, and a surface-water gully leads directly to a watercourse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking water-based paint and cement washings are harmless once they have been diluted with tap water.

21. B — Competence is the combination of training, skills, experience and knowledge for the particular task, so it must be tested against the work and not assumed from age, grade or a general qualification.

A: Length of service alone is not evidence of the specific skills, knowledge and attitude this task needs, so it is no better a test than age. C: A general award does not show experience of temporary support to structural openings, which is a different and higher-risk task. D: Relying on a person to recognise his own gaps is unsafe, as the employer must check capability before allocating a high-risk task.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a card, a qualification or a number of years in the trade proves someone can safely supervise a task they have never done.

22. D — Life-threatening limb bleeding that dressings cannot control needs a tourniquet applied above the wound, and it must stay tightened and be timed so the ambulance crew know when it went on.

A: Waiting while blood continues to pump risks death within

minutes, and a tourniquet is the accepted step when pressure fails. B: Removing dressings disturbs clots and wastes time, and pressure has already failed to control this bleed. C: Loosening the tourniquet restarts the bleeding and it should be left in place for medical staff to remove.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a tourniquet as a last resort that must be loosened periodically, when for a life-threatening limb bleed it is left tight and timed.

23. B — Overheating raises vapour release, so controlling the source temperature and ventilating the work area comes before any personal protection, and hot adhesive also needs burn protection.

A: Irritation is already a sign of harmful exposure, and waiting for it to worsen is not a control. C: Rotation shares the exposure without reducing it, and it ignores the simple step of lowering the temperature at source. D: A simple dust mask does not filter vapours, and it leaves the cause of the extra fume uncontrolled.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reaching for a mask or a rota before checking whether the process itself is generating more vapour than the data sheet intends.

24. D — Swallowing lead dust from hands, food and cigarettes is a main route into the body, so washing with soap and water and eating away from the work area breaks that route.

A: Gloves carry the dust to food and mouth, and delaying washing until home extends the time the lead stays on the skin. B: Handling the sheet and offcuts transfers lead dust to the hands whether or not it is being cut, so the hygiene rule applies throughout the work. C: Gel is designed to kill germs and does not remove metal dust, and being upwind does not stop dust on hands reaching the mouth.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a quick wipe or gel is enough, when only proper washing before eating, drinking or smoking removes lead dust from skin.

25. D — A counterweighted system only resists a fall when it is assembled and ballasted as designed, and the people installing it are themselves working at height so need protection while doing so.

A: Ballast figures depend on the design, the roof surface and slope, and random weight does not make up for a layout the system was never tested for. B: Free-standing guardrails are not designed as anchor points, and a fall load could tip the whole line over the edge. C: The installers are exposed to the open edge before any guardrail is in place, and untested ballast may fail under load.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a free-standing guardrail as safe because it is heavy, without checking it was ballasted and installed as designed for that roof.

26. C — A working platform must be fully boarded without gaps and have toe boards, so a missing board and absent toe board are the faults most likely to cause a fall of a person or material.

A: The top rail is at the correct height with a mid rail, and harnesses are not the primary control where guardrails are provided. B: The ladder is tied and set at a suitable angle, so it is not the main failing in the picture. D: Tie spacing cannot be judged from the picture and it is not the visible fault in the platform itself.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a platform safe from its top rail alone, without checking every board, gap and toe board along its length.

27. D — Support has to go in as the digging progresses so that no one works in an unsupported length, because even firm clay can collapse without warning.

A: A lookout cannot give enough warning of a sudden collapse, and unsupported depth is exactly what exposes the fitters. B: Entering an unsupported excavation to fit support puts the fitter at the greatest risk before any protection exists. C: Clay can fail suddenly with little warning, so waiting for cracks leaves the workers exposed when it happens.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming firm-looking ground can be left unsupported for a short time while the support is fitted by hand.

28. B — A floating-earth generator relies on its designed arrangement, so hirers must not change its connections, and limiting the load to one Class I item or to Class II tools keeps a fault from putting dangerous voltages on other equipment.

A: Linking tool bodies to a rod does not create a return path to the source on this type of supply and may add hazards. C: Altering the internal connections can defeat the protection the generator was designed to give and is not for the hirer to do. D: An RCD helps but does not make it acceptable to run two Class I items at once on a floating-earth set.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking every temporary supply must be earthed like the mains, when a floating-earth generator relies on its designed arrangement left unaltered.

29. B — Compaction and silt reduce infiltration and storage, so keeping vehicles and muddy runoff out and building the final form near the end of the works protects the design performance.

A: Sweeping cannot reverse compaction of the underlying soil, and

silt that has washed in can clog infiltration. C: Plant roots and a thin layer cannot stop compaction by heavy plant, and the surface is still silted by runoff. D: Traffic compacts the ground and silt clogs the surface, which can permanently reduce how well the swale drains.

COMMON MISTAKE: Viewing a drainage feature as a convenient place to put dirty water or traffic while the rest of the site is built.

30. C — An alarm shows oil or silt has reached its limit, so the separator must be emptied by a registered carrier, with oily waste treated as hazardous, and refilled with clean water before reuse.

A: The alarm means the separator should be emptied right away, as continued use will pass oil through into the drain. B: Oily waste is hazardous and does not belong in a general skip, and the separator must be refilled with clean water to work. D: Detergents emulsify oil and stop the separator working, and the oil would reach the surface-water drain and pollute the watercourse.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a separator alarm as a routine reminder, when oil that is not removed properly goes straight to the drain.

31. C — Under CDM 2015 the principal designer must liaise with the principal contractor throughout the appointment and assess the effect of design changes, but planning, managing and monitoring site work is the principal contractor's duty.

A: The principal designer has no duty to supervise site work, which belongs to the principal contractor and each employer. B: The appointment continues into construction, and changes to the design still need the principal designer's input. D: Approving how site tasks are carried out is not a principal designer duty; contractors and the principal contractor manage that.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming the principal designer is the site safety supervisor, when the role is design coordination and liaison with the principal contractor.

32. A — Section 33 of the Act makes it an offence intentionally to make a false entry in a required record, so no injury is needed and the individual as well as the company can be prosecuted.

B: Individuals who intentionally make false entries can be prosecuted personally. C: False entries are offences in their own right and do not depend on any injury. D: Recording tests that were not done when written is still false, and later testing does not undo the offence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a tidied-up record as harmless paperwork when no one was hurt.

33. D — A risk assessment must be reviewed when circumstances change, and a half-completed task with a different crew is not the situation the day rating covered.

A: The state of the work and the crew size have changed, so the original rating no longer fits. B: A written method describes the plan, not the actual condition of a half-finished job. C: Fewer people does not offset unknown isolation status, fatigue and thinner supervision, which raise the likelihood.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a risk rating stays valid across a shift change because the task has the same name.

34. C — Substitution removes the hazard itself, whereas the aerosol keeps a flammable vapour cloud near an ignition source and a vapour that a dust mask does not filter.

A: Particle filters do not stop solvent or propellant vapour, and respirators do not deal with ignition. B: A filter does nothing about flammable vapour, and a pilot flame remains an ignition source in a small room. D: Vapour can still pool near the boiler, and relying on dispersal is not a reliable control.

COMMON MISTAKE: Picking a mask for a vapour problem without asking whether a safer product removes the hazard and the fire risk.

35. D — Direct-vent goggles let liquid through their vents, so splash work needs goggles that seal against liquid, and a face shield adds cover for pouring.

A: A visor leaves gaps under and around it, and is a secondary protector used over eyewear. B: Spectacles do not seal against the face, so liquid can run or splash behind the lenses. C: Strong lenses do not help when liquid can enter through the direct vents at the side.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming eyewear that stops flying particles will also keep liquid out.

36. C — Entry beneath a raised platform needs power isolation and a positive mechanical support, because brakes, controls and switches can fail.

A: A short exposure does not make it safe to stand beneath a platform held only by its brake. B: A person at the controls cannot stop a mechanical failure, and a radio call is too slow to prevent a fall. D: Isolation alone relies on the rope and brake holding, and a failure would drop the platform onto the labourer.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a switched-off control or a brake to hold a raised platform while someone is underneath it.

37. A — Under the Electricity at Work Regulations live

conductors that could cause injury must be made dead or guarded, and a fibreglass ladder or spotter does not prevent contact or arcing.

B: Fibreglass does not guarantee safety, because dirt, damp and conductive tools or tray can still bring him into contact or arcing range. C: A warning cannot stop a slip or a long tray length touching live parts, so it is not a barrier. D: Tools, tray and raised arms reach well above the head, so the busbars remain within reach.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on an insulating ladder or a lookout instead of making the live parts dead or inaccessible.

38. D — People on foot inside the working radius of a breaking excavator risk being struck by fragments or the arm, so the area must be cleared and marked off while the breaker works.

A: He is well back from the machine, so his position is not the main danger. B: Breaking a slab from the ground is normal practice and is not the greatest danger shown. C: Dust control matters, but it is a lesser problem than a person standing inside the strike zone.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing an enclosed cab and a trained operator make it safe for others to stand close to a working machine.

39. B — Fuel spilled on hot surfaces can ignite, and an unattended wedged nozzle removes the chance to stop an overflow.

A: A damp cloth gives no dependable protection and the running engine and unattended nozzle remain. C: A spill kit does not stop fuel contacting hot parts, and leaving the nozzle unattended still causes overfill. D: A full tank cannot take thermal expansion, increases spillage, and does not remove the ignition source.

COMMON MISTAKE: Refuelling a running or hot machine and leaving the nozzle held open to save a few minutes.

40. B — Light can be a nuisance to neighbours and harm wildlife, so lights should be directed to the work area, shielded, kept as low as practicable and switched off when not needed.

A: Spill light can be reduced without making the work unsafe. C: Continuous light can disturb wildlife and increases the nuisance. D: Higher lights usually spill more widely over neighbours and wildlife.

COMMON MISTAKE: Aiming floodlights outward at the site boundary and treating the neighbours' complaints as unavoidable.

41. C — Workers affected by a new arrangement should be consulted before it starts, and the hirer and agency must cooperate, so agency staff directed on site cannot simply be left to their agency.

A: Consultation is not confined to elected representatives, and an induction briefing informs people rather than seeking their views. B: Consultation is meant to shape the arrangement beforehand, not to collect comments once it is already running. D: The hirer controls the work and the arrangement, and the hirer and agency must work together rather than pass the duty across.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that people supplied through an agency are the agency's concern when the site is changing how they work.

42. A — Equipment assembled on site needs a thorough examination after assembly and before use, and the users must separately confirm operating competence and a lift plan for their own site.

B: A trial lift is not an examination, and assembly at a new location triggers one before first use regardless of the yearly cycle. C: The thorough examination must be done by a sufficiently independent competent person, not by the erecting team checking their own work. D: Competence to erect does not show that an operator or lift plan is suitable for this site's loads, routes and signalling.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the competence of the erecting team as proof that the crane is examined and its users are ready.

43. A — Standing water breeds contamination and corrosion debris that would be flushed into a casualty's eyes, so plumbed units need regular activation, flow checks and records.

B: A yearly check leaves the water stagnating for months, so the unit could be unfit exactly when it is needed. C: Clearing after several seconds proves contamination was present, and a casualty cannot wait for the water to run clean. D: Contaminated water in the eyes is a serious hazard, and a single small bottle cannot give the sustained flushing of a plumbed unit.

COMMON MISTAKE: Signing off an eyewash because water comes out, without asking what condition the water is in.

44. B — Tools should let the wrist stay straight and use a power grip, and removing the kneeling, bent-wrist posture tackles the cause rather than the symptom.

A: Supports mask the symptoms and leave the awkward posture and sustained force that cause the injury unchanged. C: Sharing the exposure reduces each person's dose but still puts two people in the same harmful posture. D: Bulky gloves reduce grip and often increase the force needed, and they do nothing to correct wrist angle.

COMMON MISTAKE: Fixing the worker's wrist with a support instead of fixing the tool and posture that bend it.

45. A — Time in a hot, humid confined space may need limiting, and fluids and food should be taken in a clean place so that contaminated hands do not carry material to the mouth.

B: Fluid loss during hot work is real, and the answer is planned breaks outside rather than none during a three-hour entry. C: Long entries in humid heat risk heat stress, and avoiding breaks does not reduce the harm of staying in the space. D: Contaminated hands handling a bottle spout carry silt to the mouth just as they would with food.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging that a drink at the workface is a kindness when it is actually a route for contamination.

46. C — Where there is a risk of drowning the right buoyancy aid must be worn, fitted and inspected, and backed by a rescue plan, because wearing it after a fall is too late.

A: Still water can be as dangerous because of cold shock and deep water. B: Cold water shock can overcome even strong swimmers within seconds. D: A person in cold water cannot wait for equipment to be fetched.

COMMON MISTAKE: Storing lifejackets near the water but not requiring them to be worn.

47. D — Loose items near rotating tools can be snagged and drag the wearer into the machine, so neck cords should be removed or of a quick-release design.

A: Posture is a real concern, but a snagging risk can cause severe injury within a moment. B: Thick or loose gloves near rotating parts add an entanglement risk, and the gloves shown are not the main failing. C: An FFP2 or FFP3 mask is the usual protection against cement-based dust, and it does not match the immediate danger of entanglement.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking the PPE list and missing the loose item near the moving part.

48. A — Sheeting adds wind load that the design and ties must resist, so changes are for a competent scaffolder working to the design, and the scaffold is inspected after severe weather.

B: A design has a limiting wind speed, and storm conditions beyond it require action and an inspection afterwards. C: Random slits tear further in the wind, flap loose, and do not give a load reduction that anyone has designed or checked. D: Removing sheets in high wind is hazardous, and the task needs a competent scaffold team with a plan rather than general operatives.

COMMON MISTAKE: Improvising a change to sheeting on a scaffold instead of going back to its design and its scaffolders.

49. C — The test button confirms the mechanism operates but does not show that it trips at the rated current within the required time, which needs an instrument test.

A: Daily user checks are recommended, and pressing the button does not damage a sound device. B: A pass only shows the mechanism works, and waiting for an incident means a slow or failing device stays in service. D: Construction supplies are not exempt, and daily checks are in addition to periodic testing rather than a substitute.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a pressed test button as proof that the RCD protects at its rated current and speed.

50. A — Vehicles and pedestrians should be separated where practicable, and the public, including children, will not obey cones or signs the way trained workers do.

B: Being visible helps, but it does not stop shoppers, children and cars crossing the dumper's route. C: Peak customer traffic raises the chance of conflict, and more banksmen do not remove the shared route. D: Warnings and a speed limit leave the public and plant sharing the same ground, which is a weak control.

COMMON MISTAKE: Expecting members of the public to follow cones and a wave from a banksman.

PRACTICE TEST 18

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A cold-store operator hires an electrical firm to pull cables through plant rooms containing ammonia refrigeration pipework. The operator says the contractor's own employer must brief its people, so nothing needs passing on. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The operator must give the contractor's employer comprehensible information on the risks its work poses to those workers and its controls, and co-ordinate with it

☐ **B)** The operator must supply risk details only if the contractor asks in writing, because the duty is triggered by a request rather than by the work itself

☐ **C)** The operator may leave out hazards visible on a walk round, because information is required only for risks that the contractor could not discover itself

☐ **D)** Only the contractor's own employer owes a duty here, since information follows the contract of employment, so the operator need only provide site access and a plan

2. A subcontractor's method statement for unloading steel uses the main car park as the lay-down area, yet the construction phase plan shows that car park as the pedestrian route for all trades. The principal contractor stamps it 'received' and says checking content is the subcontractor's job. What should have happened?

☐ **A)** A signed declaration from the subcontractor that it has read the construction phase plan is enough, so the clash can be left to the workforce

☐ **B)** Approving it is correct, because the subcontractor is the competent specialist and carries sole responsibility for the safety of its own working method on this site

☐ **C)** Review it against the construction phase plan and other trades' work, have the clash resolved before work starts, and re-check it whenever the plan changes

☐ **D)** It should be passed to the client for sign-off, because the client holds the duty to manage how the contractors share the site space

3. On a refurbishment, a labourer unblocking a drain gets caustic drain-cleaner in one eye. There is no eyewash bottle, only a tap, and the first aider is next to him. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Rinse until the stinging stops, then let him resume light duties and review the eye at the end of shift once the pain has eased off

☐ **B)** Hold the eye shut and wait for the paramedics, since running water may carry the product into the other eye and make the injury a lot worse

☐ **C)** Rinse for about a minute, cover the eye with a pad and drive him to hospital, because caustic products need specialist neutralising treatment, not water

☐ **D)** Irrigate under running tap water for at least ten minutes, affected eye lowest, while 999 is called, and send the product label with him to hospital

4. A materials hoist loaded with blocks drops a few centimetres, then judders to a halt between floors. The operator presses the emergency stop. A labourer offers to free the brake by hand with a bar to lower the load. What should happen next?

☐ **A)** Keep everyone clear beneath, isolate and lock off the supply, and leave recovery and brake examination to a competent person following the maker's procedure

☐ **B)** Release the brake gradually by hand, because the emergency stop has already made the machine safe for anyone to work on, including the labourers

☐ **C)** Reset the emergency stop and run the platform down slowly under power, since the motor gives a more controlled descent than any manual brake release can give

☐ **D)** Unload the blocks by hand from the landing gate to remove the load, then restart the hoist and report the fault to the supervisor at the end of the shift

5. Joiners fixing fibre-cement cladding boards cut about eighty a day with a circular saw on trestles in a ground-floor room with the windows shut. Other trades are working in adjacent rooms.

Which change controls the dust best?

☐ **A)** Carry on cutting indoors but issue FFP3 masks to the saw operators, since a good mask fully protects the one person who is doing the cutting

☐ **B)** Change to a fine-toothed wood blade, because it produces larger chips that fall quickly and so leaves less harmful airborne dust behind

☐ **C)** Open the windows and run a fan to push the dust outside, which dilutes the airborne dust below the level that matters to health

☐ **D)** Cut at a dedicated outdoor station, using shears or a saw with H or M class on-tool extraction, keep others clear, and treat RPE as the back-up

6. Two labourers must get twenty 25 kg bags of render up to a first-floor scaffold lift. One proposes carrying a bag on his shoulder up the access ladder, saying he lifts 25 kg at ground level all day. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Avoid carrying bags up a ladder; raise them on a pallet by hoist or telehandler, and use lighter bags where hand-handling cannot be avoided

☐ **B)** Let two people climb together, one behind the other, so that the bag load is shared and each carries less than the full 25 kg

☐ **C)** Allow it if he keeps one hand on the stile and takes regular breaks, since 25 kg is within the ground-level guideline for a fit adult man at ground level

☐ **D)** Provide a back support belt and tie the ladder at the top, which reduces both the lifting strain and the risk of the ladder moving

7. A temporary roof of corrugated sheeting spans a tall scaffold over a re-roofing job. Overnight 15 cm of wet snow settles on it and the sheets are sagging. The supervisor wants two harnessed labourers to walk on the sheets and shovel it off. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Let the sun clear it and restrict work to areas under sheets that sag visibly, since unsagged areas are plainly carrying the load

☐ **B)** Carry on working beneath it, since the weekly scaffold inspection was done only three days ago and so is still in date for use

☐ **C)** Send the harnessed labourers up at once, because removing the load quickly is the safest way to relieve the roof and harnesses control the fall risk

☐ **D)** Keep people off and from beneath it, have the temporary works designer assess it, clear the snow by an approved method, and inspect before reuse



8. Look at the bricklayer on the scaffold lift. The scaffold has been inspected and tagged. What should the supervisor do before any more brickwork is laid?

☐ **A)** Ask him to clip a lanyard to the top guardrail while he stands on the blocks, since this arrests any fall from the stack

☐ **B)** Have him come down off the stacked blocks and re-site materials, so he works from the platform and the rails give proper edge protection

☐ **C)** Accept the set-up, because guardrails and toe boards are fitted and the current inspection tag shows the protection is built into the scaffold

☐ **D)** Have a colleague steady the blocks while he works, since the guardrails stop him falling over the edge of the platform

9. In light rain, a roofer on a pitched slate roof uses a 230 V mains circular saw on a long lead from a 30 mA RCD in the cabin. The lead lies across wet slates. The foreman says the RCD makes it safe. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Use battery-powered tools so there is no mains lead on the wet roof, because a shock could cause a fall and the RCD is only a back-up

☐ **B)** Keep the mains saw but swap to a sealed, heavy-duty outdoor extension lead, which resists rain well enough for the cable to lie on wet slates

☐ **C)** Run a 110 V supply instead and let the cable lie on the wet

slates, since reduced voltage makes contact with water harmless

☐ **D)** Keep the mains saw but have the roofer wear rubber-soled boots and insulated gloves and press the RCD test button each morning

10. In a busy warehouse, an office door opens straight onto a main forklift aisle. Contractors fitting lights cross that aisle to reach the welfare room while counterbalance trucks run past. Which is the best control?

☐ **A)** Cut truck speed to walking pace across the whole warehouse, which gives drivers time to stop without changing the aisle layout

☐ **B)** Fit barriers guiding people to a marked crossing with clear sightlines set back from the door, with trucks required to stop and give way

☐ **C)** Fit blue spot lights on each truck and sound horns at the door, so walkers get early notice without any layout change

☐ **D)** Paint yellow lines on the floor and require hi-vis for contractors, since marked routes and conspicuous clothing let drivers see and avoid walkers

11. A safety representative inspects a loading bay and writes to the site manager about a missing edge barrier and a damaged floodlight cable. The manager replies that this is only opinion, that he will act if an inspector agrees, and that the representative will be liable if anyone is hurt meanwhile. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The manager keeps his own duty to assess the reported hazards and act in proportion to the risk, and the representative carries no personal liability for them

☐ **B)** The manager may wait for an inspector to agree, because a representative's report has no legal weight until an enforcing authority has confirmed it in writing first

☐ **C)** The representative is now responsible for the hazards he listed, because putting a problem in writing transfers the duty to deal with it to him

☐ **D)** The manager need only act once the representative has served an improvement notice, because reports are not enforceable until formal notice is given

12. Two labourers drive to a rural job with a can of petrol for a breaker standing in the van cabin behind the seats. After an hour both have headaches and nausea. The driver says petrol only matters if something ignites it. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Stop and ventilate, since the vapour is a health and fire hazard, then carry petrol only in a closed approved container kept out of the cabin

☐ **B)** Accept the symptoms as brief and harmless, and simply ban smoking in the van, since only an ignition source needs controlling on the journey

☐ **C)** Open the windows and leave the can where it is, since fresh air clears the vapour and a capped can cannot give off anything harmful to the crew

☐ **D)** Seal the can inside a plastic bag in the cabin and wear dust masks while driving, so the vapour is kept in and kept out of the lungs of the crew

13. Annual occupational health checks on twelve painters who spray coatings find early work-related chest symptoms in two of them. The manager asks the nurse for each man's medical details so he can decide who keeps spraying. Which course reflects HSE guidance?

☐ **A)** Move the two affected men to other work and leave the controls as they are, since the other ten painters have shown no symptoms at all

☐ **B)** Treat the findings as a private medical matter and take no action until a painter makes a formal complaint about his work or his health

☐ **C)** Act on the nurse's fitness advice for the two men, and review controls for all similarly exposed painters using grouped, anonymous feedback

☐ **D)** Insist on each man's full medical details, because the employer pays for the checks and needs the information to make its decision on who sprays



14. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the operative is fine because he has been issued with every item of PPE this task needs. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** His hard hat needs a chin strap, because any hard hat worn while leaning over a rotating tool will slip off during the work

☐ **B)** His work gloves should be replaced by thin disposable ones, since thick gloves cause the operator to lose grip on the grinder handle

☐ **C)** His ear defenders are unsuitable, because grinding steel produces only low-frequency noise that earmuffs cannot reduce for the wearer at all

☐ **D)** His eye protection is not over his eyes, so it gives no defence against flying wire and sparks, and work should stop until it is worn

15. Joiners lay chipboard flooring on a new first floor with screw tips and grit on the deck, kneeling for hours. The supervisor buys thin foam garden pads on tight straps, saying any padding counts as knee protection. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Choose EN 14404 knee protection with puncture resistance suited to screw tips, that stays put when kneeling and has straps that spare circulation

☐ **B)** Keep the pads but tighten the straps further, so they cannot slip down while the joiners crawl across the deck all shift long

☐ **C)** Choose the thickest foam available, since cushioning matters most and puncture resistance is unimportant when the pads are well padded up

☐ **D)** Treat knee pads as comfort items that joiners buy themselves, because the employer has no duty over their choice or their suitability

16. An electrician on a handrailed step platform needs to fix a cable tray about a metre beyond its side rail. He suggests leaning out over the rail with one foot braced on the lower bar to reach it. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Tie the platform to the cable tray as he works, so the structure steadies the platform against the force of his leaning out

☐ **B)** Keep his body within the handrails and reposition the platform so the work is in easy reach, or use a tower or MEWP if moving it constantly

☐ **C)** Lean out over the rail but keep both feet on the platform floor, because the handrail will arrest any slip while he stretches to reach

☐ **D)** Lay a scaffold board across the rails to extend the platform, since the rails then give edge protection over the whole distance he needs

17. A mobile crane will lift a 3 m glass pane on a vacuum lifter to a sixth-floor balcony. The pump has stopped and the gauge shows the required vacuum. The glazier wants to hoist at once to limit the time the pane is suspended. What is the correct step?

☐ **A)** Hoist at once, since a gauge showing the correct reading when the pump stops proves the grip will hold throughout the whole lift up

☐ **B)** Have a colleague steady the lower edge by hand during the lift, so any slip of the pads can be caught before the pane falls away

☐ **C)** Raise the pane a short way and hold it while watching the gauge to confirm the vacuum is stable, keeping everyone clear of its route

☐ **D)** Skip the test lift because a pre-use check was made at the start of the week, and the lifter has not been changed or moved since then

18. A mini-excavator with a short rear overhang digs along a site hoarding. The supervisor says that as a reduced tail swing machine its only danger is behind the counterweight, so a labourer may stand beside the cab to clear spoil while it slews. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The solid hoarding acts as the barrier, so no further exclusion zone is needed as long as the operator sounds the horn before slewing

☐ **B)** Reduced tail swing removes the crushing risk, so a labourer is safe anywhere in front of the cab provided he wears hi-vis clothing and a helmet

☐ **C)** Standing near the cab is safe because the operator can see the labourer, so only the rear of the machine needs to be cordoned off with fencing or tape

☐ **D)** Barrier off the full area the machine and boom can sweep,

since slewing can trap people against structures, and allow entry only once the operator stops

19. A skip lorry driver arrives to collect a skip on a busy street. Bricks and rubble stand above the rim, and the labourer offers to throw a sheet over them from the ground. What should the driver do?

☐ **A)** Decline to lift it until the contents are reduced below the rim, then cover them from ground level so nothing falls onto the road

☐ **B)** Lift it and drive slowly, since low speed on a public road means loose pieces cannot be thrown off the vehicle as it moves

☐ **C)** Climb onto the skip rim and spread the sheet by hand, which keeps the load tidy and is quick to do before leaving the street

☐ **D)** Accept the load because a sheet pulled over the high rubble will hold it in place, and any pieces that fall become the producer's concern later

20. A ready-mix wagon's chute leaks and leaves grey slurry across 15 m of a public road, running towards a surface-water gully while traffic passes. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Sweep it away as soon as it dries without barriers or cones, since a thin film on the road is a nuisance and nothing more

☐ **B)** Leave the slurry to set hard on the road and break it out later, because traffic will cause no harm to drains or other road users passing here

☐ **C)** Cover the gully, contain the slurry with sand or absorbent, shovel it up for disposal as waste, and work inside coned-off traffic control

☐ **D)** Flush it along the gutter with water from the wagon tank, since heavy dilution makes cement slurry harmless to the drainage system there on the road

21. A pipeline contractor works beside a quarry that blasts on two unannounced afternoons a week. The risk assessment rates blasting 'remote' because it is only occasional, and nobody has contacted the quarry. What is the best way to cover this intermittent hazard?

☐ **A)** Cover the hazard with PPE by issuing hard hats and safety glasses to the whole crew, since protective equipment can be worn all week whenever blasts occur

☐ **B)** Agree blast times and signals with the quarry, then plan exclusion and shelter for those periods in the site plan and brief everyone

☐ **C)** Ask the quarry to warn the site only when a blast is unusually large, because routine blasts are already covered by the quarry's own risk assessment

☐ **D)** Keep the rating as remote, since a hazard present for a few hours each week exposes workers for a small share of their time and so adds little risk

22. A site joinery shop's dust extractor hopper is full of fine sawdust, with fine dust coating beams and a grinder working nearby. A joiner says sawdust only burns when it is lit with a flame, so there is no explosion risk. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Dust explodes only in factories handling flour or coal, so a small joinery shop need not worry about sparks near its dust

☐ **B)** The risk comes only from an open flame, so banning smoking and naked lights is enough while the grinder keeps working

☐ **C)** Fine dust suspended in air can explode if ignited, so clean regularly, control ignition sources such as grinder sparks and empty the hopper

☐ **D)** A full hopper is safer than an empty one because the dust is packed tight, and compacted dust cannot catch fire

23. A fabricator will weld stainless steel brackets inside a 12 m shipping container with the doors open at one end. He plans a pedestal fan blowing from the doorway past him and a paper dust mask. The assessment says the doors give good ventilation. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Swap the paper mask for a disposable FFP2 with an exhalation valve and weld in short bursts, because shorter arc time keeps the exposure below the limit

☐ **B)** Capture the fume at source with on-torch or portable extraction discharged outside, and add a powered or air-fed respirator for the exposure it cannot remove

☐ **C)** Place a second fan at the far end to push fresh air through the container, since a through-draught dilutes the fume enough to make respiratory protection unnecessary

☐ **D)** Rely on the open doors and natural airflow, because a

container with a large opening gives enough air changes to disperse the fume safely

24. Operatives fitting a kitchen are confronted by the homeowner, who swears, blocks the doorway and threatens to 'sort them out' over a delay. They leave unhurt, and the supervisor calls it part of dealing with the public. What is the best employer response?

☐ **A)** Send the customer a firm letter and carry on with the same arrangements, since the fault lies with one person rather than with how the job is set up

☐ **B)** Treat it as reportable only if someone is injured, since threats without physical contact fall outside what an employer is responsible for at work

☐ **C)** Record the incident, review the job's risk assessment with the crew for changes such as agreed contact routes and pairing up, and offer support to those affected

☐ **D)** Leave it to the contract terms, since a customer's conduct is a commercial matter and the firm can recover lost time through the final invoice

25. A scaffold stair tower serves six lifts. Plasterers carry 20 kg tubs of adhesive up it, one hand on the rail, and prop each landing gate open with a tub to get past. The supervisor says stairs are safer than ladders. Which response is best?

☐ **A)** Replace the gates with a single strip of tape across each landing, which is quicker to move for loads and still warns people of the edge

☐ **B)** Keep the gates shut and move heavy or bulky loads by hoist or another mechanical route, so a hand is always free to hold the handrail

☐ **C)** Accept the stairs as the main control, since the treads and handrails are designed for carrying and extra measures for materials add little protection

☐ **D)** Allow open gates while one person is on the stair at a time, because the chance of a fall through a landing opening depends on how crowded it is



26. Look at the scene. The foreman says the bracket is a five-minute job on a solid roof, with the ladder tied and a colleague footing it. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The ladder is unsecured and too short, so it could slip sideways or leave him without a handhold when stepping on and off the roof

☐ **B)** He lacks hi-vis clothing and a fastened chin strap, so inadequate PPE is the main fault and would otherwise make this short roof task acceptable

☐ **C)** The ladder needs a second person to foot it, which is the one missing measure that would make a short task on a solid roof acceptable here

☐ **D)** A fall of about three metres is possible from an unprotected edge of a roof not built for access, and the job could be done from a platform on the ground

27. Hand-dug trial holes were cleared at the design positions of a bored-pile job. The engineer then moves eight positions 1.5 m to avoid a clash, and the rig operator says the earlier scan and holes already cover the area. What must happen before drilling the moved positions?

☐ **A)** Proceed on the earlier clearance, since 1.5 m is within normal scanner accuracy and a competent person already declared the whole area clear

☐ **B)** Have the rig operator countersign the earlier permit for the new points, since the same rig, crew and method statement apply to the moved positions

☐ **C)** Drill the new positions at reduced torque and watch the spoil, since a buried service usually announces itself with obvious resistance before it is damaged

☐ **D)** Review the service drawings and scan again at the revised positions, then dig fresh hand-dug inspection holes there, as checks apply to exact points

28. A 400 V armoured cable feeding a dewatering pump crosses a site road where portable traffic lights control 26-tonne lorries. The electrician lays it flat and covers it with a light plastic ramp. The foreman says the armour and the lights make it safe. What is the best arrangement?

☐ **A)** Leave it flat but have the electrician inspect it each shift, because armour with a daily visual check will find any damage before it can cause harm

☐ **B)** Take it overhead on posts, clear of the tallest vehicles and marked, or run it in a duct below the road surface, so vehicles cannot crush or snag it

☐ **C)** Keep the surface route and add a second light plastic ramp with hazard tape either side, since doubling the cover halves the chance of a lorry damaging the cable

☐ **D)** Feed the pump at 110 V through a transformer at the road edge and keep the surface route, since the lower voltage removes the need for cable protection

29. While digging a drainage run in made ground, an operator sees fragments of grey, fibrous cement sheet in the spoil. The foreman wants to carry on and tip the spoil on the stockpile for reuse as fill. What should happen first?

☐ **A)** Send a sample to a laboratory and continue digging meanwhile, since the operator is in an enclosed cab and the result will come back within days

☐ **B)** Stop work, keep people away from the area and treat the material as asbestos until a competent person has identified it and assessed the risk

☐ **C)** Pick out the visible fragments by hand, double-bag them and keep digging, because the soil is clean once the large pieces have been removed

☐ **D)** Carry on with the spoil lightly wetted and move it to the stockpile, since cement-bound asbestos releases too few fibres to need any change of method

30. Overnight, someone dumps about forty used car tyres inside the site gate. The manager wants the area tidy before a client visit, by tipping them into the general waste skip due for collection tomorrow. What is the most appropriate action?

☐ **A)** Photograph and log the dumping, report it to the local authority, and have a registered waste carrier remove the tyres under a transfer note describing them

☐ **B)** Accept a passing man with a van who offers to take them away for cash, provided he promises to dispose of them properly elsewhere

☐ **C)** Stack them at the back of the site until completion, since one later removal costs less and dumped items are not the site's responsibility

☐ **D)** Tip them into the skip as planned, since waste left on the site becomes site waste and a general skip carrier will accept any mixed load

31. A retail chain hires a small contractor for a ten-day store refit. The contract says the contractor arranges welfare, but he arrives with no cabin and assumes he can use the staff toilets. The chain says welfare is now entirely his matter. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Welfare is the contractor's duty alone once it is written into the contract, so the client only has to allow access to its staff toilets if he asks

☐ **B)** The client must make arrangements that ensure suitable welfare is provided for the workers, and should confirm this before work starts and keep it under review

☐ **C)** The client's duty ends when a contractor is appointed, because welfare then becomes part of that contractor's own risk assessment and the client plays no further role

☐ **D)** The client duty applies only to projects notifiable to HSE, so a ten-day refit with a few workers falls outside the welfare requirement entirely

32. An HSE inspector sees a dumper with failed brakes nearly crush a worker. By her next visit the owner has had the brakes repaired and says she can do nothing more, as no notice was served. In England, which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** She must first serve an improvement notice and can prosecute only if that notice is ignored, because a case brought without a notice would not be valid

☐ **B)** Once the defect is remedied the inspector may only give advice and guidance, because both notices and prosecution require a breach that is still continuing at the time

☐ **C)** Only a magistrates' court can decide whether a case is brought, and HSE must obtain its formal permission before any prosecution can begin

☐ **D)** Prosecution is a separate option needing no prior notice, so HSE can still decide under its enforcement policy to prosecute the earlier breach despite the repair

33. In March, a risk assessment for resurfacing a seafront car park assumed a quiet site with gated access. The job slips to late July, when holiday crowds, a weekend market and heavy summer traffic use the same approach, and there is no fallback if deliveries are refused entry. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Re-brief the operatives verbally on the summer crowds and leave the written document unchanged, because rewriting it would delay the start and add more paperwork

☐ **B)** Update only the public-interface controls with extra barriers and signs, since a plan for refused deliveries is a commercial matter rather than a safety one

☐ **C)** Review and update the assessment for summer conditions, including the public and traffic interface, and add a contingency for blocked deliveries

☐ **D)** Keep the March assessment as it stands because it was suitable and sufficient when written, and let the supervisor judge the crowds and deliveries on the day

34. A decorator must move twelve 25-litre drums of masonry sealer, about 27 kg each, from a van up two flights of stairs to a flat. The back-belt-wearing carriers propose one drum per trip with rests. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Hold a briefing on bending the knees and keeping a straight back, as technique training is the main control for repeated stair carrying

☐ **B)** Keep the back belts for everyone carrying, as they take the compressive load off the spine and so permit the heavier drums to be carried

☐ **C)** Allow one drum per trip with a rest between, since the carried weight is then within a capable adult's strength and no assessment is needed

☐ **D)** Cut the handling at source by ordering smaller containers or floor delivery, then assess whatever carrying remains and reduce it further

35. At dusk a groundworker walks an unlit private access track carrying a dark rucksack that covers the rear reflective bands of his vest. His supervisor says the fluorescent colour makes him visible in any light. What is the best view?

☐ **A)** The fluorescent background is what shows up best in low light, so the reflective bands are optional and covering them with a rucksack matters little

☐ **B)** Reflective bands glow by themselves in the dark, so covering part of them only reduces the visible area slightly and the vest still works well

☐ **C)** Fluorescence works mainly in daylight and reflective bands only when light such as headlights falls on them, so keep them clear and light the track

☐ **D)** Retro-reflective material is a requirement mainly on public roads, so on a private site track the bands need not be kept visible to drivers

36. On a concrete frame, a gang fixes slab reinforcement beside the lift core while another gang, on a platform on the core wall 3 m higher, strikes and passes formwork. Nothing separates the two gangs. What is the best control?

☐ **A)** Issue the slab gang with impact-rated hard hats and let both gangs carry on as planned, because head protection is the standard control for overhead work

☐ **B)** Fit a debris net at slab level beneath the core platform and let the formwork gang work as before, as the net will catch anything dropped

☐ **C)** Stop objects falling with toe boards and secured materials on the platform, and bar people from the area below where a fall remains possible

☐ **D)** Have a banksman shout when formwork is being moved overhead, as a verbal warning gives the slab gang time to step clear of the area

37. A civil contractor applies a head-office annual test rule to all portable electrical equipment, including 110 V grinders and drills used on a muddy site, where the last test found many failures. A manager says an annual interval is a legal requirement. Which view is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Because 110 V tools carry little shock risk, they are exempt from formal inspection, so only the 230 V items need any scheduled checks on site

☐ **B)** The legal minimum is an annual test for all work equipment, and a rising failure rate only makes a six-monthly

test advisable as good practice

☐ **C)** The interval is set by the tool maker and cannot be altered by the employer, so the annual rule applies only if the maker's manual states it

☐ **D)** The law sets no fixed interval; equipment must be maintained to prevent danger, so frequency should follow risk and be cut where faults are found



38. Look at the scene. A concrete pour is under way. Which statement best identifies the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The boom is working too close to the operatives' heads, so the main hazard is wet concrete dripping into unprotected eyes, which goggles alone would solve

☐ **B)** The operatives stand on reinforcement mesh, so the main hazard is tripping, which boards would fix since the pump operator controls any hose movement

☐ **C)** The operatives are stretching the end hose out horizontally to reach the pour, so air or a blockage could whip it and throw them; the pump should be moved

☐ **D)** The pump lorry is parked too far back, so the main hazard is the pump operator losing sight of the pour, solved by a second operator on a radio

39. A mobile crane lifts a plant unit into a courtyard where the operator cannot see the landing point. The signaller plans to direct the lift by mobile phone on speaker, saying everyone has signal. Which arrangement is best?

☐ **A)** Use a dedicated crane radio, with one voice giving commands, test the link each shift, and have the operator stop if communication is lost

☐ **B)** Keep the phone but add a second person shouting and waving to the operator as a backup, so two signalling methods run at the same time during the whole lift

☐ **C)** Keep the open call but allow the operator to carry on with the last command until the call reconnects, so the load is not left hanging

☐ **D)** Use a chain of two relayed hand signals instead and allow the operator to guess at the intended landing point if one signal is missed

40. After heavy use, a site welfare unit's foul holding tank overflows at 6 am before the contractor's scheduled emptying. The sewage spreads across the yard towards a surface-water gully that drains to a brook. What is the best first response?

☐ **A)** Close the unit, block the gully and contain the flow, have a registered waste carrier empty it, and tell the Environment Agency if any reached the drain

☐ **B)** Hose the area down at once so the diluted liquid soaks away before it shows, since less visible pollution means less risk to the nearby brook

☐ **C)** Cordon the area and close the unit, then wait for the scheduled emptying visit, since a spill not yet in a watercourse needs no containment

☐ **D)** Pump the overflow into the nearest foul sewer manhole with an available pump, as sewage belongs in the public sewer network and so is properly dealt with there

41. At 06:15 in winter darkness, a haulier's own employee is told to unload plasterboard in an unlit site bay littered with offcuts. The site manager says the haulier alone must protect its driver, because site duties cover only the site's own workforce. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The site's duty is met by giving the driver a hi-vis vest and a verbal warning about the bay, since a visitor is taken to accept the conditions he finds there

☐ **B)** The site's duty begins only once the driver has signed the site rules, so with no signature yet the manager has taken on no responsibility for him at all

☐ **C)** Both owe duties: the site must run its work so the driver is not put at risk, including a lit, clear bay, alongside the haulier's own duty to him

☐ **D)** Only the haulier is responsible, because it employs the driver and the site's legal duties stretch solely to people on its own payroll or on its direct contracts

42. A cladding subcontractor hands the principal contractor's

manager its RAMS at 07:00, the planned start time. Knowing the firm is experienced, the manager proposes letting the crew begin prep work while he reads the documents at lunch. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Allow the prep work if the foreman signs to accept personal liability for anything the RAMS later turn out to have missed on this particular cladding job

☐ **B)** Hold the hazardous work until the RAMS are checked against the construction phase plan and site conditions; the subcontractor still owns its method

☐ **C)** Let the work start and approve the RAMS afterwards, which then transfers responsibility for the method from the subcontractor to the principal contractor

☐ **D)** Let the crew start because the review is only a paperwork check, and the subcontractor's own duty to work safely will cover any gap left in the method it chose

43. At a monthly walk-round, a supervisor finds a portable water extinguisher with a missing safety pin, a pressure gauge in the red and a service sticker two years old. A worker says it still looks fine and nobody has needed it. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Keep it in use until the next annual service is due, since the gauge reading only matters when an extinguisher is discharged

☐ **B)** Move it to a quieter area where it is less likely to be needed, and rely on the extinguishers in the busier parts

☐ **C)** Leave it in place because it has never been used, and replace the pin and sticker so that it looks serviced on inspection

☐ **D)** Take it out of use, replace it with a serviced extinguisher, and check all others for condition and service dates

44. Two steel fitters cut plate with an oxy-fuel torch in a poorly ventilated bay off a plant room. A grinder works 3 m away, outside the cutter's area. The supervisor plans to issue an FFP3 mask to the cutter only and let the room fan run. What is the better plan?

☐ **A)** Time-limit the cutting to short bursts and have both workers wear an FFP3 mask, because rotation and masks together make extraction unnecessary

☐ **B)** Fit the cutter with an FFP3 mask and leave the grinder where he is, since fume exposure affects only the person actually making the cut with the torch

☐ **C)** Capture the fume at the cutting point with local extraction vented outside, which also protects the grinder, and keep respirators for what remains

☐ **D)** Run the fan across the bay to dilute the fume, which is enough control so long as the doors stay open and the cutter wears suitable eye protection

45. An experienced pipefitter returns from three weeks off to a boiler house that is very hot in summer. The foreman puts him on a full shift straight away, saying he has done the job for years and the law sets no maximum workplace temperature. Which view is correct?

☐ **A)** A full shift is fine because a worker who has acclimatised once stays acclimatised for good, so only brand-new starters ever need a gradual build-up in the heat

☐ **B)** Build his time in the heat up over days with water and cooling breaks, as a long absence cuts tolerance and the employer must still assess the risk

☐ **C)** He should work the full shift but in lighter clothes, since the temperature in a boiler house is a matter of comfort and not a matter of safety or health

☐ **D)** A full shift is fine as long as he drinks when he feels thirsty, since the missing legal maximum temperature means the employer has no duty to manage the heat

46. Three roofers of very different builds pass one fall-arrest harness between them on a gable roof. The foreman adjusted its straps to fit himself at the start of the shift and says a pre-use inspection each time is enough. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** A universal-size harness fits all builds once the buckles are fastened, so inspecting the webbing and the lanyard is all the fit checking that is needed

☐ **B)** Issue a correctly sized harness to each worker where practicable, and have each wearer adjust it snugly, with the back attachment between the shoulder blades

☐ **C)** Sharing is acceptable if each wearer tightens only the chest strap to take up any slack, as the leg and shoulder straps seldom differ much between workers

☐ **D)** Set the harness once for the largest wearer and take up the rest with the lanyard, since a looser fit protects the smaller

men as well as a snug one does



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the blaster's air-fed helmet is the best respiratory protection available and fits him well. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The helmet should be swapped for an FFP3 disposable mask, since grit blasting dust is too fine for any hood to filter reliably in the open air

☐ **B)** The helmet needs a face-fit test before use, because air-fed blasting helmets seal to the skin of the face in the same way that disposable masks do

☐ **C)** The breathing air may be contaminated at source, as the compressor intake sits where engine exhaust drifts over it, so siting and air quality must be fixed

☐ **D)** The air hose is too long for blasting, because a hose that loops back across the ground will always starve the helmet of enough air to breathe

48. Before raising a mast climbing work platform loaded with cladding panels, the operator sees the ground-level base is marked only with caution tape and the load is about 10% over the displayed rating. The foreman says the masts have a large safety margin. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Remove the excess load and fence the base with a physical barrier; the rated load must not be exceeded, and tape cannot stop people walking beneath

☐ **B)** The load is acceptable, since the rating includes a built-in margin, but the base needs a barrier because anyone standing under the platform risks being struck by falling items

☐ **C)** Both are acceptable for one lift because the platform will stay at working height for only a few minutes before it comes back down again to be unloaded

☐ **D)** The base is acceptable if a banksman stands at the tape, but the load must be cut to the rating, since the platform and mast are designed around that weight

49. In an occupied shop, a fitter asks the owner if he can plug a 110 V site transformer feeding his tools, plus a 2 kW heater, into a wall socket. The owner shrugs and says to go ahead. The fitter's leads are all PAT tested. What should the fitter do?

☐ **A)** Check the socket works and the plug is fused at 13 A, then use it, since any domestic socket is built to carry two appliances at full load

☐ **B)** Connect it only for short bursts, since an overloaded socket circuit trips its breaker well before any cable could overheat or catch fire

☐ **C)** Go ahead, since the owner has agreed and his own PAT-tested leads and plug fuses will protect against any overload on the shop's existing wiring and its socket circuit

☐ **D)** Have the shop's responsible person confirm the circuit's rating and protection, and a competent electrician approve the temporary supply, before connecting

50. A tracked dumper is being driven up the ramps onto a low-loader. Halfway up it drifts toward the ramp edge and the driver turns the steering sharply to correct it, while the banksman stands beside the ramp to guide him. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Carry on up to the bed, where there is more room to straighten the machine, because stopping halfway risks it rolling back down the ramps

☐ **B)** Have the banksman step onto the ramp and push the drifting track edge across by hand, as that will line the machine up quite safely

☐ **C)** Keep climbing and correct gently with the steering, since slow progress means the tracks will pull the whole dumper back towards the centre of the narrow ramps

☐ **D)** Stop and reverse straight back down, re-align square to the ramps with the banksman clear of its path, then drive up again in one straight run

Answer Key

1. A — Under the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations, a host employer must give outside employers comprehensible risk information and work with them, so the contractor can brief its own people properly.

B: The duty applies automatically; it does not depend on the contractor asking for the information. C: The duty is to give relevant risk and control information regardless of whether a visit might reveal some hazards. D: The host employer has its own duty to give the contractor's employer risk information about its undertaking.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a contractor's own employer carries the whole duty to inform, so the host of the premises has nothing to pass on.

2. C — A principal contractor must plan, manage and co-ordinate the construction phase, so it has to check that each method statement fits the plan and other work on site.

A: A declaration does not resolve a conflict between the method and the pedestrian route in the plan. B: Specialist competence does not remove the principal contractor's duty to co-ordinate work and keep the plan consistent. D: Day-to-day co-ordination of contractors' methods is a principal contractor duty, not something to hand to the client.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the logging of a subcontractor's method statement as a review, when nobody has checked it against the plan or neighbouring work.

3. D — Prolonged irrigation dilutes and removes the chemical, and the product details help hospital staff treat the injury.

A: Pain relief does not mean the chemical has gone, and a caustic splash always needs hospital assessment. B: Waiting wastes the critical early minutes; the head can be tilted so water runs away from the good eye. C: Water is the correct first aid and must continue for several minutes, not be cut short for a car journey.

COMMON MISTAKE: Stopping irrigation as soon as the pain eases, rather than flushing for the full time and sending the product details with the casualty.

4. A — A failing hoist can drop its load, so people must be kept clear, the energy source locked off, and only a competent person should recover it and decide on repair.

B: An emergency stop is not isolation, and a manual brake release by untrained staff can let the load fall. C: Restarting a hoist with a suspected brake or drive fault risks an uncontrolled drop. D: Working beneath or beside a failing hoist is dangerous, and the fault must be examined before any restart.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that pressing the emergency stop makes a faulty machine safe, so anyone can then free it without isolation.

5. D — Cement-based boards can release harmful respirable dust, which is best controlled at source and away from other people, with RPE only as a back-up.

A: Relying on RPE alone leaves the dust in the building and exposes other trades. B: Blade choice does not remove fine respirable dust, and the hazardous fraction stays airborne. C: Dilution ventilation does not capture dust at source and can carry it into neighbouring rooms.

COMMON MISTAKE: Handing masks to the cutter and treating that as the dust control, while the dust still spreads to everyone nearby.

6. A — The handling hierarchy says to avoid hazardous handling first, and climbing a ladder with a load removes the secure grip needed for safe climbing.

B: Two people on one ladder is unsafe and the bag cannot be shared between them. C: A ground-level handling guideline does not make it safe to carry a bag on a ladder, where hand grip is vital. D: Back belts are not a proven control, and securing the ladder does not remove the load from the climber.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a load only against the weight limit for lifting at ground level, and ignoring the loss of grip and balance on a ladder.

7. D — Snow is an exceptional event that can overload the structure, so it needs assessment, a safe removal method that avoids walking on the sheeting, and inspection before work resumes.

A: Unseen overload and damage can exist in unsagged areas, so the whole structure needs assessment. B: Exceptional weather requires an inspection in its own right, whatever stage the routine cycle has reached. C: Sagging sheeting is fragile and may collapse under their weight, so a harness does not make walking on it acceptable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a routine inspection date covers a structure after heavy snow, wind or other weather has loaded it.

8. B — Standing on loose blocks raises his body above the guardrail height and on an unstable base, so the rails no longer protect him from falling.

A: A guardrail is not a suitable anchor point, and a fall from the stack

could still be over the rail. C: Inspection covers the scaffold itself, not how workers then use it or raise themselves above its protection. D: Holding loose blocks is not a stable base, and his raised position makes the guardrail ineffective.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging scaffold safety from the fitted rails and the inspection tag, without checking how workers stand and use the platform.

9. A — Removing mains voltage from a wet roof is the better control, since even a non-fatal shock may cause a fall and an RCD only limits the duration of a shock.

B: A sturdier lead is still a mains supply lying in water on a roof, so the shock and fall risks remain. C: Reduced voltage lessens the risk but does not make wet cable joints and damaged cable safe. D: Clothing is a weak control and a daily test only proves the RCD trips, not that the wet equipment is safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating an RCD as permission to use mains tools in wet conditions, instead of removing the mains hazard first.

10. B — Physical separation and a defined, controlled crossing remove the chance of people stepping straight into a truck's path.

A: Slower trucks reduce harm but still meet pedestrians at a blind door, and speed limits alone are a weak control. C: Warning devices depend on people noticing them and do not separate pedestrians from traffic. D: Markings and clothing rely on behaviour and do not stop a person stepping out into a truck's path.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on painted lines, hi-vis and warnings to keep people and trucks apart, when physical separation is what removes the risk.

11. A — The employer's general duties apply once he knows of a hazard, and the regulations state that a representative's functions do not impose any duty on him personally.

B: An employer's duty arises from the hazard itself and does not depend on an inspector confirming a representative's report. C: Reporting a hazard never moves the employer's duty onto the representative, who has no duty under these regulations. D: Safety representatives cannot serve notices, which only inspectors can issue, and the employer's duty exists without one.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a hazard becomes someone else's problem, or can wait for an inspector, once a representative has reported it.

12. A — Petrol vapour causes headache and nausea when breathed and ignites easily, so fuel must be in a suitable sealed container kept away from the people in the vehicle.

B: Breathing petrol vapour is itself harmful, so controlling ignition sources alone ignores the health effect already shown. C: A can left in the cabin keeps releasing vapour and remains a fire risk, and fresh air only masks the problem. D: A bag is not a safe fuel container and dust masks give no protection against vapour.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating fuel as dangerous only when a flame is present, and ignoring what its vapour does to people in a closed space.

13. C — Surveillance is only complete when its results are acted on, which means protecting affected workers and reviewing the risk assessment for the whole group without disclosing confidential medical detail.

A: Symptoms in two men signal that controls may be failing, so the assessment and controls must be reviewed for everyone exposed. B: Work-related ill health found by surveillance must be acted on without waiting for any complaint. D: The employer needs fitness-for-task advice rather than confidential clinical detail, which stays with the health professional.

COMMON MISTAKE: Filing surveillance results as a personal medical matter instead of using them to check that the controls work for everyone.

14. D — PPE only protects when worn in the right place at the point of exposure, and workers must use it as instructed while supervisors enforce that.

A: A hard hat is not at risk of falling off while working at chest height, and the strap is not the issue seen here. B: Gloves suited to handling steel are appropriate, and the visible fault is where the eye protection sits. C: Earmuffs reduce grinding noise perfectly well, so they are not the main failing in the picture.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that being issued with PPE is enough, when it protects only if it is worn correctly at the moment of exposure.

15. A — Knee protection must suit the actual hazard, and the standard covers puncture resistance, staying in position and straps that do not impair blood flow in the leg.

B: Over-tight straps can restrict circulation in the leg, and thin foam still does not resist punctures. C: Thick foam can still be pierced by screw tips, so cushioning alone does not match the hazard. D: Suitable knee protection is PPE, so the employer must ensure it is appropriate for the risk assessed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming any padding will do for kneeling work without checking it against the actual hazard on the floor.

16. B — Handrails only protect a person who stays inside them, and leaning out raises the risk of falling or tipping the platform, so the platform should be moved or a better access system used.

A: A cable tray is not designed as an anchorage and could be pulled off, dropping both the tray and the electrician. C: A rail is not designed to take a leaning body and over-reaching can topple the platform or tip him over it. D: A board laid on the rails is an unsupported, unstable extension that defeats the platform's own protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Over-reaching beyond the handrails because moving the platform feels slower than a quick stretch.

17. C — A short test lift shows the grip is holding before the pane goes up the building, and nobody should be beneath a suspended load that could fall.

A: A reading at the start does not prove the grip is stable once the weight comes on the pads. B: A person cannot catch a falling pane and would be directly beneath it if the grip failed. D: A pre-use check must be carried out before each use, so an earlier check does not cover this lift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting the vacuum gauge reading alone instead of proving the grip with a short test lift before going up.

18. D — Reduced tail swing lessens but does not remove the slewing hazard, so an exclusion zone around the whole working area, controlled by the operator, is needed.

A: A hoarding next to the machine creates a trapping point, and a horn is no substitute for keeping people out. B: Hi-vis clothing does not stop a boom or body sweeping into a person, and the crush hazard remains. C: Being visible does not prevent contact during a slew, and the boom and body still sweep the area beside the cab.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a compact or reduced tail swing machine has no real danger zone around it.

19. A — An overfilled skip cannot be secured safely, and the load must be positioned and secured so it causes neither danger nor nuisance on the road.

B: Slow speed does not stop rubble sliding or falling off when the vehicle brakes, corners or hits bumps. C: Climbing on the rim risks a fall from height and still leaves rubble standing above the sides. D: A sheet cannot hold material standing above the rim, and the driver remains responsible for the load on the road.

COMMON MISTAKE: Letting an overfilled skip go because a sheet over the top looks like a fix.

20. C — Cement slurry is highly alkaline and harms watercourses, so it must be kept out of drains and collected as waste while people clearing it are protected from traffic.

A: Sweeping without controls exposes the sweepers to traffic and creates dust, and does nothing to stop slurry reaching the gully. B: Wet slurry can run into the gully and a setting film on the road is a hazard to vehicles in the meantime. D: Hosing slurry towards a gully puts alkaline cement water into the drain, which dilution does not make harmless.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming cement slurry is just stone and sand that can be washed into the nearest drain.

21. B — Employers sharing a workplace or boundary must co-operate and co-ordinate under the Management Regulations, and a severe hazard with a predictable timing can be planned around rather than ignored.

A: PPE is the last line of defence and cannot stop flyrock or blast overpressure, whereas timing and distance can be controlled. C: The quarry's assessment does not cover the contractor's workers, and the two employers must co-ordinate for every blast, not just large ones. D: Brief exposure does not reduce severity, and flyrock or overpressure can kill, so low frequency alone does not justify a low rating.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a hazard by how often it occurs rather than by how severe it is and whether its timing can be known and planned around.

22. C — Fine combustible dust can burn very fast when dispersed in air and ignited by a spark, so housekeeping, ignition control and emptying collectors are needed.

A: Wood dust is also combustible and can explode when dispersed and ignited. B: Sparks from grinders and other sources can ignite dust cloud as well. D: A full hopper holds fuel and can still smoulder or burn.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming dust is only a health problem and cannot cause fires or explosions.

23. B — HSE says capturing welding fume at source is the most effective control, with suitable RPE added where extraction alone cannot control exposure, and stainless fume carries added chromium risk.

A: A particulate filter does not remove welding gases, a disposable mask has not been face-fit tested for him, and short bursts do not remove the need for source control. C: Fans only move the plume around, often past his face, and dilution does not replace capture at

source for a carcinogenic fume. D: HSE states that natural ventilation through open doors is not sufficient to disperse welding fume, and a long metal box traps it near the welder.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating an open door or a fan as a ventilation control, when it only moves fume past the welder instead of capturing it.

24. C — HSE defines work-related violence to include abuse and threats from the public, so employers should assess it, record incidents and learn from them, and support affected workers.

A: Blaming the individual leaves the crew exposed to a repeat, as the employer must review controls such as contact arrangements and working in pairs. B: Verbal abuse and threats count as work-related violence, and internal reporting should not depend on an injury. D: The employer's duty to protect staff from risks arising at work extends to people other than employees, so it cannot be left as a commercial issue.

COMMON MISTAKE: Dismissing threats and abuse from the public as part of the job unless someone is physically hurt.

25. B — A gate is the edge protection at a landing and must be closed, and stairs only reduce risk if users keep a hand free rather than carrying awkward loads.

A: Tape warns but cannot stop a person falling, so it is not edge protection. C: Stairs do not make carrying 20 kg tubs safe, because a loaded worker cannot hold the rail or see the treads. D: One person can fall through an open landing just as easily, and the gate exists to prevent exactly that.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a stair tower is so safe that carrying loads and defeating the gates is acceptable.

26. D — A cabin roof is not designed as a work platform, and with no edge protection or fall arrest the fall risk remains, so work should be avoided at height or done from a suitable platform.

A: The picture shows the ladder tied at the top with its stiles projecting above the edge, so access is not the main fault. B: He is wearing hi-vis and a fastened chin strap, and PPE does not replace edge protection or avoiding work at height. C: A colleague is already footing the ladder, and footing does nothing about the unprotected roof edge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a short job on any flat surface as safe, without asking whether it could be done without going up there.

27. D — Safe digging checks are position-specific, so when a drilling point moves, the plans, scan and inspection holes must be redone for the new point before the auger enters the ground.

A: A clearance covers the points actually checked, and a service could lie in the strip that was not dug or scanned. B: A signature on an old permit does not show the new points are free of services, which needs fresh checks. C: Spotting a strike afterwards is not prevention, and an auger can sever a cable or pipe with little warning.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming earlier all-clear checks travel with the job when the dig or drill points have moved.

28. B — Electricity at Work Regulation 6 requires equipment to be protected from foreseeable mechanical damage, which is best achieved by keeping the cable out of vehicle paths altogether.

A: An inspection finds damage after it happens, whereas the regulation requires protection to prevent damage, and crush damage can be hidden. C: Light ramps are not rated for 26-tonne wheel loads, so adding another does not give protection that is suitable. D: A crushed cable at any voltage can still cause danger and fail, so reduced voltage does not remove the need to protect it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on armour or traffic control instead of keeping the cable out of the path of vehicles.

29. B — HSE advice is to stop work immediately and treat suspect material as asbestos until it is confirmed otherwise, then assess whether the work needs a licensed contractor.

A: Work must stop until the material is identified, because others on the ground and the stockpile are exposed in the meantime. C: Small fragments and fibres remain in the soil, and untrained hand-picking exposes the worker. D: Broken asbestos cement can release fibres, and moving and stockpiling the spoil would spread the contamination.

COMMON MISTAKE: Carrying on until a laboratory result arrives, instead of stopping and treating suspect material as asbestos until proved otherwise.

30. A — Waste on the site must be described accurately, passed only to a registered carrier with a transfer note under the duty of care, and a general skip does not describe or cover tyres.

B: An unregistered carrier with no transfer note leaves the site liable if the tyres are dumped elsewhere. C: The occupier remains responsible for waste on the land, and a stack of tyres is a fire hazard. D: The skip's waste description would not include tyres, so this misdescribes the load and breaks the duty of care.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming waste dumped by someone else stops being the site's problem, or can be hidden in the next skip.

31. B — Under CDM 2015 regulation 4 the client's arrangements must ensure the Schedule 2 welfare facilities are provided, and must be maintained and reviewed, so a contract clause does not remove that duty.

A: The client keeps its own duty to ensure welfare is provided and cannot pass it away by contract wording. C: The arrangements must be maintained and reviewed throughout the project, not discharged at appointment. D: Client duties under CDM apply to commercial projects whether or not they are notifiable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a contract clause passing welfare to the contractor means the client no longer has to check it is actually provided.

32. D — Notices deal with ongoing or likely contraventions, but a past breach can be prosecuted, and HSE decides whether to do so by applying its enforcement policy to the evidence and public interest.

A: A prior notice is not a precondition for prosecution. B: Prosecution can relate to a breach that has since been put right. C: HSE decides whether to bring a prosecution; the court decides the verdict and sentence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a fault that has been fixed after the inspector's visit wipes the slate clean and removes any chance of prosecution.

33. C — A significant change in the conditions the assessment relates to requires a review, and the revised document should cover the new interface and a fallback for the access plan failing.

A: A verbal briefing does not replace a reviewed and recorded assessment of the changed risks. B: Access failure affects traffic, storage and pedestrian routes, so a contingency belongs in the safety planning. D: A significant change in circumstances means the assessment must be reviewed, not left to improvised judgement.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a risk assessment as a one-off document that stays valid after the season, access or public presence has changed.

34. D — The Manual Handling Operations Regulations require avoiding hazardous handling where reasonably practicable, then assessing and reducing the risk of any that remains.

A: Training supports but does not replace avoiding and reducing the load. B: Back belts are not an accepted control for heavy handling and do not remove the risk. C: Repeated carrying of heavy loads on stairs still needs avoidance and assessment, whatever one person can manage.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on lifting technique, rests or support belts instead of first asking whether the load can be avoided or made smaller.

35. C — Retro-reflective material returns light to its source and needs a light source and a clear surface, so it works only if uncovered and if lighting or vehicle lamps reach it.

A: Fluorescence depends on daylight and gives little benefit as light fades; the bands carry the night-time effect. B: Reflective material is not self-lit and only returns light that falls on it. D: The risk from site vehicles exists on private tracks too, so the bands must remain visible there.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a hi-vis vest makes the wearer visible in any light, however it is worn and wherever it is used.

36. C — The Work at Height Regulations require steps to prevent objects falling first, then steps to prevent anyone being struck where that is not reasonably practicable.

A: PPE is a last resort and does not replace preventing falls or keeping people clear. B: A net at slab level would sit where the other gang works and cannot take the place of preventing falls or exclusion. D: A shouted warning is unreliable and does not prevent objects falling or people being struck.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating hard hats or warning shouts as the answer to work going on above people instead of preventing falls and separating the gangs.

37. D — The Electricity at Work Regulations require maintenance to prevent danger without a set interval, so the frequency of checks and tests should reflect the equipment, environment, use and fault history.

A: Reduced voltage lowers the risk but the tools still need maintenance, particularly in harsh conditions. B: No legal minimum interval exists, and a high failure rate is itself a reason to increase frequency. C: The dutyholder sets the frequency based on risk and need not be limited to a maker's figure.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing there is a single legal test interval for portable tools instead of setting frequency by risk and fault history.

38. C — The end hose should hang near vertical and be guided, never pulled out horizontally, because pressure surges can make it whip violently and strike or throw the handlers.

A: Splash is a real but lesser risk than hose whip with the line stretched out. B: Boards are present and the hose end moves with

pressure surges that the pump operator cannot fully control. D: Moving the pump closer is part of the fix, but the hazard shown is the stretched hose, not visibility.

COMMON MISTAKE: Focusing on splash or tripping while overlooking the risk of the delivery hose whipping when it is held out and stretched.

39. A — HSE guidance on crane radio use says commands come from one person, the link is checked each shift, and the operator stops the operation if communication breaks down.

B: Two people signalling gives conflicting instructions; commands should come from one person only. C: Continuing blind after a lost link is the very risk, and the operator should stop. D: Relayed signals are slow and unreliable, and guessing a movement is unacceptable in a lift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a personal phone as equal to a dedicated, tested crane radio and carrying on moving when the link drops.

40. A — Stopping the source and keeping sewage out of surface-water drains limits harm, and sewage must be removed by a registered carrier, with any reach of a watercourse reported to the regulator.

B: Washing spreads sewage and can push it into the drain, causing the pollution it should prevent. C: Containment is needed now to stop it reaching the gully, and waiting for the routine visit leaves the risk open. D: Discharging to a public sewer needs the sewerage undertaker's consent and does not deal with contamination on the ground.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a spill is only a problem once it has visibly reached a watercourse, rather than containing it before it reaches a drain.

41. C — The Health and Safety at Work etc. Act requires an employer to conduct its undertaking so that people not in its employment are not exposed to risk, and this sits alongside the haulier's separate duty to its own employee.

A: A warning does not remove a hazard that the site can reasonably control, and visitors do not accept risk by arriving. B: The duty arises from the site's activities exposing him to risk, not from any paperwork he has or has not signed. D: Duties to people affected by the undertaking do not depend on who employs them, so the site cannot hand the whole duty to the haulier.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a visiting driver's safety belongs entirely to his own employer because he is not on the site's payroll.

42. B — The principal contractor must plan, manage, monitor and coordinate the construction phase, which means reviewing a subcontractor's method before it starts, while the subcontractor stays responsible for its own work.

A: A signature cannot transfer or remove the principal contractor's coordination duty, and it does nothing to prevent the hazard. C: Approval does not transfer responsibility for the method, and approving after the work has started defeats the purpose of review. D: Reviewing before work begins is part of coordination, and a subcontractor's own duty does not replace the principal contractor's.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the principal contractor's review of subcontractor RAMS as a formality that can follow the start of work.

43. D — An extinguisher with a missing pin, a low gauge and an out-of-date service cannot be relied on, so it must be replaced and others checked to keep fire-fighting equipment effective.

A: A gauge in the red shows it may not work when needed. B: A faulty extinguisher left on site may be used in an emergency and fail. C: Altering the appearance does not restore its working condition.

COMMON MISTAKE: Leaving a visibly faulty extinguisher on the wall because it has never been needed.

44. C — Extraction at source controls fume for everyone nearby, and respiratory protective equipment is the last line for residual exposure, rather than the main control.

A: Limiting time and issuing masks controls neither the fume at source nor the exposure of anyone without a fitted mask. B: Fume spreads through the bay and affects others nearby, and a mask for one person leaves the source uncontrolled. D: General ventilation spreads fume rather than capturing it, and in a poorly ventilated bay it exposes everyone to it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reaching for a mask or a fan first, rather than capturing welding and cutting fume at the source.

45. B — Heat tolerance is reduced after a break, so gradual reintroduction is needed, and the lack of a legal maximum temperature does not remove the duty to assess and control the risk.

A: Tolerance fades after a prolonged absence, so returning workers need a gradual build-up as well. C: Clothing alone does not manage the strain of working in great heat, which is a health risk and not merely comfort. D: Thirst lags behind fluid loss, and the general duty to assess and control risk still applies without a legal maximum.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that experience, or the lack of a

legal maximum temperature, makes a gradual build-up unnecessary after a long absence.

46. B — PPE must fit the wearer correctly after adjustment within its designed range, and a harness set for someone else may leave slack or sit wrongly, so it needs adjusting by every wearer each time.

A: No single size fits all builds, and fastened buckles do not show that the harness is correctly adjusted to the wearer. C: Leg and shoulder straps differ greatly between builds, and a loose harness can shift and fail to hold the wearer properly in a fall. D: A lanyard cannot take up slack in the harness, and a loose harness can ride up, let the wearer slip or hurt him in a fall.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a harness as one-size-fits-all so that only its condition, and not its fit on the wearer, gets checked.

47. C — An air-fed helmet is only as good as the air supplied to it, and the intake must be sited in clean air away from exhaust, with supplied air meeting the breathing air standard.

A: A disposable mask gives far lower protection than a clean-air-fed helmet for heavy dust, so it would worsen the protection. B: Loose-fitting air-fed helmets rely on the airflow rather than a face seal, and the real problem is the quality of the air supplied. D: Hose length matters within the manufacturer's limits, but the scene's main problem is contaminated supply, not a looped hose.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging air-fed protection by the helmet's fit and rating, without checking where the air comes from.

48. A — Rated load must never be exceeded whatever margin is built in, and access beneath a mast climbing work platform should be prevented by proper fencing, since tape or rope is not an acceptable barrier.

B: The displayed rating is a limit, not a starting point for a margin, and exceeding it can overload the platform and mast. C: Duration does not alter the load limit or the need for a barrier, as an overload or fall of materials can happen at any time. D: A person at the tape is not a physical barrier, and tape cannot stop others entering beneath the platform.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a built-in safety margin allows a platform to be loaded past its rating, or that tape counts as a barrier.

49. D — The shop's wiring was not installed for site loads, so its capacity and protection must be known and approved by a competent person, as a casual consent does not make the circuit suitable.

A: Sockets share a circuit with other loads, so a working socket says nothing about the circuit's capacity or protection. B: Protective devices on an unknown circuit cannot be assumed to trip in time, and short bursts still carry the risk. C: Plug fuses and tested leads protect the equipment, not the shop's fixed wiring, whose rating and protection are unknown.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a client's casual permission to use a wall socket as proof that the circuit is suitable for site equipment.

50. D — Plant should not be steered while on ramps, so a drifting machine should be backed off and re-aligned, with the banksman positioned where he is seen and outside any fall or tip zone.

A: Continuing leaves the drift uncorrected on a narrow ramp, and a braked machine can be reversed safely. B: Anyone on or beside a moving ramp load risks being crushed or struck if the machine slips. C: Steering on ramps risks one track slipping off the edge, and slow speed does not make that correction safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Steering mid-ramp to fix a bad approach instead of backing off and re-aligning before the climb.

PRACTICE TEST 19

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A firm's dumper driver ignores the marked pedestrian route and cuts across it, injuring a self-employed electrician working for another contractor. He was trained and had a written rule, but supervisors had seen him do it before and said nothing. Which statement on legal responsibility is most accurate?

☐ **A)** The electrician's own employer carries the responsibility, as it should have kept him out of areas where another firm's vehicles are operating

☐ **B)** The firm is cleared once it proves the rule existed, because liability ends the moment an individual deliberately disobeys a clear instruction

☐ **C)** The firm can be prosecuted for exposing others to risk, as tolerated rule-breaking shows weak supervision, and the driver can be prosecuted too

☐ **D)** Only the driver is answerable, because the firm trained him and issued a written rule, and its duties cover its own employees rather than outsiders

2. A manager plans the hazard walk-round for a three-week refurbishment. He will tour the empty rooms alone on Sunday with the drawings and a checklist, then brief the gang on Monday. Which change would most improve how well hazards are identified?

☐ **A)** Walk the areas with operatives who will do the work and ask how each task will really be done, including cleaning and maintenance

☐ **B)** Delay the walk-round until the gang has started, so hazards are recorded as they appear and the findings reflect real working conditions

☐ **C)** Limit the walk to supervisors and the safety adviser for independence, then ask operatives to sign the findings during the Monday briefing

☐ **D)** Rely on the checklist and past accident-book entries, because operatives' views are subjective and a consistent method gives more reliable results

3. A scaffolder lands badly after stepping off a 1 m platform. His lower leg is bent at an odd angle and swelling, he is conscious, in severe pain and cannot stand. There is no ongoing danger and an ambulance is 25 minutes away. What should the first aider do?

☐ **A)** Gently straighten the leg to its normal line, then tie it firmly to a spare scaffold board so the bone stays in place before the ambulance arrives

☐ **B)** Help him stand with support to check whether the leg takes any weight, since a genuine fracture would not allow him to stand at all

☐ **C)** Lift him into a van and drive him to hospital at once, because this is quicker than waiting for the ambulance and avoids the cold

☐ **D)** Keep him still and support the leg in the position found with hands or padding, keep him warm and reassured, and stay with him until help arrives

4. A contractor will fit out level 4 of a multi-tenant office building that has zoned fire alarms and a phased evacuation strategy run by the building's management. The foreman assumes his usual 'everyone out to the yard' routine applies. What should happen before work starts?

☐ **A)** The tenants' fire wardens will direct the crew on the day, so the contractor as a temporary occupier has no need to learn the strategy in advance

☐ **B)** Get the evacuation strategy, alarm zones and signals from the building's responsible person, co-ordinate with them and brief the crew

☐ **C)** The crew should telephone the building manager for instructions every time any alarm sounds, and stay put until a reply confirms what to do

☐ **D)** Nothing special is needed, because the contractor's own evacuation routine takes precedence over the building's arrangements for the duration of the works

5. A kerbing gang will use petrol disc cutters for three weeks. The

hire firm offers the standard model, or a quieter model of similar output for a small extra cost. The manager prefers the standard cutter and plans to issue ear defenders, calling this equally compliant. Which view is correct?

☐ **A)** The choice should be made on hire price alone, since suppliers' noise data are unreliable and exposure can only be judged from site measurements

☐ **B)** The two choices are equally compliant, because a high enough rated pair of ear defenders removes any difference in exposure between the models

☐ **C)** Noise should be cut at source first, including choosing the quietest suitable equipment, with hearing protection covering only the exposure that remains

☐ **D)** The quieter model matters only if the standard model is proven to exceed the upper exposure action value, since lower levels carry no duty to reduce noise

6. Two joiners must move 18 mm plywood sheets, 2440 by 1220 mm and about 40 kg each, from a van along a corridor and through two narrow doorways into a room. Which approach is best?

☐ **A)** Make each carry quickly without stopping, since a shorter time under load lowers the strain, and ask the pair to swap ends after each doorway

☐ **B)** Use a sheet trolley or carry each sheet on edge, with one person calling every move, after checking the route width, door swing and floor

☐ **C)** Let the stronger joiner lead, walking backwards, and take most of the weight while the other steers the trailing end through the doorways

☐ **D)** Carry each sheet flat above head height to clear the door frames, since the weight is then shared equally and no one needs to turn the sheet

7. A facade scaffold stands beside a street used by schoolchildren, and the site will be shut for two days. A ladder runs from the ground to the first lift, and loose boards and a bundle of tubes lie on the bottom lift. What is the best arrangement before leaving?

☐ **A)** Lash the bottom of the ladder with rope and fix a 'Keep off' sign at its base, since lashing and signage together will deter children from climbing

☐ **B)** Leave everything in place, because a green tag showing a recent inspection means the scaffold is secure against misuse and needs no further steps

☐ **C)** Remove the bottom ladder to a locked store or fit a padlocked guard, and clear loose boards and tubes from the lower lifts into secured storage

☐ **D)** Raise the ladder and leave it on the first lift platform, so reaching it from the pavement would need a jump and most children would not attempt it



8. Look at the fixer working beside the overhead steel beam. Which feature of his fall-arrest set-up is the most serious weakness?

☐ **A)** He is using a restraint lanyard with no energy absorber, so the force on his body in a fall would be too high for the anchor

☐ **B)** The lanyard is looped round the beam with its connector hooked back onto itself, loading it over an edge in a way it was not designed for

☐ **C)** The anchor beam is far above his harness, so a fall would be much longer than the lanyard's rated distance and strike the platform

☐ **D)** The harness straps are twisted and loose at the legs, so the harness could not hold him upright if a fall were arrested

9. A distant thunderstorm is forecast to reach a site where a crew is working with tall metal scaffold and a crane. The foreman says lightning only strikes the tallest object, so everyone else can keep working. What is the correct approach?

☐ **A)** Monitor the forecast, agree stop-work and shelter triggers, lower or secure the crane and move people away from tall metal structures

☐ **B)** Carry on as normal since only the tallest object is at risk, and ask the crane operator to stay at the controls for the duration

☐ **C)** Keep working until the first thunder is heard, then shelter

under the scaffold, since a metal frame conducts a strike safely to earth

☐ **D)** Pause work only when rain starts falling, because lightning occurs only in heavy rain and not in distant storms

10. A crowded yard is full of parked skips and pallet stacks. A visiting lorry driver must reverse into a tight bay. The yard marshal, who has never worked with him, plans to walk backwards ahead of the lorry using his own gestures to keep it centred. Which approach is best?

☐ **A)** Walk ahead of the lorry, backwards, in its path so the driver keeps a clear view of the signals, and use whatever gestures come naturally

☐ **B)** Brief the driver verbally, then stand at the rear of the bay behind the load to guide it in and raise a hand to stop it if needed

☐ **C)** Let the driver reverse on mirrors alone, with a single horn blast before each short move and the marshal watching only for pedestrians

☐ **D)** Agree standard signals with the driver first, stand in a safe, visible position clear of the vehicle's path, and have him stop if sight is lost

11. A firm with 40 staff holds a signed health and safety policy statement from 2019, filed in the director's office. Since then it has bought a tower crane, taken on agency labour and started work beside a railway. An inspector asks whether the statement still meets the law. Which view is correct?

☐ **A)** It must be rewritten every twelve months by law and each new version sent to the HSE for approval before it takes effect

☐ **B)** It stays valid until the HSE asks for any changes to be made, because the law only requires the statement to be prepared, signed and filed once

☐ **C)** It must be revised as often as is appropriate to reflect such changes, and the revised statement brought to the notice of all employees

☐ **D)** Only the arrangements section needs updating, and existing employees need not be shown it again after they have read the original

12. A labourer has worked 12-hour days for three weeks on a completion push, under a signed opt-out from the 48-hour average limit. Today he yawns, misjudges a step and says he fears dozing off on the long drive home. The supervisor says the opt-out settles the matter. What is the right response?

☐ **A)** Let him go home after a strong coffee and with an open window, since the opt-out shows he accepted the long hours and the journey is his own concern

☐ **B)** The opt-out only waives the average weekly limit, so the employer must still manage fatigue by relieving him and setting and recording limits on hours

☐ **C)** Move him to lighter tasks for the rest of the shift, since fatigue is a hazard only while a person is actually working on site

☐ **D)** Reduce his hours only after he formally withdraws the opt-out in writing, because without that notice the employer cannot change his shifts

13. After a burst pipe, a refurbishment crew must strip black-mould-covered plasterboard from a bedroom. They plan to scrape it off, dry-sweep the debris, then spray bleach over the studs. One labourer already has a chesty cough. Which plan best controls the respiratory risk?

☐ **A)** Scrape and sweep as planned, then spray bleach on every surface, because bleach kills the spores and so removes the respiratory hazard

☐ **B)** Let the crew work in basic dust masks with a window open, because mould is natural and the coughing worker will simply adapt

☐ **C)** Stop the leak, remove wet board with dust suppressed and bag it, use fit-tested respiratory protection, and get health advice for the cough

☐ **D)** Remove the boards but leave the leak until the end of the job, since the water source does not affect the mould exposure



14. Look at the scene. The foreman says the operative is well protected because he wears a hard hat, ear defenders, a

respirator and a full face visor. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The respirator is unnecessary because the water feed on the cutter already removes all of the silica dust, so it only restricts breathing

☐ **B)** The hard hat should be swapped for a bump cap, since the work is done kneeling at ground level where nothing can fall on him

☐ **C)** A clear face visor is secondary protection and does not seal around the eyes, so impact-rated glasses or goggles should be worn underneath

☐ **D)** A clear visor is the wrong type for this task, and a mesh visor would give better protection against flying fragments from the cutter

15. On a wet road-widening job, a labourer works beside reversing plant in a dark green waterproof jacket, with the hood up over his hard hat. His hi-vis vest is back in the van. He says the hood keeps him dry. Which approach best deals with the wet-weather clothing?

☐ **A)** Supply waterproofs that are high-visibility, with a hood that fits under or around the helmet without limiting side vision or muffling alarms

☐ **B)** Keep the dark jacket and hood, and add a banksman to warn him of moving plant, so awareness becomes the banksman's job

☐ **C)** Replace the jacket with a hi-vis vest over a thick hooded sweatshirt, since a fluorescent colour is all that matters for safety near plant

☐ **D)** Allow the dark jacket and hood, adding a reflective strip across the hood, since reflective material makes up for lost vision and hearing

16. A roofer repointing a gable verge on a 35-degree house roof, with eaves edge protection already fitted, hooks a home-made roof ladder over the ridge capping and slides it down the slope. The capping is old and loosely bedded. What is the main problem with this set-up?

☐ **A)** The ladder should stop short of the ridge, so that its weight is kept off the capping and the ladder lies only on the slates

☐ **B)** The roof ladder is not needed at all, as eaves edge protection alone gives enough protection for work on a sloping roof surface

☐ **C)** Ridge capping can break away, so it needs a properly designed ridge hook on the opposite slope or another secure fixing

☐ **D)** The ladder should instead be tied at its foot to the eaves gutter bracket, since the gutter fixing is the strongest point on the roof

17. A fitter finishes ceiling work in one bay of a warehouse and wants to shift a braced mobile tower 12 m to the next. Nobody is on the platform, but a drill, a tub of fixings and a roll of cable are left on it. A labourer will push on the top guardrail. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Clear the platform and push from the base, since the route can be checked when the tower arrives and the brakes applied once it stops

☐ **B)** Push from the base but leave the heavy items on the lowest deck, since a low load will not affect how the tower behaves

☐ **C)** Clear the platform, push from the base, check the route for holes and overhead obstructions, then re-apply all brakes at the new position

☐ **D)** Leave the items on the platform, as the toe boards will hold them in place, and push at the top rail where steering is easiest

18. A subcontractor sends a driver holding a full HGV licence but no site plant experience to drive a forward-tip dumper on a housing site. The subcontractor says the licence proves he can drive anything on wheels. What should the principal contractor require?

☐ **A)** Nothing further, because a licence covers all driving and a dumper that stays within the site boundary needs no other check

☐ **B)** Evidence he has been trained and assessed as competent on this type of dumper, with familiarisation and authorisation before he drives alone

☐ **C)** A short ride-along with a labourer, since heavy-vehicle experience carries straight over to rough-terrain, forward-tip site dumpers

☐ **D)** A written declaration from the subcontractor that he is

competent, since competence of its own driver is solely its responsibility

19. A 13-tonne excavator lowers drain pipes into a trench. The operator cannot see the trench bottom, so a groundworker gives informal waves and thumbs-up, while another labourer sometimes shouts. Which arrangement is best?

☐ **A)** Allow any worker to signal, since the operator can judge which signals are sensible from experience and then keep moving at a slow pace

☐ **B)** Let the groundworker signal from the trench because he sees the pipe best, and have the operator carry on slowly if the signal is lost

☐ **C)** Rely on shouted instructions over the engine noise, with gestures as a backup because they leave the signaller's hands free

☐ **D)** Appoint one trained signaller using agreed standard signals in clear view, and have the operator stop if a signal is unclear or lost

20. A contractor will demolish a concrete garage block 15 m from a care home with frail residents, using a hydraulic breaker. The manager says working in daytime hours and wearing ear defenders is enough. Which plan best applies best practicable means?

☐ **A)** Agree sensitive times with the care manager, use a quieter method such as a crusher where possible, and site plant and screens to shield the home

☐ **B)** Start work and deal with any complaints as they arise, since the home can only object once a measured noise level has been exceeded

☐ **C)** Keep to daytime hours and give the workers ear defenders, since protecting the operators is what controls the noise reaching the nearby home

☐ **D)** Send a leaflet about the dates to the home and use the breaker throughout the job, as advance warning removes the need for any other noise controls

21. A supplier will deliver 40 kg rolls of roofing membrane and tins of solvent-based adhesive to a cramped city site on Thursday. The manager intends to decide where to unload once the lorry arrives. Which approach best controls the risks?

☐ **A)** Order the smallest practical quantity and keep both materials together in the cabin, because limiting volume removes the need for a planned drop zone or store

☐ **B)** Leave the assessment to the haulier, since the driver is responsible for the load until it is on the ground, and keep site staff away until then

☐ **C)** Brief the driver on arrival and unload at the nearest kerb, because the delivery note shows what is on board and a single drop needs no earlier assessment or planning

☐ **D)** Assess beforehand using the supplier's weights and safety data sheet, then plan the unloading method, a pedestrian-free drop zone and a separate adhesive store

22. A fire in a half-built timber-frame block is put out, and the fire and rescue service hands the area back. Short of programme time, the manager wants trades back in at 7 am. What should be done before anyone is allowed back in?

☐ **A)** Keep it closed until a competent person has checked the structure and temporary works and the fire risk assessment and alarms are reviewed

☐ **B)** Re-admit workers once the area has been cleaned and dried, because soot and water are the remaining hazards and a structural check can follow later

☐ **C)** Allow trades back on any floor the fire did not reach, since only the burnt area is unsafe and the fire service has already cleared the whole building

☐ **D)** Restart when the insurer's loss adjuster has photographed the damage and approved a restart, because the insurer would otherwise refuse the claim

23. While stripping out an old boiler house, a fitter breaks a mercury thermostat switch and silver beads roll into floor cracks. The room is small and warm. What is the best immediate response?

☐ **A)** Brush the beads into a dustpan, wipe the floor with a damp cloth and put everything in the general skip, since mercury is a heavy liquid that does not spread as vapour

☐ **B)** Vacuum the beads with the site's industrial dust vacuum, because its filter will trap them and stop them settling deeper into the floor cracks

☐ **C)** Flush the beads down the floor drain with plenty of water,

then carry on stripping out while wearing a dust mask, as dilution makes mercury harmless

☐ **D)** Clear and ventilate the room, keep the heating off, and have a trained person collect the beads with a mercury spill kit for disposal as hazardous waste

24. A site has three women on it, but their toilet has no bin and items are being flushed, blocking the unit. A labourer who cleans the cabins is told to bag whatever he finds and put it in the general skip. Which arrangement is best?

☐ **A)** Fit a lidded sanitary bin in the women's toilet, plan regular emptying by a licensed waste contractor, and give the cleaner gloves and handwashing

☐ **B)** Supply a bin, treat the contents as clinical waste for specialist incineration, and restrict all emptying to trained first-aiders on site

☐ **C)** Tell everyone to flush the items and have the cleaner clear blockages by hand as part of routine cleaning, since a bin only attracts complaints and odour

☐ **D)** Supply a bin but let the cleaner empty it into the general skip each Friday, since the contents are ordinary rubbish needing no handling controls

25. A tower crane lands pallets on a cantilevered loading platform through a gate on an upper floor. The plate reads 1,000 kg, but two 600 kg pallets are due together and the gate is to be left open between lifts. Which change best controls the risk?

☐ **A)** Land the pallets singly but leave the gate open for the whole shift, since respecting the weight limit is the main control the platform needs

☐ **B)** Land one pallet at a time within the plate limit, open the gate only to receive it, and close it again once the load is unhooked and moved clear of the edge

☐ **C)** Keep the gate open all shift but hang a rope across the gap, since people will see the rope and each pallet is below the stated limit

☐ **D)** Land both pallets together if the slinger clips a harness to the building, because personal protection allows the gate to stay open and the load plate to be exceeded



26. Look at the plasterer working on stilts in the picture. Which condition in the scene is most likely to cause him to fall?

☐ **A)** The absence of a harness anchor, because anyone working on stilts must be fall-arrested whenever the stilts are raised above knee height

☐ **B)** The height setting of the stilts, since adjustable stilts above ankle height are prohibited under the Work at Height Regulations

☐ **C)** The wet plaster on the wall ahead of him, which will make him lean away from the surface and lose his footing on the stilts

☐ **D)** A trailing cable and loose offcuts lying on the floor across his walking route, which can catch a stilt and throw him off balance

27. A 1.5 m deep trench for a water pipe runs 2 m from a mature oak in clay, where a service plan shows a gas main nearby. Thick roots cross the line. Which approach best controls the risks?

☐ **A)** Dig mechanically along the line to full depth then hand-clean, since a mature tree's root mat binds the clay and makes side support unnecessary at 1.5 m

☐ **B)** Hand-dig only the top 500 mm then switch to the excavator, as roots and buried services both lie within that depth in clay

☐ **C)** Cut every root that crosses the line flush with the trench wall to give a clean face, then support the sides and rely on the service plan for the gas main

☐ **D)** Hand-dig or vacuum-excavate to expose services and roots, support the sides as roots cannot be relied on to hold soil, and take advice before cutting large roots

28. A trial hole exposes an 11 kV cable. The network plan marks it 'disconnected', and one section ends in a bottle-shaped pot end. The foreman says a sealed end proves it is disused and wants to cut it with a hacksaw. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Cut it with insulated tools and rubber gloves since the plan says disconnected, because the plan is the owner's record and the gloves protect against 11 kV

☐ **B)** Ask the owner to say by phone that it is dead, then have a competent electrician cut it, because verbal assurance from the owner is enough

☐ **C)** Treat it as live and keep clear until the owner confirms disconnection in writing and proves it dead at the point of work, supervising any cutting

☐ **D)** Check the cable's outer sheath with a voltage detector, and if there is no reading treat it as dead, because an 11 kV cable gives a clear signal when live

29. A trench on a former fuel depot fills with groundwater showing a rainbow sheen and a diesel smell. The contractor plans to pump it through a silt bag to a nearby stream under the Environment Agency's temporary dewatering position for clean water. What is the best course?

☐ **A)** Stop pumping, contain the water, and arrange testing and treatment or disposal under a bespoke permit or water company consent, as the allowance excludes contamination

☐ **B)** Dilute it by running clean mains water into the trench while pumping, so the sheen disappears before the water reaches the stream and nothing shows

☐ **C)** Continue through the silt bag and add a second settlement tank in series, as settling removes the hydrocarbons and leaves the discharge compliant with the rules

☐ **D)** Pump it to the nearest foul sewer manhole, since sewage works treat contaminants anyway and no consent is needed for temporary flows

30. A fencing gang receives 25-litre drums of solvent-based wood preservative for three weeks of work. The compound has a lockable steel container, a surface-water gully, and a cabin with an LPG heater. Where should the drums be kept overnight?

☐ **A)** In the locked container on a bund tray with lids closed and a spill kit beside it, away from heater and gully, taking out only the day's quantity

☐ **B)** On hardstanding away from the gully with the lids loosened to vent vapour, since outdoor air disperses fumes and a loose lid prevents pressure build-up

☐ **C)** Beside the cabin under a tarpaulin on pallets, because raised drums cannot leak into the gully and the cabin heater stops the liquid thickening

☐ **D)** Stacked on the container floor with an LPG heater run overnight to prevent freezing, since the lockable door is the one control that really matters

31. After a fatal fall, an HSE inspector formally requires a site supervisor to answer questions about the work and sign a declaration of truth. A coroner has opened an inquest, and the supervisor says he will stay silent until it ends in case his answers are used against him. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** He must answer, but anything he says can then be used against him in a prosecution, so he is right to insist on a solicitor first

☐ **B)** He may decline questions about his own actions, because the right to silence covers employees while only the employer must account for the work

☐ **C)** He may wait until the inquest ends, because coroner proceedings take priority over inspector questioning and early statements could prejudice the verdict

☐ **D)** He must answer and sign; answers given under that requirement cannot be used as evidence against him, and he may have a person he nominates present

32. Roofers leave a stripped roof under loosely tied sheeting overnight. A storm tears it off and rain ruins stock in the neighbouring shop. The HSE takes no action, and the contractor's manager says that without enforcement there is no liability. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** The claim succeeds automatically without proof of fault, because damage caused by building work attracts strict liability for the contractor

☐ **B)** The owner can sue in negligence for foreseeable loss whatever the HSE does, though breaching the Act's duties itself gives no civil claim

☐ **C)** No claim is possible, because the duties of a contractor under the Act protect only employees and workers on site, not neighbouring businesses

☐ **D)** The shop owner can claim only if the HSE prosecutes, because proof of a breach of the Act is what gives a neighbour

the right to compensation

33. A team will inspect a 1.5 m surface-water culvert, entering through a shaft. The assessment covers atmosphere and escape, assuming dry weather. Heavy rain is forecast over the catchment 8 km upstream, though the site itself is dry today. What must the assessment address?

☐ **A)** The foreseeable surge from upstream rainfall, with a forecast check before entry, a clear stop-work trigger and a prompt exit route for everyone below

☐ **B)** Nothing further, since the site is dry today and any later flooding would be an emergency matter for the rescue team to deal with once it happens

☐ **C)** Review the assessment only if rain actually falls at the site itself, since weather upstream lies outside the employer's control and knowledge

☐ **D)** Issue waders and buoyancy aids to everyone below, which would make an upstream surge survivable without any need to alter the working plan

34. A crew fixes a bridge parapet in minus 2 degrees C air with a strong wind, wearing several layers soaked with sweat from heavy lifting. The supervisor judges conditions by the thermometer. One man's ears feel numb and look waxy white. Which approach controls the risk best?

☐ **A)** Plan by wind chill, not air temperature, with windbreaks, warm-up breaks, dry spare layers and covered skin, as numb white patches signal freezing

☐ **B)** Provide hot drinks and sweet food at the start of the shift, which keeps the body warm enough to prevent cold injury to exposed skin

☐ **C)** Rely on the thermometer, since minus 2 degrees is only mildly cold, and let each worker add or remove layers until he feels personally comfortable

☐ **D)** Issue extra-thick insulated clothing and leave workers to set their own pace, since insulation alone prevents cold injury whatever the wind or sweat

35. On a winter day at 1 degree C, a crew places concrete in an outdoor slab. The store holds fleece-lined cold-rated gloves and thin chemical-resistant nitrile gloves, and a worker says either pair alone will do. Which glove choice best deals with both hazards?

☐ **A)** Leather gloves worn over thin nitrile, since the leather's thickness blocks the mix and also keeps the hands warm during the task

☐ **B)** The thin nitrile gloves alone, since a chemical-proof material makes insulation unnecessary and keeps the hands dry throughout the pour

☐ **C)** Waterproof chemical-resistant gauntlets over a thermal liner, replaced as soon as wet mix gets inside the cuff or the glove is torn

☐ **D)** The fleece-lined cold-rated gloves alone, since their cold rating also gives protection against the alkaline wet mix during placing

36. In a lane closure, a boom MEWP operator is to hang a 6 m by 1 m vinyl event banner from a lamp bracket. Wind is well below the machine's plated limit, and the banner weighs little. The operator says the plated limit and safe working load are both satisfied. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** The lane closure deals with the real risk, since traffic is the hazard and wind limits matter only for machines working near buildings

☐ **B)** A large banner adds sail area, so it can overturn the machine below plated wind speed; seek maker approval or use another method

☐ **C)** The plated wind limit holds whatever is being carried, so working below it with the lane closed and the load within its limits is acceptable

☐ **D)** Only the weight of the banner matters, since the safe working load is the figure that governs stability, while wind affects only heavy loads

37. A cable locator traces a line and shows 1.3 m depth. The drawings show nothing in the area. The operative plans to machine-dig to 1.0 m, then hand dig, saying the reading leaves a safe 300 mm margin. What is the main flaw?

☐ **A)** Depth readings go wrong only on plastic pipes, so for a traced metallic line the figure can be trusted when a signal generator was used

☐ **B)** A second scan from the opposite direction giving the same depth would confirm the figure, so the digging plan could then

go ahead

☐ **C)** The depth shown is only a guide and the service may lie shallower, so hand-dug trial holes should confirm its position and depth first

☐ **D)** The 300 mm margin is too small, and a margin of 600 mm would make machine digging acceptable on the strength of the reading



38. Look at the scene. The driver says it is a short trip across level, firm ground and everyone is wearing the right PPE. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The dumper has no flashing beacon, so one must be fitted before it is driven among pedestrians and other site traffic

☐ **B)** Two workers are riding in the skip, not a passenger position, so they should walk or use a vehicle with proper seats

☐ **C)** The driver's seat belt is unfastened, so the dumper must stay stationary until it is worn properly before any movement across the site

☐ **D)** The skip is raised while the machine travels, which makes it unstable on sloping ground and means it must be lowered first

39. A firm tows a weighed 2,400 kg compressor on an overrun-braked trailer behind a pickup whose handbook gives a maximum braked towing mass of 2,000 kg. The driver's licence covers the combination. The foreman says that is enough. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** The vehicle's own towing limit is a separate ceiling that licence and trailer brakes do not raise, so a more capable tow vehicle is needed

☐ **B)** Draining the compressor's fuel and air receiver for the journey would bring the combination within the limit and so make the trip acceptable

☐ **C)** The trailer's overrun brakes make up for the excess mass, so this pickup can pull it provided the driver keeps to a low speed throughout

☐ **D)** The licence entitlement is the only limit that counts, since handbook figures are only advice and a competent driver can manage the extra weight

40. To warm a cabin, a foreman feeds offcuts of pressure-treated fence posts into its wood-burning stove, saying wood is wood and the stove heats well. A neighbour smells a sharp smoke from the flue. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** It is acceptable in an enclosed stove, since high burning temperatures destroy the preservative and leave treated wood as harmless as clean timber

☐ **B)** It is acceptable because the offcuts come from the site's own work, and waste burned where it is produced is exempt from controls

☐ **C)** It is acceptable if the stove is an approved smoke-control model, since only the chimney smoke matters and not what the appliance burns

☐ **D)** Treated timber is waste, and burning it releases preservative metals and toxic fumes, so it should be kept apart and sent for licensed disposal

41. On a 30-person refurbishment the principal contractor employs one first aider and keeps the main first-aid room. A four-man plastering subcontractor and a self-employed electrician both assume this covers them, and nothing has been agreed. Which statement is correct?

☐ **A)** Each employer must appoint its own qualified first aider whatever is agreed, because the law forbids relying on another firm's first-aid room or personnel on a shared site

☐ **B)** Sharing cover is sensible, but each firm stays responsible for its own people, so agree it in writing, and the electrician still needs his own first-aid kit

☐ **C)** The subcontractor must provide cover for its four plasterers, but the self-employed electrician has no duty and can rely on the principal contractor's first aider if he is hurt

☐ **D)** Because the principal contractor controls the site, its first aider and room cover every trade, so the subcontractor and electrician carry no first-aid duty of their own once signed in

42. A permit to work covers replacing the motor on duty pump A

in a plant room, with its isolations listed. Once the motor is out, the fitter spots a leaking seal on neighbouring pump B and wants to strip it too, saying the same area and permit apply. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Strip pump B once the fitter has personally closed its isolation valves and drained it, as his competence makes a further permit unnecessary for such a closely related task

☐ **B)** Carry on, because the permit covers the plant room and the same crew, provided the fitter first notes pump B's seal fault on his daily task sheet for the supervisor

☐ **C)** Telephone the client's maintenance manager for a verbal go-ahead and begin, then have the permit amended at the end of the shift to record the extra work

☐ **D)** Stop the extra work, make the area safe and tell the permit issuer, who must check pump B's isolation and hazards and revalidate or reissue the permit first

43. A wheelchair-using inspector must check completed work on the third floor of a new building served by one passenger lift and two stairs. The visit cannot be moved downstairs. Which arrangement for a fire alarm is best?

☐ **A)** Have two fit site operatives carry her down the stairs in her chair, since the descent is only three floors and they can do it quickly

☐ **B)** Use the passenger lift when the alarm sounds, as it is the only accessible route and her escort can ride down with her to ground level and the assembly point

☐ **C)** Leave her in the stair refuge with an instruction to wait for the fire service, while her escort leaves with the others and reports to the assembly point

☐ **D)** Agree a plan beforehand: a trained escort, a route to a stair refuge with two-way communication, and a way to tell the person in charge where she is

44. Roofers set up a bitumen boiler on a flat roof 3 m from a plant-room air intake serving the occupied offices below. Fumes are drifting into the building. The foreman proposes handing out disposable dust masks. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Move the boiler well away from and downwind of the intake, agree with building management to close or shut it down during heating, and keep the temperature as low as workable

☐ **B)** Raise the boiler temperature so the bitumen is used quickly and the fumes pass sooner, which cuts the time that the office occupants are exposed to them

☐ **C)** Fit a taller flue to the boiler alone, because dispersing the fumes higher removes the risk to the offices without needing to move equipment or contact the building's managers

☐ **D)** Issue the masks to the roofers and ask the office staff to keep windows shut, since the fumes are a short-term nuisance and not a health hazard to the occupants

45. A scaffolder tells his supervisor he has had two panic attacks on the upper lifts, with shaking and dizziness. The supervisor says height is part of the trade and he should toughen up. What is the best way to handle this?

☐ **A)** Let him carry on at height because he is trained and holds a card, and ask a colleague to stay nearby in case he has another attack while he works on the lifts

☐ **B)** Treat it as a capability issue: talk to him, seek occupational health advice, and give him low-level work while the risk assessment is reviewed

☐ **C)** Remove him from the gang and the site, since anyone who has a panic attack at height is unfit for any scaffolding role and must be dismissed

☐ **D)** Leave the decision to him, because his health is private and the employer has no duty to consider it when deciding who works on the upper lifts

46. A groundworker with a valid CSCS card and a yellow Class 3 hi-vis jacket is told to walk the lineside of a live railway to collect a drum near the fence. His foreman says that is all the competence and PPE needed. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Orange hi-vis is the extra item required, because the colour marks him as a track worker and removes the need for separate track competence on short tasks

☐ **B)** A lookout watching for trains is enough on its own, since a trained lookout can make up for lacking track competence and a non-rail hi-vis jacket

☐ **C)** The CSCS card shows general construction competence and the yellow Class 3 jacket meets the visibility standard, so both are accepted for a short lineside task

☐ **D)** Lineside work needs rail-specific track safety competence, such as a Sentinel Personal Track Safety card, and orange rail hi-

vis, under controlled access



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the carpenter is wearing every item of PPE listed in the drilling task assessment. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** His eye protection is inadequate for bench drilling, so a full-face visor must replace the safety glasses even though the glasses have side shields

☐ **B)** The gloves and loose cuffs near the rotating bit can be caught and drag his hand in, so they should be taken off or secured despite being PPE

☐ **C)** A dust mask is missing, so respiratory protection is the main gap because drilling any timber creates dust above the workplace exposure limit

☐ **D)** The chuck guard is in place but should be removed so he can see the cutting point, since the clamped workpiece and gloves protect his hands

48. An electrician on guarded podium steps lifts out a ceiling tile and wants to put his head and shoulders into the void to trace a cable, resting a knee on the ceiling grid. Nobody has seen an asbestos survey for the void. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Keep off the grid and out of the void; first confirm asbestos information for it, then inspect from within the podium's guardrails using a torch and camera

☐ **B)** Swap the podium for a stepladder, which lets him climb higher and see further into the void without needing to rest any weight on the ceiling

☐ **C)** Proceed, since the podium's guardrails make the platform safe, provided he keeps most of his weight on the platform and touches the grid only lightly with his knee

☐ **D)** Ask a second person to hold the grid steady while he leans in, because shared support makes the grid adequate for the load of one knee

49. An electrician isolates the lighting circuit for a staircase in an occupied office and locks off the breaker, keeping the key. He starts to replace a failed fitting while staff are still using the now-dark stairwell. What has he missed?

☐ **A)** Nothing, because once the circuit is locked off and he holds the key the electrical risk is controlled, and the stairwell lighting is the building manager's problem alone

☐ **B)** A warning notice at the breaker and another at the foot of the stair should replace the lock, because notices tell staff and the key can stay in the cabinet

☐ **C)** He should have warned the occupants beforehand and arranged temporary lighting or closed the stair, and he still needs to prove the fitting dead at the point of work

☐ **D)** He should tell staff to use the lift instead and rely on the wall switch being off as proof that the fitting is dead, rather than testing it

50. A chain-lift skip lorry driver arrives for a large skip filled level with its sides with broken concrete and brick. It looks too heavy, but the contractor insists it is not overfilled and wants it gone quickly. What should the driver do?

☐ **A)** Lift it, because material level with the sides is not overfilled and the customer who hired the skip carries the legal responsibility for the weight of its contents

☐ **B)** Lift it a short distance to test it, then lower it and decide, since the vehicle's behaviour will show whether the chain lift is overloaded

☐ **C)** Decline to lift it if he judges it over the vehicle's weight limit, and ask for material to be removed, since a level skip of dense waste can be too heavy

☐ **D)** Net the load, drive carefully on minor roads to the tip, and let the weighbridge show whether it was overweight, since the tip will check it later

Answer Key

1. C — Employers must conduct their work so that non-employees are not exposed to risk, and ignored breaches show supervision failed, while employees also carry personal duties for their own acts.

A: Another employer's duties do not remove the dumper firm's separate duty to control its vehicles and the people it supervises. B: Deliberate disobedience does not end the employer's duty, particularly where managers knew of the behaviour and did nothing. D: The employer's duty extends to other people affected by its undertaking, and a written rule that is not enforced does not discharge it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a written rule and past training transfer all legal blame to the individual who breaks the rule.

2. A — The people doing the work know the shortcuts, awkward access and non-routine tasks, so involving them finds hazards that drawings and checklists miss.

B: Hazards must be identified and controlled before exposure begins, not discovered once people are already working. C: Signing a finished list is not involvement, and it leaves out the first-hand knowledge that would improve the assessment. D: Checklists and past accidents only reveal known or recorded hazards, and they ignore the practical knowledge of the workers.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a hazard walk-round as a desk or checklist exercise for managers rather than a conversation with the people who do the work.

3. D — Supporting the limb where it lies limits movement and further damage, and a serious injury needs paramedic care rather than improvised realignment or transport.

A: Trying to realign a deformed limb can damage nerves and vessels and should be left to trained clinicians. B: Weight-bearing tests can worsen the break, and some fractures still let casualties put weight on the leg for a moment. C: Moving him unsupported risks more injury, and a casualty in severe pain with a deformity needs ambulance care and a call for help.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that straightening, testing or moving a suspected fracture is helpful first aid rather than something that can cause further harm.

4. B — Where responsible persons share premises, even temporarily, they must co-operate and co-ordinate, so the crew must know what each signal means in this building.

A: Contractors have their own duty to co-operate and must brief their people in advance, as wardens may not be present or notice them. C: Waiting on a phone call during an alarm wastes time and replaces a planned strategy with improvisation. D: A contractor cannot override a building's fire strategy, and two conflicting routines could send people the wrong way.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a contractor's own site fire routine automatically replaces the evacuation arrangements of the building where the work takes place.

5. C — The noise regulations require risk to be eliminated or reduced at source as far as reasonably practicable, which includes choosing equipment that emits least noise, with hearing protection as a later measure.

A: Suppliers must give noise emission data and it should guide equipment choice before work begins, not be dismissed. B: Hearing protection is not a substitute for reducing noise at source, and attenuation in real use is less than the rating suggests. D: The duty to reduce noise risk as far as reasonably practicable applies below the upper action value too.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating hearing protection as the main noise control instead of first choosing quieter equipment and methods.

6. B — Handling assessment covers the task, load, individual and environment, and a planned route with an aid and clear co-ordination reduces strain and the chance of a drop or trapped fingers.

A: Rushing reduces control and ignores route checks, and changing ends mid-carry adds awkward handling. C: Walking backwards risks tripping, and unequal weight-sharing overloads one person and leaves the other poorly placed to react. D: Lifting a bulky sheet overhead blocks vision, strains the shoulders and back, and makes control through doorways harder.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that two people carrying a sheet automatically halves the risk without planning the route and agreeing how to move.

7. C — Taking away or guarding the access ladder stops unauthorised climbing, and clearing loose items removes things that could be moved or pulled down onto people.

A: Rope lashing is easily undone and signs alone are unlikely to deter children, so neither makes the rungs unusable. B: An inspection tag shows structural checks, not protection against unauthorised access

or loose materials. D: A ladder left on the first lift can still be reached or pulled down, so it should be removed or locked away rather than just moved.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that an inspected, tagged scaffold is secure out of hours when ladders and loose materials remain accessible.

8. B — Wrapping a lanyard round steel and connecting it back to itself can damage or overload the webbing at a sharp edge and may not hold as designed, so a suitable anchor connector is needed.

A: The lanyard has a visible energy absorber pack, so the problem lies in how it is connected, not in its type. C: The beam is about head height, so there is little slack and the fall distance is short, not excessive. D: The harness is shown correctly fitted with snug, untwisted straps, so this is not the weakness.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a fall-arrest set-up by whether a harness and lanyard are worn rather than by how the lanyard is actually connected to the anchor.

9. A — Lightning is a hazard to people near tall metal structures and cranes, so conditions are monitored, work is stopped by agreed triggers, plant is made safe and people go to proper shelter.

B: Strikes affect people on the ground nearby, and the operator should not stay exposed in a crane. C: Sheltering under metal scaffolding exposes people to a strike and to current in the ground. D: Lightning can strike miles ahead of the rain, so waiting for rain is too late.

COMMON MISTAKE: Waiting for rain or thunder overhead before stopping work near tall metal structures and cranes.

10. D — A signaller must use an agreed signalling system, stay visible to the driver and out of the vehicle's path, and the driver must stop immediately if he loses sight of the signaller.

A: Standing in a reversing vehicle's path is dangerous, and unagreed gestures can be misread by a driver who has not met the marshal. B: Standing between the lorry and a fixed obstruction creates a crush risk, and a raised hand may not be seen in time. C: Mirrors and a horn do not replace guidance in a tight space, and without agreed signals the driver has no direction.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a marshal's own gestures are enough for a driver who has not agreed the signals beforehand.

11. C — Section 2(3) of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974 requires the written policy to be revised as often as may be appropriate and any revision to be brought to the notice of all employees.

A: The Act sets no fixed interval and does not require HSE approval, only revision whenever it is appropriate. B: The Act places a continuing duty on the employer to revise the statement as often as appropriate, without waiting for the regulator. D: Any revision of the statement, not just the original, must be brought to the notice of all employees.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the safety policy as a document signed once and filed, rather than one that must change when the business and its risks change.

12. B — Compliance with working time rules alone does not manage fatigue, and the duty to control the risk applies regardless of a worker's willingness to work long hours.

A: A voluntary opt-out does not remove the employer's duty, and caffeine only masks drowsiness without removing the underlying fatigue. C: Fatigue impairs judgement and reaction time in any task, and tired workers also face risk on their way home. D: The employer can and must act on fatigue risk at any time, and no withdrawal notice is needed for it to do so.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a signed opt-out or willingness to do overtime means the employer has no further duty to control the effects of long hours.

13. C — Cutting off the moisture source, limiting disturbance of spores, using suitable RPE and checking on an already symptomatic worker together tackle both the cause and the exposure.

A: Dry scraping and sweeping throw spores into the air, and dead spores can still trigger allergic and asthmatic reactions. B: A basic mask may not suit the exposure, and sensitised or symptomatic workers should not be expected to just adapt. D: An active leak keeps the area damp and allows mould to regrow, so the moisture source must be dealt with first.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that killing mould with bleach makes it safe to disturb, when the spores and dust are what people breathe in.

14. C — A face visor shields the face but leaves gaps, so fragments can reach the eyes, and it is intended to be used over primary eye protection.

A: Water suppression reduces dust but does not remove it all, so suitable respiratory protection is still needed for this task. B: Plant and traffic operate alongside, and a bump cap gives no protection against falling or moving objects. D: Mesh visors are meant for

brushcutters and similar work and are no substitute for a solid visor with eye protection under it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Counting the number of items of PPE worn instead of checking that each one gives the level of protection the hazard needs.

15. A — Wet-weather clothing has to keep the wearer visible to drivers and still allow him to see and hear plant, so conspicuity and the hood design both matter.

B: A banksman cannot replace the worker's own ability to see and hear, and a dark garment still leaves him hard for drivers to spot. C: A hooded sweatshirt does not keep out rain and the hood still limits side vision and hearing, so the problem remains. D: A reflective strip may help drivers see him but does nothing to restore the vision and hearing he loses with the hood up.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging wet-weather clothing only on whether it keeps the wearer dry, ignoring its effect on being seen and on hearing plant.

16. C — HSE roof work guidance says the top anchorage should not depend on the ridge capping, and should instead use a purpose-made ridge hook or other secure means.

A: A roof ladder that is not anchored at the top can slide down the roof, and a ladder that simply rests on slates is not secure. B: On most sloping roofs a roof ladder or crawling board is needed in addition to edge protection, so that nobody works directly on the slates. D: Domestic gutters are not strong enough to support a roof ladder and must not be relied on as a footing or fixing.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that anything solid-looking at the ridge, such as the capping, is a safe anchor for a roof ladder.

17. C — Loose items raise the centre of gravity and can fall, pushing at height can tip the tower, and an unchecked route can hide hazards, so each step is needed.

A: Floor holes, level changes and overhead services must be checked before the tower moves, not after it has reached them. B: Equipment should be removed from every level before a tower is moved, because any load can shift or fall as the tower moves. D: Loose items can shift or fall and pushing high up makes the tower easier to overturn, whatever the toe boards do.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a tower move as a quick shuffle, when the load left aboard, the pushing point and the route all affect stability.

18. B — Drivers need to be trained, competent and authorised for the specific dumper, and a road licence says nothing about site plant competence.

A: Lawful driving on roads is not evidence of the training and competence needed for site dumpers, which have their own hazards. C: Dumpers handle very differently from road lorries, so a brief ride-along does not replace assessed training and familiarisation. D: The principal contractor still has to be satisfied about competence on its site, and a bare declaration is no evidence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a driving licence as proof of competence to operate site plant.

19. D — A single known signaller using standard signals removes confusion, and a rule to stop on any doubt stops the machine moving blind.

A: Competing signals from different people cause confusion, and judging signals by experience is no substitute for a clear system. B: Operators must stop when the signaller cannot be seen or understood, because carrying on blind is how people are hit. C: Shouted words are easily lost under engine noise, so they are unreliable as the main method.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that informal gestures between two people who know each other are as safe as an agreed signal system.

20. A — Best practicable means looks at the noise source, working methods and control measures, and liaison with the neighbour helps plan the noisiest work for the least sensitive times.

B: Waiting for complaints is reactive, and neighbours should be consulted and noise controlled before the work begins. C: Ear defenders protect only the wearer and do nothing to reduce the noise reaching the residents. D: Warning residents is helpful but does not reduce noise, and best practicable means requires controls at source as well.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that daytime working hours and PPE for the workforce are enough to protect neighbours from construction noise.

21. D — Risks from materials are controlled by assessing the delivery before it arrives, using the supplier's hazard information to plan unloading, segregation and storage rather than improvising at the kerb.

A: Reducing the quantity helps but does not remove the manual handling or the fire risk, and flammable adhesive should not be kept with other materials in a cabin. B: The site controls its own premises and must plan access, ground, storage and people, so it cannot hand this assessment to the haulier. C: A delivery note is not hazard information, and deciding on the spot leaves no time to arrange safe

unloading or storage.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that deliveries can be sorted out when they turn up, rather than assessing the materials before they are ordered or arrive.

22. A — A fire can weaken frames, props and floors and put out of action detectors and escape routes, so re-occupation needs a competent structural check and a revised fire risk assessment.

B: Hidden structural weakening is the main danger and must be checked before people return, not after. C: Handing back the area ends firefighting but does not confirm the structure is sound, and smoke, water and damaged fire systems affect floors beyond the burnt area. D: An insurer's approval is about cover and says nothing about whether the structure and fire precautions are safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that once the fire is out and the brigade has left, the area is safe to re-occupy.

23. D — Mercury gives off toxic vapour, especially when warm, so people should be removed, the room ventilated, and the beads collected by a trained person with the right kit rather than swept or vacuumed.

A: Mercury does evaporate to a toxic vapour, and sweeping breaks beads into smaller ones that run into cracks. B: An ordinary vacuum does not capture mercury and its warm exhaust can spread the vapour around the room. C: Washing mercury into drains pollutes the environment, and a dust mask gives no protection against mercury vapour.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a mercury spill like any other liquid spill that can be swept, mopped or hoovered away.

24. A — Sanitary waste disposal must be provided where women work, and a planned, hygienic emptying arrangement by a licensed carrier protects the cleaner and the drainage.

B: Sanitary waste does not normally need to be treated as clinical waste, and tying emptying to first-aiders is impractical. C: Flushing blocks the unit and exposes the cleaner to sewage, so the bin is a required control. D: Waste needs hygienic collection through a licensed carrier and the cleaner needs gloves and washing facilities.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a toilet cabin is adequate welfare without a way for women to dispose of sanitary waste hygienically.

25. B — The platform's rated load must not be exceeded and the edge should be protected whenever no load is being received, so loads are handled singly and the gate is opened only when needed.

A: Respecting the load limit does not protect people from the open edge between lifts, so the gate must be closed whenever it is not in use. C: A rope is not edge protection and cannot stop a person or a load from falling out of the opening. D: A harness does not make an overloaded platform safe and collective edge protection should not be removed for convenience.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the edge gate on a loading platform as an obstruction to be left open rather than as part of the edge protection.

26. D — Stilts raise the user and make him far more sensitive to trip hazards, so the floor must be kept clear of cables, offcuts and debris before he moves around.

A: No rule requires a harness for stilts, and the real danger is losing balance on the floor because of obstructions. B: The regulations do not ban stilts at any set height, and the key control is a clear, even floor for the user. C: Wet plaster does not make him lean away, whereas obstructions on the floor are a direct cause of falls.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that stilts are safe because the user is not far off the ground, and ignoring trip hazards on the floor.

27. D — Services and roots are exposed safely by hand or vacuum methods, the trench sides need proper support whatever the roots seem to do, and large structural roots should not be cut without specialist advice.

A: Roots do not reliably hold trench sides and mechanical digging risks hitting the gas main, while clay can still collapse suddenly. B: Services and structural roots can be deeper than 500 mm, so excavating mechanically beyond that depth risks striking them. C: Cutting large roots can destabilise the tree and ground, and a plan alone does not locate the main accurately.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that a mass of tree roots is holding the soil together and that a trench beside a tree can be left unsupported.

28. C — Cables must be assumed live until disconnected and proven safe at the point of work, and pot-ended cables must not be treated as abandoned, so the owner confirms and supervises.

A: A plan can be out of date, and hand tools and gloves give no dependable protection against the arc from an 11 kV cable. B: Confirmation must be in writing and the cable must be proven dead at the point of work, so a call is not enough. D: A detector on the outside of a sheathed cable cannot prove an HV cable dead, so this gives false reassurance.

COMMON MISTAKE: Taking a plan note or a sealed pot end as proof that a buried cable is dead.

29. A — The temporary dewatering position covers uncontaminated water only, so contaminated groundwater must be contained and discharged or removed with the proper permit or consent.

B: Dilution does not remove the contamination and the discharge would still be unpermitted pollution of the stream. C: Silt bags and settlement remove solids, not dissolved or emulsified hydrocarbons, and the discharge still lacks a permit. D: Discharge to a sewer needs the sewerage company's consent, and fuel contamination can damage the sewer and its treatment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that any water pumped out of a trench can go to a stream or drain once it has passed through a silt bag.

30. A — Storing flammable, polluting liquids secure, contained and away from ignition sources and drains limits both the fire risk and pollution from any spill, and small working quantities reduce exposure.

B: Loosened lids allow spills and rain contamination, and an unsecured, unbunded stack is open to tampering and pollution. C: A tarpaulin gives no containment or security, and storing flammable liquid beside a cabin heater creates a fire risk. D: Heating a store holding flammable vapour is an ignition risk, and a lock alone does not contain any spill.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking a container's lock or a distance from the drain is enough to store flammable chemicals safely.

31. D — Inspectors can require answers under section 20 of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act, and section 20(7) bars those answers being used in evidence against the person who gave them.

A: Section 20(7) prevents answers given under the requirement being used in evidence against him. B: The requirement applies to any person the inspector believes can give relevant information, employee or not. C: An inquest does not suspend or outrank the inspector's statutory powers to require answers.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that talking to an inspector is optional or that an inquest lets people hold back until it is over.

32. B — Civil liability rests on the common-law duty of care, and section 47 of the Act says its duties do not confer a right of action, so the claim does not depend on HSE enforcement.

A: Negligence still requires a breach of the duty of care that caused foreseeable loss, so fault must be shown. C: The Act also protects non-employees affected by the work, and the common-law duty of care extends to neighbours. D: Section 47 removes any civil right of action for breach of the Act's general duties, and civil claims do not need a prosecution.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that no enforcement action means no liability, or that civil claims depend on the HSE.

33. A — A suitable and sufficient assessment must cover foreseeable hazards that arise from conditions away from the site, and prevent exposure rather than rely on rescue.

B: A foreseeable flood hazard must be assessed and prevented in advance, not left to emergency response. C: Foreseeable conditions elsewhere in the catchment are part of the hazard and cannot be ignored for being off site. D: PPE is the last line of control and does not make a fast-moving surge in a tunnel survivable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging tunnel and culvert conditions from the weather at the entrance rather than from the whole catchment.

34. A — Wind makes exposed skin colder than the thermometer suggests, and damp insulation loses its value, so planning must cover shelter, breaks and dry clothing.

B: Drinks help but cannot protect exposed skin from freezing in strong wind. C: Air temperature ignores wind chill and the numb, white ears show that individual comfort is not a safe guide. D: Sweat-soaked insulation loses effect, and clothing alone does not replace shelter and warm-up breaks.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reading the thermometer as the true cold exposure and forgetting wind chill and sweat-damp clothing.

35. C — Wet cement needs a waterproof, chemical-resistant barrier, while the cold needs insulation underneath, and mix trapped inside a cuff keeps alkali against the skin.

A: Leather absorbs wet cement and holds alkali against the glove beneath, so it is a poor barrier. B: Thin nitrile gives no insulation, so cold hands lose grip and dexterity and risk cold injury. D: Cold rating is not chemical protection, and fleece soaks up wet cement and holds it against the skin.

COMMON MISTAKE: Picking one glove for the most obvious hazard and forgetting that cold and wet cement need different protection.

36. B — Wind ratings are based on a set surface area, and a banner acts as a sail that adds wind load far beyond what its weight suggests.

A: Wind limits apply to every MEWP use, and traffic management

does not address overturning. C: The rating depends on the exposed area allowed for, which a large banner exceeds. D: A light but wide sheet can create big wind forces, so weight alone does not govern stability.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the plated wind speed as a fixed limit and forgetting that sheets and banners add sail area.

37. C — Locator depth indications can be wrong, especially where other buried metal re-radiates signals, so services are positively identified by hand-dug trial holes.

A: Plastic pipes are not detected at all, and readings on traced metallic lines can still be distorted. B: A repeated reading only repeats the same limitation and is not positive identification. D: No margin makes a depth reading reliable, because the service must be physically exposed and confirmed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Taking the locator's depth display as a measured fact rather than an estimate.

38. B — Dumper skips are not designed to carry people, and riders risk being thrown out or crushed whatever PPE they wear or how short the journey is.

A: The beacon is lit in the picture, so this is not the hazard. C: The picture shows the driver's belt fastened, so this is not the problem. D: The skip is fully lowered in the picture, so this is not the hazard.

COMMON MISTAKE: Letting people ride on plant because the trip is short and they are wearing PPE.

39. A — Driver entitlement, the trailer's braking and the tow vehicle's rated limit are separate checks, and the combination must pass every one of them.

B: Fuel and air are far less than the 400 kg excess, and the trailer is already weighed at 2,400 kg. C: Brakes help stopping but do not raise the tow vehicle's rated limit, and low speed does not cure overloading. D: The manufacturer's towing limit is a firm rating covering the vehicle's braking, hitch and stability.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a valid driving licence as proof that any combination of vehicle and trailer is acceptable.

40. D — Preservative-treated wood is not clean fuel; burning releases its chemicals into the smoke, and it should be segregated as waste and removed by a registered carrier.

A: Metal-based preservatives are not destroyed by burning and pass into the smoke and ash. B: No blanket exemption applies, because burning waste is controlled wherever it was produced. C: Appliance approval applies to the fuels it is designed for, and treated waste timber is not one of them.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating offcuts of treated wood as free fuel rather than as waste needing proper disposal.

41. B — Joint first-aid arrangements are encouraged, but each employer keeps its own legal duty and a self-employed person must have equipment to treat himself, so the shared arrangement should be confirmed in writing.

A: Sharing first-aid provision by agreement is permitted and often sensible, so a ban on relying on another firm is wrong. C: Self-employed workers must provide their own adequate first-aid equipment and cannot assume another firm's arrangements cover them. D: Duties under the First-Aid Regulations stay with each employer and each self-employed person, and are not transferred by signing in.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that working on someone else's site means their first-aid arrangements automatically cover your own people without checking or agreeing it.

42. D — A change in the nature or scope of the work means work stops until the issuing authority has assessed it and revalidated or issued a permit, because the existing isolations were not set up for pump B.

A: Competence does not replace the permit system, and the issuer has not verified isolation or checked interactions with pump A. B: A permit covers the specific work and isolations it lists, not a whole room, so recording the fault does not authorise new work. C: Work must not start on an informal approval; the permit has to be revalidated or reissued before the new work, not after it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a permit as general approval for a location and crew, so that a related job nearby can be added without going back to the issuer.

43. D — Advance planning with the person, a trained escort, a refuge with communication and passing her location to the person in charge, who informs the fire service, is the approach recommended in fire safety guidance.

A: Carrying down is only acceptable with a risk assessment and proper training, and untrained lifting risks injury to her and to them. B: Ordinary lifts are taken over by the fire service and must not be used in a fire unless designed as evacuation lifts. C: A person should not be left alone in a refuge to wait for the fire service, and the plan must not depend on rescue arriving.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that the standard alarm and assembly point cover everyone, and that colleagues can improvise a carry-down when the alarm sounds.

44. A — Fumes are best controlled at source by siting,

downwind positioning and the lowest workable temperature, with building management protecting occupants, who masks for the roofers would not protect.

B: Higher temperatures increase fume emission and fire and burn risk, so they worsen exposure rather than reducing it. C: Raising the discharge does not guarantee fumes stay clear of intakes, and the building's occupants and managers still need to be involved. D: Fume from heated bitumen is an irritant hazard, and paper dust masks give poor protection while doing nothing for people in the building.

COMMON MISTAKE: Reaching for respirators or masks for the workers first, instead of moving the source and protecting other people who share the building.

45. B — Employers must take account of employees' capabilities as regards health and safety when allocating tasks, so a worker reporting panic at height needs support, advice and interim safe work.

A: Training does not remove the risk of a panic attack at height, and a colleague nearby cannot prevent a fall. C: Fitness depends on assessment and advice, not a blanket judgement, and low-level work may remain suitable. D: Regulation 13 requires employers to consider capabilities when entrusting tasks, so the employer cannot ignore health information it has been given.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating anxiety or panic at height as a matter of toughness instead of a health and safety capability issue that the employer must assess.

46. D — Network Rail lineside access requires track-specific competence and orange hi-vis, which is not interchangeable with a general construction card and a yellow jacket.

A: Colour alone does not give competence; the worker must also be trained and registered for track safety. B: A lookout is one control within a track safety system and does not substitute for competence or the correct clothing. C: General construction credentials do not cover track hazards such as trains and traction power, and orange is used to identify track workers.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing a CSCS card and any Class 3 hi-vis jacket are enough for every construction environment, including the railway.

47. B — Gloves and loose sleeves near a rotating spindle can wind onto the bit and drag the hand in, so the PPE itself creates an entanglement hazard that outweighs any protection from handling.

A: Side-shielded safety glasses are suitable for drilling timber, and a visor would not address the entanglement risk. C: A few drilled holes produce little dust, and respiratory protection would not remove the more serious risk of entanglement. D: Guards must stay in place, and gloves do not protect hands from rotating parts, which is the very hazard they add.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that more PPE is always safer, when gloves and loose cuffs near rotating machinery can themselves pull the hand in.

48. A — A suspended ceiling grid is not designed to carry a person, leaning out of the guarded platform defeats its protection, and the void must be checked for asbestos information before it is disturbed.

B: A stepladder is less suitable for a long task, still leaves the void entry and asbestos question unresolved, and adds a fall risk. C: Guardrails protect only while he stays inside them, and a ceiling grid is not designed to support any body weight. D: A colleague holding the grid cannot make it a safe working platform, and the asbestos question is ignored.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a guarded podium makes any posture safe, including leaning or kneeling beyond its rails into a ceiling void.

49. C — Safe isolation requires notifying those affected by the loss of supply and controlling the new hazard it creates, while locking off and then proving the fitting dead before touching conductors.

A: Isolation creates a new hazard for occupants that the person isolating must warn about and help control, beyond the electrical lock-off. B: Notices are easily missed and are not a substitute for keeping the isolation under the control of the person working. D: A wall switch off does not prove the fitting is dead, and sending people to a lift does not address safe lighting for the stair.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking safe isolation is only about protecting the electrician, and forgetting the people who lose lighting or other services when the circuit goes off.

50. C — Weight, not volume, decides whether a skip can be lifted and carried, so a driver should check the load is not overweight and refuse to lift it when the pick-up seems unsafe.

A: The driver and operator must not lift or carry an overweight load, whoever filled the skip and however level it looks. B: A trial lift loads the chains and vehicle beyond their limits and risks failure with people close by. D: Driving an overweight vehicle is unlawful and unsafe, and a weighbridge check afterwards does not make the lift or journey safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging whether a skip can be lifted by how full it looks instead of how heavy the contents are.

PRACTICE TEST 20

50 QUESTIONS

Answer all questions. Each question has one correct answer. Tick the box next to your choice.

1. A firm replaces its disc cutters with new battery saws that have a different guard and kickback behaviour. The manager says experienced operators need no retraining and offers an optional toolbox talk on Saturday morning, unpaid. What does the law require?

☐ **A)** Training may be held outside working hours if operators agree in writing, since a signed agreement passes the time and cost of it to the worker

☐ **B)** Training is a legal requirement only on recruitment, so experienced staff may join a voluntary session outside their normal hours if they choose to

☐ **C)** Experience on cutters is presumed to cover any similar tool, so handing out the manufacturer's written instructions is enough to meet the employer's duty

☐ **D)** Operators must be trained on the new saws' risks before they use them, repeated where appropriate, and the training must take place during working hours

2. To take operatives away from a noisy, dusty breaking-out task, a firm swaps hand breakers for a remote-controlled demolition machine. The assessor marks the job low risk because nobody now stands at the work face. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A new assessment is needed only for the noise and dust, since the machine's electronic controls mean its movement hazards are already covered by the manufacturer

☐ **B)** The original assessment still stands, because moving people away from the work face removes the hazard and a fresh one is needed only if someone is hurt

☐ **C)** The change needs reassessing before work starts, as it brings new hazards such as the operator's view, the machine's reach and flying debris

☐ **D)** Reassessment is required but can wait until the machine has run for a week, as observed working conditions give a more reliable picture than predictions

3. A groundworker who uses breakers and vibrating plates every day gives his employer a doctor's letter diagnosing hand-arm vibration syndrome. The manager says RIDDOR covers only accident injuries and files the letter. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** The worker must report it to the HSE himself, since a diagnosis letter is his own medical information and the employer has no part in reporting it

☐ **B)** RIDDOR covers only sudden injuries, so a gradual condition belongs in the health record and becomes reportable only if he later loses more than seven days

☐ **C)** The employer must report the disease to the HSE, because it is reportable where the work regularly involves vibrating tools and a doctor has diagnosed it

☐ **D)** Reporting is required only if the doctor ties the condition in writing to one named incident, because years of general tool use cannot be linked to work

4. A bracket falls 5 m and strikes a labourer on his helmet. He says he is fine and goes back to work. An hour later he vomits and seems confused and drowsy. What should the supervisor do, and why?

☐ **A)** Send him home in a colleague's car with advice to see a doctor if symptoms last until the next morning, to save waiting

☐ **B)** Call 999, keep him still and watched, and record the accident, as a delayed head injury can turn life-threatening

☐ **C)** Give him a sweet drink and a painkiller, then move him back to light duties where the supervisor can see him

☐ **D)** Let him rest in the welfare cabin for the afternoon, because he walked away unaided and the helmet absorbed the impact safely

5. Four labourers will barrow wet concrete 60 m along a rutted, sloping plank route to a footing, about 200 loads in a day. The foreman says barrows are cheap and the lads are fit. Which approach best follows the manual handling regulations?

☐ **A)** Pick the four strongest workers after assessing their fitness, since individual capability is the main factor and the

route and load matter much less

☐ **B)** Allow a rest break each hour and rotate the barrow users, since a task is acceptable under the regulations when the time spent on it is limited

☐ **C)** Avoid the manual movement if reasonably practicable with a dumper or pump, otherwise assess the task and route and reduce the load, distance and slope

☐ **D)** Issue back support belts and lifting technique training, as these two measures keep a barrow task within the regulations without altering the route

6. Groundworkers wash oily hands and scrub concrete off tools using diesel from the site bowser, and one rinses his boots with petrol before lunch in a cabin where a heater is running. Which statement best identifies the problems?

☐ **A)** Fuels strip skin oils and can cause dermatitis, and petrol vapour near a heater can ignite, so provide a skin cleanser and a safer tool-cleaning method

☐ **B)** Wearing disposable gloves removes the hazard, so fuel can remain the cleaning method provided the cabin heater is switched off while it is used

☐ **C)** Washing with fuel is acceptable if followed by soap and water, since the main risk is swallowing it, which hand washing before lunch controls

☐ **D)** Diesel is harmless to skin because it is oily, but petrol vapour is a fire risk, so petrol should be banned and diesel allowed for cleaning

7. An electrician must fit a rain cowl on the flat roof of a 1.8 m high electrical kiosk, standing on the roof beside an open edge above a paved yard. The supervisor says the Work at Height Regulations apply only above 2 m, so a stepladder and care will do. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** There is no minimum height, so avoid the roof work if possible, for example with a long-handled tool, or use a guarded platform before personal protection

☐ **B)** Work under 2 m falls under the general duty only, so a risk assessment is enough and the electrician may choose equipment by his own judgement

☐ **C)** The 2 m figure applies, but a harness and short lanyard should be used because personal protection is the accepted standard at any height near an edge

☐ **D)** The regulations apply, but only where the surface below is hard, so the paved yard makes it a controlled task needing a colleague to foot the ladder



8. Look at the scene. The decorator says the set-up is wide and steady and that he will be up there for only an hour. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** The stepladders are the wrong height for the room, so taller ones fitted with a locked spreader would give the board a more secure rest

☐ **B)** The board is too thick for the span, so a thinner one would flex less and share the load more evenly between the two stepladders beneath it

☐ **C)** He is not wearing a harness, which is the main protection needed on any raised platform, and a lanyard clipped to a stepladder would solve it

☐ **D)** Stepladders are not designed to carry a board as a working platform, so the board can slip or twist and the legs can spread under sideways load

9. Aggregate has bridged in the outlet of a 4 m deep storage hopper at a batching plant. A fitter proposes climbing in through the top hatch on a rope to break the arch with a bar while the feed is stopped and a colleague watches. What is the best advice?

☐ **A)** Treat it as a confined space and do not enter, as the arch can collapse and engulf him, but clear it from outside with rodding or a vibrator

☐ **B)** It is not a confined space because the top hatch is open to the air, so a work-at-height assessment and a gas test cover the hazards

☐ **C)** Entering is acceptable because the feed is stopped, provided he wears a harness and the watcher can haul him out if the material moves

☐ **D)** Entry is acceptable under a permit once the hopper is half emptied, because a lower material level removes the engulfment risk for the fitter

10. A dumper driver regularly takes calls from the office while driving between the stockpile and the compound, using a hands-free earpiece. The foreman says that is fine because both hands stay on the controls. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A ban is unnecessary since the dumper has a camera and alarm, and these aids will warn pedestrians even when his attention is on the call

☐ **B)** Hands-free calls are acceptable on private ground, since phone restrictions apply only on public roads and each driver can judge when it is safe to talk

☐ **C)** Only handheld use needs controlling, so hands-free calls can continue if the driver slows to walking pace and keeps each call under two minutes

☐ **D)** Calls distract plant drivers even hands-free, so the assessment should ban phone use while plant moves and give a safe way to pass urgent messages

11. A labourer lifts two sections of pedestrian barrier away from a deep excavation so he can wheel a barrow through, then leaves them down. Nobody is hurt. The manager says no offence arose because there was no injury. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** It is an offence only if he was warned in writing not to move the barrier, because intent cannot be shown without a signed instruction from his supervisor

☐ **B)** Reckless or intentional interference with a safety provision is an offence under HSWA section 8 even without injury, and the manager should ask why the route was blocked

☐ **C)** Only the employer can be prosecuted, because workers have no personal legal duty over barriers and are covered entirely by the employer's general duty to provide safe arrangements

☐ **D)** The labourer commits an offence only if someone is later hurt, because section 8 depends on actual harm, so the manager should log a near miss and take no further action

12. A rotating laser level, marked Class 3R, is set on a tripod in a corridor where other trades walk, with its beam sweeping at head height. The operator says it is only a weak red line. What is the best way to control the eye risk?

☐ **A)** Set the beam well above or below head height or screen it, warn other trades, and switch it off when unattended, since the blink reflex is no dependable defence

☐ **B)** Keep the laser running all day for stability and put one warning sign at each end of the corridor, since a sign alone gives passers-by complete protection

☐ **C)** Issue ordinary impact-rated safety glasses to everyone using the corridor, because standard eyewear filters laser light of this power and so removes any need to move the beam

☐ **D)** Leave the beam at head height and rely on the blink reflex, since visible red light of this class always makes anyone look away before any harm occurs

13. A specialist firm will radiograph pipe welds in a plant room on Friday evening. The site manager says the radiographer will look after everything, so other trades need not be told. Which approach is correct?

☐ **A)** Let other trades pass through while the work continues, as radiation harms only those who stand directly in front of the equipment while an exposure is under way

☐ **B)** Give the contractor advance written notice and agree access control, so trades are told of the controlled area and kept out until the source is confirmed secured

☐ **C)** Let other trades carry on behind the plant room wall, since any wall absorbs the radiation and access control is needed only inside the room where the work happens

☐ **D)** Tell only the night security guard, since the radiographer's lead apron also protects any other worker who happens to wander into the area during a short exposure



14. Look at the scene. The foreman says the painter is fully protected because he wears a respirator, goggles, coveralls and

gloves. What is the most significant problem, and what should be done?

☐ **A)** His gloves are the wrong type, and thick chemical-resistant gauntlets would stop paint penetrating at spray pressure, so he could then clean the tip safely while it is live

☐ **B)** His coveralls are inadequate, since liquid-tight Type 3 suits are needed for paint contact with skin, and that is the main route of harm from airless spraying

☐ **C)** His respirator is inadequate, because airless spraying of any coating requires an air-fed hood, and that is the main hazard to put right before any other change

☐ **D)** He is wiping the tip of a gun still under pressure, and gloves cannot stop paint injecting through skin, so release the pressure and lock the trigger first

15. A fixer handling sharp-edged metal studs finds a split across the palm of his issued gloves. The stores are closed. His supervisor suggests wrapping tape round the split and carrying on until morning. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Stop using them and report the defect at once, because the employer must keep PPE in good repair and replace it, and tape cannot restore protection

☐ **B)** Carry on at his own risk, because once PPE is issued the wearer alone decides whether it is still good enough and the employer has no further duty

☐ **C)** Carry on with the taped gloves, because tape restores the cut resistance of the palm and the repair only needs reporting at the next weekly PPE check

☐ **D)** Buy a pair from a shop and wear them, because the employer's duty to replace PPE ends once the original pair has been used for a full shift

16. A scaffolder's competent person inspects a facade scaffold each week and hangs a fresh tag, but keeps the written reports at the scaffolder's yard. The principal contractor holds no copies. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Reports are needed only for a monthly check, since the weekly inspections need nothing more than a verbal confirmation to the principal contractor on the day concerned

☐ **B)** For a platform with a possible fall of 2 m or more, the report must reach the person it was done for within 24 hours and stay on site until work ends

☐ **C)** The tag is the legal record of the inspection, so a separate written report is optional provided the tag carries the date, the inspector's initials and the lift covered

☐ **D)** The reports may stay at the scaffolder's yard indefinitely, because only the firm that carried out the inspection has any duty to hold the records of its own checks

17. A steel fixer works 7 m up a portal-frame column, held by a waist belt and an adjustable positioning lanyard looped round the column so both hands are free to bolt. Nothing else is fitted. The supervisor says a taut lanyard means he cannot fall. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A second positioning lanyard looped round the same column counts as the required back-up, since it would give him identical protection should the first lanyard slip

☐ **B)** The belt and lanyard are enough alone, because a taut lanyard stops any fall and a back-up is needed only for rope work carried out above ten metres high

☐ **C)** A work positioning system may be used only with a suitable back-up that prevents or arrests a fall, such as a separate fall-arrest line to a harness

☐ **D)** Replacing the belt with a full-body harness allows the lanyard to serve as the only system, since a harness spreads load and removes the need for a back-up

18. A concrete pump's placing hose blocks during a slab pour. The operator wants to knock off a coupling clamp to clear the plug quickly, while the hose-end man stays at the discharge to keep the pour going. What is the safest course?

☐ **A)** Knock off the clamp straight away but stand to one side of the coupling, because any pressure escapes only in a straight line along the hose itself

☐ **B)** Stop pumping and release pressure as the maker requires, keep everyone clear of the hose line, and open the coupling only when pressure is confirmed off

☐ **C)** Keep the hose-end man at the discharge holding the hose firmly, because a hose held tightly by hand cannot whip when the clamp is finally released

☐ **D)** Strike the blocked section with a lump hammer while pumping continues slowly, so the pour is not delayed while the

plug is shaken loose from outside

19. Overnight, a steel road plate was laid over a trench across a street used by buses and delivery lorries. By morning it has shifted a few centimetres, leaving a gap at one edge. The supervisor wants to cone the gap and leave it for the day. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Allow only cars and vans across until the end of the shift, since lighter vehicles cannot move a plate and a small gap is a minor fault

☐ **B)** Leave it in place and cone the gap, since a plate that has carried traffic overnight has proved it is strong enough for the rest of the day

☐ **C)** Lay a second plate over the first to cover the gap, because doubling the steel thickness removes any need to secure either plate against movement later

☐ **D)** Stop vehicles using it, then re-fix the plate secured against movement and ramped at the edges, and confirm it is rated for the heaviest traffic expected

20. A site has stripped 400 kg of old copper cable. A man in a van offers cash on the spot, saying he is in the scrap trade and will take it with no paperwork because it has resale value. Which approach correctly follows waste and scrap rules?

☐ **A)** Hand it over without paperwork, because material with a resale value counts as a product rather than as waste, so no transfer records are needed at all

☐ **B)** Hand it only to a registered waste carrier with the right dealer or collector licence, keep written transfer records, and take payment by cheque or transfer

☐ **C)** Accept the cash after noting his van registration, because that note satisfies the duty of care for waste and cash payment is allowed for small loads

☐ **D)** Sell it for cash if the value is under a set limit, since the waste and payment rules apply only to larger loads of scrap metal from site

21. Plasterers must carry 20 kg tubs of adhesive up to a second-floor flat. The assessment specifies a sack trolley, but the stair doorway is too narrow, so the gang carries tubs by hand. The manager wants to discipline them. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Discipline the gang for ignoring the written control, because a documented assessment sets the standard that workers must follow as written

☐ **B)** Let the gang choose how to carry the tubs, since experienced workers' judgement can replace a control that does not suit the building

☐ **C)** Review the assessment with the gang, adopt a control that suits the real layout such as a hoist, then brief everyone

☐ **D)** Keep the trolley requirement and repeat it at the next briefing, because the assessment is sound and only compliance has failed

22. A fitter wipes a hydraulic hose on a tracked excavator with his gloved hand and feels a sting. There is a tiny pinhole in his fingertip, with little pain and no bleeding. He wants to finish the shift. What should happen?

☐ **A)** Clean and plaster the puncture, then watch it for a day, as a small painless wound with no bleeding is unlikely to be deep

☐ **B)** Squeeze the finger to push the oil back out and wash it with soap, because removing the fluid quickly stops it spreading

☐ **C)** He should go to hospital urgently and tell staff it may be a high-pressure injection, as deep damage can hide beneath a small mark

☐ **D)** Record it in the accident book and see his GP if swelling appears, since hospital treatment is for wounds that bleed or hurt badly

23. A supplier delivers sealed, unlabelled crates of ducting fittings to a first-floor job. Their weights vary widely and some are heavier at one end. Two fitters must carry them up a stair, and the manager says to tell them to lift carefully. What is best?

☐ **A)** Set a single weight limit for one person on every crate, because a fixed figure removes any need to know each load's weight

☐ **B)** Tell them to tilt each crate to feel its weight before lifting, since judging the load on the day replaces a formal assessment

☐ **C)** Issue back support belts for the job, as supports reduce the strain enough to let unmarked crates be carried by hand

☐ **D)** Weigh each crate and mark its weight and heavy end, assess the carry, and use a hoist or team lift for heavy ones

24. A slinger-signaller with Type 1 diabetes, who skipped breakfast, becomes sweaty, shaky and muddled by mid-morning.

A colleague says he must be drunk and should be left to sleep it off. What is the right action?

☐ **A)** Keep him signalling but pair him with a second signaller, because he is conscious and his colleague can cover any errors he makes

☐ **B)** Give no sugar until a breath test rules out alcohol, since sweet drinks could mask the real cause of his confusion

☐ **C)** Take him off the lifting task, give a fast-acting sugary drink if he is conscious, and keep him supervised until he recovers

☐ **D)** Let him rest in the cabin for an hour with nothing to eat or drink, because the confusion will pass once he is calm

25. A six-storey facade scaffold runs along a busy public pavement while bricklayers work on its upper lifts. The planner proposes only a hanging debris net and cones along the kerb. Which arrangement best protects pedestrians below?

☐ **A)** Barriers set one metre out from the scaffold base, because falling objects drop straight down and cannot travel beyond that line

☐ **B)** Debris netting on the outer face, plus a banksman who stops pedestrians whenever a bricklayer shouts that material is moving

☐ **C)** A thin plywood canopy at first-floor level, since any overhead cover is enough once netting has been fitted above it

☐ **D)** A lit, covered walkway with a deck strong enough to stop falling objects, plus brick guards and toe boards on the working lifts



26. Look at the scene. The roofer says the ladder is tied, set at a safe angle and standing on firm paving. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** Nobody is footing the base of the ladder, so it could slip sideways while he climbs towards the roof edge

☐ **B)** The ladder stands on paving without a purpose-made stabiliser, so its feet could skid outwards under his weight

☐ **C)** He is not clipped to the ladder with a harness, which is mandatory for every ladder climb to a flat roof

☐ **D)** The ladder stiles stop level with the roof edge, so he has no handhold while stepping across onto the roof

27. Digging a drainage trench in a former wartime dock area, an excavator bucket uncovers a rusty, finned metal cylinder about a metre long. The operator wants to lift it out and set it aside until the engineer arrives. What is correct?

☐ **A)** Tap it with a spade to hear whether it rings hollow, since an empty casing is harmless scrap that can go in a skip

☐ **B)** Photograph it, keep digging at the far end of the site, and ask the client to arrange a survey by the end of the week

☐ **C)** Stop work, leave it untouched, move everyone well back and alert the police, treating it as live until experts say otherwise

☐ **D)** Lift it carefully clear of the trench and cordon off the pile, because a slow, smooth lift is safer than leaving it beside an unstable trench wall

28. While trenching, an excavator bucket cuts into an unmarked buried cable, with a flash and bang. The operator is unhurt in the cab, and the cable may still be live. A banksman shouts for him to climb out. What is the best action?

☐ **A)** Reverse the bucket out of the cable at once to free it, then lower the bucket and check the damage on foot

☐ **B)** Stay in the cab, keep the machine still, warn others to keep clear and call the network operator at once

☐ **C)** Climb down quickly and run to the banksman, so that he can check for burns while the machine stays where it stopped

☐ **D)** Wait a few minutes to see if the flash dies away, then cover the cable with soil and carry on with the trench

29. A strip-out crew will remove ten split air-conditioning units from an office. The foreman plans to cut the copper pipework with a disc cutter to save time, then scrap the units, saying the gas inside will soon disperse. What is correct?

☐ **A)** A suitably certified engineer must recover the refrigerant before removal, since releasing it harms the climate and cutting charged pipework is hazardous

☐ **B)** Remove the units as they are and let the carrier deal with

the gas later, since a signed transfer note passes on all responsibility

☐ **C)** Cut the pipes outdoors in the open air, because the gas then disperses harmlessly and release in the open is permitted

☐ **D)** Cap each pipe after cutting and send the units for scrap, since the small amount of gas in each unit falls below any legal limit

30. A contractor will pressure-wash flaking old paint, possibly lead-based, and algae from a brick facade beside a road. The run-off would flow along the kerb to a surface-water drain, and the foreman suggests a gully sock to catch the solids. What is better?

☐ **A)** Keep the gully sock and add a spill kit beside the drain, since a sock removes dissolved paint residues as well as solids

☐ **B)** Add a biodegradable detergent to the wash water, because water treated with it is safe for the surface-water drain

☐ **C)** Wash only on dry, warm days so the run-off evaporates, because the water will dry before it can reach the gully

☐ **D)** Collect the run-off with bunds and a vacuum, settle or filter it, and dispose of it with the sewerage undertaker's consent or as waste

31. A labourer notices that the barrier line separating his work bay from the plant route has been dragged aside by delivery drivers for two days. He tells nobody, reasoning that supervisors walk the site daily and reporting is their job. Which statement about his legal position is most accurate?

☐ **A)** He has done enough by mentioning it informally to a workmate, because that shows reasonable care and passes responsibility up the chain of command

☐ **B)** His reporting duty covers only injuries and near misses, so a moved barrier remains a management matter until someone has actually been hurt or nearly struck

☐ **C)** Only supervisors and managers carry a duty to monitor protection arrangements, so a worker with no safety role cannot be in breach by staying quiet

☐ **D)** He must tell his employer or a nominated person about a shortcoming in the protection arrangements affecting his work, so staying silent is itself a breach

32. A joiner who has heated a two-part epoxy adhesive daily for months gives his employer a doctor's written diagnosis of occupational asthma. The manager calls it a private medical matter, does not report it, and changes nothing for the five other joiners. What is the correct response?

☐ **A)** Wait until the HSE confirms the cause of the illness, because a doctor's written diagnosis alone cannot show that his work was responsible for it

☐ **B)** Report it under RIDDOR as a diagnosed disease, then review the COSHH controls and consider health surveillance for colleagues with the same exposure

☐ **C)** No report is needed unless he is off work for more than seven days, because a reportable occupational disease follows the same threshold as a workplace injury

☐ **D)** Log it in the accident book only, because RIDDOR disease reports are made by the treating doctor and the employer has no part in the reporting process

33. A risk assessment for lining a tank records 84 dB(A) from a nearby compressor, controlled by ear defenders, and separately rates a toluene-based coating as low risk because vapour levels are modest. The assessor treats the two hazards independently. What should the assessment have considered?

☐ **A)** Nothing further, because each hazard has its own limit and meeting both separately guarantees that their combined effect on hearing is also acceptable to the employer

☐ **B)** The ear defenders, which remove the extra risk entirely because attenuating the noise cancels any added hearing effect of the vapour that is being inhaled

☐ **C)** Whether the two interact, since solvents such as toluene can add to noise-induced hearing damage, so the combined effect may need tighter controls or earlier checks

☐ **D)** Only the noise, because solvent vapour harms the lungs and skin and has no bearing on hearing, so any interaction belongs in the COSHH file and nowhere else

34. In a closed basement, a crew uses a petrol-driven disc cutter, with a fan blowing air across the doorway. One worker develops a headache and feels dizzy, and a colleague says it is just the dust. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Rotate the crew every thirty minutes to limit individual exposure and keep the cutter running to finish the job on time

☐ **B)** Open a second doorway and carry on, since the symptoms

show the worker is unfit and the others have no sign of any effect

☐ **C)** Treat it as dust irritation and fit tighter dust masks, as masks also filter engine fumes and will protect the whole crew

☐ **D)** Suspect carbon monoxide, stop work, move everyone into fresh air, then switch to a battery or electric tool

35. A worker grinding a concrete floor wears a battery-powered respirator with a loose-fitting hood. Twenty minutes in, its low-airflow alarm sounds. A colleague says the fan means he can carry on until the shift ends. What is the correct action?

☐ **A)** Keep working but use shorter grinding passes, because the alarm shows only reduced filter efficiency and less time at the floor lowers the dose he receives

☐ **B)** Carry on while the hood still feels inflated, because the fan keeps positive pressure inside and any leakage then flows outwards rather than inwards

☐ **C)** Leave the dusty area at once and check the battery, filter and hose, because the alarm means airflow has dropped below the safe minimum

☐ **D)** Silence the alarm and continue, since a warning that clears after a few seconds only reflects a brief dip in battery voltage and not a loss of airflow

36. Scaffolders erecting a facade scaffold clip double lanyards to ledgers as they work and fit each lift's guardrails only after its boards are laid. The supervisor says the harnesses make this acceptable. What does the work at height hierarchy require them to consider first?

☐ **A)** A suspension rescue plan on its own, because planning for rescue is what the regulations treat as the effective control for people working at an open edge

☐ **B)** Collective protection that goes up before the people, such as advance guardrails or temporary platforms, with harnesses only where that is impossible

☐ **C)** Nothing more, because trained scaffolders with double lanyards are safer than guardrails, which crews tend to knock or interfere with while they are erecting

☐ **D)** A stricter inspection regime, since regular checks by a competent person are the main legal safeguard for the erectors while the scaffold is being built

37. Mains power fails at an occupied shop where fitters are working. To restore lighting, a labourer plugs a portable generator into a wall socket using a lead with a plug at each end, leaving the main switch on. Which statement correctly describes the danger and the proper arrangement?

☐ **A)** It is safe once the main switch is turned off, because the building is then cut off from the supply and the generator behaves like any other source of power

☐ **B)** The lead can leave live pins exposed and back-feed the supply, so fixed wiring may be connected only through a changeover switch fitted by a competent electrician

☐ **C)** It is acceptable if the generator is rated below the socket circuit's fuse, because the circuit then cannot be overloaded and the lead is just another extension

☐ **D)** The only risk is damage to the generator from mains voltage, since the socket's RCD already protects everyone else working on the premises from any shock



38. Look at the scene. The driver says it is only a two-minute run to the stockpile and the track is level and dry. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** People ride on a machine built only for the driver, so a bump or braking could throw them off or under the wheels

☐ **B)** The skip should be raised slightly while travelling, so that the driver has a clearer view of the track surface ahead of him

☐ **C)** The pallet of kerbs on the verge is too close to the track, so vibration from the passing dumper could bring the whole stack down

☐ **D)** No banksman is walking ahead of the machine, so the driver cannot be guided along what is a straight and otherwise clear stretch of track

39. Two mobile cranes will share a lift of a 14-tonne steel truss.

Each operator has checked that his own crane's chart covers the whole load, so the foreman proposes that each follows his own signaller and works at his own pace. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A tandem lift is a complex lift needing a written plan from a competent person, with load shares for both cranes and coordinated control

☐ **B)** The foreman's approach is fine, since each crane could carry the full load alone, so the lift stays safe even if one crane takes all the weight

☐ **C)** The two operators can agree signals by radio between themselves, as a trained pair does not need a formal plan or coordinated control of the lift

☐ **D)** A written plan is needed only if the cranes are different makes, because matched cranes share a load equally whatever the rigging or lift speed

40. In June, a manager must clear rough grass and scrub from a 0.4 ha plot where a walkover finds slow-worms beneath old roofing felt. He plans to strip it with a bulldozer in one pass, saying slow-worms are common and so unprotected. Which approach best fits the law and good practice?

☐ **A)** Proceed with one pass, because common species are protected only from sale and keeping, not from being harmed by lawful development works

☐ **B)** Hand-pick the animals from under the felt before machines start, then scrape immediately, which removes any risk of an offence on the rest of the plot

☐ **C)** Clear it in midwinter instead, since hibernating reptiles lie deep and are unaffected by surface scraping, so the works would not harm any of them

☐ **D)** Take advice from a qualified ecologist and clear in stages in the active season, with refuges removed, so animals move out before machines arrive

41. A drainage firm's three gangs work on a different customer's site each week and never visit the yard office, where the HSE health and safety law poster hangs. The owner says displaying it there meets the legal duty. What is the correct position?

☐ **A)** A spoken summary of the main duties at the start of each new job is a lawful substitute, as no particular format is required

☐ **B)** A poster no gang ever sees does not count, so each employee should be given the approved leaflet or pocket card

☐ **C)** The duty passes to each customer whose site the gangs visit, because the occupier must inform everyone working on its premises

☐ **D)** A poster in the yard office is enough, because the duty is owed to the company as a whole and not to each employee on its books

42. A contractor strips ceilings in a corridor beside an occupied hospital ward. The risk assessment covers only the operatives' own dust exposure, with FFP3 masks as the control. Several patients on the ward are immunosuppressed. What is the most important omission?

☐ **A)** Nothing is missing, because masks protect those doing the work and the hospital alone is responsible for its patients' safety

☐ **B)** The ward windows should be kept shut during the work, since closing them removes the need for any further dust control measures

☐ **C)** Patients are not considered, so dust must be contained at source with sealed barriers and extraction before it can reach the ward

☐ **D)** A higher-rated mask should be issued to the operatives, since better personal protection also prevents spores leaving the work area

43. A joiner grips a mains drill with a cracked casing, shaking and unable to let go. A colleague reaches him first. What should the colleague do, and what should happen once the joiner is free and says he feels better?

☐ **A)** Isolate or unplug at the supply without touching him, then get him checked medically, as shock can upset the heartbeat

☐ **B)** Cut the drill's cable with the nearest side cutters to end the contact, then watch him on site for an hour before deciding on a medical check

☐ **C)** Pull him clear by his clothing to break contact at once, then let him resume work if he feels well and looks perfectly normal again

☐ **D)** Keep everyone back until an electrician arrives to isolate the supply, then leave it to the joiner whether he sees a doctor

44. A concreter kneels for an hour in wet concrete and wet cement has gone inside his boots. He feels no pain and wants to

finish the pour first. By afternoon his knees are red and sore. What is the correct view?

☐ **A)** Cement only harms skin when it is dry and dusty, so let the concrete dry on his knees and brush it off in the evening

☐ **B)** Wet cement is alkaline and can burn without early pain, so wash with clean water, remove wet clothing, get medical advice

☐ **C)** Rinse his knees with a little solvent from the site store to cut the cement, because water would make the burn spread

☐ **D)** Mild redness from cement is normal for the trade, so apply barrier cream after work and keep using the same boots tomorrow

45. A supervisor notices a normally reliable plumber has become withdrawn, makes errors and has worked long hours on a tight deadline for weeks. A colleague says it is his own business and he should toughen up. What is the best approach?

☐ **A)** Record a warning for his errors, because a formal process will motivate him to improve quality before the deadline

☐ **B)** Move him to a lighter task without discussing it and tell the gang the reason so that they can keep an eye on him

☐ **C)** Talk to him privately, treat work stress as a risk to assess, adjust workload and hours, and point him to support

☐ **D)** Leave him alone since stress is a personal matter outside the employer's duties, and step in only if he asks for help

46. A cleaner is given thin disposable gloves to wipe parts with a solvent, and finds they go soft and tacky within minutes. The supervisor says any glove is fine if the worker changes it when it looks damaged. What is the best response?

☐ **A)** Carry on with the same gloves but double them up, since two thin layers always give the same protection as one thick glove

☐ **B)** Keep to the thin gloves and wash hands afterwards with a hand cleaner, since the gloves are only there for general hygiene

☐ **C)** Use the heaviest leather gloves in the store, because thick material resists any liquid and keeps the hands dry and safe

☐ **D)** Pick gloves from the solvent's safety data sheet by breakthrough time, and replace them before that time has passed



47. Look at the scene. The supervisor says the fitter is properly protected because he wears cut-resistant gloves and safety boots. What is the most significant problem?

☐ **A)** A fixed blade is drawn towards his body, so a retractable knife and cut-away technique should come before gloves

☐ **B)** A longer blade should be fitted so the sheet is sliced in one pass, because shorter exposure time makes the task much safer

☐ **C)** Kneeling on the floor is the problem, so he should cut the sheet on a bench, since posture is the main factor in knife injuries

☐ **D)** The gloves are too thin for blade work, so a heavier leather pair should be issued since hand protection is the main control for knives

48. A steel erector must cross a 12 m run of beams to reach a connection, clipping and unclipping one single lanyard at each bracket as he moves. He says he is clipped on most of the time. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** Each change leaves him unconnected for a moment, so he needs continuous protection such as a twin-tail lanyard or a running line

☐ **B)** Moving unclipped is allowed for experienced steel erectors, as they are competent to judge when a slip is unlikely

☐ **C)** A longer single lanyard solves it, by letting him reach the next bracket before he unclips from the one he is leaving

☐ **D)** Being attached most of the time is acceptable, because a fall is only likely during the few seconds he spends crossing between brackets

49. A supported 2 m trench was inspected at 07:00. At 10:30 a block of soil slumps from one wall into the trench without hurting anyone. The foreman says the morning inspection is valid for the whole shift, so work can resume once the soil is cleared. What is

correct?

☐ **A)** The 07:00 inspection covers the shift, so work can restart once the fallen soil is shovelled out and the gang checks the supports

☐ **B)** Any trained operative may confirm it is safe again, because a competent person is needed only if supports have been removed

☐ **C)** The fall is an event that may affect stability, so a competent person must inspect again and be satisfied before anyone re-enters

☐ **D)** A further inspection is needed at the start of the next shift, since the rules tie checks to shift starts and not to events

50. A fitter must change a wheel on an articulated dumper. He jacks the front axle clear of the ground and works beneath it on level ground with the engine off. He says the jack and the stopped engine make it safe. Which statement is most accurate?

☐ **A)** A jack can slip or fail, so the axle needs rated stands or blocks, and the articulation lock must be fitted to stop folding

☐ **B)** A jack plus the stopped engine is enough on level ground, so nothing more is needed under a raised axle while he works there

☐ **C)** The articulation lock matters only when travelling on slopes, so fitting it for maintenance on level ground is unnecessary extra work

☐ **D)** Chocks on the other wheels replace stands, because a chocked machine cannot move whatever happens to the jack at the raised end of it

Answer Key

1. D — The Management Regulations require health and safety training when new work equipment is introduced, adapted to the changed risks, repeated where appropriate and delivered during working hours.

A: The duty to train in working hours stays with the employer and an operator's agreement cannot move it on. B: Training is also required when new equipment brings new or changed risks, and it cannot be left to voluntary unpaid attendance. C: Experience on the old discs does not cover the new guard and kickback, and leaflets alone are not training.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that experienced workers do not need retraining when the equipment they use changes.

2. C — Substituting equipment removes some exposure but creates new hazards, so the assessment must be reviewed before the work starts, with an exclusion zone and a trained operator.

A: The manufacturer's design does not address the site-specific reach, debris and visibility hazards, which the employer must assess. B: A change of method alters the hazards, and waiting for an injury before reassessing defeats the purpose of assessment. D: The assessment must be suitable and sufficient before the work begins, not after exposure has already happened.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a control which removes people from one hazard has removed every hazard from the task.

3. C — RIDDOR lists hand-arm vibration syndrome as a reportable disease when a doctor diagnoses it in someone whose work regularly involves vibrating tools, whether or not any time is lost.

A: Once an employee gives a written diagnosis, the employer has the duty to make the report. B: RIDDOR also lists specified work-related diseases, and reporting does not depend on lost working days. D: The disease is reportable from regular use of vibrating tools and needs no single named incident.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that RIDDOR reporting applies only to sudden accidents and not to diagnosed work-related diseases.

4. B — Drowsiness and vomiting after a blow to the head can signal bleeding or swelling in the skull, so he needs emergency medical help and constant observation, and the accident must be recorded.

A: Delaying help and moving him unobserved risks collapse on the way; this needs emergency care now. C: Light duties do not treat a possible head injury, and giving medication is not an acceptable first-aid response here. D: Walking away does not exclude serious brain injury, and symptoms like these need urgent medical assessment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging a head injury by whether the person can walk and talk straight afterwards.

5. C — The regulations require avoiding hazardous manual handling where reasonably practicable, then assessing and reducing the remaining risk, including task, load and ground conditions.

A: The individual is only one factor, and the task, load and working environment must also be assessed and improved. B: Rotation shortens each person's exposure but leaves the avoidable hazard and the poor route unchanged. D: Belts are not a proven control and training does not replace avoiding or redesigning the handling operation.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on fit workers, rotation or technique training instead of first asking whether the load can be moved mechanically.

6. A — Fuels are unsuitable cleaning agents because they harm skin and give off flammable vapour, so the substitute should be a proper cleanser and a safer method of cleaning tools.

B: Thin gloves can be permeated by fuel, and the better control is to stop using fuel for cleaning at all. C: Skin damage and absorption happen during contact, so washing afterwards does not undo them and the vapour fire risk remains. D: Diesel also strips skin oils and irritates the skin, so neither fuel is suitable for washing hands or tools.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating fuels as handy cleaning products when they damage skin and give off flammable vapour.

7. A — The regulations apply wherever a fall could cause injury, and the hierarchy is to avoid the work, then prevent falls with collective protection, before relying on personal equipment.

B: The regulations apply at any height and require the hierarchy to be followed, which personal judgement alone does not do. C: No height threshold exists, and a harness ranks below avoidance and collective measures and cannot work with so little fall clearance. D: The rules apply whenever a fall

could cause injury, and footing a ladder does not stop a fall from the roof edge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that work below 2 m is exempt from the Work at Height Regulations.

8. D — A stepladder is a means of access, not a support for a platform, so bridging two with a board gives an unstable and unsuitable work surface that is a common cause of falls.

A: No height of stepladder is designed to carry a board, so taller ones would only increase the fall height. B: Board thickness is not the flaw, because ladders are not designed to support a platform of any thickness. C: A stepladder is not a suitable anchor for fall arrest, and the unsuitable platform itself is the fault to correct.

COMMON MISTAKE: Improvising a working platform from ladders and a board because it looks wide and steady for a short job.

9. A — Free-flowing solids that can engulf a person are a specified risk, and entry should be avoided by doing the work from outside whenever that is possible.

B: Engulfment by loose material is a specified risk whether or not the space is open, and a gas test does not deal with it. C: A rope cannot pull a person out of collapsing material quickly enough, and entry must be avoided if the work can be done from outside. D: Partly emptying does not stop a remaining arch collapsing, and a permit does not replace the duty to avoid entry.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a confined space needs a bad atmosphere, and ignoring engulfment by loose material.

10. D — The risk comes from divided attention rather than hand position, so the employer should stop calls while plant moves and provide safe alternatives such as stopping points or radios.

A: Aids support an alert driver but cannot replace one, and they do not warn of every hazard. B: The employer's health and safety duties apply on site, and distraction is a mental load that a driver cannot reliably judge for himself. C: Lower speed and shorter calls reduce but do not remove the loss of attention, so the moving-plant risk remains.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that hands-free calling is safe because the driver's hands stay on the controls.

11. B — Section 8 makes deliberate or reckless interference with anything provided for safety an offence for any person, with no need for harm, and a sound employer also fixes the access problem that prompted it.

A: Section 8 covers intentional or reckless acts, and no written warning is needed to establish that. C: Workers carry personal duties under the Act, including not interfering with safety provisions, in addition to the employer's duties. D: Section 8 is breached by the interference itself, so the absence of injury does not remove the offence.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that moving a safety barrier is only a problem once somebody has been injured by its absence.

12. A — Removing the beam from eye level and limiting its use controls the hazard at source, whereas the aversion reflex cannot be relied on to prevent a harmful direct exposure.

B: A sign only warns and does not remove the beam from eye level, so it cannot be the sole control. C: Impact eyewear is not designed to filter laser wavelengths, so it gives a false sense of protection. D: The blink reflex is not guaranteed, particularly if someone stares or views the beam through optical aids.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a low-power visible laser is harmless because it looks dim and people will blink away from it.

13. B — Radiography contractors need advance notice and liaison on restricting access to their controlled area, so everyone else on site is excluded while the source is exposed.

A: Scattered radiation can affect people outside the direct beam, so the controlled area has to be kept clear. C: Shielding and distance must be assessed by the contractor, and a wall cannot simply be assumed to make the area outside safe. D: A lead apron worn by someone else gives other workers no protection, and access must be physically controlled.

COMMON MISTAKE: Leaving a specialist contractor to manage their own hazard without telling the other trades who share the site.

14. D — Airless paint leaves the nozzle at a pressure that can inject through skin and glove alike, so the only safe controls are depressurising, locking the trigger and fitting a tip guard.

A: No glove withstands high-pressure injection, so changing glove type does not make wiping a live tip safe. B: The serious danger is injection at the nozzle, which a different suit would not prevent. C: Respiratory protection depends on the coating's assessment, and it is not the most urgent

danger shown in the picture.

COMMON MISTAKE: Believing that wearing gloves makes it safe to touch the tip of a pressurised spray gun.

15. A — Workers must report loss or obvious defects immediately, and the employer must keep PPE in efficient working order and good repair, which includes prompt replacement.

B: The employer must maintain and replace PPE, so the risk cannot simply be passed to the wearer. C: Tape does not restore tested cut resistance, and a defect must be reported immediately and not saved for a later check. D: The employer's duty to maintain and replace PPE continues, and a worker should not be left to source equipment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Patching damaged PPE with tape and carrying on rather than reporting it and swapping it for a sound replacement.

16. B — The inspection report must be given to the person on whose behalf the inspection was carried out within 24 hours and kept at the site until the construction work is finished.

A: Each required inspection must be recorded and reported, and a verbal confirmation does not meet that duty. C: A tag is only evidence of a recent inspection, and the written report is still required. D: The report goes to the person who obtained the inspection, who must keep it on site until the work ends.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a scaffold tag as a substitute for the written inspection report that has to be on site.

17. C — Schedule 5 of the Work at Height Regulations allows work positioning only with a suitable back-up, because a positioning line can slacken or fail and the user may fall.

A: A second line of the same kind on the same anchorage does not arrest a fall if the positioning method fails. B: A back-up is required whatever the height, and the ten-metre threshold is invented. D: A harness improves body support but the positioning system still needs its own separate back-up.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that a tight positioning line, by itself, makes a separate fall-arrest back-up unnecessary.

18. B — A blocked line can hold stored pressure that throws out the plug or whips the hose, so pressure must be released and people kept clear before any coupling is opened.

A: Released pressure can eject the plug and whip the hose unpredictably, so standing to one side is not a control. C: A person cannot restrain a pressurised hose, and holding it places him in the danger zone. D: Continuing to pump into a blockage increases stored pressure and puts workers beside the likely failure point.

COMMON MISTAKE: Opening a blocked pump line quickly to save the pour without first making sure the stored pressure is gone.

19. D — A plate over a live trench must be rated for the traffic and secured so it cannot move, because coning a gap does not stop heavy vehicles shifting or dislodging it.

A: Light vehicles can still catch a loose plate or edge, and the plate must be properly secured before any traffic uses it. B: Surviving traffic overnight proves nothing about its rating, and a plate that has already moved is a clear failure of its securing. C: Stacking plates does not stop movement and can create a trip and a sliding hazard between the layers.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating cones as the fix for a loose road plate instead of securing it and confirming it is rated for the traffic.

20. B — Scrap metal is still waste, so the duty of care applies to its carrier and paperwork, and scrap metal dealers may not pay cash.

A: Scrap sent for recycling is waste in the hands of the site, so the duty of care and records still apply. C: Cash payment for scrap is prohibited whatever the amount, and a note of the van does not prove he is authorised. D: The cash ban and duty of care apply to scrap loads of any size, so no size limit permits this sale.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating valuable scrap as a product to sell for cash to whoever turns up, instead of waste that must go to an authorised carrier.

21. C — A control that cannot be used in practice is a flaw in the assessment, so it must be reviewed with the people doing the work and replaced by one that is workable.

A: Discipline leaves an unworkable control in place and ignores the employer's duty to review an assessment that is no longer valid. B: Leaving the method to individual judgement removes the planned control and leaves the heavy carry unassessed. D: Repeating an impossible instruction does not remove the manual handling risk or make the control achievable.

COMMON MISTAKE: Blaming workers for bypassing a control without asking whether the control was ever practical on that site.

22. C — Fluid forced under the skin by a pinhole leak can destroy deep tissue while the surface looks trivial, so it needs urgent specialist treatment.

A: The small, painless appearance is typical of an injection injury, and delay can lead to amputation. B: Squeezing can drive the fluid further into the tissue, and washing does not remove what is already under the skin. D: Waiting for swelling or pain wastes the critical early hours, and the severity of the injury does not match its look.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging an injury by how small and painless it looks rather than by what was under pressure.

23. D — Where a load could cause injury, the employer should avoid or assess the handling and give information on its weight and heaviest side so the method can be matched to it.

A: The law sets no safe weight, and a single figure ignores the stair route, awkward shape and uneven balance of each crate. B: Testing by feel exposes the person to the risk and does not give the information needed to plan the carry. C: Back belts are not proven to prevent injury and are no substitute for avoiding, assessing and reducing the handling risk.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that telling people to lift carefully, or issuing a support belt, counts as a manual handling control.

24. C — Confusion, sweating and shaking in a person with diabetes suggests low blood sugar, which needs quick sugar and removal from safety-critical work until fully recovered.

A: A person with impaired judgement must not carry out safety-critical lifting duties, even with a second person alongside. B: Delaying treatment while testing for alcohol risks worsening low blood sugar, and the symptoms point to a hypo first. D: Rest alone does not raise blood sugar, so his condition can deteriorate towards unconsciousness.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that confusion and unsteadiness at work must come from alcohol rather than a treatable medical condition.

25. D — Overhead protection that can arrest falling objects, combined with edge protection at source, protects the public where netting and cones cannot.

A: Objects bounce, roll and are carried by wind, and a barrier does not protect against anything that falls. B: Netting does not stop heavy items, and a shouted warning gives too little time for pedestrians to react. C: A canopy that is not designed for impact loads can fail or shatter and drop its own debris onto the walkway.

COMMON MISTAKE: Relying on nets, cones or warnings to protect the public when a falling object needs a physical barrier overhead.

26. D — A ladder used to reach another level should extend at least 1 m above the landing point so that the climber keeps a secure handhold when stepping on or off.

A: A ladder that is tied at the top does not also need footing, which is only a last-resort way of securing it. B: Firm, level paving with a correctly angled, tied ladder gives a stable base, and the real fault is at the top of the ladder. C: Harnesses are not a requirement for climbing a secured ladder, and a lanyard clipped to a ladder gives no real fall protection.

COMMON MISTAKE: Checking the angle, base and tie of a ladder but forgetting that the top must extend above the landing for a handhold.

27. C — Suspected unexploded ordnance can be unstable after decades underground, so it must not be moved or disturbed and the area must be cleared pending specialist disposal.

A: Striking an unknown item is dangerous, and it is impossible to tell from outside whether it is empty or fused. B: Carrying on work and waiting days leaves people near a possible explosive, when the area should be cleared at once. D: Lifting or moving a suspect item can set it off, and the bucket and trench wall should not be disturbed further.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a rusty old object as scrap or as someone else's problem instead of as possibly live ordnance.

28. B — A damaged live cable can energise the machine and the ground nearby, so the operator stays inside, others are kept well away and the supplier is called to make the cable dead.

A: Moving the machine could drag or tear the cable further and increase the danger to everyone close by. C: Stepping from an energised machine to the ground can cause a fatal shock and the area is not safe. D: A cable that has flashed is a continuing danger and burying it hides it from the supplier.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming the danger is over once the bang and flash have stopped.

29. A — Refrigerant gases are strong greenhouse gases that must not be deliberately vented, and recovering them before pipes are cut also avoids a pressurised release.

B: A transfer note does not remove the producer's duty, and the gas must be recovered by qualified people before disposal. C: Deliberately releasing these gases is prohibited wherever it happens, and it also harms the atmosphere. D: There is no small-quantity exemption for deliberate venting, and cutting the pipe has already released the charge.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that gas inside scrap equipment is harmless and will simply blow away.

30. D — Surface-water drains lead to watercourses, so contaminated wash water must be contained and disposed of through a route with consent rather than allowed into them.

A: A sock catches only coarse solids and does nothing to dissolved or very fine pollutants such as lead compounds. B: Detergent adds pollution, and it does not make water containing paint residues acceptable for a surface-water drain. C: Run-off from pressure washing flows freely and is not removed by evaporation, so the paint residues still reach the drain.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a gully sock or a spill kit as enough to let contaminated wash water run into a surface-water drain.

31. D — Regulation 14 of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations requires employees to report serious danger and any shortcoming in the employer's protection arrangements that affects their work.

A: The report must reach the employer or a person nominated to receive such reports, not simply a colleague. B: The duty extends to shortcomings in protection arrangements, not just to harm that has already occurred. C: Employees have their own statutory duty to report, whatever their job title.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that because supervisors walk the site, spotting a failed control is their job alone and not the worker's duty to report.

32. B — Occupational asthma from regular exposure to a known respiratory sensitiser is reportable on a doctor's written diagnosis, and the COSHH duty to review controls protects the others exposed.

A: A written diagnosis from a doctor is exactly what triggers the report; the HSE does not need to confirm causation first. C: Reportable diseases are triggered by the written diagnosis and the type of exposure, not by days lost. D: The employer is the responsible person who must report a diagnosed reportable disease.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a diagnosed work-related illness as a private health matter instead of a trigger to report and to review the controls for everyone exposed.

33. C — The Control of Noise at Work Regulations require the assessment to consider, so far as practicable, any interaction between noise and ototoxic substances used at work.

A: Separate compliance does not rule out additive harm, which the assessment must consider. B: Defenders do nothing about the solvent absorbed by breathing, so the interaction is not removed. D: Some solvents are ototoxic and can damage hearing, so they are relevant to the noise assessment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assessing each hazard in isolation and assuming that their effects on the body never combine.

34. D — Petrol engines give off odourless carbon monoxide, which builds up in enclosed spaces, so work stops, people move to fresh air and a non-combustion tool replaces the cutter.

A: Rotation keeps people exposed to a gas that is dangerous at low levels and has no safe exposure routine. B: Symptoms in one person are a warning for all and the cause must be removed first. C: A dust mask does not filter carbon monoxide gas.

COMMON MISTAKE: Blaming headaches in enclosed spaces on dust when engine exhaust is in use.

35. C — A low-airflow alarm shows the hood is no longer delivering its designed protection, so work stops until the cause is found and corrected.

A: Shorter passes do not restore protection and the wearer still breathes unfiltered dust through the hood. B: Pressure felt by the wearer is not reliable evidence of the minimum airflow the hood needs. D: Dismissing the alarm ignores a warning that protection may have fallen, whatever the

cause.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that powered respiratory equipment keeps protecting the wearer after its airflow warning has sounded.

36. B — The Work at Height Regulations give collective protection priority over personal protection wherever it is reasonably practicable.

A: A rescue plan is needed with harnesses, but it responds to a fall rather than preventing one. C: Personal systems rely on the worker's behaviour and rank below collective measures. D: Inspection of the finished scaffold does not protect erectors from falling while they build it.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a harness as the default protection when erecting scaffolds instead of fitting collective measures ahead of the person.

37. B — Connecting a generator to fixed wiring by a plug-in lead can energise exposed pins and back-feed the supply, so a competent electrician must install an interlocked changeover arrangement.

A: Switching off does not remove the exposed pins, lack of earthing arrangements or the risk of the supply being restored. C: Rating does not remove the exposed live pins or the back-feed to the supply. D: The main danger is to people, and an RCD does not prevent live pins or back-feed.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating a generator as just another socket outlet that can be plugged into fixed wiring with a home-made lead.

38. A — Site dumpers are not built to carry passengers, and anyone riding on the skip is at risk of falling and being run over or crushed.

B: Travelling with the skip raised reduces stability and is not good practice; it is also not what makes this scene dangerous. C: The stack is neat, set back from the track and not the most significant hazard in the picture. D: A banksman is not the key issue on a clear, level track; the bigger fault is people on the machine.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a short journey on firm, level ground makes it acceptable to let colleagues ride on plant not built for passengers.

39. A — The HSE treats multi-crane lifts as complex, requiring a written plan from someone with specific competence because load sharing changes as the lift proceeds.

B: Capacity of each crane alone does not control how the load shifts between them as they lift and slew. C: Complex lifts need a written plan and suitable supervision rather than informal agreement between operators. D: Equal sharing cannot be assumed, even with identical cranes, so every tandem lift needs planning.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that two competent operators with adequate cranes can safely share a load without a specific plan.

40. D — Native reptiles are protected from intentional killing and injury under the Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981, and phased clearance in the active season reduces harm.

A: Intentional killing or injuring is itself an offence, and being common gives no exemption. B: Picking up a few visible animals does not clear the rest of the site, and handling may itself need a licence. C: Hibernating reptiles are vulnerable to being crushed or exposed, so winter clearance is not safer.

COMMON MISTAKE: Thinking that a species being common means it has no legal protection when works kill or injure it.

41. B — Employers must either display the approved poster where employees can read it or give each employee the approved leaflet, and a poster in a yard nobody visits achieves neither.

A: The regulations specify the approved poster or leaflet, so a verbal summary does not satisfy them. C: The employer's duty to inform its own employees is not transferred to the occupier of the premises they visit. D: The information duty is owed to every employee, so it must actually reach them wherever they work.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming a poster on the wall of a base office informs employees who spend their working week on other people's sites.

42. C — Employers must assess risks to non-employees affected by their work, and for vulnerable patients this means containing dust at source rather than relying on masks worn by the workers.

A: The contractor owes a duty to others affected by its work, and masks do nothing to stop dust spreading. B: Dust travels through doors, corridors and ventilation, so shut windows alone do not stop it reaching patients. D: Masks protect only the wearer, while dust on clothing and in the air still

spreads from the work area.

COMMON MISTAKE: Writing the assessment around the workers' own exposure and forgetting vulnerable people nearby who can be harmed by the same dust.

43. A — Touching a casualty still in contact with the supply risks a second victim, and electric shock can cause heart rhythm problems that are not obvious at first.

B: Cutting a live cable is itself dangerous, and observation on site is no substitute for a medical check. C: Touching him while he is live endangers the rescuer, and feeling well does not exclude delayed heart effects. D: Leaving him in contact while waiting is dangerous, and the decision to seek care should not rest with the casualty.

COMMON MISTAKE: Rushing to grab a shock victim before the supply is off, then assuming no treatment is needed because the casualty looks fine.

44. B — Cement burns can develop painlessly over hours, so affected skin is washed thoroughly, soaked clothing and boots are removed, and medical advice is sought, with proper waterproof PPE used in future.

A: Wet cement is the main cause of burns, and leaving it on the skin makes injury worse. C: Solvents irritate skin further and do nothing helpful; copious clean water is the standard treatment. D: Redness may be a chemical burn, and barrier cream does not treat it or make wet boots safe.

COMMON MISTAKE: Waiting for pain before treating skin that has been in contact with wet cement.

45. C — Employers must assess and manage work-related stress like other health risks, which means a private conversation, changes to workload and hours, and access to support.

A: Discipline adds pressure and ignores the likely cause of the errors. B: Telling colleagues breaches his privacy and acting without talking to him may not tackle the cause. D: Work-related stress is a health risk that the employer must manage.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating signs of work-related stress as a personal weakness rather than a hazard to manage.

46. D — Solvents can pass through some glove materials without visible damage, so gloves are chosen for the substance using safety data and breakthrough times and replaced on schedule.

A: Doubling gloves of the wrong material still lets the solvent through to the skin. B: Washing afterwards does not stop skin absorbing the solvent while the work is going on. C: Leather absorbs solvents and holds them against the skin, so thickness is not the right test.

COMMON MISTAKE: Judging chemical glove protection by how thick or intact the glove looks.

47. A — PPE is the last line of defence, and the safer tool and cutting method remove the hazard of the blade travelling towards the body and the guiding hand.

B: A longer exposed blade increases the injury potential and does not change the direction of cut or the guiding hand position. C: Posture matters for strain, but the exposed blade drawn towards the body is the main cause of knife injury here. D: Heavier gloves would still be PPE, which ranks below changing the tool and technique, and they would reduce his grip and feel.

COMMON MISTAKE: Assuming that gloves and boots make unsafe cutting practice acceptable.

48. A — A fall can happen at any moment, so a system that keeps at least one connection attached throughout movement is required rather than one that leaves gaps.

B: Competence does not remove the need for continuous protection, since falls are caused by unexpected slips and trips. C: A longer lanyard increases the fall distance and still does not give him a second connection at the point of transfer. D: A fall is possible at any moment, and the unprotected seconds are exactly when it can happen.

COMMON MISTAKE: Accepting short gaps in connection while moving between anchors because the unprotected time seems brief.

49. C — Excavations must be inspected at the start of each shift and after any event likely to affect strength or stability, including a fall of earth, before work continues.

A: An earth fall is a trigger for a fresh inspection, so the morning inspection does not cover it. B: The inspection must be done by a competent person, whatever the condition of the supports. D: Inspection is also required after events affecting stability, not only at the start of each shift.

COMMON MISTAKE: Treating the start-of-shift inspection as covering everything that happens until the end of the shift.

50. A — Raised plant must be supported by suitably rated stands or blocks rather than a jack alone, and the articulation lock prevents the machine pivoting while someone is working under it.

B: A jack alone is not a safe support to work beneath, and level ground does not prevent it failing or slipping. C: The lock is also a maintenance safeguard, preventing the frame from pivoting while someone works near the joint or beneath. D: Chocks stop rolling but do nothing if the jack fails and the raised axle drops onto the person below.

COMMON MISTAKE: Trusting a jack and a stopped engine to hold a raised machine while working beneath it.